

The Lay of
Gavelok the Dane.

Early English Text Society.

Extra Series. No. IV.

1868.

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HAVELOK THE DANE ***

This text includes characters that require UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

œ : “oe” ligature

Ʒ, þ, ƿ, ƿ, æ : yogh, wynn, long s, accented æ

These characters, as well as a single Greek phrase, occur only in the notes, not in the poem itself. If any of the characters do not display properly, or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

Corrections made by the transcriber are marked with mouse-hover popups; editorial corrections from the Emendations section are similarly marked.

Anglo-Saxon diphthongs are written as **eá**, **eó** with stress on second vowel. The form “hung” (with the meaning “hanged”) is used consistently. A number of Glossary entries are missing the part of speech, usually *n*. They have not been individually noted.

One minor typographic change was made in the modern material. Where Roman (upright) type represents “double italics”, it is *shown instead as **bold** within italics*.

A few French passages in the Preface use a trailing tilde ~, as in the word “q~”. In the original, the ~ was attached to the preceding letter, but not directly above it.

All square brackets [] are in the original.

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The original book (EETS E.S. 4, 1868, ed. Skeat) exists in at least two forms. See the [end of the e-text](#) for details.

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The Lay of

Gavelok the Dane:

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FORMERLY EDITED BY SIR F. MADDEN FOR THE ROXBURGHE CLUB,

AND NOW RE-EDITED FROM THE UNIQUE MS. LAUD MISC. 108,
IN THE BODLEIAN LIBRARY, OXFORD;

BY THE

REV. WALTER W. SKEAT, M.A.,

AUTHOR OF "A MÆSO-GOTHIC GLOSSARY," EDITOR OF "PIERS PLOWMAN,"
"WILLIAM OF PALERNE," &c.



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PREFACE.

§ 1. THE English version of the Lay of Havelok, now here reprinted, is one of the few poems that have happily been recovered, after having long been given up as lost. Tyrwhitt, in his Essay on the Language and Versification of Chaucer, has a footnote (No. 51) deploring the loss of the Rime concerning Gryme the Fisher, the founder of Grymesby, Hanelok [*read* Havelok] the Dane, and his wife Goldborough; and Ritson, in his Dissertation on Romance and Minstrelsy—(vol. i. p. lxxxviii. of his Metrical Romanceës)—makes remarks to the same effect. It was at length, however, discovered by accident in a manuscript belonging to the Bodleian library, which had been described in the old Catalogue merely as *Vitæ Sanctorum*, a large portion of it being occupied by metrical legends of the Saints. In 1828, it was edited for the Roxburghe Club by Sir F. Madden, the title-page of the edition being as follows:— “The Ancient English Romance of Havelok the Dane, accompanied by the French Text: with an introduction, notes, and a glossary, by Frederick Madden, Esq., F.A.S. F.R.S.L., Sub-Keeper of the MSS. in the British Museum. Printed for the Roxburghe Club, London. W. Nicol, Shakspeare Press, MDCCCXXVIII.” This volume contains a very complete Introduction, pp. i-lvi; the English version of Havelok, pp. 1-104; the French text of the Romance of Havelok, from a MS. in the Herald’s College, pp. 105-146; the French Romance of Havelok, as abridged and altered by Geffrei Gaimar, pp. 147-180; notes to the English text, pp. 181-207; notes to the French text, pp. 208-210; and a glossary, &c., pp. 211-263. But there are sometimes bound up with it two pamphlets, viz. “Remarks on the Glossary to Havelok,” by S. W. Singer, and an “Examination of the Remarks, &c.,” by the Editor of Havelok. In explanation of this, it may suffice to say, that the former contains some criticisms by Mr Singer

(executed in a manner suggestive of an officious wish to display superior critical acumen), of which a few are correct, but others are ludicrously false; whilst the latter is a vindication of the general correctness of the explanations given, and contains, incidentally, some valuable contributions to our general etymological knowledge, and various remarks which have proved of service in rendering the glossary in the present edition more exactly accurate. ¹

§ 2. Owing to the scarcity of copies of this former edition, the committee of the Early English Text Society, having first obtained the approval of Sir Frederic Madden, resolved upon issuing a reprint of it; and Sir Frederic having expressed a wish that the duty of seeing it through the press should be entrusted to myself, I gladly undertook that responsibility. He has kindly looked over the revises of the whole work, ² but as it has undergone several modifications, it will be the best plan to state in detail what these are.

§ 3. With respect to the text, the greatest care has been taken to render it, as nearly as can be represented in print, an exact copy of the MS. The text of the former edition is exceedingly correct, and the alterations here made are few and of slight importance. Sir F. Madden furnished me with some, the results of a re-comparison, made by himself, of his printed copy with the original; besides this, I have myself carefully read the proof sheets with the MS. *twice*, and it may therefore be assumed that the complete correctness of the text is established. It seems to me that this is altogether the most important part of the work of a *Text Society*, in order that the student may never be perplexed by the appearance of words having no real existence. For a like reason the letters þ and p (the latter of which I have represented by an italic w) have now been inserted wherever they occur, and the expansions of abbreviations are now denoted by italics. For further remarks upon the text, see the description of the MS. below, § 26. Sidenotes and headlines have been added, but the numbering of the lines has not been altered. The French text of the romance, the title of which is *Le Lai de Aveloc*, and the abridgment of the story by Geffrei Gaimar, have not been here reprinted; the fact being, that the French and English versions differ very widely, and that the passages of the French which really correspond to the English are few and short. *All* of these will be found in the Notes, in

their proper places, and it was also deemed the less necessary to print the French text, because it is tolerably accessible; for it may be found either in vol. i. of *Monumenta Historica Britannica*, ed. Petrie, 1848, in the reprint by M. Michel (1833) entitled “*Le Lai d’Havelok*,” or in the edition by Mr T. Wright for the Caxton Society, 1850. An abstract of it is given at p. xxiii. The Notes are abridged from Sir F. Madden’s, with but a very few additions by myself, which are distinguished by being placed within square brackets. The Glossarial Index is, for the most part, reprinted from Sir F. Madden’s Glossary, but contains a large number of *slight* alterations, re-arrangements, and additions. The references have nearly all been verified,³ and the few words formerly left unexplained are now either wholly or partially solved. I have now only to add that a large portion of the remainder of this preface, especially that which concerns the historical and traditional evidences of the story (§ 4 to § 18), is abridged or copied from Sir F. Madden’s long Introduction, which fairly exhausts the subject.⁴ All extracts included between marks of quotation are taken from it without alteration. But I must be considered responsible for the rearrangement of the materials, and I have added a few remarks from other sources.

§ 4. NOTICES OF THE STORY OF HAVELOK BY EARLY WRITERS. There can be little doubt that the tradition must have existed from Anglo-Saxon times, but the earliest mention of it is presented to us in the full account furnished by the French version of the Romance. Of this there are two copies, one of which belongs to Sir T. Phillipps; the other is known as the Arundel or Norfolk MS., and is preserved in the Heralds’ College, where it is marked E. D. N. No. 14; the various editions of the latter have been already enumerated in § 3. This version was certainly composed within the first half of the twelfth century. From the fact that it is entitled a *Lai*, and from the assertion of the poet—“*Qe vn lai en firent li Breton*”—“whereof the Britons made a lay”—we easily conclude that it was drawn from a British source. From the evident connection of the story with the Chronicle called the *Brut*, we may further conclude that by *Breton* is not meant Armorican, but belonging to *Britain*. The story is in no way connected with France; the tradition is British or Welsh, and the French version was doubtless written in England by a subject of an English king. That the language is French is due merely to the accident that the Norman conquerors of England had acquired that

language during their temporary sojourn in France. From every point of view, whether we regard the British tradition, the Anglo-Norman version, or the version printed in the present volume, the story is wholly English. It is not to be connected too closely with the Armorican lays of Marie *de France*.⁵

§ 5. We next come to the abridgment of the same as made by Geffrei Gaimar, who wrote between the years 1141 and 1151. In one place, Geffrei quotes Gildas as his authority, but no conclusion can easily be drawn from this indefinite reference. In another place, he mentions a feast given by Havelok after his defeat of Hodulf— *si cum nus dit la verai estoire*— “as the true history tells us.” As this feast is not mentioned in the fuller French version, and yet reappears in the English text, we perceive that he had some additional source of information; and this is confirmed by the fact that he mentions several additional details, also not found in the completer version. That the lay of Havelok, as found in Gaimar, is really his, and not an interpolation by a later hand, may fairly be inferred from his repeated allusions to the story in the body of his work. There are three MS. copies containing Gaimar’s abridgment, of which the best is the Royal MS. (Bibl. Reg. 13 A. xxi.) in the British Museum; the two others belong respectively to the Dean and Chapter of Durham (its mark being C. iv. 27) and to the Dean and Chapter of Lincoln (its mark being H. 18). It is curious that the Norfolk MS. contains not only the fuller French version of the story, but also the Brut of Wace, and the continuation of it by Gaimar. Gaimar’s abridgment, as printed in Sir F. Madden’s edition, is taken from the Royal MS., supplemented by the Durham and Lincoln MSS. See also Monumenta Historica Britannica, vol. i. p. 764. It is important to mention that Gaimar speaks of the Danes as having been in Norfolk since the time that Havelok was King, after he has been relating the combats between the Britons and the Saxons under the command of Cerdic and Cynric. Another allusion makes Havelok to have lived long before the year 800, according to every system of chronology.

§ 6. The next mention of Havelok is in the French Chronicle of Peter de Langtoft, of Langtoft in Yorkshire, who died early in the reign of Edward II., and whose Chronicle closes with the death of Edward I. Here the only

trace of the story is in the mention of “Gountere le pere Havelok, de Danays Ray clamez”—Gunter, father of Havelok, called King of the Danes. The allusion is almost valueless from its evident absurdity; for he confounds Gunter with the Danish invader defeated by Alfred, and who is variously called Godrum, Gudrum, Guthrum, or Gurmound. He must have been thinking, at the moment, of a very different Gurmund, viz. the King of the Africans, as he is curiously called, whose terrible devastations are described very fully in *Lazamon*, vol. iii. pp. 156-177, and who may fairly be supposed to have lived much nearer to the time of Havelok; and he must further have confounded this Gurmund with Gunter. For the account of Robert of Brunne’s translation of Langtoft’s Chronicle, see below, § 10.

§ 7. But soon after this, we come to a most curious account. In MS. Harl. 902 is a late copy, on paper, of a Chronicle called *Le Bruit Dengleterre*, or otherwise *Le Petit Bruit*, compiled A.D. 1310, by Meistre Rauf de Boun, at the request of Henry de Lacy, earl of Lincoln. It is a most worthless compilation, put together in defiance of all chronology, but with respect to our present inquiry it is full of interest, as it soon becomes obvious that one of his sources of information is the very English version here printed, which he cites by the name of *l’estorie de Grimesby*, and which is thus proved to have been written before the year 1310. “The Chronicler,” says Sir F. Madden, “commences, as usual, with Brute, B.C. 2000, and after taking us through the succeeding reigns to the time of Cassibelin, who fought with Julius Cæsar, informs us, that after Cassibelin’s death came Gurmound out of Denmark, who claimed the throne as the son of the eldest daughter of Belin, married to Thorand, King of Denmark. He occupies the kingdom 57 years, and is at length slain at *Hunteton*, called afterwards from him *Gurmoundcestre*. He is succeeded by his son Frederick, who hated the English, and filled his court with Danish nobles, but who is at last driven out of the country, after having held it for the short space of 71 years. And then, adds this miserable History-monger: ‘Et si entendrez vous, que par cel primer venue de auaunt dit Roy Gormound, et puis par cele hountoux exil de son fitz Frederik, si fu le rancour de Daneis vers nous enpendaunt, et le regne par cel primere accion vers nous enchalangount plus de sept C auns apre, iekis a la venue Haneloke, fitz le Roy Birkenebayne de Dannemarche, q~ le regne par mariage entra de sa femme.’ —f. 2 b.

“After a variety of equally credible stories, we come to Adelstan II. ⁶ son of Edward [the Elder], who corresponds with the real king of that name, A.D. 925-941. He is succeeded by his son [brother] Edmund, who reigned four years [A.D. 941-946], and is said to have been *poisoned* at Canterbury; after whom we have ADELWOLD, whose identity with the Athelwold of the English Romance, will leave no doubt as to the source whence the writer drew great part of his materials in the following passage:

‘Après ceo vient Adelwold son fitz q~ reigna xvj et demie, si engendroit ij feiz et iij filis, dount trestoutz murrerent frechement fors q~ sa pune file, le out a nom *Goldburgh*, del age de vj aunz kaunt son pere Adelwold morust. Cely Roy Adelwold quant il doit morir, comaunda sa file a garder a vn Count de Cornewayle, al heure kaunt il quidou~ie (sic) hountousment auoir deparagé, quaut fit *Haueloke*, fitz le Roy Byrkenbayne de Denmarche, esposer le, encountre sa volonté, q~ primis fuit Roy Dengleterre et de Denmarch tout a vn foitz, par quele aliaunce leis Daneis queillerunt g^endr~ (sic) mestrie en Engleterre, et long temps puise le tindrunt, *si cum vous nounce l’estorie de Grimesby*, come *Grime* primez nurist Haueloke en Engleterre, depuis cel heure q’il feut chasé de Denmarche &c. deqis al heure q’il vint au chastelle de Nichole, q~ cely auaunt dit traître *Goudriche* out en garde, en quel chastel il auaunt dit Haueloke espousa l’auaunt dit Goldeburgh, q~ fuit heir Dengleterre. Et par cel reson tynt cely Haueloke la terre de Denmarche auxi comme son heritage, et Engleterre auxi par mariage de sa femme; et si entendrez vous, q~ par la reson q~ ly auaunt dit Gryme ariua primez, kaunt il amena l’enfaunt Haueloke hors de Denmarche, par meyme la reson reseut cele vile son nom, de Grime, quel noun ly tint vnquore Grimisby.

‘Après ceo regna meyme cely Haueloke, q~ mult fuit prodhomme, et droiturelle, et bien demenoit son people en reson et ley. Cel Roy Haueloke reigna xlj. aunz, si engendroit ix fitz et vij filis, dount trestoutz murrerount ainz q~ furunt d’age, fors soulement iiij de ses feitz, dont l’un out a noum Gurmound, cely q~ entendy auoir son heire en Engleterre; le secound out a noun Knout, quen fitz feffoit son pere en le regne de Denmarche, quant il estoit del age de xvij aunz, et ly mesme se tynt a la coroune Dengleterre, quel terre il entendy al oepe son ainez fitz Gurmound auoir gardé. Mes il debusa son col auxi comme il feu mounté vn cheval testous q~ poindre volleyt, en l’an de son regne xxij entrant. Le tiers fitz ont a noun Godard, q~ son pere feffoit de la Seneschacie Dengleterre, q~ n’auo~ut (sic) taunt come ore fait ly quart. Et le puisnez fitz de toutz out a noum Thorand, q~ espousa la Countesse de Hertouwe en Norway. Et par la reson q~ cely Thorand feut enherité en la terre de Norway, ly et ses successours sont enheritez iekis en sa p~ce (sic) toutdis, puis y auoit affinité de alliaunce entre ceulx de Denmarche et ceulx de Norway, a checun venue q~ vnkes firent en ceste terre pur chalenge ou clayme mettre, iekis a taunt q~ lour accion feut enseyne destrut par vn noble chevallere *Guy de Warwike*, &c. Et tout en sy feffoit Haueloke sez quatre fitz: si gist a priorie de *Grescherche* en Loundrez.’ —f. 6 b.

“The *Estorie de Grimesby* therefore, referred to above, is the identical English Romance before us, and it is no less worthy of remark, that the whole of the passage just quoted, with one single variation of import, has been literally translated by Henry de Knyghton, and inserted in his

Chronicle.⁷ Of the sources whence the information respecting Havelok's sons is derived, we are unable to offer any account, as no trace of it occurs either in the French or English texts of the story."

§ 8. "About the same time at which Rauf de Boun composed his Chronicle, was written a brief Genealogy of the British and Saxon Kings, from Brutus to Edward II., preserved in the same MS. in the Heralds' College which contains the French text of the Romance. The following curious rubric is prefixed:— *La lignée des Bretons et des Engleis, queus il furent, et de queus nons, et coment Brut vint premerement en Engleterre, et combien de tens puis, et dont il vint. Brut et Cornelius furent chevalers chacez de la bataille de Troie, M. CCCC. XVII. anz deuant qe dieus nasquit, et vindrent en Engleterre, en Cornewaille, et riens ne fut trouee en la terre fors qe geanz, Geomagog, Hastripoldius, Ruscalbundy, et plusurs autres Geanz.* In this Genealogy no mention of Havelok occurs under the reign of Constantine, but after the names of the Saxon Kings Edbright and Edelwin, we read: 'ATHELWOLD auoit vne fille *Goldeburgh*, et il regna vi. anz. HAUELOC esposa meisme cele *Goldeburgh*, et regna iij. anz. ALFRED le frere le Roi Athelwold enchaca Haeloc par Hunehere, et il fut le primer Roi corone de l'apostolle, et il regna xxx. anz.' —fol. 148 b. By this account Athelwold is clearly identified with Ethelbald, King of Wessex, who reigned from 855 to 860, whilst Havelok is substituted in the place of Ethelbert and Ethered."

§ 9. "Not long after the same period was written a Metrical *Chronicle of England*, printed by Ritson, Metr. Rom. V. ii. p. 270. Two copies are known to exist,⁸ the first concluding with the death of Piers Gavestone, in 1313 (MS. Reg. 12. C. xii.), and the other continued to the time of Edw. III. (Auchinleck MS.). The period of Havelok's descent into England is there ascribed to the reign of King Ethelred (978-1016), which will very nearly coincide with the period assigned by Rauf de Boun, viz. A.D. 963-1004."

‘ *Haeloc* com tho to this lond,
With gret host & eke strong,
Ant sloh the Kyng Achelred,
At Westmustre he was ded,
Ah he heuede reigned her

Seuene an tuenti fulle 3er.^{.....}

MS. Reg. 12. C. xii.

“This date differs from most of the others, and appears founded on the general notion of the Danish invasions during that period.”

§ 10. Before proceeding to consider the *prose* Chronicle of the Brute, it is better to speak first of the translation of Peter de Langtoft's Chronicle by Robert of Brunne, a translation which was completed A.D. 1338. At p. 25 of Hearne's edition is the following passage:

‘ 3it a nother Danes Kyng in the North gan aryue.
Alfrid it herd, thidere gan he dryue.
Hauelok ⁹ fader he was, *Gunter* was his name.
He brent citees & tounes, ouer alle did he schame.
Saynt Cutbertes clerkes tho Danes thei dred.
The toke the holy bones, about thei tham led.
Seuen 3ere thorgh the land wer thei born aboute,
It comforted the kyng mykelle, whan he was in doute
¶ Whan Alfrid & Gunter had werred long in ille,
Thorgh the grace of God, Gunter turned his wille.
Cristend wild he be, the kyng of fonte him lift,
& thritty of his knyghtes turnes, thorgh Godes gift.
Tho that first were foos, and com of paien lay,
Of Cristen men haf los, & so thei wend away.’

“This is the whole that appears in the original, but after the above lines immediately follows, in the language of Robert of Brunne himself (as noted also by Hearne, Pref. p. lxvii.), the following curious, and to our inquiry, very important passage:”

‘ Bot I haf grete ferly, that I fynd no man,
That has writen in story, how *Hauelok* this lond wan.
Noither *Gildas*, no Bede, no Henry of Huntinton,
No William of Malmesbiri, ne Pers of Bridlynton,
Writes not in ther bokes of no kyng Athelwold,
Ne Goldeburgh his douhtere, ne *Hauelok* not of told,
Whilk tyme the were kynges, long or now late,

Thei mak no menyng whan, no in what date.
Bot that thise *lowed men vpon English tellis*,
Right story can me not ken, the certeynte what spellis.
Men sais in Lyncoln castelle ligges 3it a stone,
That Haelok kast wele forbi euer ilkone
& 3it the chapelle standes, ther he weddid his wife,
Goldeburgh the kynges douhter, *that saw is 3it rife*.
& of Gryme a fisshere, *men redes 3it in ryme*,
That he bigged Grymesby Gryme that ilk tyme.
Of alle stories of honoure, that I haf thorgh souht,
I fynd that no compiloure of him tellis ouht.
Sen I fynd non redy, that tellis of Haelok kynde
Turne we to that story, that we writen fynde.'

“There cannot exist the smallest doubt, that by the ‘Ryme’ here mentioned ‘that lowed men vpon English tellis,’ the identical English Romance, now before the reader, is referred to. It must therefore certainly have been composed prior to the period at which Robert of Brunne wrote, ¹⁰ in whose time the traditions respecting Havelok at Lincoln were so strongly preserved, as to point out various localities to which the story had affixed a name, and similar traditions connected with the legend, as we shall find hereafter, existed also at Grimsby. The doubts expressed by the Chronicler, as to their authenticity, or the authority of the ‘Ryme,’ are curious, but only of value so far as they prove he was ignorant of the existence of a French Romance on the subject, or of its reception in Gaimar’s historical poem.”

§ 11. “But on consulting the Lambeth copy of Rob. of Brunne, in order to verify the passage as printed by Hearne from the Inner Temple MS. we were not a little surprised to ascertain a fact hitherto overlooked, and indeed unknown, viz. that the Lambeth MS. (which is a folio, written on paper, and imperfect both at the beginning and close) ¹¹ does not correspond with the Edition, but has evidently been revised by a later hand, which has abridged the Prologues, omitted some passages, and inserted others. The strongest proof of this exists in the passage before us, in which the Lambeth MS. entirely omits the lines of Rob. of Brunne respecting the authenticity of the story of Havelok, and in their place substitutes an abridged outline of the

story itself, copied apparently from the French Chronicle of Gaimar. The interpolation is so curious, and so connected with our inquiry, as to be a sufficient apology for introducing it here.”

‘ ¶ Forth wente Gounter & his folk, al in to Denemark,
Sone fel ther hym vpon, a werre styth & stark,
Thurgh a Breton kyng, th^t out of Ingeland cam,
& asked the tribut of Denmark, th^t Arthur whylom nam.
They wythseide hit schortly, & non wolde they 3elde,
But rather they wolde dereyne hit, wyth bataill y the
felde.

Both partis on a day, to felde come they stronge,
Desconfit were the danes, Gounter his deth gan fonge.
When he was ded they schope brynge, al his blod to
schame,
But Gatferes doughter the kyng, *Eleyne* was hure name,
Was kyng Gounteres wyf, and had a child hem
bytwene,
Wyth wham scheo scapede vnethe, al to the se with
tene.

The child hym highte HAUELOK, th^t was his moder dere,
Scheo mette with grym atte hauene, a wel god marinere,
He hure knew & highte hure wel, to helpe hure with his
might,
To bryng hure saf out of the lond, wythinne th^t ilke
night.

When they come in myd se, a gret meschef gan falle,
They metten wyth a gret schip, lade wyth outlawes alle.
Anon they fullen hem apon, & dide hem Mikel peyne,
So th^t wyth strengthe of their assault, ded was quene
Eleyne.

But 3yt ascapede from hem Grym, wyth Haelok &
other fyue,
& atte the hauene of Grymesby, ther they gon aryue.
Ther was brought forth child Haelok, wyth Grym &
his fere,

Right als hit hadde be ther own, for other wyste men
nere.

Til he was mykel & mighti, & man of mykel cost,
Th^t for his grete sustinaunce, nedly serue he most.
He tok leue of Grym & Seburc, as of his sire & dame,
And askede ther blessinge curteysly, ther was he nought
to blame.

Thenne drow he forth northward, to kynges court
Edelsie,

Th^t held fro Humber to Rotland, the kyngdam of
Lyndesye.

Thys Edelsy of Breton kynde, had Orewayn his sister
bright

Maried to a noble kyng, of Northfolk Egelbright.
Holly for his kyngdam, he held in his hand,
Al the lond fro Colchestre, right in til Holand.

Thys Egelbright th^t was a Dane, & Orewayn the quene,
Hadden gete on Argill, a doughter hem bytwene.
Sone then deyde Egelbright, & his wyf Orewayn,
& therfore was kyng Edelsye, bothe joyful & fayn.
Anon their doughter & here Eyr, his nece dame Argill,
& al the kyngdam he tok in hande, al at his owene will.
Ther serued Haelok as quistron, & was y-cald
Coraunt,

He was ful mykel & hardy, & strong as a Geaunt.
He was bold Curteys & fre, & fair & god of manere,
So th^t alle folk hym louede, th^t auewest hym were.
But for couetise of desheraison, of damysele Argill,
& for a chere th^t the kyng sey, scheo made Coraunt till,
He dide hem arraye ful symplely, & wedde togydere
bothe,

For he ne rewarded desparagyng, were manion ful
wrothe.

A while they dwelt after in court, in ful pore degre,

The schame & sorewe th^t Argill hadde, hit was a deol to
se.

Then seyde scheo til hure maister, of whenne sire be 3e?
Haue 3e no kyn ne frendes at hom, in 3oure contre?
Leuer were me lyue in pore lyf, wythoute schame &
tene,

Than in schame & sorewe, lede the astat of quene.
Thenne wente they forth to Grymesby, al by his wyues
red,

& founde th^t Grym & his wyf, weren bothe ded.
But he fond ther on Aunger, Grymes cosyn hend,
To wham th^t Grym & his wyf, had teld word & ende.
How th^t hit stod wyth Haelok, in all manere degre,
& they hit hym telde & conseilled, to drawe til his
contre,

Tasaye what grace he mighte fynde, among his frendes
there,

& they wolde ordeyne for their schipyng, and al th^t
hem nede were.

When Aunger hadde y-schiped hem, they seilled forth
ful swythe,

Ful-but in til Denemark, wyth weder fair & lithe.
Ther fond he on sire Sykar, a man of gret pousté,
Th^t hey styward somtyme was, of al his fader fe.
Ful fayn was he of his comyng, & god help him
behight,

To recouere his heritage, of Edulf kyng & knyght.
Sone asembled they gret folk, of his sibmen & frendes,
Kyng Edulf gadered his power, & ageyn them wendes.
Desconfyt was ther kyng Edulf, & al his grete bataill,
& so conquered Haelok, his heritage saunz faille.
Sone after he schop him gret power, in toward
Ingelond,

His wyues heritage to wynne, ne wolde he nought
wonde.

Th^t herde the kyng of Lyndeseye, he was come on th^t
 cost,
 & schop to fighte wyth hym sone, & gadered hym gret
 host.
 But atte day of bataill, Edelsy was desconfit,
 & after by tretys gaf Argentill, hure heritage al quit.
 & for scheo was next of his blod, Haelokes wyf so
 feyr,
 He gaf hure Lyndesey after his day, & made hure his
 Eyr.
 & atte last so byfel, th^t vnder Haelokes schelde,
 Al Northfolk & Lyndeseye, holy of hym they helde.’
 MS. Lamb. 131. leaf 76.

§ 12. We now come to the prose Chronicle called *The Brute*, which became exceedingly popular, and was the foundation of “Caxton’s Chronicle,” first printed by Caxton A.D. 1480, but of which Caxton was not the author, though he may have added some of the last chapters. The original is in French, and was probably compiled a few years *before* Robert of Brunne’s translation of Langtoft was made, as it concludes with the year 1331, or, in some copies, with 1332. The author of it is not known, but it was probably only regarded as a compilation from the Chronicles of the earlier Historians. “In this Chronicle, in all its various shapes, is contained the Story of Havelock, *engrafted on the British History of Geoffrey of Monmouth*, and in its detail, following precisely the French text of the Romance. The only variation of consequence is the substitution of the name of Birkabeyn (as in the English text) for that of Gunter, and in some copies, both of the French and English MSS. of the Chronicle, the name of *Goldeburgh* is inserted instead of *Argentille*; which variations are the more curious, as they prove the absolute identity of the story. For the sake of a more complete illustration of what has been advanced, we are induced to copy the passage at length, as it appears in the French Chronicle, taken from a well-written MS. of the 14th century, MS. Reg. 20 A 3, fol. 165 b.” ¹²

‘Des Rois Adelbriht & Edelfi, Cap. III^{xx}. XIX.

Après le Roi Constantin estoient deux Rois en graunt Brutaigne, dount li vns out a noun Adelbriht, & fust Danois, & [tint] tut le pais de Norff' & de Suffolk, & ly altre out a noun Edelfi, qe fust Brittone, & tint Nicol & Lindesey, & tote la terre desques a Humber, Ceux deux Rois soi entreguerroierent, [& moult s'entrehaierent] mais puis furent il entre acordez & soi entreamerent, taunt com s'il vssent estee freres de vn ventre neez. Le Roi Edelfi out vne soer, Orewenne par noun, & la dona par grant amour al Roi Adelbriht a femme. Et il engendra de ly vne fille qe out a noun Argentille. En le tieriez an apres vne greue Maladie ly suruint, si deuerait morrir, & maunda par vn iour al Roi Edelfi, soun frere en lei, q'il venist a ly parler, & cil ly emparla volentiers. Donqe ly pria le Roi Adelbriht et ly coniuira en le noun [de] Dieu, q'il apres sa mort preist Argentille sa fille, & sa terre, & q'il la feist honestement garder [& nurrir] en sa chambre, & quant ele serreit de age, q'il la feist marier al plus fort hom & plus vaillaunt q'il porroit trouer, & qe a donqe ly rendist sa terre. Edelfi ceo graunta, & par serment afferma sa priere. Et quant Adelbriht fust mort, & enterree, Edelfi prist la damoysele, & la norrist en sa chambre, si deuynt ele la plus beale creature qe hom porreit trouer.

Coment le Roi Edelfi Maria la damoisele Argentille a vn quistroun de sa quisine. Cap^m. C.

Le Roi Edelfi, qe fust vncler a la Damoysele Argentille, pensa fausement coment il porreit la terre sa Nece auoir par touz iours, & malueisement coudre soun serment pensa a deceiure la pucelle, si la maria a vn quistroun de sa quisine qe fust apellée Curan, si esteit il le plus haut, le plus fort, & le plus vaillaunt de corps, qe hom sauoit nulle part a cel temps, & la quidoit hountousement marier, pur auoir sa terre a remenaunt, Mais il fust deceu. Car cest Curan fust [le Roi] Hauelok, filz le Roi Kirkebain de Denemarche, & il conquist la terre sa femme [en Bretagne], & occist le Roi Edelfi, vncler sa femme, & conquist tote la terre, *si com aillours est trouée plus pleinement [en l'estorie]*, & il ne regna qe treis anz. Car Saxsouns & Danoys le occirent, & ceo fust grant damage a tote la grant Brutaigne. Et les Brutouns le porterent a Stonhenge, & illoeqes ly enterrerent a grant honour.'

§ 13. "With the above may be compared the English version, as extant in MS. Harl. 2279, which agrees with the Ed. of Caxton, except in the occasional substitution of one word for another." ¹³

'MS. Harl. 2279, f. 47. *Of the kinges Albriht & of Edelf*. Ca^o III^{xx}. XI^o.

After kyng Constantinus deth, ther were .ij. kynges in Britaigne, that one men callede Adelbriht, that was a Danoys, and helde the cuntray of Northfolk and Southfolk, that other hight Edelf, and was a Britoun & helde Nichole, Lindeseye, and alle the lande vnto Humber. Thes ij. kynges faste werred togeders, but afterward thei were acorde, and louede togedere as thei had ben borne of o bodie. The kyng Edelf had a suster that men callede Orewenne, and he yaf here thurgh grete frenshipe to kyng Adelbriht to wif, and he begate on here a doughter that men callede Argentille, and in the .iiij. yeer after him come vpon a strong sekenesse that nedes he muste die, and he sent to kyng Edelf, his brother in lawe, that he shulde come and speke with him, and he come to him with good wille. Tho prayed he the kyng and coniured also in the name of God, that after whan he were dede, he shulde take

Argentil his doughter, and the lande, and that he kepte hir wel, and noreshed in his chambre; and whan she were of age he shulde done here be mariede to the strongest and worthiest man that he myȝt fynde, and than he shulde yelde vp her lande ayen. Edelf hit grauntid, and bi othe hit confermede his prayer. And whan Adelbright was dede and Enterede, Edelfe toke the damesel Argentil, and noreshid her in his chambre, and she become the fayrest creature th^t myȝt lif, or eny man finde.

How kyng Edelf mariede the damysel Argentil to a knaue of his kichyn.

Ca^o IIII^{xx}. XII.

This kyng Edelf, that was vnclē to the damesel Argentil, bithought how that he myȝte falsliche haue the lande from his nece for euermore, and falsly ayens his othe thouȝte to desceyue the damysel, and marie here to a knave of his kichon, that men callede Curan, and he become the worthiest and strengest man of bodie that eny man wist in eny lande that tho leuede. And to him he thouȝt here shendfully haue mariede, for to haue had here lande afterward; but he was clene desceyuede. For this Curan that was Huelokis son that was kyng of Kirkelane in Denmark, and this Curan Conquered his wifes landes, and slow kyng Edelf, that was his wifes vnclē, and had alle here lande, as in a-nother stede hit [MS. but] telleth more oponly, and he ne regnede but iij. year, for Saxones and Danoys him quelde, and that was grete harme to al Britaigne, and Britouns bere him to Stonehenge, and ther thei him interede with mochel honour and solempnite.’

“It must not be concealed, that in some copies, viz. in MSS. Harl. 1337, 6251, Digby 185, Hatton 50, Ashmole 791 and 793, the story is altogether omitted, and Conan made to succeed to Arthur. In those copies also of the English Polychronicon, the latter part of which resembles the above Chronicle, the passage is not found.” “Among the Harl. MSS. (No. 63) is a copy of the same Chronicle in an abridged form, in which the name of *Goldeburghe* is substituted for that of *Argentille*.” Sir F. Madden now adds—that “the story occurs also in some interpolated copies of Higden (the Latin text, viz. MSS. Harl. 655, Cott. Jul. E. 8, Reg. 13 E. 1). In an earlier form it is found in a Latin Chronicle of the 13th century, MS. Cott. Dom. A. 2, fol. 130.”

§ 14. “It was, in all probability, to this Chronicle also, in its original form, that Thomas Gray, the author of the *Scala Cronica* (or *Scale Cronicon*), a Chronicle in French prose, composed between the years 1355 and 1362, is indebted for his knowledge of the tale.” The original MS. is No. 132 in the library of Corpus Christi College, Cambridge, and was edited by Stevenson for the Maitland Club in 1836. The passage relative to Havelok is translated

by Leland, *Collectanea*, vol. i. pt. 2, p. 511. This account resembles the others, and involves no new point of interest.

§ 15. I may here introduce the remark, that the story is also to be found in the *Eulogium Historiarum*, ed. Haydon, 1860, vol. ii. p. 378. I here quote the passage at length, as it is not referred to in Sir F. Madden's edition. The date of the Chronicle is about 1366. For various readings, see Haydon's edition.

Non enim est prætermittendum de quodam Dano generoso ætate juvenili florente, qui tempore regis Edelfridi casualiter Angliam adiit, qui a propria patria expulsus per quendam ducem falsissimum, cui pater ejus illum commiserat ipso moriente et ducem rogavit ut puerum nutriret usque dum posset Denemarchiæ regnum viriliter gubernare. Dux vero malitiam machinans juvenem hæredem rectum, Hæwelok nomine, voluit occidisse. Puer vero comperiens aufugit per latibula usque dum quidam Anglicus et mercator in illis partibus adventaret; nomen autem mercatoris Grym vocitabatur. Hæwelok autem, Grym rogans ut ipsum in Angliam transvectaret, ipse autem annuens, puerum secum conduxit et cum eo per aliquot tempus apud Grymesby morabatur. Tandem ipsum ad curiam regis Edelfridi conduxit et ibi in coquina regis moratus est.

Rex autem Edelfridus quamdam habuit sororem nomine Orwen et illam maritavit regi Athelberto, quod conjugium inter duos reges vinculum amoris catenavit. Rex autem Athelbert terram citra Trentam cum regio diademate occupavit, cum terra de Northfolk' et de Southfolk' et eis adjacentibus. Rex vero Edelfrid comitatum Lincolnæ et Lyndeseye et eis spectantibus. Ante maritagium puellæ Orwen illi duo reges semper debellabant, post matrimonium factum nulla fuit divisio, nec in familia inter eos nec in dominio.

Rex vero Ethelbert de uxore sua quamdam filiam genuit, nomine Argentile, pulcherrimam valde. Athelberto obiente, vel ante mortem ejus, regem rogavit Edelfridum ut filiam suam homini fortissimo ac validiori totius sui regni in conjugium copularet, nihil doli vel mali machinans.

Rex autem Adelfrid omnem malitiam ingeminans de conjugio puellæ malitiose disponens, cogitans se habere unum lixam in coquina sua qui omnes homines regni sui in vigore et fortitudine superabat, et juxta votum patris puellæ ad illum hominem fortissimum illam generosam juvenulam toro maritali copulavit, ob cupiditatem regni puellæ ipsam ita enormiter maritabat. Hæwelok in patria Danemarchiæ et Argentile in Britannia æquali sorte ad custodiendum deputati sunt, totum tamen nutu Divino cedebat eis in honorem. Nam Hæwelok post paucos annos regnum Britannia adoptus est, et a Saxonibus tandem occisus et apud le Stonhenge est sepultus. Pater ejus Kirkeban vocabatur.

This agrees closely with the accounts given above (§ 12 and § 13). The chief point to be noticed is that this account identifies Edelfrid with the Æthelfrith son of Æthelric who was king of the Northumbrians from A.D. 593 to 617, according to the computation of the A.S. Chronicle, and who was succeeded by Eadwine son of Ælle, who drove out the æthelings or

sons of Æthelfrith. It may be remarked further, that the same Æthelfrith is called Æluric by Lazamon, who gives him a very bad character; see Lazamon, ed. Madden, vol. iii. p. 195.

§ 16. The story is also mentioned by Henry de Knyghton, a canon of Leicester abbey, whose history concludes with the year 1395. But his is no fresh evidence, as it is evidently borrowed from the French Chronicle of Rauf de Boun; see § 7. It is also alluded to in a blundering manner in a short historical compilation extending from the time of Brutus to the reign of Henry VI., and preserved in MS. Cotton Calig. A. 2. At fol. 107 *b* is the passage— “Ethelwolde, qui generavit filiam de (*sic*) Haueloke de Denmarke, per quem Danes per cccc. annos postea fecerunt clameum Anglie.” Some omission after the word *de* has turned the passage into nonsense; but it is noteworthy as expressing the claim of the Danes to the English crown by right of descent from Havelok; a claim which is more clearly expressed in MS. Harl. 63, in which the King of Denmark is represented as sending a herald to Æthelstan (A.D. 927)— “to witte wheder he wold fynde a man to fight with Colbrande ¹⁴ for the righ[t]e of the kyngdom Northumbre, that the Danes had claymed byfore by the title of kyng Haueloke, that wedded Goldesburghe the kyngis daughter of Northumbre” —fol. 19. ¹⁵ Four hundred years before this date would intimate some year early in the sixth century. Finally, the story is found at a later period in Caxton’s Chronicle (A.D. 1480) as above intimated in § 12; whence it was adopted by Warner, and inserted into his poem entitled Albion’s England; book iv. chap. 20, published in 1586. Warner called it the tale of “Argentile and Curan;” and in this ballad-shape it was reprinted in Percy’s Reliques of Ancient Poetry (vol. ii. p. 261; ed. 1812) with the same title. Not long after, in 1617, another author, William Webster, published a larger poem in six-line stanzas; but this is a mere paraphrase of Warner. The title is— “The most pleasant and delightful historie of Curan, a prince of Danske, and the fayre princesse Argentile,” &c. John Fabyan, in his Concordance of Historyes, first printed in 1516, alludes to the two kings Adelbryght and Edill, only to dismiss the “longe processe” concerning them, as not supported by sufficient authority. See p. 82 of the reprint by Ellis, 4to, 1811.

§ 17. The only other two sources whence any further light can be thrown upon our subject are the traditions of Denmark and Grimsby. A letter addressed by Sir F. Madden to Professor Rask elicited a reply which was equivalent to saying that next to nothing is known about it in Denmark. This seems to be the right place to mention a small book of 80 pages, published at Copenhagen in the present year (1868), and entitled “Sagnet om Havelok Danske; fortalt af Kristian Köster.” It contains (1) a version, in Danish prose, of the English poem; (2) a version of the same story, following the French texts of the Arundel and Royal MSS.; and (3) some elucidations of the legend. The author proposes a theory that Havelok is really the Danish king Amlet, i.e. Hamlet; but I have not space here to state all his arguments. As far as I follow them, some of the chief ones are these; that Havelok ought to be found in the list of Danish kings; ¹⁶ that Hamlet’s simulation of folly or madness is paralleled by Havelok’s behaviour, as expressed in ll. 945-954 of our poem; and that both Hamlet and Havelok succeeded in fulfilling the revenge which they had long cherished secretly. But I am not much persuaded by these considerations, for, even granting some resemblance in the names, ¹⁷ the resemblance in the stories is very slight. But I must refer the reader to the book itself.

§ 18. Turning however to local traditions, we find that Camden briefly alludes to the story in a contemptuous manner (p. 353; ed. 8vo, Lond. 1587); but Gervase Holles is far from being disposed to regard it as fabulous. In his MSS. collections for Lincolnshire, preserved in MS. Harl. 6829, he thus speaks of the story we are examining. ¹⁸

“And it will not be amisse, to say something concerning y^e Common tradition of her first founder Grime, as y^e inhabitants (with a Catholique faith) name him. The tradition it thus. *Grime* (say they) a poore Fisherman (as he was launching into y^e Riuer for fish in his little boate vpon Humber) espyed not far from him another little boate, empty (as he might conceaue) which by y^e fauour of y^e wynde & tyde still approached nearer & nearer vnto him. He betakes him to his oares, & meetes itt, wherein he founde onely a Childe wrapt in swathing clothes, purposely exposed (as it should seeme) to y^e pittylesse [rage] of y^e wilde & wide Ocean. He moued with pitty, takes itt home, & like a good foster-father carefully nourisht itt, & endeauoured to nourishe it in his owne occupation: but y^e childe contrarily was wholly deuoted to exercises of actiuity, & when he began to write man, to martiall sports, & at length by his signall valour obteyned such renowne, y^t he married y^e King of England’s

daughter, & last of all founde who was his true Father, & that he was Sonne to y^e King of Denmarke; & for y^e comicke close of all; that *Haueloke* (for such was his name) exceedingly aduanced & enriched his foster-father Grime, who thus enriched, builded a fayre Towne neare the place where Hauelocke was founde, & named it Grimesby. Thus say some: others differ a little in y^e circumstances, as namely, that Grime was not a Fisherman, but a Merchant, & that Hauelocke should be preferred to y^e King's kitchin, & there liue a longe tyme as a Scullion: but however y^e circumstances differ, they all agree in y^e consequence, as concerning y^e Towne's foundation, to which (sayth y^e story) Hauelocke y^e Danish prince, afterward graunted many immunities. This is y^e famous Tradition concerning Grimsby w^{ch} learned Mr. Cambden gives so little credit to, that he thinkes it onely *illis dignissima, qui anilibus fabulis noctem solent protrudere.*"

And again, after shewing that *by* is the Danish for *town*, and quoting a passage about Havelock's father being named Gunter, which may be found in Weever (*Ancient Funeral Monuments*, fol. Lond. 1631, p. 749), he proceeds:

"that Hauelocke did sometymes reside in Grimsby, may be gathered from a great blew Boundry-stone, lying at y^e East end of Briggowgate, which retaines y^e name of *Hauelock's-Stone* to this day. Agayne y^e great priuiledges & immunities, that this Towne hath in Denmarke aboue any other in England (as freedome from Toll, & y^e rest) may fairely induce a Beleife, that some preceding favour, or good turne called on this remuneration. But lastly (which prooffe I take to be *instar omnium*) the Common Seale of y^e Towne, & that a most auncient one," &c. [Here follows a description of the Seal.]

"The singular fact," adds Sir F. Madden, "alluded to by Holles, of the Burgesses of Grimsby being free from toll at the Port of Elsineur, in Denmark, is confirmed by the Rev. G. Oliver, in his *Monumental Antiquities of Grimsby*, 8vo, Hull, 1825, who is inclined from that, and other circumstances, to believe the story is not so totally without foundation." There is also an absurd local story that the church at Grimsby, which has now but one turret, formerly had four, three of which were kicked down by Grim in his anxiety to destroy some hostile vessels. The first fell among the enemy's fleet; the second dropped in Wellowgate, and is now Havelock's stone; the third fell within the churchyard, but the fourth his strength failed to move. Perhaps amongst the most interesting notices of the story are the following words by Sir Henry Havelock, whose family seems to have originally resided in Durham. His own account, however, is this. "My father, William Havelock, descended from a family which

formerly resided at Grimsby in Lincolnshire, and was himself born at Guisborough in Yorkshire.”¹⁹ And it may at least be said with perfect truth, that if the name of *Havelock* was not famous formerly, it is famous now.

§ 19. The last evidence for the legend is the still-existing seal of the corporation of Great Grimsby. The engraving of this seal, as it appears in the present edition, was made from a copy kindly furnished to the E.E.T.S. by the Mayor of Grimsby, and I here subjoin a description of it, communicated to me by J. Hopkin, Esq., Jun., of Grimsby, which was first printed, in a slightly different form, in *Notes and Queries*, 2nd Series, vol. xi. p. 41; see also p. 216.

“The ancient Town Seal of Great Grimsby is engraven on a circular piece of brass not very thick; and on the back, which is rather arched, is a small projecting piece of brass, placed as a substitute for a handle, in order when taking an impression the more easily to detach the matrix from the Wax. This seal is in an excellent state of preservation, and is inscribed in Saxon characters ‘Sigillvm Comunitatis Grimebye’ and represents thereon Gryme (‘Gryem’) who by tradition is reported to have been a native of Souldburg in Denmark, where he gained a precarious livelihood by fishing and piracy; but having, as is supposed, during the reign of Ethelbert,²⁰ been accidentally driven into the Humber by a furious storm, he landed on the Lincolnshire Coast near Grimsby, he being at this time miserably poor and almost destitute of the common necessities of life; for Leland represents this ‘poor fisschar’ as being so very needy that he was not ‘able to kepe his sunne Cuaran for poverty.’ Gryme, finding a capacious haven adapted to his pursuits, built himself a house and commenced and soon succeeded in establishing a very lucrative Trade with Norway, Sweden, and Denmark. Other Merchants having in process of time settled near him, attracted by the commercial advantages offered by this excellent Harbour, they jointly constructed convenient appendages for extensive Trade, and the colony soon rose into considerable importance, and became known at an early period by the name of Grimsby. For not only was Grimsby constituted a borough so early as the seventh century, but Peter of Langtoft speaks of it as a frontier Town and the boundary of a Kingdom erected by the conquests of Egbert in the year 827, which he states included all that portion of the Island which lay between ‘the maritime Towns of Grymsby and Dover.’ So that even at that period, Grimsby must have been a place of peculiar strength and importance. Gryme is represented on the seal as a man of gigantic stature with comparatively short hair, a shaven chin, and a moustache, holding in his right hand a drawn sword and bearing on his left arm a circular shield with an ornate boss and rim. The sleeveless tunic above his under vest is most probably the panzar or panzara of the Danes. Between his feet is a Conic object, possibly intended for a helmet, as it resembles the chapelle-de-fer worn by William Rufus on his Great Seal, and which in the laws of Gula is distinguished as the Steel hufe. On the right hand of Gryme stands his protégé Haveloc (‘Habloc’), whom, during one of his mercantile excursions soon after his arrival in Lincolnshire, Gryme had the good fortune to save from imminent danger of Shipwreck, and who proved to be the Son of Gunter, King of Denmark, and who was therefore conveyed to the British Court, where he subsequently received in marriage Goldburgh, the Daughter of the British Sovereign. Above Gryme is represented a

hand, being emblematical of the hand of providence by which Haveloc was preserved, and near the hand is the star which marks the point where the inscription begins and ends. Haveloc made such a favourable representation of his preserver at the British and Danish Courts, that he procured for him many honours and privileges. From the British Monarch Gryme, who had already realised an abundance of wealth, received a charter, and was made the chief governor of Grimsby; and the Danish Sovereign granted to the Town an immunity (which is still possessed by the Burgesses of Grimsby) from all Tolls at the Port of Elsinour. Gryme afterwards lived in Grimsby like a petty prince in his Hereditary Dominions. Above Haveloc is represented a crown and in his right hand is a battle axe, the favourite weapon of the Northmen, and in his left hand is a ring which he is presenting to the British Princess Goldburgh ('Goldebvrgh'), who stands on the left side of Gryme and whose right hand is held towards the Ring. Over her head is a Regal Diadem, and in her left hand is a Sceptre. Sir F. Madden states that it is certain that this seal is at least as old as the time of Edward I. (and therefore contemporaneous with the MS.) as the legend is written in a character which after the year 1300 fell into disuse, and was succeeded by the black letter, or *Gothic*."

§ 20. SKETCH OF THE STORY OF "Le Lai d'Aueloc." ²¹

It is my intention to offer some remarks on the probable sources of the legend, and to fix a conjectural date for the existence of Havelok. But it is obviously convenient that a sketch of the story should first be given. It appears, however, that the resemblance between the French and English versions is by no means very close, and it will be necessary to give separate abstracts of them. I begin with the French version, in which I follow the Norfolk MS. rather than the abridgment by Gaimar. I have already said that the former is printed in Sir F. Madden's edition, and that it was reprinted by M. Michel with the title "Lai d'Havelok le Danois," Paris, 1833, and by Mr Wright for the Caxton Society in 1850.

The Britons made a lay concerning King Havelok, who is surnamed Cuaran. His father was Gunter, King of the Danes. Arthur crossed the sea, and invaded Denmark. Gunter perished by the treason of Hodulf, who gained the kingdom, and held it of Arthur. Gunter had a fine castle, where his wife and son were guarded, being committed to the protection of Grim. The child was but seven years old; but ever as he slept, an odorous flame issued from his mouth. Hodulf sought to kill him, but Grim prepared a ship, and furnished it with provisions, wherein he placed the queen and the child, and set sail from Denmark. On their voyage they encountered pirates ("outlaghes"), who killed them all after a hard fight, excepting Grim, who was an acquaintance of theirs, and Grim's wife and children. Havelok also was saved. They at last arrived at the haven, afterwards named "Grimesbi" from Grim. Grim there resumed his old trade, a fisherman's, and a town grew up round his hut, which was called Grimsby. The child grew up, and waxed strong. One day Grim said to him, "Son, you will never thrive as a fisherman; take your brothers with you, and seek service amongst the King's servants." He was soon well apparelled, and repaired with his two foster-brothers to Nicole [Lincoln]. ²² Now at that time there was a king named Alsi, who ruled over all Nicole and Lindesie; ²³ but

the country southward was governed by another king, named Ekenbright, who had married Alsi's sister Orewen. These two had one only daughter, named Argentille. Ekenbright, falling ill, committed Argentille to the care of Alsi, till she should be of age to be married to the strongest man that can be found. At Ekenbright's death, Alsi reigned over both countries, holding his court at Nicole. Havelok, on his arrival there, was employed to carry water and cut wood, and to perform all menial offices requiring great strength. He was named Cuaran, which means—in the British language—a scullion. Argentille soon arrived at marriageable age, and Alsi determined to marry her to Cuaran, which would sufficiently fulfil her father's wish—Cuaran being confessedly the strongest man in those parts. To this marriage he compelled her to consent, hoping thereby to disgrace her for ever. Havelok was unwilling that his wife should perceive the marvellous flame, but soon forgot this, and ere long fell asleep. Then had Argentille a strange vision—that a savage bear and some foxes attacked Cuaran, but dogs and boars defended him. A boar having killed the bear, the foxes cried for quarter from Cuaran, who commanded them to be bound. Then he would have put to sea, but the sea rose so high that he was terrified. Next she beheld two lions, at seeing which she was frightened, and she and Cuaran climbed a tree to avoid them; but the lions submitted themselves to him, and called him their lord. Then a great cry was raised, whereat she awoke, and beheld the miraculous flame. "Sir," she exclaimed, "you burn!" But he reassured her, and, having heard her dream, said that it would soon come true. The next day, however, she again told her dream to a chamberlain, her friend, who said that he well knew a holy hermit who could explain it. The hermit explained to Argentille that Cuaran must be of royal lineage. "He will be king," he said, "and you a queen. Ask him concerning his parentage. Remember also to repair to his native place." On being questioned, Cuaran replied that he was born at Grimsby; that Grim was his father, and Saburc his mother. "Then let us go to Grimsby," she replied. Accompanied by his two foster-brothers, they came to Grimsby; but Grim and Saburc were both dead. They found there, however, a daughter of Grim's, named Kelloc, who had married a tradesman of that town. Up to this time Havelok had not known his true parentage, but Kelloc thought it was now time to tell him, and said: "Your father was Gunter, the King of the Danes, whom Hodulf slew. Hodulf obtained the kingdom as a grant from Arthur. Grim fled with you, and saved your life; but your mother perished at sea. Your name is HAVELOK. My husband will convey you to Denmark, where you must inquire for a lord named 'Sigar l'estal;' and take with you my two brothers." So Kelloc's husband conveyed them to Denmark, and advised Havelok to go to Sigar and show himself and his wife, as then he would be asked who his wife is. They went to the city of the seneschal, the before-named Sigar, where they craved a night's lodging, and were courteously entertained. But as they retired to a lodging for the night, six men attacked them, who had been smitten with the beauty of Argentille. Havelok defended himself with an axe which he found, and slew five, whereupon the sixth fled. Havelok and his party fled away for refuge to a monastery, which was soon attacked by the townsmen who had heard of the combat. Havelok *mounted the tower*, and defended himself bravely, *casting down a huge stone on his enemies*.²⁴ The news soon reached the ears of Sigar, who hastened to see what the uproar was about. Beholding Havelok fixedly, he called to mind the form and appearance of Gunter, and asked Havelok of his parentage. Havelok replied that Grim had told him he was by birth a Dane, and that his mother perished at sea; and ended by briefly relating his subsequent adventures. Then Sigar asked him his name. "My name is Havelok," he said, "and my other name is Cuaran." Then the seneschal took him home, and determined to watch for the miraculous flame, which he soon perceived, and was assured that Havelok was the true heir. Therefore he gathered a great host of his friends, and

sent for the horn which none but the true heir could sound, promising a ring to any one who could blow it. When all had failed, it was given to Havelok, who blew it loud and long, and was joyfully recognized and acknowledged to be the true King. Then with a great army he attacked Hodulf the usurper, whom he slew with his own hand. Thus was Havelok made King of Denmark.

But after he had reigned four years, his wife incited him to return to England. With a great number of ships he sailed there, and arrived at Carleflure; ²⁵ and sent messengers to Alsi, demanding the inheritance of Argentille. Alsi was indeed astonished at such a demand as coming from a scullion, and offered him battle. The hosts met at Theford, ²⁶ and the battle endured till nightfall without a decisive result. But Argentille craftily advised her lord to support his dead men by stakes, to increase the apparent number of his army; and the next day Alsi, deceived by this device, treated for peace, and yielded up to his former ward all the land, from Holland ²⁷ to Gloucester. Alsi had been so sorely wounded that he lived but fifteen days longer. Thus was Havelok king over Lincoln and Lindsey, and reigned over them for twenty years. Such is the lay of Cuaran.

§ 21. The chief points to be noticed in Gaimar's abridgment are the few additional particulars to be gleaned from it. We there find that Havelok's mother was *Alvive*, a daughter of King *Gaifer*; that the King of Nicole and Lindeseie was a *Briton*, and was named Edelsie; that his sister, named Orwain, was married to Adelbrit, a *Dane*, who ruled over Norfolk; and that Edelsie and Adelbrit lived in the days of Costentin (Constantine), who succeeded Arthur. It is also said that the usurper Hodulf was brother to Aschis, who is the Achilles of Geoffrey of Monmouth. Another statement, that Havelok's kingdom extended from Holland to *Colchester*, seems to be an improvement upon "from Holland to *Gloucester*."

The words of Mr Petrie, in his remarks upon the lay in Monumenta Historica Britannica, vol. i., may be quoted here. "Although both [French versions] have the same story in substance, and often contain lines exactly alike, yet, besides the different order in which the incidents are narrated, each has occasionally circumstances wanting in the other, and such too, it should seem, as would leave the story incomplete unless supplied from the other copy. Thus, the visit to the hermit, which is omitted in Gaimar, was probably in the original romance; for without it Argentille's dream tells for nothing; and in the Arundel copy there is a particular account of Haveloc's defence of a tower by hurling stones on his assailants, which in Gaimar is so obscurely alluded to as to be hardly intelligible. On the other hand, instead of the description of the extraordinary virtues of Sygar's ring in

Gaimar, it is merely said in the Arundel copy that Sygar would give his *anel d'or* to whoever could sound the horn; and, to omit other instances, a festival is described in Gaimar on the authority of *l'Estorie*, of which no notice whatever occurs in the Arundel MS."

§ 22. SKETCH OF THE ENGLISH POEM.

The "Lay of Havelok" has been admirably paraphrased by Professor Morley, in his "English Writers," vol. i. pp. 459-467, a book which should be in every reader's hands, and which should by all means be consulted. I only intend here to give a briefer outline, for the sake of comparing the main features of our poem with those of the French *Lai*.

Hear the tale of Havelok! There was once a good king in England, named Athelwold, renowned and beloved for his justice. He had but one child, a daughter named Goldborough. Knowing that his end was approaching, he sent for all his lords to assemble at Winchester, and there committed Goldborough to the care of Godrich, the earl of Cornwall; directing him to see her married to the strongest and fairest man whom he could find. But Godrich imprisoned her at Dover, and resolved to seize her inheritance for his own son. At that time there was also a King of Denmark, named Birkabeyn, who had one son, Havelok, and two daughters, Swanborough and Helfled. At the approach of death, he committed these to the care of Earl Godard. But Godard killed the two girls, and only spared Havelok because he did not like to kill him with his own hand. He therefore hired a fisherman, named Grim, to drown Havelok at sea. But Grim perceived, as Havelok slept, a miraculous light shining round the lad, whereby he knew that the child was the true heir, and would one day be king. In order to avoid Godard, Grim fitted up a ship, and provisioned it, and with his wife Leve, his three sons, his two daughters, and Havelok, put out to sea. They landed in Lindesey at the month of the Humber, at a place afterwards named Grimsby after Grim. Grim worked at his old trade, a fisherman's, and Havelok carried about the fish for sale. Then arose a great dearth in the land, and Havelok went out to seek his own livelihood, walking to Lincoln barefoot. He was hired as a porter by the earl of Cornwall's cook, and drew water and cut wood for the earl's kitchen. One day some men met to contend in games and to "put the stone." At the cook's command, Havelok also put the stone, hurling it further than any of the rest. ²⁸ Godrich, hearing the praises of Havelok's strength, at once resolved to perform his oath by causing him to marry Goldborough; and carried his design into execution. As soon as the pair were married, Havelok suddenly quitted Lincoln with his wife, and returned to Grimsby, where he found that Grim was dead, but that his five children are yet alive. At night, Goldborough perceived a light shining round about Havelok, and observed a cross upon his shoulder. At the same time she heard an angel's voice, telling her of good fortune to come. Then he awoke, and told her a dream; how he had dreamt that all Denmark and England became his own. She encouraged him, and urged him to set sail for Denmark at once. He accordingly called to him Grim's three sons, and narrated to them his own history, and Godard's treachery, asking them to accompany him to Denmark. To this they assented, and sailed with him and Goldborough to Denmark. There he sought out a former friend of his father's, Earl Ubbe, who invited him and his friends to a sumptuous feast. After the feast, Havelok and Goldborough and Grim's sons

went to the house of one Bernard Brown, whose house was that night attacked by sixty thieves. By dint of great prowess, the friends at length slew all their sixty assailants, and Ubbe was so amazed at Havelok's valour that he resolved to dub him a knight, and invited him to sleep in his own castle. At night, he peeped into Havelok's chamber, and beheld the marvellous light, and saw a bright cross on his neck. Rejoiced at heart, he did homage to Havelok, and commanded all his friends and dependents to do the same. He also dubbed him knight, and proclaimed him King. With six thousand men he set out to attack Godard, whom he defeated and made prisoner, and afterwards caused to be flayed, drawn, and hung. Then Havelok swore that he would establish at Grimsby a priory of black monks, to pray for Grim's soul; and Godrich, having heard that Havelok has invaded England, raised a great army against him. An indecisive combat took place between Ubbe and Godrich, but a more decisive one between Godrich and Havelok; for Havelok cut off his foe's hand and made him prisoner. Then the English submitted to Goldborough, and acknowledged her as queen; but Godrich was condemned and burnt. Havelok rewarded both his own friends and the English nobles; for he caused Earl Reyner of Chester to marry Gunild, Grim's daughter, and Bertram, formerly Godrich's cook, to marry Levive, another of Grim's daughters; bestowing upon Bertram the earldom of Cornwall. Then were Havelok and Goldborough crowned at London, and a feast was given that lasted forty days. The kingdom of Denmark was bestowed upon Ubbe, who held it of King Havelok. Havelok and Goldborough lived to the age of a hundred years, and their reign lasted for sixty years in England. They had fifteen children, who were all kings and queens. Such is the *geste* of Havelok and Goldborough.

§ 23. POSSIBLE DATE OF HAVELOK'S REIGN.

The various allusions to the story of Havelok already cited naturally lead us to consider the question as to what date we should refer such circumstances of the story as may have some foundation in truth, or such circumstances as may have originated the story. I do not look upon this as altogether a hopeless or profitless inquiry, for it seems to me that a theory may be constructed which will readily and easily fit in with most of the statements of our authorities. In the first place, to place Havelok's father in the time of Alfred, as is done by Peter de Langtoft and his translators, is absurd, and evidently due to the confusion between the names of Gunter and Godrum or Guthrum. We may even adduce Langtoft's evidence against himself, as he alludes to Grimsby as being the boundary of Egbert's kingdom; and indeed, the mere fact of its being a British lay points to a time before the establishment of the Heptarchy. As already suggested in § 16, some of the authorities point to the sixth century. But the evidence of the French poem and of Gaimar points still more steadily to a similar early date. There we find Gunter appearing as the enemy, not of Alfred, but of Arthur. The French prose chronicle of the Brute places Adelbright and Edelfi after the

death of Constantine, and it is clear that there is some close connection between the British lay of Havelok and the British Chronicle. The *Godrich* of the English version is the *Alsi* of the French poem, the *Edelsi* of Gaimar, the *Adelfrid* ²⁹ or *Edelfrid* of the *Eulogium Historiarum*, the *Elfroi* of Wace, the *Æluric* of *Lazamon*, the *Æthelfrith* who succeeded to the throne of Northumbria A.D. 593, according to the *Saxon Chronicle*. The *Athelwold* of the English version is the *Adelbrict* of Gaimar, the *Ekenbright* of the French poem, the *Athelbert* of the *Eulogium Historiarum*, the *Aldebar* of Wace, and the *Æthelbert* of *Lazamon*, i.e. no other than the celebrated *Æthelberht* of Kent, who was baptized by St Augustine A.D. 596, according to the *Saxon Chronicle*. This is the right clue to the *names*, from which, when once obtained, the rest follows easily. The variations between the English and French versions are very great, and it is clear that each poet proceeded much as poets are accustomed to do. Taking a legend as the general guide or thread of a narrative, it is the simplest and easiest plan to dress it up after one's own fashion, and to draw upon the materials that are supplied by the *general surroundings* of the story. I feel confident that the narrators of the Lay of Havelok must have used materials not much unlike those used by *Lazamon*, and a mere comparison of the French and English lays with *Lazamon* will amply suffice to elucidate this. *Æluric* is first mentioned at p. 195 of vol. iii. of *Lazamon*, as edited by Sir F. Madden; if we allow ourselves a margin on both sides of this, we may find many things akin to the lay of Havelok between pages 150 and 282 of that volume, as I will now shew. The character of the good king Athelwold is taken from that of *Æthelberht* of Kent, and his love of justice may remind us of the ancient collection of laws which are still extant as having been made by that king. His extensive rule, such as is also attributed to *Godrich* and *Havelok*, may point to the title of *Bretwalda*, which *Æthelberht* so long coveted, and at last obtained. Our poet, in describing *Birkabeyn*, repeats this character so exactly, and makes the circumstances of the deaths of Athelwold and *Birkabeyn* so similar, that they are almost indistinguishable; a fault which he doubles by repeating the character of *Godrich* in describing that of *Godard*. Both of these answer to *Lazamon*'s *Æluric*, who was "the wickedest of all kings" (*La3*. iii. 195). So far, perhaps, the connection of the various stories is not very evident, but I will now mention an obvious coincidence. The quarrel and reconciliation between *Athelbert* and *Edelfrid*,

as told in the *Eulogium Historiarum*, &c., exactly answers to the quarrel and reconciliation between Cadwan and Æluric as told in *Lazamon* (vol. iii. p. 205); where Cadwan has come forward in place of Æthelbert, who has by this time dropped out of *Lazamon*'s narrative. Again, the Gunter or Gurmond who was Havelok's father reminds us of the Gurmund of *Lazamon* (p. 156), who is curiously described as king of Africa; but the name is Danish. The character of Grim is fairly paralleled by that of Brian, who makes sea-voyages, and goes about as a merchant (*Lazamon*, iii. 232). In several respects Havelok may have been drawn from Cadwalan, whose gallant attempts to gain the king of Northumberland are recorded in *Lazamon* (iii. 216-254); his opponent being Edwin, who has replaced Ethelfrid as *Lazamon*'s narrative proceeds. At last he overthrows him and slays him in the great battle of Heathfield or Hatfield, which took place, according to the *Saxon Chronicle*, A.D. 633. This great battle resembles the decisive one between Havelok and Godrich. As Cadwalan was well supported by his liegeman Penda (*Lazamon*, iii. 251), so was Havelok by Ubbe. Again, Cadwalan marries Helen, whom he found at

—þan castle of Deoure
on þere sæ oure;
(*Lazamon*, iii. 250),

which reminds us of Havelok's wife Goldborough, who was imprisoned at

—doure
þat standeth on þe seis oure;
(l. 320).

The very name Helen, though not the name of Havelok's wife, was that of his mother, who was killed by the pirates. For the connection between *Lazamon*'s Helen and pirates, see Sir F. Madden's note, vol. iii. p. 428. There is a most curious contradiction in the English lay about Havelok's religion; in l. 2520 he is a devout Christian, but in l. 2580 Godrich speaks of him as being a cruel pagan. Now it was just about this very time that Paulinus preached in Lindsey, "where the first that believed was a powerful man called *Blecca*, with all his followers" (*A.S. Chron.* ed. Thorpe, vol. ii. p. 21; A.D. 627). Havelok, according to some, was buried at Stonehenge; but

so was Constantine (Lazamon, iii. 151). A dearth is mentioned in the English lay (l. 824); cf. Lazamon, iii. 279. And I may here add another coincidence, of an interesting but certainly of a very circuitous nature. A close examination of the Lay of King Horn shews that there is no real connection between the story therein contained and that of Havelok. Yet there is a connection after a sort. Though by different authors, and in different metre, both lays are found in English in the same MS.; both versions belong to the same date; both are from French versions, written by Englishmen from British sources; and now, if we compare King Horn with the very part of Lazamon now under consideration, there is at once seen to be a most exact resemblance in one point. The story of the ring given by Horn to Rymenhild (K. Horn, ed. Lumby, ll. 1026-1210) is remarkably like that of the ring whereby Brian is recognized by his sister (Lazamon, iii. 234-238). But it is hardly worth while to pursue the subject further. It may suffice to suppose that the period of the existence of Havelok and Grim may be referred to the times of Æthelberht of Kent and Æthelfrith and Eadwine of Northumbria.³⁰ It is exceedingly probable that Havelok was never more than a chief or a petty prince, and whether he was a Danish or only a British enemy of the Angles is not of very great importance. If, however, more exact dates be required, they may be found in "The Conquest of Britain by the Saxons," by Daniel P. Haigh, London, 8vo, 1861, pp. 363-367; where the following dates are suggested. Havelok's father slain, A.D. 487; his expedition to Denmark, A.D. 507; his reign in England, A.D. 511-531, or a little later. These dates follow a system which is here about 16 years earlier than the dates in the A.S. Chronicle. His results are obtained from totally different considerations. On the whole, let us place Havelok in the *sixth* century, at *some* period of his life.

§ 24. It is, perhaps, worthy of a passing remark that some of the circumstances in the Lay may have been suggested by the romantic story of Eadwine of Northumbria, who was also born at the close of the sixth century. For he it was who really married the *daughter of Æthelberht*, and it was the *archbishop of York*, Paulinus, who performed the ceremony. The relation of how Eadwine was persecuted by Æthelfrith, how he fled and was protected by Rædwald, king of the East Angles, how he saw a vision of an angel who promised his restoration to the throne and that his rule should

exceed that of his predecessors, how, with the assistance of Rædwald, he overthrew and *slew Æthelfrith* in a terrible battle beside the river Idle, may be found in Beda's Ecclesiastical History, bk. II. ch. 9-16.³¹ In the last of these chapters there is again mention of *Blecca, the governor of the city of Lincoln*. Sir F. Madden, in his note to l. 45, speaks of the extraordinary proofs of the peaceable state of the country in the reign of Ælfred; but Beda uses similar language in speaking of the reign of Eadwine; and the earlier instance is even more remarkable. "It is reported that there was then such perfect peace in Britain, wheresoever the dominion of King Edwin extended, that, as *is still proverbially said*, a woman with her new-born babe might walk throughout the island, from sea to sea, without receiving any harm. That king took such care for the good of his nation, that in several places where he had seen clear springs near the highways, he caused stakes to be fixed, with brass dishes hanging at them, for the conveniency of travellers; nor durst any man touch them for any other purpose than that for which they were designed, either through the dread they had of the king, or for the affection which they bore him, &c."³² Readers who are acquainted with the pleasing poem of "Edwin of Deira," by the late Alexander Smith, will remember his adventures; and it may be noted, as an instance of the manner in which poets alter names at pleasure, that Mr Smith gives to Æthelfrith the name of Ethelbert, to Eadwine's wife Æthelburh, that of Bertha, and to his father Ælle, that of Egbert. My theory of the Lay of Havelok is then simply this, that I look upon it as the general result of various narratives connected with the history of Northumbria and Lindesey at the close, or possibly the beginning, of the sixth century, gathered round some favourite local (i.e. Lincolnshire) tradition as a nucleus. A similar theory may be true of the Lay of Horn.

§ 25. ON THE NAMES "CURAN" AND "HAVELOK."

The French version tells us that *Coaran*, *Cuaran*, or *Cuheran* is the British word for a scullion. This etymology has not hitherto been traced, but it may easily have been perfectly true. A glance at Armstrong's Gaelic Dictionary shews us that the Gaelic *cearn* (which answers very well to the Old English *hirne*, a corner) has the meaning of a *corner*, and, secondly, of a *kitchen*; and that *cearnach* is an adjective meaning *of or belonging to a kitchen*. But

we may come even nearer than this; for by adding the diminutive ending -*an* to the Gaelic *cocaire*, a cook, we see that *Cuheran* may really have conveyed the idea of *scullion* to a British ear, and this probably further gave rise to the story of Havelok's degradation. It is a common custom—one which true etymologists must always deplore—to invent a story to account for a derivation; and such a practice is invariably carried out with greater boldness and to a greater extent if the said derivation chances to be false. For it is possible that Curan may be simply the Gaelic *curan*, a brave man, and the Irish *curanta*, brave. The derivation of Havelok is certainly puzzling. Professor Rask declared it to have no meaning in Danish. It bears, however, a remarkable resemblance to the Old English *gavelok*, which occurs in Weber's *Kyng Alisaunder*, l. 1620, and which is the A.S. *gafeluc*, Icel. *gaflak*, Welsh *gaflach*, a spear, dart, or javelin. This is an appropriate name for a warrior, and possibly reappears in the instance of Hugh *Kevelock*, earl of Chester (Bp. Percy's Folio MS., ed. Hales and Furnivall, i. 128). It is remarkable that the Gaelic and Irish *corran* has the same sense, that of a *spear*, whilst *curan*, as above-mentioned, means a *brave man*. It is best, perhaps, to stop here; for etymology, when pursued too far, is wont to beguile the pursuer into every possible quagmire of absurdity.

§ 26. DESCRIPTION OF THE MS., &c.

The MS. from which the present poem is printed is in the Laudian collection in the Bodleian Library, where its old mark is K 60, and its present one Misc. 108. Being described in the old printed catalogue merely as *Vitæ Sanctorum*, the romance was in consequence for a long time overlooked. The Lives of the Saints occupy a large portion of the volume, and are probably to be ascribed to the authorship of Robert of Gloucester. "These Lives or Festivals," says Sir F. Madden, "are [here] 61 in number, written in long Alexandrine verse. Then succeed the Sayings of St Bernard and the Visions of St Paul, both in six-line stanzas; the *Disputatio inter Corpus et Animam*, the English Romance of Havelok, the Romance of Kyng Horn, and some additions in a hand of the 15th century, including the lives of St Blaise, St Cecilia, and St Alexius, and an alliterative poem intitled *Somer Soneday*, making in all the Contents of the Volume to amount to 70 pieces." The lays of Havelok and Horn are written out in the same

handwriting, of an early date, certainly not later than the end of the thirteenth century. The Havelok begins on fol. 204, and is written in double columns, each column containing 45 lines. A folio is lost between fol. 211 and 212, but no notice of this has been taken in numbering the folios; hence the catchword which should have been found at the bottom of fol. 215 *b*, appears at the bottom of fol. 214 *b* (see l. 2164). The poem terminates at the 27th line on fol. 219 *b*, and is immediately followed by Kyng Horn in the same column. The character of the handwriting is bold and square, but the words are very close together. The initial letter of every line is written a little way apart from the rest, as in William of Palerne, and other MSS. Both the long and short *s* (*f* and *s*) are used. The long *s* is in general well distinguished from *f*, and on this account I have taken the liberty of printing both *esses* alike, as my experience in printing the Romans of Partenay proved that the difficulty of avoiding misprints is greater than the gain of representing the difference between them. The chief point of interest is that, as in *early* MSS., the long *s* is sometimes found at the *end* of a word, as in “*uf*” in l. 22, and “*if*” in l. 23. The following are all the examples of the use of this letter in the first 26 lines; *fo* (4), *wictefte* (9), *ftede* (10), *crift*, *fchilde* (16), *Krift*, *fo* (17), *fo* (19), *fchal* (21), *Krift*, *uf* (22), *if* (23), *ftalworpi* (24), *ftalworpefte* (25), *ftede* (26). With this exception, the present reprint is a faithful representation of the original; for, as the exact fidelity of a text is of the first importance, I have been careful to compare the proof-sheets with the MS. twice throughout; besides which, the original edition is itself exceedingly correct, and had been re-read by Sir F. Madden with the MS. His list of errata (nearly all of them of minor importance) agreed almost exactly with my own. A great difficulty is caused by the use of the Saxon letter *w* (*p*). This letter, the thorn-letter (*þ*), and *y*, are all three made very nearly alike. In general, the *y* is dotted, but the dot is occasionally omitted. Wherever the letter really appears to be a *w*, I have denoted it by printing the *w* as an italic letter. The following are, I believe, the *only* examples of it. Wit-drow = withdrew, l. 502; we, 1058; was, 1129 (cf. “him was ful wa,” *Sir Tristr.* f. iii. st. 43); berwen, 1426 (written “berwen” in l. 697); wat = known, 1674; we, miswritten for wo = who, 1914; to which perhaps we may add wit, 997. This evidence is interesting as shewing that this letter was then fast going out of use, and I think that we may safely date the final disappearance of this letter from MSS. at about the year 1300. As regards

the *th*, we may remark that at the end of a word both *þ* and *th* are used, as in “norþ and suth,” l. 434; sometimes *th* occurs in the middle of a word, as “sithen,” l. 1238, which is commonly written “siþen,” as in l. 399. The words *þe*, *þat*, *þer*, &c., are hardly ever written otherwise. But the reader will remark many instances in which *th* final seems to have the hard sound of *t*, as in *brouth*, 57, *nouth*, 58, *lith*, 534, *pouth*, 1190, &c.; cf. § 27. The letter *t* is sometimes shortened so as nearly to resemble *c*, and *c* is sometimes lengthened into *t*. The letters *n* and *u* are occasionally alike, but the difference between them is commonly well marked. The *i* has a long stroke over it when written next to *m* or *n*. On the whole, the writing is very clear and distinct, after a slight acquaintance with it. The poem is marked out into paragraphs by the use of large letters. I have introduced a slight space at the end of each paragraph, to shew this more clearly.

§ 27. ON THE GRAMMATICAL FORMS OCCURRING IN THE POEM.

The following peculiarities of spelling may be first noted. We frequently find *h* prefixed to words which it is usual to spell without one. Examples are: *holde* for *old*, *hete* for *ete* (eat), *het* for *et* (ate), *heuere* for *euere*, *Henglishe* for *Englishe*, &c.; see the Glossary, under the letter H. This enables us to explain some words which at first appear puzzling; thus *her* = *er*, *ere*; *hayse* = *ayse*, ease; *helde* = *elde*, old age; *hore* = *ore*, grace; *hende* = *ende*, which in one passage means *end*, but in another *a duck*. The forms *hof*, *hus*, *hure*, for *of*, *us*, *ure* are such as we should hardly have expected to find. On the other hand, *h* is omitted in the words *auelok*, *aueden*, *osed*, and in *is* for *his* (l. 2254). These instances, and other examples such as follow, may readily be found by help of the Glossarial Index. Again, *d* final after *l* or *n* was so slightly sounded as to be omitted even in writing. Examples are: *lon* for *lond*, *hel* for *held*, *bihel* for *biheld*, *shel* for *sheld*, *gol* for *gold*. But a more extraordinary omission is that of *r* final in *the*, *neythe*, *othe*, *douthe*, which does not seem to be satisfactorily explained even by the supposition that the scribe may have omitted the small upward curl which does duty for *er* so frequently in MSS. For we further find the omission of *l* final, as in *mike* for *mikel*, *we* for *wel*, and of *t* final, as in *bes* for *best*; from which instances we should rather infer some peculiarity of pronunciation rendering final letters indistinct, of which there are numerous examples, as

fiel for *field*, in modern provincial English. Cf. *il* for *ilk*, in ll. 818, 1740; and *twel* for *twelf*. “From the same license,” says Sir F. Madden, “arises the frequent repetition of such rhythm as *riden* and *side*, where the final *n* seems to have been suppressed in pronunciation. Cf. ll. 29, 254, 957, 1105, 1183, 2098, &c, and hence we perceive how readily the infinitive verbal Saxon termination glided into its subsequent form. The broad pronunciation of the dialect in which the poem was written is also frequently discernible, as in *slawen*, l. 2676, and *knaue*, l. 949, which rhyme to *Rauen* and *plawe*.³³ So likewise, *bothe* or *bethe* is, in sound, equivalent to *rede*, ll. 360, 694, 1680.” Other peculiarities will be noticed in discussing the Metre. Observe also the Anglo-Saxon *hw* for the modern *wh*, exemplified by *hwo*, 368, *hwan*, 474, *hweper*, 294, *hwere*, 549, *hwil*, 301; compare also *qual*, *qui*, *quan*, meaning *whale*, *why*, *when*.³⁴ The letter *w* (initial) is the modern provincial ’oo, as in *wlf*, *wluine*, *wman*; cf. *hw*, *w*, both forms of *how*; and *lowerd* for *louerd*. In particular, we should notice the hard sound of *t* denoted by *th* in the words *with*, *rithe*, *brouth*, *nouth*, *ricth*, *knichth*, meaning *white*, *right*, *brought*, *naught*, *right*, *knight*; so too *douth*, daughter, *neth*, a net, *uth*, out, *woth*, wot, *leth*, let, *lauth* (*laught*), caught, *nither-tale* (*nighter-tale*), night-time.³⁵ On the other hand, *t* stands for *th* in *hauet*, 564, *seyt*, 647, *herknet*, 1, *wit*, 100. When *th* answers to the modern sound, it seems equivalent to A.S. *ð* rather than to A.S. *þ*; examples are *mouth*, 433, *oth*, 260, *loth*, 261. *Y* and *g* are interchangeable, as in *yaf*, *gaf*, *youen*, *gouen*; *g* even occurs for *k*, as in *rang*, 2561. In MSS., *e* is not uncommonly written by mistake for *o*; this may perhaps account for *helde*, 2472, *meste*, 233, *her*, 1924, which should rather be *holde*, 30, *moste*, and *hor*, 235; there is a like confusion of *weren* and *woren*; and perhaps *grotinde* should be *gretinde*.³⁶ The vowel *u* is replaced by the modern *ou* in the words *prud*, 302, *suth*, 434, *but*, 1040, *hus*, 740, *spusen*, 1123; cf. *hws* in l. 1141. Mr Ellis shews, in his *Early English Pronunciation*, chap. v, that in pure specimens of the *thirteenth* century, there is no *ou* in such words, and in the *fourteenth* century, no simple *u*. This furnishes a ready explanation of the otherwise difficult *sure*, in l. 2005; it is merely the adverb of *sour*, *sourly* being used in the sense of *bitterly*; to *bye it bitterly*, or *bye it bittre*, is a common phrase in *Piers Plowman*. Other spellings worth notice occur in *ouerga*, 314, *stra*, 315 (spelt *strie* in l. 998), *hawe*, 1188, *plawe*, 950, *sal*, 628 (commonly spelt *shal*). Note also *arum* for *arm*, *harum* for *harm*, *boren*

for *born*, 1878, and *koren* for *corn*, 1879. There are several instances of words joined together, as *hau*i, 2002, *biddi*, 484; *shaltu*, 2186, *wiltu*, 905, *wenestu*, 1787; *wilte*, 528, *thenkeste*, 578, *shaltou*, 1800; *thouth*e, 790, *hauedet*, *youenet*, *hauenet*; *sawe*, 338; *latus*, 1772; where the personal pronouns *i*, *þu*, *he*, *it*, *we*, *us* are added to the verb. Hence, in l. 745, it is very likely that *calleth* is written for *callet*, i.e. call it; and on the same principle we can explain *done*s; see *Es* in the Glossary. In like manner *goddot* is contracted from *God wot*; and *þerl* from *þe erl*.

Nouns. As regards the nouns employed, I may remark that the final *e* is perhaps always sounded in the oblique cases, and especially in the dative case; as in *nedè*, *stedè*, &c. (see ll. 86-105), *willè*, 85, *gyuè*, 357, *blissè*, 2187, *cricè*, 2450; cf. the adjectives *longè*, 2299, *wisè*, 1713; also the nominatives *rosè*, 2919, *newè*, 2974. *Frend* is a pl. form; cf. *hend*, which is both a plural (2444) and a dat. sing. (505). In the plural, the final *e* is fully pronounced in the adjectives *allè*, 2, *hardè*, 143, *starkè*, 1015, *fremdè*, 2277, *bleikè* 470, and in many others; cf. the full form *bopen*, 2223. Not only does the phrase *none kines*, of no kind, occur in ll. 861, 1140, but we find the unusual phrase *neuere kines*, of never a kind, in l. 2691. Among the numerals, we find not only *þre*, but *þrinne*.

Pronouns. The first personal pronoun occurs in many forms in the nominative, as *i*, *y*, *hi*, *ich*, *ic*, *hic*, and even *ihc*; the oblique cases take the form *me*. For the second person, we have *þu*, *þou*, in the nominative, and also *tu*, when preceded by *þat*, as in l. 2903. We may notice also *hij*s for *his*, l. 47; *he* for *they*; *sho*, 112, *scho*, 126, *sche*, 1721, for *she*; and, in particular, the dual form *unker*, of you two, 1882. The most noteworthy possessive pronouns are *minè*, pl. 1365, *þinè*, pl. 620; *his* or *hise*, pl. *hisè*, 34; *ure*, 606; *youres*, 2800; *hirè*, 2918, with which cf. the dat. sing. *hirè* of the personal pronoun, 85, 300. *þis* is plural, and means *these*, in l. 1145. As in other old English works, *men* is frequently an impersonal pronoun, answering to the French *on*, and is followed by a singular verb; as in *men ringes*, 390, *men seyt and suereth*, 647, *men fetes*, 2341, *men nam*, 900, *men birþe*, 2101, *men dos*, 2434; cf. *folk sau*, 2410; but there are a few instances of its use with a plural verb, as *men haueden*, 901, *men shulen*, 747. The former is the more usual construction.

Verbs. The infinitives of verbs rarely have *y-* prefixed; two examples are *y-lere*, 12, *y-se*, 334. Nor is the same prefix common before past participles; yet we find *i-gret*, 163, *i-groten*, 285, and *i-maked*, 5, as well as *maked*, 23. Infinitives end commonly in *-en* or *-e*, as *riden*, 26, *y-lere*; also in *-n*, as *don*, 117, *leyn*, 718; and even in *-o*, as *flo*, 612, *slo*, 1364. The present singular, 3rd person, of the indicative, ends both in *-es* or *-s*, and *-eth* or *-th*, the former being the more usual. Examples are *longes*, 396, *leues*, 1781, *haldes*, 1382, *fedes*, 1693, *bes*, 1744, *comes*, 1767, *glides*, 1851, *þarnes*, 1913, *haues*, 1952, *etes*, 2036, *dos*, 1913; also *eteth*, 672, *haueth*, 804, *bikenneth*, 1269, *doth*, 1876, *lip*, 673. The full form of the 2nd person is *-est*, as *louest*, 1663; but it is commonly cut down to *-es*, as *weldes*, 1359, *slepes*, 1283, *haues*, 688, *etes*, 907, *getes*, 908; cf. *dos*, 2390, *mis-gos*, 2707, *slos*, 2706. The same dropping of the *t* is observable in the past tense, as in *reftes*, 2394, *feddes* and *claddes*, 2907. Still more curious is the ending in *t* only, as in *þu bi-hetet*, 677, *þou mait*, 689; cf. ll. 852, 1348. In the subjunctive mood the *-st* disappears as in Anglo-Saxon, and hence the forms *bute þou gonge*, 690, *þat þu fonge*, 856, &c.; cf. *bede*, 668. In the 3rd person, present tense, of the same mood, we have the *-e* fully pronounced, as in *shildè*, 16, *yeuè*, 22, *leuè*, 334, *redè*, 687; and in l. 544, *wreken* should undoubtedly be *wrekè*, since the *-en* belongs to the plural, as in *moten*, 18. The plural of the indicative present ends in *-en*, as, we *hauen*, 2798, *ye witen*, 2208, *þei taken*, 1833; or, very rarely, in *-eth*, as *ye bringeth*, 2425, *he (they) strangleth*, 2584. Sometimes the final *-n* is lost, as in *we haue*, 2799, *ye do*, 2418, *he (they) brenne*, 2583. There is even a trace of the plural in *-es*, as in *haues*, 2581. The present tense has often a future signification, as in *etes*, 907, *eteth*, 672, *getes*, 908.

Past tense. Of the third person singular and plural of the past tense the following are selected examples. WEAK VERBS: *hauede*, 770, *sparedè*, 898, *yemedè*, 975, *semedè*, 976, *sparkèdè*, 2144, *þankedè*, 2189; pl. *loueden*, 955, *leykeden*, 954, *woundeden*, 2429, *stareden*, 1037, *yemedè* (rather read *yemedén*), 2277, *makeden*, 554, *sprauleden*, 475; also *calde*, 2115, *gredde*, 2417, *herde*, 2410, *kepte*, 879, *fedde*, 786, *ledde*, 785, *spedde*, 756, *clapte*, 1814, *kiste*, 1279; pl. *herden*, *brenden*, 594, *kisten*, 2162, *ledden*, 1246; and, thirdly, of the class which change the vowel, *aute*, 743, *laute*, 744, *bitauhte*, 2212. Compare the past participles *osed*, 971, *mixed*, 2533, *parred*, 2439,

gadred, 2577; *reft*, 1367, *wend*, 2138, *hyd*, 1059; *told*, 1036, *sold*, 1638, *wrouth* = *wrout*, 1352. There are also at least two past participles in *-et*, as *slenget*, 1923, *grethet*, 2615, to which add *weddeth*, *beddeth*, 1127, In l. 2057, *knawed* seems put for *knawen*, for the rime's sake.

STRONG VERBS: third person singular, past tense, *bar*, 815, *bad*, 1415, *yaf*, or *gaf*, *spak*; *kam*, 766 (spelt *cham*, 1873), *nam*, *kneu*, *hew*, 2729, *lep*, 1777, *let*, 2447 (spelt *leth*, 2651), *slep*, 1280, *wex*, 281: *drou*, 705, *for*, 2943, *low*, 903, *slow*, 1807, *hof*, 2750, *stod*, 986, *tok*; 751, *wok*, 2093; pl. *beden*, 2774, *youen*, or *gouen*; *comen*, 1017 (spelt *keme*, 1208), *nomen*, 2790 (spelt *neme*, 1207), *knewen*, 2149, *lopen*, 1896, *slepen*, 2128; *drowen*, 1837, *foren*, 2380, *lowen*, 1056, *slowen*, 2414, &c. And secondly, of the class which more usually change the vowel in the *plural* of the preterite, we find the singular forms *bigan*, 1357, *barw*, 2022, *karf*, 471, *swank*, 788, *warp*, 1061, *shon*, 2144, *clef*, 2643, *sau*, 2409, *grop*, 1965, *drof*, 725, *shof*, 892; pl. *bigunnen*, 1011, *sowen*, 1055, *gripen*, 1790, *driue*, for *driuen*, 1966; also *bunden*, 2436, *scuten*, 2431 (spelt *schoten*, 1864, *shoten*, 1838), *leyen*, 2132, &c. Compare the past participles *boren*, 1878, *youen* or *gouen*, *cumen*, 1436, *nomen*, 2265 (spelt *numen*, 2581), *laten*, 1925, *waxen*, 302, *drawen*, 1925, *slawen*, 2000, which two last become *drawe*, *slawe* in ll. 1802, 1803.

We should also observe the past tenses *spen*, 1819, *stirt*, 812, *fauth* for *faut* or *fauht*, 1990, *citte*, 942, *bere*, 974, *kipte*, 1050, *flow*, 2502, *plat*, 2755; and the past participles *demd* for *demed*, 2488, *giue* for *giuen*, 2488, *henged*, 1429, *keft*, 2005.

Imperative Mood. Examples of the imperative mood singular, 2nd person, are *et*, *sit*, 925, *nim*, 1336, *yif*, 674; in the plural, the usual ending is *-es*, as in *lipēs*, 2204, *comes*, 1798, *folwes*, 1885, *lokes*, 2292, *bes*, 2246, to which set belong *slos*, 2596, *dos*, 2592; but there are instances of the ending *-eth* also, as in *cometh*, 1885, *yeueþ*, 911, to which add *doth*, 2037, *goth*, 1780. Indeed both forms occur in one line, as in *Cometh swiþe, and folwes me* (1885). Instead of *-eth* we even find *-et*, as in *herknet*, 1. These variations afford a good illustration of the unsettled state of the grammar in some parts of England at this period; we need not suppose the scribe to be at fault in all cases where there is a want of uniformity.

Of reflexive verbs, we meet with *me dremede*, 1284, *me met*, 1285, *me pinkes*, 2169, *him hungrede*, 654, *him semede*, 1652, *him stondes*, 2983, *him rewede*, 503. The present participles end most commonly in *-inde*, as *fastinde*, 865, *grotinde* (? *gretinde*), 1390, *lauhwinde*, 946, *plattinde*, 2282, *starinde*, 508; but we also find *gangande*, 2283, *driuende*, 2702. Compare the nouns *tīpande*, 2279, *offrende*, 1386, which are Norse forms, *tíðindi* (pl.) being the Icelandic for *tidings*, and *offrandi* the present participle of *offra*, to offer. But the true Icelandic equivalent of the substantive *an offering* is *offran*, and the old Swedish is *offer*; and hence we see at how very early a date the confusion between the noun-ending and the ending of the present participle arose; a confusion which has bewildered many generations of Englishmen. Yet this very poem in other places has *-ing* as a noun-ending *only*, never (that I remember) for the present participle. Examples of it are *greting*, 166, *dreping*, i.e. slaughter, 2684, *buttinge*, *skirming*, *wrastling*, *putting*, *harping*, *piping*, *reding*; see ll. 2322-2327. Such words are frequently called *verbal nouns*, but the term is very likely to mislead. I have found that many suppose it to imply *present participles used as nouns*, instead of *nouns of verbal derivation*. If such nouns could be called by some new name, such as *nouns of action*, or by any other title that can be conventionally restricted to signify them, it would, I think, be a gain. Amongst the auxiliary verbs, may be noted the use of *cone*, 622, as the subjunctive form of *canst*; *we mone*, 840, as the subjunctive of *mowen*; cf. *ye mowen*, 11; but especially we should observe the use of the comparatively rare verbs *birþe*, it behoves, pt. t. *birde*, it behoved, and *þurte*, he need, the latter of which is fully explained in the Glossary to William of Palerne, s.v. *þort*.

The prefix *to-* is employed in *both* senses, as explained in the same Glossary, s.v. *To-*. In *to-brised*, *to-deyle*, &c., it is equivalent to the German *zer-* and Mæso-Gothic *dis-*; of its *other* and *rarer* use, wherein it answers to the German *zu-* and Mæso-Gothic *du-*, there is but *one* instance, viz. in the word *to-yede*, 765, which signifies *went to*; cf. Germ. *zugehen*, to go to, *zugang* (A.S. *to-gang*), access, approach. There are some curious instances of a peculiar syntax, whereby the infinitive mood active partakes of a passive signification, as in *he made him kesten*, and *in feteres festen*, he caused him to be cast in prison (*or perhaps*, overthrown), and to be fastened

in fetters; l. 81. But it is probable that this is to be explained by considering it as a phrase in which we should *now* supply the word *men*, and that we may interpret it by “he caused [men] to cast him in prison, and to fasten him with fetters;” for in ll. 1784, 1785, the phrase is repeated in a less ambiguous form. See also l. 86. So also, in ll. 2611, 2612, I consider *keste*, *late*, *sette*, to be in the infinitive mood. Such a construction is at once understood by comparing it with the German *er liess ihn binden*, he caused him to be bound. In l. 2352, appears the most unusual form *ilker*, which is literally *of each*, and hence, *apiece*; cf. *unker*, which also is a genitive plural. It will be observed that the verb following is in the plural, the real nominative to it being *pei þre*. In l. 2404, the expression *þat þer þrette*, “that there threat,” recalls a colloquialism which is still common. The word *þrie*, 730, is, apparently, the O.E. adverb *thrie*, thrice; *liues*, 509, is an adverb ending in -es, originally a genitive case. *Þus-gate* is, according to Mr Morris, unknown to the Southern dialect; it occurs in ll. 785, 2419, 2586. I may add that Havelok contains as many as five expressions, which seem to refer to *proverbs* current at the time of writing it. See ll. 307, 648, 1338, 1352, 2461.

§ 28. ON THE METRE OF HAVELOK.

The poem is written in the familiar rhythm of which I have already spoken elsewhere, viz. at p. xxxvii of the Preface to Mr Morris’s edition of Genesis and Exodus. The metre of Havelok is rather more regular, but many of the remarks there made apply to it. The chief rule is that every line shall contain four accents, ³⁷ the two principal types being afforded (1) by the eight-syllable and nine-syllable lines—

- (a) For hém | ne yé|dē góld | ne fé, 44;
- (b) It wás | a kíng | bi á|rē dāwēs, 27;

and (2) by the seven-syllable and eight-syllable lines—

- (c) Hérk|net tó | me gó|dē men, 1;
- (d) Al|lē thát | he míc|h|ë fyndē, 42.

To one of these four forms every line can be reduced, by the use of that slighter utterance of less important syllables which is so very common in English poetry. It is not the number of *syllables*, but of *accents*, that is

essential. In every line throughout the poem there are four accents, with only two or three exceptions, viz. ll. 1112, 1678, &c, which are defective. In a similar manner, we may readily scan any of the lines, as e.g. ll. 2-4;

(c) Wi|uës, mayd|nës, and all|lë men

(b) Of a ta|lë þat | ich you | wile tellë ³⁸

(b) Wo-so | 't wil' her' | and þer|to duellë, &c.

Here the syllables *-nes* and in l. 3, *of a* in l. 4, and *it wile* in l. 5, are so rapidly pronounced as to occupy only the room of one unaccented syllable in lines of the strict type. However awkward this appears to be in theory, it is very easy in practice, as the reciter readily manages his voice so as to produce the right rhythmical effect; and, indeed, this variation of arrangement is a real improvement, preventing the recitation from becoming monotonous. Those who have a good ear for rhythm will readily understand this, and it seems unnecessary to dwell upon it more at length. But it may be remarked, that the three lines above quoted are rather *more irregular than usual*, and that the metre is such as to enable us to fix the instances in which the final *-e* is pronounced with great accuracy, on which account I shall say more about this presently. I would, however, first enumerate the rimes which seem to be more or less inexact or peculiar, or otherwise instructive.

I. *Repetitions*. Such are *men, men; holden, holde*, 29; ³⁹ *erþe, erþe*, 739; *heren, heren*, 1640; *nithes, knithes*, 2048; *youres, youres*, 2800. To this class belong also *longe, londe*, 172, *heye, heie*, 1151, 2544; where *longe, londe* is, however, only an assonance.

II. *Assonant rimes*. Here the rime is in the vowel-sound; the consonantal endings differ. Such are *rym, fyn*, 21; *yeme, quene*, 182; *shop, hok*, 1101 (where *shop* is probably corrupt); *odrat, bad*, 1153; *fet, ek*, 1303; *yer, del*, 1333; *maked, shaped*, 1646; *beþe, rede*, 1680; *riche, chinche*, 1763, 2940; *feld, swerd*, 1824, 2634; *seruede, werewed*, 1914; *wend, gent*, 2138; *þank, rang*, 2560; *bopen, ut-drowen*, 2658. To the same class belong *name, rauēn*, 1397, *grauen, name*, 2528; *slawen, rauēn*, 2676. *Henged, slenget*, 1922, should rather be called an imperfect rime. ⁴⁰ There is also found the exact opposite to this, viz., an agreement or *consonance* at the end, preceded by an apparent diversity in the vowel; as *longe, gange*, 795 (but see *longe*,

gonge, 843), *bidde*, *stede*, 2548, *open*, *drepen*, 1782, *gres*, *is*, 2698, *bope*, *rathe*, 2936 (but see *rathe*, *bathe*, 1335, 2542), *fet* (long *e*), *gret*, 2158; and not unlike these are some instances of loose rimes, as *bepe*, *rede*, 360, *knaue*, *plawe*, 949, *sawe*, *hawe* (where *hawe* is written for *haue*), 1187, *sawe*, *wowe*, 1962 (but see *wowe*, *lowe*, 2078, *lowe*, *sawe*, 2142, *wawe*, *lowe*, 2470). Observe also *bouth*, *oft* (read *vt* or *ut* = *out*?), 883, *tun*, *barun*, 1001 (cf. *toun*, *brun*, 1750, *champions*, *barouns*, 1032); *plattinde*, *gangande*, 2282, &c. *Eir*, *tofer*, 410, *harde*, *crakede*, 567, are probably due to mistakes. ⁴¹

III. Rimes which shew that the final *-en* was pronounced so slightly as to be nearly equivalent to *-e*. Examples: *holden*, *holde*, 29; *gongen*, *fonge*, 855; *bringe*, *ringen*, 1105; *mouthen*, *douthe*, 1183; *riden*, *side*, 1758; *wesseylen*, *to-deyle*, 2098; *slawen*, *drawe*, 2476. In the same way *hon* rimes to *lond*, 1341, owing to the slight pronunciation of the final *d*. ⁴²

IV. Rimes which appear imperfect, but may be perfect. *Riche* answers to *like*, 132, but the true spelling is *rike*, answering to *sike*, 290. *Mithe*, 196, should probably be *moucte*, as in l. 257, and it would thus rime with *poucte*. *Blinne*, 2670, should certainly be *blunne*; cf. A.S. *blinnan*, pt. t. s. *ic blan*, pt. t. pl. *we blunnon*; and thus it rimes to *sunne*. *Misdede*, 993, is clearly an error for *misseide*, as appears from the parallel passage in ll. 49, 50; and it then rimes with *leyde*. So in l. 1736, for *deled* read *deyled*, as in l. 2098. *Bope*, 430, has no line answering to it, and a line may have been lost. *Nicth*, *lict*, 575, is a perfect rime. *Halde*, *bolde*, 2308, may also be perfect. *For-sworen* answers to *for-lorn* (pronounced *for-loren*), 1423; *bitawte* to *authe* (pronounced *aute*), 1409; *yemede* (pronounced *yem-dè*) is not an improper rime to *fremde*, 2276; *anon* rimes with *iohan* (if pronounced *ion* or *John*, as indicated by the spelling *ion* in l. 177), 2562, 2956. Yet in another instance it seems to be two syllables, *Jo-han*; see *wimman*, *iohan*, 1720. ⁴³ *Speche* should be *speke*, and thus rimes to *meke*, 1065. *Stareden* should perhaps be *stradden*, or some such form, rightly riming to *ladden*, 1037. Under this head we may notice some rimes which throw, possibly, some light on the pronunciation. Thus, for the sound of *ey*, *ei*, observe *hayse*, *preyse*, 60; *leyke*, *bleike*, 469; *laumprei*, *wei*, 771; *deye* rimes to *preye*, 168; *day* to *wey*, 663; *seyd* to *brayd*, 1281; but we also find *hey*, *fri*, 1071; *hey*, *sley*, 1083, *heye*, *heie*, 1151; *heye*, *eie*, 2544; *leye*, *heye*, 2010; *heye*, *fleye*, 2750. *Fram*

rimes to *sham*, 55; yet the latter word is really *shame*, 83; *gange* is also spelt *gonge*, *halde* rimes with *bolde*, 2308. The pronunciation of *ware*, *were*, or *wore*, seems ambiguous; we find *sore*, *wore*, 236; *wore*, *more*, 258; *ware*, *sare*, 400; *wore*, *sore*, 414; *were*, *pere*, 741; *more*, *pore*, 921. For the sound of *e*, observe *suere*, *gere*, 388; *suereth*, *dereth*, 648; *eten*, *geten*, 930; *yet*, *fet*, 1319; *stem*, *bem*, 592; *glem*, *bem*, 2122; also *yeue*, *liue*, 198; *liue*, *gyue*, 356; *lyue*, *yeue*, 1217; *her*, *ther*, 1924; *fishere*, *swere*, 2230. For that of *i*, observe *cri*, *merci*, 270; *sire*, *swire*, 310; *swipe*, *vnblipe*, 140; *fir*, *shir*, 587; *sire*, *hire*, 909; *rise*, *bise*, 723; *fyr*, *shir*, 915; *lye*, *strie*, 997; *hey*, *fri*, 1071; *for-pi*, *merci*, 2500. For that of *o*, observe *two*, *so*, 350; *do*, *so*, 713; *shon*, *on*, 969; *hom*, *grom*, 789; *lode*, *brode*, 895; *anon*, *ston*, 927; *ston*, *won*, 1023; *do*, *sho* (shoe), 1137; *do*, *sho* (she), 1231; *stod*, *mod*, 1702; *ilkon*, *ston*, 1842; *shon* (shoon), *ston*, 2144; *croud*, *god*, 2338; *don*, *bon*, 2354; *sone* (soon), *bone*, 2504; *bole*, *hole*, 2438.⁴⁴ Only in a few of these instances would the words rime in modern standard English. For the *ou* and *u* sounds, observe *coupe*, *moupe*, 112; *yow*, *now*, 160; *wolde*, *fulde*, 354; *yw*, *nou*, 453; *bounden*, *wnden*, 545; *sowel*, *couel*, 767; *low*, *ynow*, 903; *sowen*, *lowe*, 957; *strout*, *but*, 1039; *pou*, *nou*, 1283; *doun*, *tun*, 1630; *crus*, *hous*, 1966; *wounde*, *grunde*, 1978; *bowr*, *tour*, 2072; *spuse*, *huse*, 2912. *Lowe*, 1291, 2431, 2471, should rather be *lawe*, as in l. 2767. These hints will probably suffice for the guidance of those who wish to follow up the subject. It is evident that full dependence cannot be placed upon the exactness of the rimes.

§ 29. ON THE FINAL -E, &c.

There can be little doubt that the final *-e* is, in general, fully pronounced in this poem wherever it is written, with but a very few exceptions; but at the same time it is liable to be elided when followed by a vowel or (sometimes) by the letter *h*, as is usual in old English poetry. In the following remarks, I shall use an apostrophe to signify that *e* is written, but not pronounced; thus “*wil*” signifies that “*wile*” is the MS. form, but “*wil*” the apparent pronunciation. I shall use an italic *e* to signify that the *e* is elided because followed by a vowel or *h*, as “*cuppe*” (l. 14); and in the same way, “*riden*,” “*litel*,” &c, signify that the syllables *-en*, *-el* are slurred over in a like manner. It will be seen that such syllables are, in general, slurred over when

they occur before a vowel or *h*; under the same circumstances, that is, as the final *-e*. When I simply write the word in the form “gode” as in the MS., I mean that the *-e* is *fully pronounced*; so that “gode” stands for “godë.”

The following, then, are instances. I follow the order in Mr Morris’s Introduction to Chaucer’s Prologue, &c. (Clarendon Press Series).

(A) In nouns and adjectives (of A.S. origin) the final *-e* represents one of the final vowels *a, u, e*, and hence is fully sounded even in the nominative case in such instances. Examples; gome (A.S. *goma*), 7, blome (A.S. *bloma*), 63, trewe (A.S. *treowe*), 179, knaue (A.S. *cnafa*), 308, 450, sone (A.S. *sunu*), 394.

(B) In words of French origin it is sounded as in French verse. Such words are scarce in Havelok. Examples: hayse, 59, beste, 279, miracle, 500, rose, 2919, curtesye (*miswritten* curteyse), 2876, cf. 194, drurye, 195, male, 48, large, 97, noble, 1263.

(C) It is a remnant of various grammatical inflexions:—

(1) it is a sign of the *dative* case in nouns; as, nede, 9, stede, 10, trome, 8, wronge, 72, stede, 142, dede (not elided, because of the *cæsura*), 167, arke, 222, erþe, 248, lite þrawe, 276. It also sometimes marks the accusative, or the genitive of feminine nouns: *accusatives*, cuppe, 14, wede, 94, brede, 98, shrede, 99, mede, 102, quiste, 219, sorwe, 238 (cf. *sorw’* in l. 240), sone, 308, knaue, 308, sone, 350, wille, 441: *genitives*, messe, 186, 188, helle, 405.

(2) In adjectives it marks—

(a) the *definite form* of the adjective; as, þe meste, 233, þe riche (not elided ⁴⁵), 239, te beste, 87, þe hexte [man], 1080, þat wicke, 1158, þat foule, 1158, þe firste, 1333, þe rede, 1397. This rule is most often violated in the case of *dissyllabic* superlatives; as, þe wictest’, 8, þe fairest, þe strangest, 1081, 1110; cf. 199, 200.

(b) the *plural* number. Examples abound, as, gode, 1, alle, 2, are, 27, yung = yunge, 30, holde, 30, gode, 34, 55, harde, 143, grene, 470, bleike, 470, halte, 543, doumbe, 543, &c.

The same use is often extended to possessive pronouns; we find the plurals mine, 385, 514 (but min', 392), þine, 620, hise, 34, 67, hure, 1231; and even the singulars hire, 84, 85, hure, 338, yure, 171. But the personal pronoun feminine is often hir', 172, 209; yet see l. 316.

(c) the *vocative* case, as, dere, 839, 2170; leue, 909.

(3) In verbs it marks—

(a) the infinitive mood; as, telle, 3, duelle, 4, falle, 39, beye, 53, swere, 254, be-bedde, 421, bere, 549, &c. On this point there cannot be a moment's doubt, for the form *-en* is found quite as often, and they rime together, as in 254, 255, cf. 29, 30. But it is well worth remarking that *-en* is slurred over exactly where *-e* would be, with much regularity. Examples are: riden, 10, biginnen, 21, maken, 29, hengen, 43, lurken, 68, crepen, 68, riden, 88, hauen, 270. Other examples are very numerous. But we sometimes find *-en* not slurred over, as, drinken, 15; and the same is true even of *-e*, but such cases are exceptional and rare.

(b) the gerund; as, to preye, 60.

(c) the past participle of a strong verb; as, drawe, 1802, slawe, 1803. But these are rare, as they are commonly written drawn, slawen, 2224.

(d) the past tense of weak verbs, where the *-e* follows *-ed*, *-t*, or *-d*. Examples are very numerous; as, louede = lov'de, 30, 35 (not elided), 37, hauede = hav'de, 343; cf. haued = havd', 336; þurte, 10, durste, 65, refte, 94; dede, 29, sende, 136, seyde, 228, herde, 286. Observe hated = hatede, 40. The plurals of these tenses are rarely in *-e*, generally in *-en*, as, haueden, 241, deden, 242, sprauleden = spraul'den, 475.

(e) the subjunctive or optative mood, or the 3rd person of the imperative mood, which is really the 3rd person of the subjunctive. This rule seems to be carefully observed. Examples are yeue, 22, thaue, 296, yerne, 299, leue, 406, were, 513, wite, 517, &c. So for the *first* person, as, late, 509, lepe (not elided), 2009, speke, 2079;

and for the *second* person, as, understonde, 1159, fare, 2705, cone, 622, 623.

(f) other parts of a *few* verbs; thus, the 1st person singular present, as, liue, 301, ete, 793, rede, 1660, wille, 388, where *wille* is equivalent to *wish*.

(g) present participles: thus, plattinde, 2282, is a half-rime to gangánde. In other places, the author is careful to place them before a vowel, as gretinde, 1390, lauhwinde, 946, starinde, 508, driuende, 2702, fastinde, 865.

(4) In adverbs the final *-e* denotes—

(a) an older vowel-ending; as, sone (A.S. *sóna*), 136, sone, 218, 251, yete (A.S. *géta*, as well as *gét*), 495, ofte (Swed. *ofta*, Dan. *ofte*), 227.

(b) an adverb as distinguished from its corresponding adjective, as, yerne, 153, loude, 96, longe, 241, more, 301, softe, 305, heye, 335, swiþe, 455, harde, 639. Hence, in l. 640, we should read *neye*.

(c) an older termination in *-en* or *-an*; as, þer-hinne, 322, 709, 712, henne, 843, inne, 855. Cf. A.S. *heonan*, *innan*.

(d) It is also sounded in the termination *-like*, as, sikerlike, 422. Hence, in baldelike, 53, *both* the *ees* are sounded; cf. feblelike, 418. When the final *-e* is slurred over before an *h* in *Chaucer*, *h* is found commonly to begin the pronoun *he*, or its cases, the possessive pronouns *his*, *hire*, or their cases, a part of the verb to *have*, or else the adverbs *how* or *heer*. The same rule seems to hold in *Havelok*. Observe, that *e* often forms a syllable in the *middle* of a word, as, bondeman, 32, engelondes, 63, pourelike, 322.

With regard to the final *-en*, it is most commonly slurred over before a vowel or the *h* in *he* or *haue*, not only when it is the termination of the infinitive mood, but in *many other cases*. One striking example may suffice:

He greten and gouleden and gouen hem ille, 164.

A still more striking peculiarity is that *the same rule often holds* for the ending *-es*. We find it, of course, forming a distinct syllable in plurals; as, *limes*, 86; and in adverbs, as, *liues*, 509. But observe such instances as *maydnes*, 2, *prestes*, 33, *vtlawes*, 41, *sipes*, 213, &c.

In the same way, when rapid final syllables such as *-el*, *-er*, *-ere*, &c., are slurred over, it will *generally* be found *that a vowel or h follows them*. Examples: *litel*, 6, *woneth*, 105, *bedels*, 266, *bodi*, 345, *deuel*, 446, *hunger*, 449. Compare *oueral*, 38, 54. There are many other peculiarities which it would take long to enumerate, such as, that *sworn* is pronounced *sworen*, 204; that the final *-e* is sometimes preserved before a vowel, as in *dedë am*, 167; that the word *ne* is very frequently not counted, as it were, in the scansion, as in 57, 113, 220, 419, the second *ne* in l. 547, and in several other places. But it must suffice to state merely, that when the above rules (with allowance of a few exceptions) are carefully observed, it will be found that the metre of *Havelok* is *very regular*, and *valuable on account of its regularity*.

It would therefore be easy to correct the text in many places by help of an exact analysis of the rhythm. But this, except in a very few places, has not been attempted, because the imperfect, but unique, MS. copy is more instructive as it stands. In l. 19, e.g. *wit* should be *wite*; in l. 47, *red* should be *rede*; in l. 74, *his soule* should be *of his soule*, &c. The importance of attending to the final *-e* may be exemplified by the lines—

Allë greten swiþë sore, 236;
But sonë dedë hirë fetë, 317;
þinë cherlës, þinë hinë, 620;
Grimës sonës allë þre, 1399;
Hisë sistres herë lif, 2395.

Mr Ellis writes— “These final examples suggested to me to compose the following German epitaph, which contains just as many final *e*’s, and which I think no German would find to have anything peculiar in the versification:

GRABSCHRIFT.

Diese alte reiche Frau
Hasste jede eitle Schau,

Preiste Gottes gute Gabe,
Mehrte stets die eig'ne Habe,
Liegt hier unbeweint im Grabe.

I think Havelok may be well compared with Goethe's ballad,

Es war ein König *in Thule*,
Gar treu bis an das Grab,
Dem, sterbend, seine Buhle
Einen goldenen Becher gab.

Es ging ihm nichts darüber,
Er leert' ihn jeden Schmaus,
Die Augen gingen *ihm* über
So oft er trank daraus.

Und als er kam zu sterben,
Zählt' er *seine Städt'* im Reich,
Gönnt' alles seinem Erben,
Den Becher nicht zugleich:—

and the end:—

Die Augen thäten *ihm* sinken,
Trank nie *einen Tropfen* mehr.

The *italicised* trisyllabic measures are fine. Observe also the elisions of final *-e* before a following vowel (*Städt'* being very unusual), and the omission of the dative *-e* in *im Reich*, to rhyme with *zugleich*."

I have only to add that my special thanks are due to Sir F. Madden for his permission to make use of his valuable notes, glossary, and preface, and for his assistance; as also to Mr Ellis for his notes, which, however, reached me only at the last moment, when much alteration of the proofs was troublesome. There are many things probably which Mr Ellis does not much approve of in this short popular sketch of the metre, in which attention is drawn only to some of the *principal* points. In particular, he disapproves of the term *slurring over*, though I believe that I mean precisely the same thing as he does, viz. that these light syllables are really *fully pronounced*, and not in any way forcibly suppressed; but that, owing to their being light

syllables, and occurring before vowel sounds, the full pronunciation of them does not cause the verse to halt, but merely imparts to it an agreeable vivacity. As I have already said elsewhere ⁴⁶— “A poet’s business is, in fact, to take care that the syllables which *are* to be rapidly pronounced are such as easily *can* be so; and that the syllables which are to be heavily accented are naturally those that *ought* to be. If he gives attention to this, it does not much matter whether each foot has *two* or *three* syllables in it.”

FOOTNOTES TO INTRODUCTION

Skip to [Emendations](#)

[1.](#) In particular, we find there a complete proof, supported by some fifty examples, that, *as* can be traced, through the forms *ase*, *als*, *alse*, *also*, to the A.S. *eall-swa*; a proof, that in the difficult phrase *lond and lithe*, the word *lithe* [also spelt *lede*, *lude*] is equivalent to the French *tenement*, *rente*, or *fe*; and, thirdly, a complete refutation of Mr Singer’s extraordinary notion that the adverb *swithe* means *a sword*!

[2.](#) In the same way, *William of Palerne* was prepared by me for the press, subject to his advice; see *William of Palerne*, Introduction, p. ii.

[3.](#) I say *nearly*, because I have not been able to verify *every* reference to *every* poem quoted. I have verified and critically examined all the citations from the *poem itself*, from Ritson’s *Romances*, Weber’s *Romances*, *Lazamon*, *Beowulf*, Chaucer, Langland, and Sir Walter Scott’s edition of *Sir Tristrem* (3rd edition, 1811).

[4.](#) To this, the reader is referred for fuller information.

[5.](#) “The word Breton, which some critics refer to Armorica, is here applied to a story of mere English birth.” Hallam; *Lit. of Europe*, 6th ed. 1860; vol. i. p. 36. See the whole passage.

[6.](#) “The Chronicler writes of him, f. 6. ‘Il feu le plus beau bacheleir qe vnqes reigna en Engleterre, *ceo dit le Bruit*, par quoy ly lays ly apellerunt *King Adelstane with gilden kroket*, pour ce q’il feu si beaus.’ We have here notice of another of those curious historical poems, the loss of which can never be sufficiently deplored. The term *crocket* (derived by Skinner from the Fr. *crochet*, uncinulus) points out the period of the poem’s composition, since the fashion alluded to of wearing those large rolls of hair so called, only arose at the latter end of Hen. III. reign, and continued through the reign of Edw. I. and part of his successor’s.”

[7.](#) See below, § 16.

[8.](#) The poems in MSS. Camb. Univ. Lib. Ff. 5. 48 and Dd. 14. 2 resemble this Chronicle, but do not mention Havelok’s name.

[9.](#) This proof is rendered unnecessary by the citations from it by Rauf de Boun in 1310, and by the age of our MS. itself.

[10.](#) *Hanelok* in Hearne, throughout, but undoubtedly *contra fidem* MSS.

[11.](#) The writing in the earlier portion (concerning Havelok) is hardly later than A.D. 1400.

[12.](#) Sir F. Madden adds— “collated with another of the same age, MS. Cott. Dom. A. x, and a third, of the 15th century, MS. Harl. 200.” I omit the collations; the words within square brackets are supplied from these other copies.

[13.](#) I omit the collations with MSS. Harl. 24 and 753. Sir F. Madden proves that this English version was made A.D. 1435, by *John Maundevile*, rector of Burnham Thorp in Norfolk.

[14.](#) Colbrande is the giant defeated by Guy in the Ballad of “Guy and Colebrande.” See *Percy Folio MS.*; ed. Hales and Furnivall, vol. ii. p. 528, where *Auelocke* means *Anlaf*.

[15.](#) Quoted in a note in Sir F. Madden’s preface, p. xxiii.

[16.](#) So then ought Hamlet; but the editor of Saxo Grammaticus says, “in antiquioribus regum Daniae genealogiis Amlethus non occurrit.” See Saxo Gram. ed. Müller, Havniæ, 1839; end of lib. iii. and beginning of lib. iv.; also the note on p. 132 of the *Notæ Uberiores*. The idea that Havelock is Amlet is to be found in Grundtvig, *North. Myth.* 1832, p. 565.

[17.](#) Havelok [*or* Hanelock, as it is sometimes read] is quite as like Anlaf, whence the blunder noticed in note 1, p. xviii. In the form Hablok, it is not unlike *Blecca*, who was a great man in *Lindesey* soon after the days of *Æthelberht* of Kent; see *Saxon Chronicle*, An. DCXXVII.

[18.](#) His account has been printed in the *Topographer*, V. i. p. 241. sq. 8vo, 1789. We follow, as usual, the MS. itself, p. 1.

[19.](#) Quoted in Brock’s *Biography of Sir H. Havelock*, 1858; p. 9.

[20.](#) *Æthelberht* of Kent reigned from A.D. 560-616 (56 years).

[21.](#) For this latter portion of the Preface I am entirely responsible.

[22.](#) *Nicole* is a French inversion of Lincoln. It is not uncommon.

[23.](#) The northern part of Lincolnshire is called *Lindsey*.

[24.](#) Hence the obvious origin of the legend of “Havelok’s stone,” and the local tradition about Grim’s casting down stones from the tower of Grimsby church.

[25.](#) Possibly Saltfleet, suggests Mr Haigh. Such, at least, is the position required by the circumstances.

[26.](#) In the Durham MS. it is Tiedfort, i.e. Tetford, not far from Horncastle, in Lincolnshire.

[27.](#) A name given to the S.E. part of Lincolnshire.

[28.](#) Here again is an allusion to “Havelok’s stone.”

[29.](#) Hence, by confusion, the placing of Havelok’s father in the time of *Ælfred*.

[30.](#) Or, as I should prefer to say, earlier than those times. The two kings spoken of in the Lay may have had names somewhat similar to these, which may have been replaced by the

more familiar names here mentioned.

[31.](#) Cf. Lappenberg's History of England, tr. by Thorpe, vol. i. pp. 145-154.

[32.](#) See the same statement in Fabyan's Chronicles, p. 112; ed. Ellis, 1811.

[33.](#) "Cf. K. Horn, 1005, where *haue* rhymes with *plawe*." —M. Mr A. J. Ellis would consider *slawen*, *knaue*, &c., as assonances— "Do not think of the pronunciation of modern *drawen*. Read *sla-wen*, *kna-ue*, an assonance. *Beþe* does *not* rhyme to *reden*; it is only an assonance." —Ellis. On the other hand, we find the spellings *rathe*, *rothe* instead of *rede* in ll. 1335 and 2817.

[34.](#) "*Qual* = *quhal*, the aspirate being omitted; and *quhal* = *whal*." —Ellis.

[35.](#) The use of *th* for *t* is not uncommon. In the *Romans of Partenay*, we have *thown*, *thaken*, *thouchyng*, &c., for *town*, *taken*, *touching*; see Preface, p. xvi. In the copy of *Piers Plowman* in MS. Camb. Univ. Lib. Dd l. 17, I have observed several similar examples. Cf. Eng. *tea*, Ital. *tè*, Span. *té*, with Fr. *thé*, Swed. *the*, G. Du. Dan. *thee*.

[36.](#) "Is *e* for *o* a mistake, or may it be compared with *preue* for *prove*, &c.?" —Ellis. I would observe that *greting* is the spelling of the *substantive* in l. 166.

[37.](#) "This *four accents* I consider to be a wrong way of stating the fact. . . The metre consists of four measures, each generally, not always, of *two* syllables, the first often *one* syllable, the others often of *three* syllables, and each measure has generally more stress on the last than on any other, but the accents or principal stresses in the verse are usually 2, sometimes 3, perhaps never 4." —A. J. Ellis. I need hardly add that such a statement is more exact, and that I here merely use the word *accent* in the loose sense it often bears, viz. as denoting the "stress," more or less heavy, and sometimes imperceptible, which is popularly supposed to belong to the last syllable in a measure. I must request the reader to remember that this present sketch of the metre is very slight and imperfect, and worded in the usual not very correct popular language. For more strict and careful statements the reader is referred to Mr A. J. Ellis's work on Early English Pronunciation. Until readers have made themselves acquainted with that work, they will readily understand what I *here* mean by "accents;" afterwards, they can easily adopt a stricter idea of its meaning.

[38.](#) "You cannot scan this line in any way. This method of doing it is quite impossible; it is a mere chopping to make a verse like this. The line is corrupt. Omit *þat*, and you have

Of | a tal' | ich you | wile telle

or better,

Of | a tal' | ich wil|e telle."

Ellis.

[39.](#) The number is that of the *first* line of the pair.

[40.](#) "You have omitted the curious *harde*, *krakede*, 567, here; it is only an assonance, not a mistake, I believe." —Ellis. But see [note to l. 567](#).

[41.](#) "On *i*, *e* rhymes, see p. 271, last line and following, of my Chap. IV. The *o*, *a* depend on a provincialism, and this applies to *sawe*, *wowe*; *beþe*, *rede*; *knaue*, *plawe*; *sawe*, *hawe*; &c. *Bouth*, *oft* is a case of assonance, *bouth* being *bought*, where properly the *ugh* is the voiced

sound of Scotch *quh*, and easily passes into *f*. The assonance is therefore nearly a rhyme. *Plattinde*, *gangande* is probably a scribal error. *Eir*, *toþer* is certainly a mistake; read

Swanborow, helfled, his sistres fair.”

Ellis.

We may then perhaps alter *gangande* to *ganginde*. I do not quite like writing the modern form *fair* instead of the old plural *fayre* in order to gain a rime to *eir*. Cf. ll. 1095, 2300, 2538, 2768.

[42.](#) “*Hon*, *lond* may arise from a Danism, or from an English custom at that time of not pronouncing *d* after *n* in *nd* final; Danish *Mand* and German *Mann* are identical.” —Ellis. I prefer to call it Danish; we English, now at least, often *add* a *d*, as in *sound*, *gownd*, from *soun*, *gown*.

[43.](#) “*Johan* is almost *Jon* in Chaucer, however written, but l. 177 wants a measure; read—

Bi [Jhesu] crist, and bi seint ion.

In l. 1720 also the verse is defective; omit *al*, and read—

In denemark nis wimman [non]

So fayr so sche, bi seint Johan,

where *seint* is a dissyllable; see p. 264 of my *Early English Pronunciation*. *Hey*, *fri*, 1071, is an error; read *hy*, and see p. 285 of my book. The other instances of *ei*, *ai* are all regular, the confusion of *ei*, *ai* being perfect in the thirteenth century. *Shame*, l. 88, is dative, and would prove nothing, but *shame* in Orrmin is conclusive. Hence in *sham*’, 56, we have an *e* omitted; compare p. 323 of my book, and the German *Ruh*’.” —Ellis. In other places, the spelling *heye* occurs, rather than *hy*: see ll. 719, 987, 1071, 1083, 1289, 1685, 2431, 2471, 2544, 2724, 2750, 2945, &c.

[44.](#) “The instances of *o* are all regular, except *croud*, *god*, 2338, which is a false rhyme altogether; *ou* = modern *oo*.” —Ellis.

[45.](#) *Riche* being both A.S. and French, has the *e* even when indefinite; a *riche* king, 841; a *riche* man, 373.

[46.](#) Preface to Mr Morris’s *Genesis and Exodus*, p. xxxviii.

EMENDATIONS, ETC.

This section is shown as printed. The editor’s corrections were variously handled. Minor changes to the primary text are shown in brackets and marked with mouse-hover popups. The more complicated or tentative emendations are given as supplementary footnotes, separately outlined. Additions to the

Glossary are marked in the same way. The following paragraph is part of the original text.

SOME emendations have been made in the text by inserting letters and words within square brackets. A few more may be noticed here.

p. 2, l. 47. The MS. has *red*; but it should be *rede*.

p. 3, l. 66. For the MS. reading *here* Mr Garnett proposed to read *othere*, which is clearly right.

p. 3, l. 74. For *his soule* (as in the MS.) we should probably read *of his soule*.

p. 3, l. 79. For *wo diden* (as in the MS.) we should read *wo so dide*.

p. 6, l. 177. *Read*— “Bi [ihesu] crist,” &c, to fill up; but this is doubtful; see l. 1112.

p. 18, l. 560. For *with*, Mr Garnett proposed to read *wilt*.

p. 20, l. 640. For *ney* (as in MS.) read *neye*, the adverbial form.

p. 21, l. 660. Perhaps there should be a comma after *Slep*, making the sense to be *sleep, son*, not *sleep soon*.

p. 23, l. 746. For *alle*, Mr Garnett proposed to read *shalle*.

p. 24, l. 784. Perhaps we should, however, read *se-weren*, and the note on the line (p. 93) may be wrong. See *Weren* in the Glossary.

See [Endnote](#).

p. 32, l. 1037. For *stareden* we should perhaps read *stradden*; see the Glossary.

p. 33, l. 1080. For *hexte* we should rather read *hexte [man]*; cf. l. 199.

p. 38, l. 1233. Mr Garnett suggested that *clopen* may mean *clothes*. If so, dele the comma after it.

p. 43, l. 1420. For *wolde* we should rather read *[he] wolde*.

p. 46, l. 1687. *þarned* is an error of the scribe for *þoled*; see the Glossary.

p. 47, l. 1720. Perhaps we should rather read—*is womman [non]*.

p. 47, l. 1733. *Bidde* must mean *offer*, rather than *bid* (as in the Glossary); unless it be miswritten for *bide* = tarry.

p. 47, l. 1736. The MS. reading *deled* should be *deyled*; cf. l. 2099.

p. 76, l. 2670. The MS. reading *blinne* should clearly be *blunne*. A few other suggestions of emendations will be found in the Glossarial Index. See the words *Arwe*, *Birþe*, *Felde*, *Sor*, *Tauhte*, *Þenne*, *Thit*, *Werewed*, *Wreken*, &c. See also the suggestions in the preface, pp. xxxix, xli, xlvi, xlvii.

p. 132, s.v. *Loken*. The reference to the *Ancren Riwe* is to MS. Titus D 18, fol. 17; cf. the edition by Morton (Camd. Soc. 1853), p. 56.

In the Glossary, *Dunten* is wrongly placed after *Dint*.

See [Endnote](#) for following items.

Also, *Greting* is wrongly placed before *Gres*.

Hal, more probably, is shortened from *half*, like *twel* from *twelue*.

Shoten, in l. 1838, means *rushed*, *darted*, *flew*.

Teyte may mean *lively*. My explanation is not generally accepted.

Bise occurs in l. 724.

-
-
Incipit bita Hævelok, quondam
Rex Anglie et Denemarchie.

Herknet to me, gode men,
Wiues, maydnes, and alle men,
Of a tale þat ich you wile telle,

4

Wo so it wile here, and þer-to duelle.
Þe tale is of haelok i-maked;
Wil he was litel he yede ful naked:
Haelok was a ful god gome,

8

He was ful god in eueri trome,

9

He was þe wicteste man at nede,
Þat þurte riden on ani stede.
Þat ye mowen nou y-here,

12

And þe tale ye mowen y-lere.
At the beginning ¹ of vre tale,
Fil me a cuppe of ful god ale;

15

And [y] wile drinken her y spelle,

16

Þat crist vs shilde alle fro helle!
Krist late vs heuere so for to do,
Þat we moten comen him to,

19

And wit[e] ² þat it mote ben so!

20

Benedicamus domino!

Here y schal biginnen a rym,
Krist us yeue wel god fyn!
The rym is maked of haelok,

24

A stalworþi man in a flok;

[Fol. 204, col. 1.]
Hearken!

I will tell you the tale
of Havelok,

a wight man at need.

First, fill me a cup of
ale.

Christ grant we may
do right!

The rime is about
Havelok.

He was þe stalworþeste man at nede,
þat may riden on ani stede.

¹ MS. Beginnig.

² See ll. 517, 1316.

GOOD KING ATHELWOLD IS KING OVER ALL ENGLAND.

IT was a king bi are dawes,
28

That *in* his time were gode lawes
He dede maken, an ful wel holden;
Hym louede yung, him louede holde,

³¹

Erl and barun, dreng and kayn,

32

Knict, bondeman, and swain,
Wydues, maydnes, prestes and clerkes,
And al for hise gode werkes.

He louede god with al his micth,

36

And holi kirke, and soth, ant rich;
Rich-wise ³ man he louede alle,
And oueral made hem forto calle;
Wreieres and wrobberes made he falle,

40

And hated hem so man doth galle;
Vtlawes and theues made he bynde,
Alle that he micthe fynde,
And heye hengen on galwe-tre;

44

For hem ne yede gold ne fe.

⁴⁵

In that time a man þat bore
[Wel fyfty pund, y woth, or more,] ⁴

There was once a king
who made good laws.

All loved him.

He hated traitors and
robbers.

At that time, men
could carry gold about
safely,

Of red[e] gold up-on hijs bac,

48

In a male with or blac,
Ne funde he non that him misseyde,
N[e] with iuele on [him] hond leyde.
Þanne micthe chapmen fare

52

Þuruth englond wit here ware,
And baldelike beye and sellen,
Oueral þer he wilen dwellen,
In gode burwes, and þer-fram

56

Ne funden he non þat dede hem sham,
Þat he ne weren sone to sorwe brouth,
An pouere maked, and browt to nouth.
Þanne was engelond at hayse; ⁵

60

Michel was svich a king to preyse,
Þat held so eng[e]lond in grith!
Krist of heuene was him with.
He was engelondes blome;

64

Was non so bold lond to rome,
Þat durste upon his [menie] bringhe
Hunger, ne here * wicke þinghe.
Hwan he felede hise foos,

68

He made hem lurken, and crepen in wros:
Þe hidden hem alle, and helden hem stille,
And diden al his herte wille.
Ricth he louede of alle þinge,

72

To wronge nicht him no man bringe,
Ne for siluer, ne for gold:—

[Fol. 204, col. 2.]

and boldly buy and
sell.

Then was England at
ease.

The king made his
foes hide themselves.

So was he his soule † hold.

To þe faderles was he rath,

76

Wo so dede hem wrong or lath,

Were it clerc, or were it knicth,

He dede hem sone to hauen ricth;

And wo [so] didnen ‡ widuen wrong,

80

Were he neure knicth so strong,

Þat he ne made him sone kesten,

And in feteres ful faste festen;

And wo so dide maydne shame

84

Of hire bodi, or brouth in blame,

Bute it were bi hire wille,

He 6 made him sone of limes spille.

He was te 7 beste knith at nede,

88

Þat heuere micthe riden on stede,

Or wepne wagge, or folc vt lede;

Of knith ne hauede he neuere drede,

91

Þat he ne sprong forth so sparke of glede,

92

And lete him [knaue] of hise hand-dede,

Hw he coupe with wepne spede;

And oþer he refte him hors or wede,

Or made him sone handes sprede,

96

And “louerd, merci!” loude grede.

He was large, and no wicth gnede;

Hauede he non so god brede,

Ne on his bord non so god shrede,

100

He befriended the
fatherless.

Them who wrought
shame he punished.

[Fol. 204b, col. 1.]

He made his foes cry
for mercy.

Þat he ne wolde þorwit fede,
Poure þat on fote yede;
Forto hauen of him þe mede
Þat for vs wolde on rode blede,

104

Crist, that al kan wisse and rede,
Þat euere woneth in ani þede.

He fed the poor.

3 MS. "Rirth wise."

4 Supplied from conjecture. Cf. v. 653, 787. A few more instances will be found where a similar liberty has been taken, for the purpose of completing the sense.

5 MS. athayse.

* For the MS. reading *here* Mr Garnett proposed to read *othere*, which is clearly right.

† For *his soule* (as in the MS.) we should probably read *of his soule*.

‡ For *wo diden* (as in the MS.) we should read *wo so dide*.

6 MS. Ke.

7 MS. Ke waste.

LWOLD IS ABOUT TO DIE.

¶ Þe king was hoten apelwold,
Of word, of wepne he was bold;

108

In engeland was neure knicth,
Þat betere hel þe lond to ricth.

110

Of his bodi ne hauede he eyr
Bute a mayden swiþe fayr,

112

Þat was so yung þat sho ne coupe
Gon on fote, ne speke wit mouþe.
Þan him tok an iuel strong,
Þat he we[l] wiste, and under-fong,

116

His name was
Athelwold.

He had but a young
daughter to succeed
him.

Þat his deth was comen him on:
And seyde, “*crist*, wat shal y don!

118

Louerd, wat shal me to rede!
I woth ful wel ich haue mi mede.

120

W shal nou mi douhter fare?
Of hire haue ich michel kare;
Sho is mikel in mi þouth,
Of me self is me rith nowt.

124

No selcouth is, þou me be wo;
Sho ne kan speke, ne sho kan go.
Yif scho couþe on horse ride,
And a thousande men bi hire syde;

128

And sho were comen intil helde,
And engelond sho couþe welde;

130

And don hem of þar hire were *queme*,
An hire bodi couþe yeme;

132

No wolde me neuere iuele like
Me þou ich were *in heuene-riche*!”

He feels he is dying,
and says,

“I am in trouble about
her.

Were she but of age,

I would not care for
myself.”

JMMONS HIS LORDS TO WINCHESTER.

Q uanne he hauede þis pleinte maked,
Þer-after stronglike [he] quaked.

136

He sende writes sone on-on
After his erles euere-ich on;
And after hise baruns, riche and poure,
Fro rokesburw al into douere,

[Fol. 204b, col. 2.]

He summons his
lords, from Roxburgh

140

That he shulden comen swiþe
Til him, that was ful vnþliþe;
To þat stede þe[r] he lay,
In harde bondes, niȝt and day.

144

He was so faste wit yuel fest,
Þat he ne mouthe hauen no rest;
He ne mouthe no mete hete,
Ne he ne mouchte no lyþe gete;

148

Ne non of his iuel þat coupe red;
Of him ne was nouth buten ded.

Alle þat the writes herden,
Sorful an sori til him ferdene;

152

He wrungen hondes, and wepen sore,
And yerne preyden cristes hore,
Þat he [wolde] turnen him
Vt of þat yuel þat was so grim!

156

Þanne he weren comen alle
Bifor þe king into the halle,
At winchestre þer he lay:
“Welcome,” he seyde, “be ye ay!”

160

Ful michel þank[e] kan [y] yow
That ye aren comen to me now!”

to Dover.

He can no longer eat.

All sadly obey his
summons.

They come to
Winchester.

LWOLD SELECTS EARL GODRICH TO BE HIS DAUGHTER'S GUARDIAN.

Quanne he weren alle set,
And þe king aueden i-gret,

They all mourn and
lament.

164

He greten, and gouleden, and gouen hem ille,
And he bad hem alle ben stille;
And seyde, “þat greting helpeth nouth,
For al to dede am ich brouth.

168

Bute nov ye sen þat i shal deye,
Nou ich wille you alle preye
Of mi douter þat shal be
Yure leuedi after me,

He prays them to tell
him who can guard his
daughter best.

172

Wo may yemen hire so longe,
Boþen hire and engelonde,
Til þat she [mowe] winan of helde,

175

And þa she mowe yemen and welde?”

176

He ansuereden, and seyden an-on,
Bi crist * and bi seint ion,
That þerl Godrigh of cornwayle
Was trewe man, wit-uten faile;

They answer, “Earl
Godrich of Cornwall.”

180

Wis man of red, wis man of dede,
And men haueden of him mikel drede.
“He may hire alþer-best[e] yeme,
Til þat she mowe wel ben quene.”

[Fol. 205, col. 1.]

* Read— “Bi [ihesu] crist,” &c, to fill up; but this is doubtful; see l. 1112.

184

Þe king was payed of that Rede;
A wol fair cloth bringen he dede,
And þer-on leyde þe messebok,
Þe caliz, and þe pateyn ok,

The king sends for
chalice and paten,

188

Þe corporaus, þe messe-gere;

189

Þer-on he garte þe erl suere,
Þat he sholde yemen hire wel,
With-uten lac, wit-uten tel,

for the earl to swear
upon.

192

Til þat she were tuelf ⁸ winter hold,
And of speche were bold;
And þat she covþe of curteysye,
Gon, and speken of luue-drurye;

His daughter is to
marry the best and
fairest man that can be
found.

196

And til þat she louen þoucte, ⁹
Wom so hire to gode thoucte;
And þat he shulde hire yeue
Þe beste man that micthe liue,

200

Þe beste, fayreste, the strangest ok:—
Þat dede he him sweren on þe bok.
And þanne shulde he engelond
Al bitechen in-to hire hond.

⁸ *Qu.* tuenti. Cf. v. 259.

⁹ MS. mithe. But see l. 257.

204

Q uanne ¹⁰ þat was sworn on his wise,
Þe king dede þe mayden arise,
And þe erl hire bitaucte,
And al the lond he euere awcte;

He gives up all
England to the earl, to
keep for her.

208

Engelonde eueri del;
And preide, he shulde yeme hire wel.

¹⁰ MS. Ouanne. And perhaps “his” should have been “þis.”

Pe king ne mowcte don no more,
But yerne preyede godes ore;

212

And dede him hoslen wel and shriue,
I woth, fif hundred sipes and fiue;
An ofte dede him sore swinge,
And wit hondes smerte dinge;

The king does
penance.

216

So þat þe blod ran of his fleys,
Þat tendre was, and swiþe neys.

¹¹And sone gaf it euere-il del;
He made his quiste swiþe wel.

He makes his will.

220

Wan it was gouen, ne micte men finde
So mikel men micte him in winde,
Of his *in* arke, ne in chiste,
In engelond þat noman wiste:

224

For al was youen, faire and wel,
Þat him was leued no catel.

¹¹ Some lines appear to be wanting here, such as—
“He þoucte his quiste þan to make,
His catel muste he wel bitake,” &c.

ATHELWOLD DIES.

Panne he hauede ben ofte swngen,
Ofte shriuen, and ofte dungen,

[Fol. 205, col. 2.]

228

“*In manus tuas, lou[er]de,*” he seyde,
Her þat he þe speche leyde.
To ihesu crist bigan to calle,
And deyede biforn his heymen alle.

The king dies.

232

þan he was ded, þere micte men se
þe meste sorwe that micte be;
þer was sobbing, siking, and sor,
Handes wringing, and drawing bi hor.

236

All mourn for him.

Alle greten swiþe sore,
Riche and poure þat þere wore;
An mikel sorwe haueden alle,
Leuedyes in boure, knictes in halle.

240

Q uan þat sorwe was somdel laten,
And he haueden longe graten,
Belles deden he sone ringen,
Monkes and prestes messe singen;

244

Masses are sung for him.

And sauterres deden he manie reden,
þat god self shulde his soule leden
Into heuene, biforn his sone,
And þer wit-uten hende wone.

248

He is buried and the
earl takes possession,

þan he was to þe erþe brouth,
þe riche erl ne foryat nouth,
þat he ne dede al engeland
Sone sayse intil his hond;

252

And in þe castels leth he ¹² do
þe knictes he micte tristen to;
And alle þe englis dede he swere[n],
þat he shulden him ghod fey baren;

256

till the maiden is
twenty years old.

He yaf alle men, þat god þoucete,
Liuen and deyen til þat him moucte, ¹³
Til þat þe kinges dowter wore

Tuenti winter hold, and more.

¹² Sir F. Madden printed “lechhe”; but the MS. may be read “leth he.”

¹³ So in MS. But the sense requires

“He gaf alle men, þat god *him* þouchte,
Liuen and deyen til þat *he* mouete,” &c.

GODRICH TAKES POSSESSION.

260

Þanne he hauede taken þis oth
Of erles, baruns, lef and loth,
Of knictes, cherles, fre and þewe,

²⁶³

Justises dede he maken newe,

264

Al engelond to faren þorw,
Fro douere into rokesborw.
Schireues he sette, bedels, and greyues,
Grith-sergeans, wit longe gleyues,

268

To yemen wilde wodes and papes
Fro wicke men, that wolde don scapes;
And forto hauen alle at his cri,
At his wille, at his merci;

272

Þat non durste ben him ageyn,
Erl ne baron, knict ne sweyn.
Wislike for soth, was him wel
Of folc, of wepne, of catel,

276

Soplike, in a lite þrawe
Al engelond of him stod [in] awe;
Al engelond was of him adrad, ¹⁴
So his þe beste fro þe gad.

Earl Godrich appoints
justices, sheriffs, &c.

[Fol. 205*b*, col. 1.]

He grows very rich,

and all England fears
him.

14 MS. “adred,” altered to “adrad.”

280

The maiden grows up
very fair.

Þe kinges douthur bigan þriue,
And wex þe fayrest wman on liue.
Of alle þewes w[as] she wis,
Þat gode weren, and of pris.

284

Her name is
Goldborough.

Þe mayden Goldeboru was hoten;
For hire was mani a ter igroten.

ICH PLOTS AGAINST HIS WARD.

Quanne the Erl godrich him herde
Of þat mayden, hw we[l s]he ferde;

288

Hw wis sho was, w chaste, hw fayr,
And þat sho was þe rithe eyr
Of engelond, of al þe rike:—
Þo bigan godrich to sike,

Godrich is vexed.

292

And seyde, “weþer she sholde be
Quen and leuedi ouer me?
Hweþer sho sholde al engelond,
And me, and mine, hauen in hire hond?

296

Daþeit hwo it hire thaue!
Shal sho it neuere more haue.
Sholde ic yeue a fol, a þerne,
Engelond, þou sho it yerne?

“Shall I give England
to a fool, a girl?”

300

Daþeit hwo it hire yeue,
Euere more hwil i liue!
Sho is waxen al to prud,

For gode metes, and noble shrud,
304
Þat hic haue youen hire to offte;
Hic haue yemed hire to softe.
Shal it nouth ben als sho þenkes,
'Hope maketh fol man ofte blenkes.'

308
Ich haue a sone, a ful fayr knaue,
He shal engelond al haue.
He shal [ben] king, he shal ben sire,
So brouke i euere mi blake swire!"
312

Hwan þis trayson was al þouth,
Of his oth ne was him nouth.
He let his oth al ouer-ga,
Þerof ne yaf he nouth a stra;

316
But sone dede hire fete,
Er he wolde heten ani mete,
Fro winchestre þer sho was,
Also a wicke traytur iudas;

320
And dede leden hire to doure,
Þat standeth on þe seis oure;
And þerhinne dede hire fede
Poureluke in feble wede,

324
Þe castel dede he yemen so,
Þat non ne micte comen hire to
Of hire frend, with [hire] to speken,
Þat heuere micte hire bale wreken.

328

My son shall have
England.

He lets his oath go for
nothing.

[Fol. 205b, col. 2.]

He sends the maiden
to Dover.

He shuts her up in the
castle.

O f Goldeboru shul we nou laten,
þat nouth ne blinneth forto *graten*,
þet sho liggeth in *prisoun*:

Ihesu *crist*, that *lazarun*

332

To liue broucte fro dede bondes,

He lese hire wit hise hondes;

And leue sho mo him y-se

Heye hangen on galwe tre,

336

þat hire haued in sorwe brouth,

So as sho ne misdede nouth!

May Christ release
Goldborough from
prison!

ABEYN IS KING OF DENMARK.

338

S awe nou forth in hure spelle;
In þat time, so it bifelle,

340

Was in þe lon of denemark

A riche king, and swyþe stark.

Þ[e] name of him was birkabeyn,

He hauede mani knict and sueyn;

344

He was fayr man, and wicth,

Of bodi he was þe beste knicth

þat euere micte leden uth here,

Or stede onne ride, or handlen spere,

348

Þre children he hauede bi his wif,

He hem louede so his lif.

He hauede a sone [and] douhtres two,

Swiþe fayre, as fel it so.

352

At that time there was
a king of Denmark,
called Birkabeyn.

He had three children.

He þat wile non forbere,
Riche ne poure; king ne kaysere,
Deth him tok þan he bes[t] wolde
Liuen, but hyse dayes were fulde;

Death came upon him.

356

Þat he ne moucte no more liue,
For gol ne siluer, ne for no gyue.

He sends for the
priests.

Hwan he þat wiste, raþe he sende
After prestes fer an hende,

360

Chanounes gode, and monkes beþe, ¹⁵
Him for to ¹⁶ wisse, and to Rede;
Him for to hoslon, an forto shriue,
Hwil his bodi were on liue.

[Fol. 206, col. 1.]

¹⁵ MS. "boþe." But "beþe" rimes to "Rede"; see l. 694.

¹⁶ MS. *forthm* to, the *hm* being expuncted.

ABEYN SELECTS EARL GODARD TO BE GUARDIAN OF HIS THREE CHILDREN.
--

364

Hwan he was hosled and shriuen,
³⁶⁵
His quiste maked, and for him gyuen,
His knictes dede he alle site,
For þorw hem he wolde wite,

He asks who will
guard his children?

368

Hwo micte yeme hise children yunge,
Til þat he kouþen speken wit tunge;
Speken and gangen, on horse riden,
Knictes an sweynes bi here siden.

372

He spoken þer-offe, and chosen sone
A riche man was under mone,

Was þe trewest þat he wende,
Godard, þe kinges oun frende;

376

And seyden, he Mouthe hem best loke,
Yif þat he hem vndertoke,
Til hise sone Mouthe bere
Helm on heued, and leden vt here,

380

In his hand a spere stark,
And king ben maked of denemark.
He wel trowede þat he seyde,
And on Godard handes leyde;

384

And seyde, “Here bi-teche i þe
Mine children alle þre,
Al denemark, and al mi fe,
Til þat mi sone of helde be;

388

But þat ich wille, þat þo[u] suere
On auter, and on messe-gere,
On þe belles þat men ringes,
On messe-bok þe prest on singes,

392

Þat þou mine children shalt we[l] yeme,
Þat hire kin be ful wel queme,
Til mi sone mowe ben knicth,
Þanne biteche him þo his Ricth,

396

Denemark, and þat þertil longes,
Casteles and tunes, wodes and wonges.”

Godard stirt up, an swor al þat
þe king him bad, and siþen sat

400

He chooses Godard.

He commends the
children to Godard.

He makes him swear
to take care of them,

and to give up the
kingdom to the boy.

Godard swears to do
so.

Bi the knictes, þat þer ware,
þat wepen alle swiþe sare
For þe king þat deide sone:
Ihesu crist, that makede mone
404
On þe mirke nith to shine,
Wite his soule fro helle pine;
And leue þat it mote wone
In heuene-riche with godes sone!

[Fol. 206, col. 2.]

ARD IMPRISONS THE THREE CHILDREN.

408

Hwan birkabeyn was leyd *in graue*,
þe erl dede sone take þe knaue,
Hauelok, þat was þe eir,
Swanborow, his sister, helfled, þe toper, ¹⁷

Godard shuts up the
children, Havelok,
Swanborough, and
Helfled, in a castle.

412

And in þe castel dede he hem do,
þer non ne micte hem comen to
Of here kyn, þer þei sperd wore; ¹⁸
þer he greten ofte sore,

416

Boþe for hunger and for kold,
Or he weren þre winter hold.
Feblelike he gaf hem cloþes,
He ne yaf a note of hise oþes;

He cares not for his
oaths.

420

He hem [ne] clopede rith, ne fedde,
Ne hem ne dede richelike be-bedde.

þanne godard was sikerlike

Vnder god þe moste swike,

He is a traitor.

424

þat eure in erþe shaped was,

With-uten on, þe wike Iudas.

Haue he þe malisun to-day

Of alle þat eure speken may!

428

Of patriark, and of pope!

And of prest with loken kope!

Of monekes, and hermites bope! ¹⁹

And of þe leue holi rode,

432

Þat god him-selue ran on blode!

⁴³³

Crist warie him with his mouth!

Waried wrthe he of norþ and suth!

Offe alle man, þat speken kunne!

436

Of crist, þat made ²⁰ mone and sunne!

Þanne he hauede of al þe lond

Al þe folk tilled in-til his hond,

And alle haueden sworn him oth,

440

Riche and poure, lef and loth,

Þat he sholden hise wille freme,

And þat he shulde[n] him nouth greme,

He þouthe a ful strong trechery,

444

A trayson, and a felony,

Of þe children forto make:

Þe deuel of helle him sone take!

May he be accursed!

Cursed be he by north
and south!

He plots against the
children.

¹⁷ Corrupt? Lines 410, 411 do not rime well together.

¹⁸ MS. were. But see l. 237.

¹⁹ Lines 430, 431, 432 rime together. NB. The words *holi rode* are written over an erasure.

²⁰ MS. mande.

H⁴⁴⁸ wan þat was þouth, onon he ferde

He goes to the tower
where they are.

To þe tour þer he worn *sperde*,
þer he greten for hunger and cold:
þe knaue þat was *sumdel* bold,
Kam him ageyn, on knes him sette,
452

[Fol. 206*b*, col. 1.]

And godard ful feyre he fer grette;
And Godard seyde, “Wat is *yw*?
Hwi grete ye and goulen nou?”
“For us hungreth swiþe sore:”—
456

Havelok says they are
hungry.

Seyden he wolden [*haue*] more,
“We ne haue to hete, ne we ne haue
Herinne neyther knith ne knaue
þat yeueth us *drinken*, ne no mete,
460

Haluendel þat we moun ete.
Wo is us þat we weren born!
Weilawei! nis it no korn,
þat men micte maken of bred?
464

“Alas, that we were
born!”

Vs ²¹ hungreth, we aren ney ded.”

²¹ MS. þs; of. l. 455.

ARD KILLS SWANBORGUGH AND HELFLED.

G odard herde here wa,
Ther-offe yaf he nouth a stra,
But tok þe maydnes bothe *samen*,
468
Al-so it were up-on hiis *gamen*;
Al-so he wolde with *hem* leyke,
þat weren for hunger *grene* and bleike.

Godard cares not.

Of boþen he karf on two here þrotes,

472

And siþen [karf] hem alto grotes.

Þer was sorwe, we so it sawe!

Hwan þe children bi þ[e] ²² wawe

Leyen and sprauleden in þe blod:

476

Hauelok it saw, and þe[r] bi stod.

Ful sori was þat seli knaue,

Mikel dred he mouthe haue,

For at hise herte he saw a knif,

480

For to reuen him hise lyf.

But þe knaue, ²³ þat litel was,

He knelede bifor þat iudas,

And seyde, “louerd, merci nov!

484

Manrede, louerd, bidði you!

Al denemark i wile you yeue,

To þat forward þu late me liue;

Here hi wile on boke swere,

488

Þat neure more ne shal i bere

He cuts the throats of
the two girls.

Havelok sees it, and is
afraid.

He begs Godard to
spare him,

ARD SPARES HAVELOK FOR A TIME.

Ayen þe, louerd, shel ne spere,

Ne oþer wepne ²⁴ that may you dere.

Louerd, haue merci of me!

492

To-day i wile fro denemark fle,

Ne neuere more comen ageyn:

Sweren y wole, þat bircabein

Neuere yete me ne gat:”—

offering never to
oppose him,

and to flee from
Denmark.

496

Hwan þe deuel he[r]de ²⁵ that,
Sum-del bigan him forto rewe;
With-drow þe knif, þat was lewe
Of þe seli children blod;

[Fol. 206*b*, col. 2.]

Godard has pity on
him.

500

Þer was miracle fair and god!
Þat he þe knaue nouth ne slou,
But fo[r] rewnesse him wit-drow. ²⁶
Of auelok rewede him ful sore,

504

And þoucte, he wolde þat he ded wore,
But on þat he nouth wit his hend

⁵⁰⁶

Ne drepe him nouth, ²⁷ þat fule fend!
Þoucte he, als he him bi stod,

508

Starinde als he were wod:
“Yif y late him liues go,
He micte me wirchen michel wo.
Grith ne get y neuere mo,

But he reflects

512

He may [me] waiten for to slo;
And yf he were brouct of liue,
And mine children wolden thriue,
Louerdinges after me

that, were Havelok
dead, his children
would be the heirs.

516

Of al denemark micten he be.
God it wite, he shal ben ded,
Wile i taken non oþer red;

ARD TELLS GRIM TO DROWN HAVELOK.

I shal do casten him in þe se, ²⁸

520

He determines to
drown him.

Ʒer i wile Ʒat he drench[ed] be;
Abouten his hals an anker god,
Ʒat he ne flete in the flod.”

Ʒer anon he dede sende

524

After a fishere Ʒat he wende,
Ʒat wolde al his wille do,
And sone anon he seyde him to:

“Grim, Ʒou wost Ʒu art mi Ʒral,

528

Wilte don mi wille al,
Ʒat i wile bidden Ʒe,
To-morwen [i] shal maken Ʒe fre,
And aucte Ʒe yeuen, and riche make,

532

With-Ʒan Ʒu wilt Ʒis child[e] take,
And leden him with Ʒe to-nicht,
Ʒan Ʒou sest se ²⁹ Mone lith,
In-to Ʒe se, and don him Ʒer-inne,

536

Al wile [i] taken on me Ʒe sinne.”
Grim tok Ʒe child, and bond him faste,
Hwil Ʒe bondes micte laste;
Ʒat weren of ful strong line:—

540

Ʒo was havelok in ful strong pine.
Wiste he neuere her wat was wo:

Ihesu crist, Ʒat made to go
Ʒe halte, and Ʒe doumbe speken,

544

Havelok, Ʒe of Godard wrenken!

He sends for a
fisherman, and says to
him,

“Grim, I will make
you free.

Throw this child into
the sea”.

Grim binds the child.

[Fol. 207, col. 1.]

Christ wreak thee of
Godard, Havelok!

²² MS. biƷ; of. l. 2470.

²³ MS. kaue.

²⁴ MS. “wepne bere,” where “bere” is redundant.

25 MS. hede.

26 Printed thus in the former edition:— “But to rewnesse him thit drow.” But the MS. has *fo*, not *to*, where *fo* is corruptly written for *for*, as in l. 1318; and the initial letter of the last syllable but one may be read as a Saxon *w* (*p*), not a thorn-letter (*þ*). It merely repeats the idea in ll. 497, 498.

27 Qu. mouth.

28 MS. she.

29 *So in MS. Qu. þe.*

LOK IS TAKEN TO GRIM’S COTTAGE.

Hwan grim him hauede faste bounden,
And sipen in an eld cloth wnden

A keuel of clutes, ful, un-wraste,

Grim gags the child.

548

Þat he [ne] mouthe speke, ne fnaste,

Hwere he wolde him bere or lede.

550

Hwan he hauede don þat dede,

Hwan ³⁰ þe swike him hauede hethede, ³¹

552

Þat he shulde him forth [lede]

And him drinchen in þe se;

Þat forwarde makeden he.

In a poke, ful and blac,

He puts him in a bag,
and takes him on his
back.

556

Sone he caste him on his bac,

Ant bar him hom to hise cleue,

And bi-taucte him dame leue,

And seyde, “wite þou þis knaue,

He puts him in charge
of his wife.

560

Al-so thou with * mi lif haue;

I shal dreinchen him in þe se,

For him shole we ben maked fre,

Gold hauen ynou, and oþer fe;

564

Þat hauet mi louerd bihoten me.”

30 We should rather read “*þan*.”

31 MS. he þede.

* For *with*, Mr Garnett proposed to read *wilt*.

SEES THAT HAVELOK IS THE KING’S SON.

Hwan dame [leue] herde þat,
Vp she stirte, and nouth ne sat,

567

And caste þe knaue adoun so harde,

568

Þat hise croune he þer crakede

Ageyn a gret ston, þer it lay:

Þo havelok micte sei, “weilawei!

Þat euere was i kinges bern!”

572

Þat him ne hauede grip or ern,

Leoun or wlf, wluine or bere,

Or oþer best, þat wolde him dere.

So lay þat child to middel nictþ,

576

Þat grim bad leue bringen lict,

For to don on [him] his cloþes:

“Ne thenkeste nowt of mine oþes

Þat ich haue mi louerd sworn?”

580

Ne wile i nouth be forloren.

I shal beren him to þe se,

Þou wost þat [bi-]houes me;

And i shal drenchen him þer-inne;

584

Ris up swiþe, an go þu binne,

And blou þe fir, and lith a kandel:”

She throws down
Havelok violently.

The child lies there till
midnight.

Grim tells his wife to
light the fire and a
candle.

Als she shulde hise cloþes handel
On forto don, and blawe þe ³² fir,

588

She saw þer-inne a lith ful shir,
Also brith so it were day,
Aboute þe knaue þer he lay.

⁵⁹¹

Of hise mouth it stod a stem,

592

Als it were a sunnebem;
Also lith was it þer-inne,
So þer brenden cerges inne: ³³
“Ihesu crist!” wat dame leue,

596

“Hwat is þat lith in vre cleue!
Sir ³⁴ up grim, and loke wat it menes,
Hwat is þe lith as þou wenes?”
He stirten boþe up to the knaue,

600

For man shal god wille haue,
Vnkeueleden him, and swiþe unbounden,
And sone anon [upon] him funden,
Als he tirned of his serk,

604

On his rith shuldre a kyne merk;
A swiþe brith, a swiþe fair:
“Goddot!” quath grim, “þis [is] ure eir
Þat shal [ben] louerd of denemark,

608

He shal *ben* king strong and stark;
He shal *hauen* in his hand
A[l] denemark and engeland;
He shal do godard ful wo,

612

[Fol. 207, col. 2.]

She sees a light
shining round the lad.

She bids Grim come
and see.

They find a mark on
his shoulder.

Grim says the lad is to
be king.

He shal him hangen, or quik flo;
Or he shal him al quic *graue*,
Of him shal he no *merci* haue.”

Þus seide grim, and sore gret,

616

And sone fel him to þe fet,
And seide, “louerd, haue *merci*
Of me, and leue, that is me bi!

Louerd, we aren boþe þine,

620

Þine cherles, þine hine.

He prays Havelok to
forgive him.

AND HIS WIFE FEED HAVELOK.

Lowerd, we sholen þe wel fede,
Til þat þu cone *riden* on stede,
Til þat þu cone ful wel bere

624

Helm on heued, sheld and spere.
He ne shal neuere wite, sikerlike,
Godard, þat fule swike.

Þoru oþer man, louerd, than þoru þe,

628

Sal i neuere freman be.

Þou shalt me, louerd, fre maken,
For i shal yemen þe, and waken;
Þoru þe wile i fredom haue:”

632

Þo was haveloc a bliþe knaue.

He sat him up, and crauede bred.
And seide, “ich am [wel] ney ded,
Hwat for hunger, wat for bondes

636

Þat þu leidest on min hondes;

Godard shall never
know about this.

[Fol. 207b, col. 1.]

Havelok is glad, and
asks for bread.

And for [þe] keuel at þe laste,
þat in mi mouth was þrist faste.
y was þe[r]-with so harde prangled,
640
þat i was þe[r]-with ney[e] strangled.”
“Wel is me þat þu mayth hete:
Goddoth!” quath leue, “y shal þe fete
Bred an chese, butere and milk,
644
Pastees and flaunes, al with suilk
Shole we sone þe wel fede,
Louerd, in þis mikel nede,
Soth it is, þat men seyt and suereth:
648
‘þer god wile helpen, nouth no dereth.’”

³² MS. þer.

³³ Qu. þrinne. See ll. 716, 761, 2125.

³⁴ Qu. stir, or stirt.

SAYS HE HAS DROWNED HAVELOK.

Þanne sho hauede brouth þe mete,
Haueloc anon bigan to ete
Grundlike, and was ful bliþe;
652
Couþe he nouth his hunger Miþe.
A lof he het, y woth, and more,
For him hungrede swiþe sore.
þre dayes þer-biforn, i wene,
656
Et he no mete, þat was wel sene.
Hwan he hauede eten, and was fed,
Grim dede maken a ful fayr bed;
Vncloþede him, and dede him þer-inne,

Dame Leve brings
him bread and cheese,
butter, &c.

Havelok eats all up
greedily.

Grim puts him to bed.

660

And seyde, “Slep * sone, with michel winne;
Slep wel faste, and dred þe nouth,
Fro sorwe to ioie art þu brouth.”
Sone so it was lith of day,

664

Grim it under-tok þe wey
To þe wicke traitour godard,
Þat was denemak a ³⁵ stiward,
And seyde, “louerd, don ich haue

Grim tells Godard he
has killed Havelok,

668

Þat þou me bede of þe knaue;
He is drenched in þe flod,
Abouten his hals an anker god;
He is witer-like ded,

672

Eteth he neure more bred;
He liþ drenched in þe se:—
Yif me gold [and] oþer fe, ³⁶
Þat y mowe riche be;

and asks for his
reward.

⁶⁷⁶

And with þi chartre make [me] fre,
For þu ful wel bi-hetet me,
Þanne i last[e] spak with þe.”
Godard stod, and lokede on him

[Fol. 207b, col. 2.]

680

Þoruth-like, with eyne grim;
And seyde, “Wiltu [nou] ben erl?
Go hom swiþe, fule drit, cherl;
Go heþen, and be euere-more

Godard bids him go
home, and remain a
thrall;

684

Þral and cherl, als þou er wore.
Shal [þou] haue non oþer mede;
For litel i [shal] ³⁷ do þe lede

To þe galues, so god me rede!

688

For þou haues don a wicke dede.

þou Mait stonden her to longe,

Bute þou swiþe eþen gonge.”

for he has done
wickedly.

* Perhaps there should be a comma after *Slep*, making the sense to be *sleep*,
son, not *sleep soon*.

35 *Qu.* Denemarkes.

36 Cf. l. 1225.

37 The MS. has “ig,” but the *g* is expuncted; and it omits “shal.”

SETS SAIL FOR ENGLAND.

Grim thoucte to late þat he ran

692

Fro þat traytour, þa wicke man;

And þoucte, “wat shal me to rede?

694

Wite he him onliue, he wile beþe

Heye hangen on galwe-tre:

696

Betere us is of londe to fle,

And berwen boþen ure liues,

And mine children, and mine wiues.”

Grim solde sone al his corn,

700

Shep wit wolle, neth wit horn,

701

Hors, and swin, [and gate] wit berd,

þe gees, þe hennes of þe yerd;

Al he solde, þat outh douthe,

704

That he eure selle moucte,

And al he to þe peni drou:

706

Grim fears that both
himself and Havelok
will be hung.

Grim sells his live
stock.

Hise ship he greyþede wel inow,
He dede it tere, an ful wel pike,

708

þat it ne doutede sond ne krike;
þer-inne dide a ful god mast,
Stronge kables, and ful fast,
Ores god, an ful god seyl,

712

þer-inne wantede nouth a nayl,
þat euere he sholde þer-inne do:
Hwan he hauedet greyþed so,

715

Hauelok þe yunge he dide þer-inne,

716

Him and his wif, hise sones þrinne,
And hise two doutres, þat faire wore,
And sone dede he leyn in an ore,
And drou him to þe heye se,

720

þere he mith alþer-best[e] fle.
Fro londe woren he bote a mile,
Ne were neuere but ane hwile,
þat it ne bigan a wind to Rise

724

Out of þe north, men calleth 'bise'
And drof hem intil engelond,
þat al was sipen in his hond,
His, þat hauelok was þe name;

728

But or he hauede michel shame,
Michel sorwe, and michel tene,
And þrie he gat it al bidene;
Als ye shulen nou forthwar lere, [38](#)

732

He fits up his ship
carefully.

He takes with him his
wife, his three sons,
his two daughters, and
Hauelok.

[Fol. 208, col. 1.]

A north wind arises,
called the *bise*, and
drives them to
England.

Yf that ye wilen þer-to here.

38 MS. here; *read* here. Cf. ll. 12, 1640.

FOUND THE TOWN OF GRIMSBY.

733

Grim went up the
Humber to Lindesey.

IN humber grim bigan to lende,
In lindeseye, Rith at þe north ende.
þer sat is ship up-on þe sond,

736

But grim it drou up to þe lond;
And þere he made a litel cote,
To him and to hise flote.

Bigan he þere for to erþe,

740

A litel hus to maken of erþe,
So þat he wel þore were
Of here herboru herborwed þere;
And for þat grim þat place aute,

744

þe stede of grim þe name laute;
So þat [hit] grimesbi calleth alle
þat þer-offe speken alle, *

There he built a house.

That place was called
Grimsby, after Grim.

And so shulen men callen it ay,

748

Bituene þis and domesday.

* For *alle*, Mr Garnett proposed to read *shalle*.

LOK DOES NOT LIKE BEING IDLE.

Grim was fishere swiþe god,
And mikel coupe on the flod;
Mani god fish þer-inne he tok,

Grim was a good
fisherman.

752

Boþe with neth, and with hok.

753

He tok þe sturgiun, and þe qual,
And þe turbut, and lax with-al,
He tok þe sele, and þe hwel;

He caught sturgeons,
turbot, &c.

756

He spedde ofte swiþe wel:
Keling he tok, and tumberel,
Hering, and þe makerel,
þe Butte, þe schulle, þe þornebake:

760

Gode paniers dede he make
Ontil him, and oþer þrinne,
Til hise sones to beren fish inne,
Vp o-londe to selle and fonge;

He had four panniers
made for himself and
his sons.

764

Forbar he neyþe[r] tun, ne gronge,
þat he ne to-yede with his ware;
Kam he neuere hom hand-bare,
þat he ne broucte bred and sowel,

[Fol. 208, col. 2.]

768

In his shirte, or in his couel;
In his poke benes and korn:—
Hise swink ne hauede he nowt forlorn.
And hwan he tok þe grete laumprei,

He used to sell
lampreys at Lincoln,

772

Ful we[l] he couþe þe rithe wei
To lincolne, þe gode boru;
Ofte he yede it þoru and þoru,
Til he hauede wol ³⁹ wel sold,

776

And þer-fore þe penies told.
þanne he com, þenne he were bliþe,

For hom he brouthe fele siþe
Wastels, simenels with þe horn,
780
Hise pokes fulle of mele an korn,
Netes flesh, shepes, and swines,
And hemp to maken of gode lines;
And stronge ropes to hise netes,

784

In þe se weren he ofte setes. 40 *

39 *Qu.* ful or al.

40 *Sic* in MS.

* Perhaps we should, however, read *se-weren*, and the [note](#) on the line (p. 93) may be wrong. See [Weren](#) in the Glossary.

and bring home
simnells, meal, meat,
and hemp.

See [Endnote](#).

LOK SELLS FISH LIKE THE BEST.

Þus-gate grim him fayre ledde.
Him and his genge wel he fedde
Wel twelf winter, oþer more:
788
Hauelok was war þat grim swank sore
For his mete, and he lay at hom:
Thouthe, “ich am nou no grom;
Ich am wel waxen, and wel may eten

792

More þan euere Grim may geten.
Ich ete more, bi god on liue,
þan grim an hise children fiue!
It ne may nouth ben þus longe,

796

Goddot! y wile with þe gange,
For to leren sum god to gete;
Swinken ich wolde for mi mete.
It is no shame forto swinken;

Thus they lived for 12
years.

Havelok thinks he eats
too much to be idle.

800
þe man þat may wel eten and drinken,
þat nouth ne haue but on swink long,
To liggen at hom it is ful strong.
God yelde him þer i ne ⁴¹ may,

It is no shame for a
man to work.

804
þat haueth me fed to þis day!
Gladlike i wile þe paniers bere;
Ich woth, ne shal it me nouth dere,
þey þer be inne a birþene gret,

He determines to carry
about panniers like the
rest.

808
Al so heui als a neth.
Shal ich neuere lengere dwelle,
To morwen shal ich forth pelle.”

⁴¹ MS. ine.

LOK GOES TO LINCOLN TO GET WORK.

On þe morwen, hwan it was day,
812
He stirt up sone, and nouth ne lay;
And cast a panier on his bac,
With fish giueled als a stac;
Also michel he bar him one,
816
So he foure, bi mine mone! ⁴²
Wel he it bar, and solde it wel,
þe siluer he brouthe hom il del;
Al þat he þer-fore tok

[Fol. 208b, col. 1.]

He carries a pannier
full of fish,

and sells them.

820
With-held he nouth a ferþinges nok.
So yede he forth ilke day,
þat he neuere at home lay.
So wolde he his mester lere;

824

Bifel it so a strong dere
Bigan to rise of korn of bred,
That grim ne coupe no god red,
Hw he sholde his meine fede;

828

Of havelok hauede he michel drede:
For he was strong, and wel mouthe ete
More þanne heuere mouthe he gete;
Ne he ne mouthe on þe se take

832

Neyþer lenge, ne þorn[e]bake, ⁴³
Ne non oþer fish þat douthe
His meyne feden with he[r] ⁴⁴ mouthe.

Of havelok he hauede kare,

836

Hwilgat þat he micthe fare;
Of his children was him nouth,
On havelok was al hise þouth,

⁸³⁹

And seyde, “havelok, dere sone,

840

I wene that we deye mone
For hunger, þis dere is so strong,
And hure mete is uten long.

Betere is þat þu henne gonge,

844

þan þu here dwelle longe;
Heþen þow mayt gangen to late;
Thou canst ful wel þe ricthe gate
To lincolne, þe gode borw,

848

Pou hauest it gon ful ofte þoru;
Of me ne is me nouth a slo,

A great dearth arises.

They have not enough
to eat.

Grim is sorry for
Havelok.

He advises him to go
to Lincoln,

Betere is þat þu þider go,
For þer is mani god man inne,
852
þer þou mayt þi mete winne.
But wo is me! þou art so naked,
Of mi seyl y wolde þe were maked
A cloth, þou mithest inne gongen,
856
Sone, no cold þat þu ne fonge.”

and work there.

He makes him a coat
of an old sail.

ELPS THE EARL OF CORNWALL'S COOK.

He tok þe sh[e]res ⁴⁵ of þe nayl,
And made him a couel of þe sayl,
And havelok dide it sone on;
860
Hauede neyþer hosen ne shon,
Ne none kines oþe[r] wede;
To lincolne barfot he yede.
Hwan he kam þe[r], he was ful wil,
864
Ne hauede he no frend to gangen til;
Two dayes þer fastinde he yede,
þat non for his werk wolde him fede;
þe þridde day herde he calle:
868
“Bermen, bermen, hider forth alle!”
[Poure þat on fote yede] ⁴⁶
Sprongen forth so sparke on glede.
Hauelok shof dun nyne or ten,
872
Rith amidewarde þe fen,
And stirte forth to þe kok,
[þer the herles mete he tok,]

[Fol. 208b. col. 2.]

Havelok goes to
Lincoln barefoot.

He fasts for two days.

Havelok becomes the
earl's cook's porter.

Ʒat he bouthe at Ʒe brigge:
876
Ʒe bermen let he alle ligge,
And bar Ʒe mete to Ʒe castel,
And gat him Ʒere a ferƷing wastel.

He gets a farthing
cake.

⁴² Cf. ll. 1711, 1972.

⁴³ See l. 759.

⁴⁴ *Qu.* her, *i.e.* their. MS. he.

⁴⁵ *Qu.* sheres. MS. shres.

⁴⁶ Cf. ll. 91, 101. Here and below an additional line seems requisite.

LOK IS HIRED BY THE EARL'S COOK.

Ʒet oƷer day kepte he ok
880
SwiƷe yerne Ʒe erles kok,
Til Ʒat he say him on Ʒe b[r]igge,
And bi him mani fishes ligge.
Ʒe herles mete hauede he bouth
884
Of cornwalie, and kalde oft:
“Bermen, bermen, hider swiƷe!”
Hauelok it herde, and was ful bliƷe,
Ʒat he herde “bermen” calle;

Another day, he
watches the earl's
cook,

who calls for a porter.

888
Alle made he hem dun falle
Ʒat in his gate yeden and stode,
Wel sixtene laddes gode.
Als he lep Ʒe kok [vn-]til,

Havelok upsets 16
lads.

892
He shof hem alle upon an hyl;
Astirte til him with his rippe,
And bigan Ʒe fish to kippe.
He bar up wel a carte lode

He catches up the
cook's fish,

896

Of segges, laxes, of playces brode,
Of grete laumprees, and of eles;
Sparede he neyþer tos ne heles,
Til þat he to þe castel cam,

and carries them to the
castle.

900

Þat men fro him his birþene nam.
Þan men haueden holpen him doun
With þe birþene of his croun,

903

Þe kok [bi] stod, and on him low,

904

And þoute him stalworþe man ynow,
And seyde, “wiltu ben wit me?

[Fol. 209, col. 1.]

Gladlike wile ich feden þe;
Wel is set þe mete þu etes,

The cook takes him
into his service.

908

And þe hire þat þu getes.”

JTS WOOD, AND DRAWS WATER.

“**G**oddot!” ⁴⁷ quoth he, “leue sire,
Bidde ich you non oþer hire;
But yeueþ me inow to ete,

912

Fir and water y wile yow fete,
Þe fir blowe, an ful wele maken;
Stickes kan ich breken and kraken,
And kindlen ful wel a fyr,

Havelok tells the cook
what he can do.

916

And maken it to brennen shir;
Ful wel kan ich cleuen shides,
Eles to-turnen ⁴⁸ of here hides;
Ful wel kan ich dishes swilen,

920

And don al þat ye euere wilen.”

Quoth þe kok, “wile i no more;

Go þu yunder, and sit þore,

And y shal yeue þe ful fair bred,

924

And make þe broys in þe led.

Sit now down and et ful yerne:

Daþeit hwo þe mete werne!”

The cook is content to hire him.

⁴⁷ Soddot, MS.

⁴⁸ MS. to turuen; *but the u and n are almost indistinguishable*. Cf. l. 603; and *William of Palerne*, 2590.

LOK GROWS VERY TALL AND STRONG.

Hauelok sette him dun anon,
928

Also stille als a ston,

Til he hauede ful wel eten;

Þo hauede hauelok fayre geten.

Hwan he hauede eten inow,

932

He kam to þe welle, water up-drow,

And filde þe[r] a michel so;

Bad he non ageyn him go,

But bi-twen his hondes he bar it in,

936

A[l] him one to þe kichin.

Bad he non him water to fete,

Ne fro b[r]igge to bere þe mete,

⁹³⁹

He bar þe turues, he bar þe star,

940

Þe wode fro the brigge he bar;

Havelok eats a good dinner.

He fills a large tub with water for the kitchen.

Al that euere shulden he nytte,
Al he drow, and al he citte;
Wolde he neuere hauen rest,

944

More þan he were a best.

945

Of alle men was he mest meke,
Lauhwinde ay, and blipe of speke;
Euere he was glad and blipe,

948

His sorwe he coupe ful wel miþe.
It ne was non so litel knaue,
For to leyken, ne forto plawe,
Þat he ne wo[l]de with him pleye:

952

Þe children that y[e]den in þe weie
Of him he deden al he[r] wille,
And with him leykeden here fille.
Him loueden alle, stille and bolde,

956

Knictes, children, yunge and holde;
Alle him loueden þat him sowen,
Boþen heyemen and lowe.

959

Of him ful wide þe word sprong,

960

Hw he was mike, hw he was strong,
Hw fayr man god him hauede maked,
But on þat he was alмест naked:
For he ne hauede nouth to shride,

964

But a kouel ful unride,
Þat [was] ful, and swiþe wicke,
Was it nouth worth a fir sticke.

He draws water, and
cuts wood.

He is always laughing
and blithe.

[Fol. 209, col. 2.]

Children play with
him.

All like him.

He has nothing to
wear but the old sail.

Þe cok bigan of him to rewe,
968
And bouthe him cloþes, al spannewe;
He bouthe him boþe hosen and shon,
And sone dide him dones on.
Hwan he was cloþed, used, and shod,
972

The cook buys him
new clothes.

He looks very well in
his new suit.

Was non so fayr under god,
Þat euere yete in erþe were,
Non þat euere moder bere;
It was neuere man þat yemedede
976
In kinneriche, þat so wel semede
King or cayser forto be,
Þan he was shrid, so semede he;
For þanne he weren alle samen
980

Havelok is the tallest
man in Lincoln,

At lincolne, at þe gamen,
And þe erles men woren al þore,
Þan was havelok bi þe shuldren more
Þan þe meste þat þer kam:

984

In armes him noman [ne] nam,
Þat he doune sone ne caste;
Havelok stod ouer hem als a mast.
Als he was heie, al ⁴⁹ he was long,
988

He was boþe stark and strong;
In engelond [was] non hise per
Of strengþe þat euere kam him ner.
Als he was strong, so was he softe;

and the strongest in
England.

992

Þey a man him misdede ofte,
Neuere more he him misdede,
Ne hond on him with yuele leyde.
Of bodi was he mayden clene,

[Fol. 209b, col. 1.]

He is good-natured
and pure.

996

Neuere yete in game, ne in grene,
Þit ⁵⁰ hire ne wolde leyke ne lye,
No more þan it were a strie.

In þat time al hengelond

1000

Þerl Godrich hauede in his hond,
And he gart komen into þe tun
Mani erl, and mani barun;
And alle [men] þat liues were

Godrich summons a
parliament at Lincoln.

1004

In eng[e]lond, þanne wer þere,
Þat þey haueden after sent,

¹⁰⁰⁶

To ben þer at þe parlement.

With hem com mani chanbioun,

Some champions
begin to contend in
games.

1008

Mani with ladde, blac and brown;
An fel it so, þat yunge men,
Wel abouten nine or ten,
Bigunnen þe[r] for to layke:

1012

Þider komen bothe stronge and wayke;
Þider komen lesse and more,
Þat in þe borw þanne weren þore;
Chaunpiouns, and starke laddes,

Strong lads and
bondmen are there.

1016

Bondemen with here gaddes,
Als he comen fro þe plow;

Pere was sembling i-now!
For it ne was non horse-knaue,
1020
þo þei sholden in honde haue,
þat he ne kam þider, þe leyk to se:

1022

Biforn here fet þanne lay a tre,
And putten ⁵¹ with a mikel ston

1024

þe starke laddes, ful god won.

They begin to “put the stone.”

UTS THE STONE” FURTHER THAN ANY.

þe ston was mikel, and ek greth,
And al so heui so a neth;
Grund stalwrthe man he sholde be,

1028

þat mouthe liften it to his kne;
Was þer neyþer clerc, ne prest,
þat mithe liften it to his brest:
þerwit putten the chaunpiouns,

1032

þat þider comen with þe barouns.
Hwo so mithe putten þore
Biforn a-noþer, an inch or more,
Wore ye yung, [or] wore he hold,

1036

He was for a kempe told.

Al-so þe[i] stoden, an ofte streden, ^{*}
þe chaunpiouns, and ek the ladden,
And he maden mikel strout

1040

Abouten þe alperbeste but,
Hauelok stod, and lokede þer-til;

Few can lift it.

Whilst this is going on,

[Fol. 209b, col. 2.]

Havelok looks on at them.

And of puttingge he was ful wil,
For neuere yete ne saw he or

1044

Putten the stone, or þanne þor.
Hise mayster bad him gon þer-to,
Als he couþe þer-with do.

His master tells him to try.

Þo hise mayster it him bad,

1048

He was of him sore adrad;
Þerto he stirte sone anon,
And kipte up þat heui ston,
Þat he sholde puten wiþe;

1052

He putte at þe firste siþe,
Ouer alle þat þer wore,
Twel fote, and sumdel more.
Þe chaunpiouns þat [þat] put sowen,
1056
Shuldreden he ilc oþer, and lowen;
Wolden he no more to putting gange,
But seyde, “we ⁵² dwellen her to longe!”

He puts the stone 12 feet beyond the rest.

WICH HEARS OF HAVELOK'S STRENGTH.

Þis selkouth mithe nouth ben hyd,

1060

Ful sone it was ful loude kid
Of hauelok, hw he warp þe ston
Ouer þe laddes euerilkon;
Hw he was fayr, hw he was long,

1064

Hw he was with, hw he was strong;
Þoruth england yede þe speke, ⁵³
Hw he was strong, and ek meke;

This feat is everywhere talked about.

In the castel, up in þe halle,

1068

Þe knithes speken þer-of alle,

So that Godrich it herde wel

Þe[r] speken of havelok, eueri del,

Hw he was strong man and hey,

1072

Hw he was strong and ek fri,

And þouthte godrich, “þoru þis knaue

Shal ich engelond al haue,

And mi sone after me;

1076

For so i wile þat it be.

1077

The king apelwald me dide swere

Vpon al þe messe-gere,

Þat y shu[l]de his douthe[r] yeue

1080

Þe hexte [man] þat mithe liue,

Þe beste, þe fairest, þe strangest ok;

Þat gart he me sweren on þe bok.

Hwere mithe i finden ani so hey

1084

So havelok is, or so sley?

Þou y southe heþen in-to ynde,

So fayr, so strong, ne mithe y finde.

Havelok is þat ilke knaue,

1088

Þat shal goldeborw haue.”

Þis þouthte [he] with trechery,

With traysoun, and wit felony;

For he wende, þat havelok wore

1092

Sum cherles sone, and no more;

Godrich hears the
knights talking of it.

“Athelwold said I was
to marry his daughter
to the strongest man
alive.

[Fol. 210, col. 1.]

That is Havelok.”

Ne shulde he hauen of engellond
Onlepi forw in his hond,
With hire, þat was þerof eyr,

1096

Þat boþe was god and swiþe fair.
He wende, þat havelok wer a þral,
Þer-þoru he wende hauen al
In engelond, þat hire rith was;

1100

He was werse þan sathanas,
Þat ihesu crist in erþe shop: ⁵⁴
Hanged worþe he on an hok!

He thought Havelok
was only a thrall.

⁴⁹ *Qu.* so; see l. 991.

⁵⁰ *Qu.* wit = with: miswritten owing to confusion of þ with p (w)?

⁵¹ MS. pulten. But see ll. 1031, 1033, 1044, 1051, &c.

* For *stareden* we should perhaps read *stradden*; see the [Glossary](#).

⁵² In the former edition— “ye”. But the y is not dotted, and it may be “pe.”

⁵³ MS. speche. Read “speke,” as in l. 946.

⁵⁴ *Qu.* shok or strok.

BOROUGH IS SENT FOR TO LINCOLN.

¹¹⁰³

After goldebo[r]w sone he sende,
1104

Þat was boþe fayr and hende,
And dide hire to lincolne bringe,
Belles dede he ageyn hire ringen,
And ioie he made hire swiþe mikel,
1108

But neþeles he was ful swikel.
He seyde, þat he sholde hire yeue
Þe fayrest man that mithe liue.
She answerede, and seyde anon,

He sends for
Goldborough to
Lincoln.

1112

Bi crist, and bi seint iohan,
þat hire sholde noman wedde,
Ne noman bringen to hire ⁵⁵ bedde,
But he were king, or kinges eyr,

1116

Were he neuere man so fayr.

⁵⁵ *Qu. hise.*

She says she will
marry none but a king.

ICH ASKS HAVELOK IF HE WILL MARRY.

Godrich þe erl was swiþe wroth,
þat she swore swilk an oth,
And seyde, “hwor þou wilt be

1120

Quen and leuedi ouer me?
þou shalt hauen a gadeling,
Ne shalt þou hauen non oþer king;
þe shal spusen mi cokes knaue,

1124

Ne shalt þou non oþer louerd haue.
Daþeit þat þe oþer yeue
Euere more hwil i liue!

To-mo[r]we ye sholen ben weddeth,

1128

And, maugre þin, to-gidere beddeth.”

Goldeborw gret, and was ⁵⁶ hire ille,
She wolde ben ded bi hire wille.

On the morwen, hwan day was sprungun,

1132

And day-belle at kirke rungen,
After havelok sente þat iudas,
þat werse was þanne sathanas:
And seyde, “mayster, wille wif?”

Godrich is wrath at
this.

He says she shall
marry his cook’s
servant.

[Fol. 210, col. 2.]

He sends next day for
Havelok, and says,

1136

“Nay,” quoth, havelok, “bi my lif!
Hwat sholde ich with wif do?
I ne may hire fede, ne cloþe, ne sho.
Wider sholde ich wimman bringe?

“Master, wilt wive?”

1140

I ne haue none kines þinge.
I ne haue hws, y ne haue cote,
Ne i ne ⁵⁷ haue stikke, y ne haue sprote,
I ne haue neyþer bred ne sowel,

Havelok refuses.

1144

Ne cloth, but of an hold with couel.
Þis cloþes, þat ich onne haue,
Aren þe kokes, and ich his knaue.”
Godrich stirt up, and on him dong

Godrich beats him,
and threatens to hang
him.

1148

[With dintes swiþe hard and strong,]
And seyde, “But þou hire take,
Þat y wole yeuen þe to make,
I shal hangen þe ful heye,

1152

Or y shal þristen vth þin heie.”
Hauelok was one, and was odrat,
And grauntede him al þat he bad.
Þo sende he after hire sone,

Havelok consents.

1156

Þe fayrest wymman under mone;
And seyde til hire, [false] ⁵⁸ and slike,
Þat wicke þral, þat foule swike:
“But þu þis man under-stonde,

Godrich next threatens
Goldborough.

1160

I shal flemen þe of londe;
Or þou shal to þe galwes renne,
And þer þou shalt in a fir brenne.”

Sho was adrad, for he so þrette,

1164

And durste nouth þe spusing lette,

But þey hire likede swiþe ille,

Pouthe it was godes wille:

God, þat makes to growen þe korn,

1168

Formede hire wimman to be born.

Hwan he hauede don him for drede,

Þat he sholde hire spusen, and fede,

And þat she sholde til him holde,

1172

Þer weren penies þicke tolde,

Mikel plente upon þe bok:

1174

He ys hire yaf, and she as tok.

He weren spused fayre and wel,

1176

Þe messe he deden eueridel,

Þat fel to spusing, and god cle[r]k,

Þe erchebishop uth of yerke,

Þat kam to þe parlement,

1180

Als god him hauede þider sent.

She consents, thinking
it is God's will.

A dowry is given her.

[Fol. 210b, col. 1.]

The archbishop of
York marries them.

⁵⁶ The first letter of this word is either *þ* or a Saxon *w* (*p*). I read it as the latter.

⁵⁷ MS. *ine*.

⁵⁸ Both sense and metre require this word.

LOK RESOLVES TO GO TO GRIMSBY.

Hwan he weren togydere *in* godes lawe,

Þat þe folc ful wel it sawe,

He ne wisten hwat he mouthen,

1184

Ne he ne wisten wat hem douth;
þer to dwellen, or þenne to gonge,
þer ne wolden he dwellen longe,
For he wisten, and ful wel sawe,

1188

þat godrich hem hatede, þe deuel him hawe!
And yf he dwelleden þer outh—
þat fel havelok ful wel on þouth—
Men sholde don his leman shame,

1192

Or elles bringen in wicke blame.
þat were him leuere to ben ded,
For-þi he token anoper red,

Havelok knows not
what to do.

He determines to go to
Grimsby.

'S CHILDREN WELCOME HAVELOK.

þat þei sholden þenne fle

1196

Til grim, and til hise sonas þre;
þer wenden he alþer-best to spede,
Hem forto cloþe, and for to fede.

þe lond he token under fote,

1200

Ne wisten he non oper bote,
And helden ay the riþe [sti] ⁵⁹
Til he komen to grimesby.

¹²⁰³

þanne he komen þere, þanne was grim ded,

1204

Of him ne haueden he no red;
But hise children alle fyue
Alle weren yet on liue;
þat ful fayre ayen hem neme,

1208

He finds that Grim is
dead, but his five
children are alive.

Hwan he wisten þat he keme,
And maden ioie swiþe mikel,
Ne weren he neuere ayen hem fikel.

On knes ful fayre he hem setten,

1212

And hanelok swiþe fayre gretten,
And seyden, “welkome, louerd dere!
And welkome be þi fayre fere!

They welcome
Havelok very kindly.

Blessed be þat ilke þrawe,

1216

Þat þou hire toke in godes lawe!
Wel is hus we sen þe on lyue,
Þou mithe us boþe selle and yeue;
Þou mayt us boþe yeue and selle,

1220

[Fol. 210b, col. 2.]

With þat þou wilt here dwelle.
We hauen, louerd, alle gode,
Hors, and neth, and ship on flode,
Gold, and siluer, and michel auchte,

They beg him to stay
with them.

1224

Þat grim ute fader us bitawchte.
Gold, and siluer, and oþer fe
Bad he us bi-taken þe.

We hauen shep, we hauen swin,

1228

Bi-leue her, louerd, and al be þin;
Þo shalt ben louerd, þou shalt ben syre,
And we sholen seruen þe and hire;
And hure sistres sholen do

They will serve him
and his wife.

1232

Al that euere biddes sho;
He sholen hire cloþen, * washen, and wringen,
And to hondes water bringen;

He sholen bedden hire and þe,
1236
For leuedi wile we þat she be.”
Hwan he þis ioie haueden maked,
Sithen stikes broken and kraked,
And þe fir brouth on brenne,

They make a fire, and
spare neither goose
nor hen.

1240
Ne was þer spared gos ne henne,
Ne þe hende, ne þe drake,
Metete he deden plente make;
Ne wantede þere no god mete,

They fetch wine and
ale.

1244
Wyn and ale deden he fete,
And made[n] hem [ful] glade and bliþe,
Wessey ladden he fele siþe.

[59](#) A word is here erased; but see l. 2618.

* Mr Garnett suggested that *clopen* may mean *clothes*. If so, dele the comma after it.

BOROUGH SEES THE WONDROUS LIGHT.

[1247](#)

At night Goldborough
lies down sorrowful.

O n þe nith, als goldeborw lay,
1248
Sory and sorwful was she ay,
For she wende she were bi-swike,
þat sh[e w]ere [60](#) yeuen un-kyndelike.

O nith saw she þer-inne a lith,

She sees a great light.

1252
A swiþe fayr, a swiþe bryth,
Al so brith, al so shir,
So it were a blase of fir.
She lokede no[r]þ, [61](#) and ek south,

1256

And saw it comen ut of his mouth,
þat lay bi hire in þe bed:
No ferlike þou she were adred.
Pouthe she, “wat may this bi-mene!

1260

He beth heyman yet, als y wene,
He beth heyman er he be ded:”—
On hise shuldre, of gold red
She saw a swiþe noble croiz,
1264
Of an angel she herde a uoyz:

60 MS. shere, *evidently miswritten for she were.*

61 MS. noþ.

It comes out of
Havelok’s mouth.

She sees a red cross
on his shoulder, and
hears an angel, saying,

LOK TELLS HER HIS STRANGE DREAM.

“**G**oldeborw, lat þi sorwe be,
For havelok, þat haueþ spuset þe,
He ⁶² kinges sone, and kinges eyr,
1268

þat bikenneth þat croiz so fayr.
It ⁶³ bikenneth more, þat he shal
Denemark hauen, and englond al;
He shal ben king strong and stark
1272

Of engelond and denemark;
þat shal þu wit þin eyne sen,
And þo shalt quen and leuedi ben!”

62 *Qu. Is.*

63 MS. Iit.

[Fol. 211, col. 1.]
“Goldborough, be not
sad.

Havelok shall be a
king,

and thou, queen.”

Þanne she hauede herd the steuene
1276
Of þe angel uth of heuene,

She was so fele sipes blithe,
þat she ne mithe hire ioie mythe;
But havelok sone anon she kiste,

1280

And he slep, and nouth ne wiste.
Hwan þat aungel hauede seyd,
Of his slep a-non he brayd,
And seide, “lemman, slepes þou?

1284

A selkuth drem dremede me nou.

She rejoices, and
kisses Havelok.

He awakes, and says
he has had a dream.

AYS HAVELOK WILL BE A GREAT KING.

Herkne nou hwat me haueth met:
Me þouthe y was *in* denemark set,
But on on þe moste hil

1288

þat euere yete kam i til.
It was so hey, þat y wel mouthe
Al þe werd se, als me þouthe.
Als i sat up-on þat lowe,

1292

I bigan denemark for to awe,
þe borwes, and þe castles stronge;
And mine armes weren so longe,
That i fadmede, al at ones,

1296

denemark, with mine longe bones;
And þanne y wolde mine armes drawe
Til me, and hom for to haue,
Al that euere in denemark liueden

1300

On mine armes faste clyueden;
And þe stronge castles alle

He dreamt he was on a
high hill in Denmark,

and began to possess
all that country.

All things in Denmark
cleaved to his arms.

On knes bigunnen for to falle,
þe keyes fellen at mine fet:—

1304

Anoþer drem dremede me ek,
þat ich fley ouer þe salte se
Til engeland, and al with me
þat euere was in denemark lyues,

1308

But bondemen, and here wiues,
And þat ich kom til engelond,
Al closede it intil min hond,
And, goldeborw, y gaf [it] þe:—

1312

Deus! lemman, hwat may þis be?”
Sho answerede, and seyde sone:
“Thesu crist, þat made mone,
Þine dremes turne to ioie;

1316

þat wite þw that sittes in trone!
Ne non strong king, ne caysere,
So þou shalt be, fo[r] þou shalt bere
In engelond corune yet;

1320

Denemark shal knele to þi fet;
Alle þe castles þat aren þer-inne,
Shal-tow, lemman, ful wel winne.
I woth, so wel so ich it sowe,

1324

To þe shole comen heye and lowe,
And alle þat in denemark wone,
Em and broþer, fader and sone,
Erl and baroun, dreng an kayn,

1328

Knithes, and burgeys, and sweyn;

He also dreamt that he
went to England,

[Fol. 211, col. 2.]

and that became his
too.

She says, he will be
king of England and
Denmark.

“All men in Denmark
shall come to thee.

And mad king heyelike and wel,
Denemark shal be þin euere-ilc del.
Haue þou nouth þer-offe douthe

1332

Nouth þe worth, of one nouth;
Þer-offe with-inne þe firste yer

1334

Shalt þou ben king, of euere-il del.
But do nou als y wile rathe,

1336

Nim in with þe to denema[r]k baþe,
And do þou nouth onfrest þis fare,
Lith and selthe felawes are.
For shal ich neuere bliþe be

1340

Til i with eyen denemark se;
For ich woth, þat al þe lond
Shalt þou hauen in þin hon[d].
Prey grimes sones alle þre,

1344

That he wenden forþ with þe;
I wot, he wilen þe nouth werne,
With þe wende shulen he yerne,
For he louen þe herte-like,

1348

Þou maght til he aren quike,
Hwore so he o worde aren;
Þere ship þou do hem swithe yaren,
And loke þat þou dwellen nouth:

1352

Dwelling haueth ofte scape wrouth.”

Thou shalt be king
within the year.

Pray Grim’s sons to
go with you to
Denmark.

Go at once.

Delays are
dangerous.”

Hwan Hauelok herde þat she radde,
Sone it was day, sone he him cladde,
And sone to þe kirke yede,

[Fol. 211*b*, col. 1.]

1356

Or he dide ani oper dede,
And bifer þe rode bigan falle,
Croiz and crist bi[gan] to kalle,
And seyde, “louerd, þat al weldes,

Havelok prays for
success,

1360

Wind and *water*, wodes and felde,
For the holi milce of you,
Haue *merci* of me, louerd, nou!

And wreke me yet on mi fo,

and for vengeance on
his foe,

1364

Þat ich saw biforn min eyne slo
Mine sistres, with a knif,
And siþen wolde me mi lyf
Haue reft, for in the [depe] se

1368

Bad he grim haue drenched me.
He [hath] mi lond with mikel vn-Rith,
With michel *wrong*, with mikel plith,
For i ne ⁶⁴ misdede him neuere nouth,

1372

And haued me to sorwe brouth.
He haueth me do mi mete to þigge,
And ofte in sorwe and pine ligge.
Louerd, haue *merci* of me,

who had caused him
to be a beggar.

1376

And late [me] wel passe þe se,
Þat ihc haue ther-offe douthe and kare,
With-uten stormes ouer-fare,
Þat y ne drenched [be] þer-ine,

He prays for a fair
passage across the sea.

1380

Ne forfaren for no sinne.
And bringge me wel to þe lond,
þat godard haldes in his hond;
þat is mi Rith, eueri del:

1384

Ihesu crist, þou wost it wel!”

64 MS. ine.

Þanne he hauede his bede seyd,
His offrende on þe auter leyd,
His leue at ihesu crist he tok,

1388

And at his suete moder ok,
And at þe croiz, þat he biforn lay,
Sipen yede sore grotinde away.

He leaves his offering
on the altar.

LOK ADDRESSES GRIM'S THREE SONS.

Hwan ⁶⁵ he com hom, he wore yare,
1392

Grimes sones, forto fare
In-to þe se, fishes to gete,
þat havelok mithe wel of ete.
But auelok þouthe al anoþer,

1396

First he ka[l]de þe heldeste broþer,
Roberd þe rede, bi his name,

He finds Grim's sons
ready to fish.

Havelok calls Grim's
three sons.

ÞKS THEM TO GO WITH HIM TO DENMARK.

Wiliam wenduth, and h[uwe r]auen, ⁶⁶
Grimes sones alle þre,

1400

And sey[d]e, “lipen nou alle to me,
Louerdinges, ich wile you sheue,

[Fol. 211b, col. 2.]

A þing of me þat ye wel knewe.
Mi fader was king of denshe lond,
1404

He says, "My father
was king of Denmark.

Denemark was al in his hond
Þe day þat he was quik and ded;
But þanne hauede he wicke red,
Þat he me, and denemark al,
1408

He left me and my
sisters in charge of a
foul fiend,

And mine sistres bi-tawte a þral:
A deueles lime [he] hus bitawte,
And al his lond, and al hise authe.
For y saw that fule fend
1412

Mine sistres slo with hise hend;
First he shar a-two here þrotes,
And siþen [karf] hem al to grotes,
And siþen bad [he] in þe se
1416

who slew my sisters,

Grim, youre fader, drenchen me.
Deplike dede he him swere
On bok, þat he sholde me bere
Vnto þe se, an drenchen ine,
1420

and bade Grim drown
me.

And [he] wolde taken on him þe sinne.
But grim was wis, and swiþe hende,
Wolde he nouth his soule shende;
Leuere was him to be for-sworen,
1424

But Grim was wise.

Þan drenchen me, and ben for-lorn;
But sone bigan he forto fle
Fro denemark, forto berwen ⁶⁷ me,
For yif ⁶⁸ ich hauede þer ben funden,
1428

He fled from Denmark
with me,

Hauede ben slayn, or harde bunden,

And heye ben hanged on a tre,

1430

Hauede go for him gold ne fe.

For-þi fro denemark hider he fledde,

1432

and took care of me.

And me ful fayre and ful wel fedde,

So þat vn-to þis [ilke] day,

Haue ich ben fed and fostred ay.

But nou ich am up to þat helde

1436

Cumen, that ich may wepne welde,

And y may grete dintes yeue,

Shal i neuere hwil ich lyue

Ben glad, til that ich denemark se;

1440

And now, I must go to
Denmark.

I preie you þat ye wende with me,

And ich may mak you riche men,

Ilk of you shal haue castles ten,

And þe lond þat þor-til longes,

1444

Go with me, and I will
make you rich men."

Borwes, tunes, wodes and wonges." ⁶⁹

* * * * *
* * * * *

⁶⁵ In the MS. the Capital letter is prefixed to the next line.

⁶⁶ MS. hauen. Cf. ll. 1868, 2528. Only an assonance, not a rime, seems intended.

⁶⁷ MS. berpen, *the A.S. w being used here*. Cf. l. 697.

⁶⁸ MS. yif.

⁶⁹ A folio has here been cut out of the MS., containing 180 lines. The missing portion must have been to this effect. "To this they gladly assented; and Havelok, accompanied by his wife Goldeborw and the sons of Grim, set sail for Denmark. Disembarking, they travel till they reach the castle of a great Danish earl, named Ubbe, who had formerly been a close friend to king Birkabeyn. Havelok begs that he will allow him to live in that part of the country, and to gain a livelihood by trading."

“With swilk als ich byen shal:
þer-of bi-seche you nou leue;
Wile ich speke with non oper reue,
1628
But with þe, þat iustise are,
þat y mithe seken ⁷⁰ mi ware
In gode borwes up and down,
And faren ich wile fro tun to tun.”

1632

A gold ring drow he forth anon,
An hundred pund was worth þe ston,
And yaf it ubbe for to spede:—
He was ful wis þat first yaf mede,

1636

And so was havelok ful wis here,
He solde his gold ring ful dere,
Was neuere non so dere sold,
For chapmen, neyþer yung ne old:

1640

þat sholen ⁷¹ ye forthward ful wel heren,
Yif þat ye wile þe storie heren.

⁷⁰ Qu. sellen.

⁷¹ MS. shoren.

INVITES HAVELOK TO A FEAST.

Hwan ubbe hauede þe gold ring,
Hauede he youenet for no þing,

1644

Nouth for þe borw euere-il del:—
Havelok bi-hel he swiþe wel,

1646

Hw he was wel of bones maked,
Brod in þe sholdres, ful wel schaped,

[Fol. 212, col. 1.]

Havelok asks Ubbe to
give him leave to buy
and sell there.

He gives Ubbe a gold
ring.

Dearly he sells it, all
the same.

Ubbe takes the ring,

admires Havelok's
make and strength,

1648

Picke in þe brest, of bodi long;
He semede wel to ben wel strong.
“Deus!” hwat ubbe, “qui ne were he knith?
I woth, þat he is swiþe with!

1652

Betere semede him to bere
Helm on heued, sheld and spere,
Þanne to beye and selle ware.
Allas! þat he shal þer-with fare.

and thinks he ought to
be a knight, not a
pedlar.

1656

Goddot! wile he trowe me,
Chaffare shal he late be.”
Neþeles he seyde sone:
“Hauelok, haue [þou] þi bone,

“Havelok, bring your
wife, and come and
eat with me.”

1660

And y ful wel rede þ[e]
Þat þou come, and ete with me
To-day, þou, and þi fayre wif,
Þat þou louest also þi lif.

1664

And haue þou of hire no drede,
Shal hire no man shame bede.
Bi þe fey that y owe to þe,
Perof shal i me serf-borw be.”

TAKES A GREAT FANCY TO HAVELOK.

1668

Hauelok herde þat he bad,
And thow was he ful sore drad,
With him to ete, for hise wif;
For him wore leuere þat his lif

[Fol. 212, col. 2.]

Havelok fears ill may

1672

Him wore reft, þan she in blame
Felle, or lauthe ani shame.
Hwanne he hauede his wille wat, ⁷²

Þe stede, þat he onne sat,

1676

Smot ubbe with spures faste,
And forth away, but at þe laste,

¹⁶⁷⁸

Or he fro him ferde,
Seyde he, þat his folk herde:

1680

“Loke þat ye comen beþe,
For ich it wile, and ich it rede.”

⁷² MS. *either þat or pat*.

SENDS HAVELOK TO BERNARD.

Hauelok ne durste, þe he were adrad,
Nouth with-sitten þat ubbe bad;

1684

His wif he dide with him lede,
Vn-to þe heye curt he y[e]de. ⁷³

Robert hire ledde, þat was red,
Þat hau[ed]e þarned * for hire þe ded

1688

Or ani hauede hire misseyd,
Or hand with iuele onne leyð.

Willam wendut was þat oþer
Þat hire ledde, roberdes broþer,

1692

Þat was with at alle nedes:
Wel is him þat god man fedes!
Þan he weren comen to þe halle,
Biforen ubbe, and hise men alle,

come of it.

But Ubbe rides away,
saying,

“Mind that you
come.”

Havelok dares not
refuse.

Robert the Red leads
Goldborough.

William Wendut is on
the other side of her.

1696

Vbbe stirte hem ageyn,
And mani a knith, and mani a sweyn,
Hem for to se, and forto shewe;
Þo stod havelok als a lowe

Ubbe starts up to
welcome them.

1700

Aboven [þo] þat þer-inne wore,
Rith al bi þe heued more
Þanne ani þat þer-inne stod:
Þo was ubbe bliþe of mod,

Havelok is a head
taller than any of
them.

1704

Þat he saw him so fayr and hende,
Fro him ne mithe his herte wende,
Ne fro him, ne fro his wif;
He louede hem sone so his lif.

1708

Weren non in denemark, þat him þouthe,
Þat he so mikel loue mouthe;
More he louede havelok one,
Þan al denemark, bi mine wone!

Ubbe loves Havelok
better than any one
else.

1712

Loke nou, hw god helpen kan
O mani wise wif and man.

73 MS. yde.

* *þarned* is an error of the scribe for *þoled*; see the [Glossary](#).

Hwan it was comen time to ete,
Hise wif dede ubbe sone in fete,

[Fol. 212b, col. 1.]

1716

And til hire seyde, al on gamen:
“Dame, þou and havelok shulen ete samen,
And goldeboru shal ete wit me,
Þat is so fayr so flour on tre;

Ubbe’s wife is to eat
with Havelok, and
Goldborough with
Ubbe.

1720

In al denemark nis ⁷⁴ * wimman
So fayr so sche, bi seint iohan!”

1722

Þanne [he] were set, and bord leyd,
And þe beneysun was seyd,

1724

Biforn hem com þe beste mete
Þat king or cayser wolde ete;

There were cranes,
swans, venison, fish,
and wines.

1726

Kranes, swannes, ueneysun,
Lax, lampreys, and god sturgun,

1728

Pyment to drinke, and god clare,
Win hwit and red, ful god plente.
Was þer-inne no page so lite,
Þat euere wolde ale bite.

1732

Of þe mete forto tel,
Ne of þe metes ⁷⁵ bidde † i nout dwelle;
Þat is þe storie for to lenge,
It wolde anuye þis fayre genge.

No need to tell it all.

1736

But hwan he haueden þe kiwing ⁷⁶ de[y]led,
And fele siþes haueden wosseyled,
And with gode drinkes seten longe,
And it was time for to gonge,

When the feast is over,

1740

Il man to þer he cam fro,
Þouthe ubbe, “yf I late hem go,
Þus one foure, with-uten mo,
So mote ich brouke finger or to,

Ubbe thinks he must
let them have an
escort.

1744

For þis wimman bes mike wo!

For hire shal men hire louerd slo.”

He tok sone knithes ten,

And wel sixti oþer men,

1748

Wit gode bowes, and with gleiues,

1749

And sende him unto þe greyues,

Þe beste man of al þe toun,

Þat was named bernard brun;

1752

And bad him, als he louede his lif,

Haue lok wel y[e]men, ⁷⁷ and his wif,

And wel do wayten al þe nith,

Til þe oþer day, þat it were lith.

1756

Bernard was trewe, and swiþe with,

In al þe borw ne was no knith

Þat betere couþe on stede riden,

Helm on heued, ne swerd bi side.

1760

Haue lok he gladlike under-stod,

With mike loue, and herte god,

And dide greyþe a super riche,

Also he was no with chinche,

1764

To his bihoue euer-il del,

Þat he mithe supe swiþe wel.

He sends them to
Bernard Brown, and
bids him take care of
them till next day.

[Fol. 212b, col. 2.]

Bernard provides a
rich supper for
Havelok.

⁷⁴ MS. is.

* Perhaps we should rather read—*is womman* [non].

⁷⁵ Qu. win.

† *Bidde* must mean *offer*, rather than *bid* (as in the [Glossary](#)); unless it be miswritten for *bide* = tarry.

⁷⁶ Uncertain in MS. See [note](#).

⁷⁷ MS. ymen.

NG OF THIEVES BESET BERNARD'S HOUSE.

Also he seten, and sholde soupe,
So comes a ladde in a ioupe,
1768
And with him sixti oþer stronge,
With swerdes drawen, and kniues longe,
Ilkan in hande a ful god gleiue,
And seyde, “undo, bernard þe greyue!
1772
Vndo swiþe, and latus ⁷⁸ in,

At suppertime sixty-
one thieves come to
the house,

and bid Bernard open
the door.

E OF THE THIEVES ATTACK HAVELOK.

Or þu art ded, bi seint austin!”
Bernard stirt up, þat was ful big,
And caste a brinie up-on his rig,
1776
And grop an ax, ⁷⁹ þat was ful god,
Lep to þe dore, so he wore wod,
And seyde, “hwat are ye, þat are þer-oute,
Þat þus biginnen forto stroute?
1780
Goth henne swiþe, fule þeues,
For, bi þe louerd, þat man on leues,
Shol ich casten þe dore open,
Summe of you shal ich drepn!
1784
And þe oþre shal ich kesten
In feteres, and ful faste festen!”
“Hwat haue ye seid,” quoth a ladde,
“Wenestu þat we ben adradde?
1788
We shole at þis dore gonge
Maugre þin, carl, or outh longe.”

Bernard starts up,
arms himself,

and tells them to go
away.

They defy him.

He gripen sone a bulder ston,
And let it fleye, ful god won,

1792

Agen þe dore, þat it to-rof:
Auelok it saw, and þider drof,
And þe barre sone vt-drow,
Þat was unride, and gret ynow,

1796

And caste þe dore open wide,
And seide, “her shal y now abide:
Comes swiþe vn-to me! ⁸⁰
Datheyt hwo you henne fle!”

1800

“No,” quodh on, “þat shaltou coupe,”
And bigan til him to loupe,
In his hond is swerd ut-drawe,
Hauelok he wende þore haue slawe;

1804

And with [him] comen oþer two,
Þat him wolde of liue haue do.

They break the door
open with a boulder.

Havelok seizes the bar
of the door, and says,

“Come here to me.”

Three men attack
Havelok.

[Fol. 213, col. 1.]

LOK SLAYS SEVEN OF THE THIEVES.

¹⁸⁰⁶

Hauelok lifte up þe dore-tre,
And at a dint he slow hem þre;

1808

Was non of hem þat his hernes
Ne lay þer-ute ageyn þe sternes.
Þe ferþe þat he sipen mette,
Wit þe barre so he him grette,

1812

Bifor þe heued, þat þe rith eye
Vt of þe hole made he fleye,

He kills them all.

A fourth he knocks
down with a blow on
the head.

And siþe clapte him on þe crune,
So þat he stan-ded fel þor dune.

1816

Þe fifte þat he ouer-tok,
Gaf he a ful sor dint[e] ok,
Bitwen þe sholdres, þer he stod,
Þat he spen his herte blod.

A fifth he hits between
the shoulders.

1820

Þe sixte wende for to fle,
And he clapte him with þe tre
Rith in þe fule necke so,
Þat he smot hise necke on to.

A sixth he smites on
the neck.

1824

Þanne þe sixe weren doun feld,
Þe seuenþe brayd ut his swerd,

A seventh aims at
Havelok's eye.

[1826](#)

And wolde havelok Riht *in* the eye;
And havelok le[t þe] [81](#) barre fleye,

Havelok kills him.

1828

And smot him sone ageyn þe brest,
Þat hauede he neuere sch[r]ifte of prest;
For he was ded on lesse hwile,
Þan men mouthe renne a mile.

The rest divide into
two parties,

1832

Alle þe opere weren ful kene,
A red þei taken hem bi-twene,
þat he sholde him bi-halue,
And brisen so, þat wit no salue

1836

Ne sholde him helen leche non:
Þey drowen ut swerdes, ful god won,

and rush at him like
dogs at a bear.

[1838](#)

And shoten on him, so don on bere
Dogges, þat wolden him to-tere,

1840

Þanne men doth þe bere beyte:
Þe laddes were kaske and teyte,
And vn-bi-yeden him ilkon,
Sum smot with tre, and sum wit ston;

1844

Summe putten with gleyue, in bac and side,
And yeuen wundes longe and wide;
In twenti stedes, and wel mo,
Fro þe croune til the to.

They wound Havelok
in twenty places.

1848

Hwan he saw þat, he was wod,
And was it ferlik hw he stod,
For the blod ran of his sides
So water þat fro þe welle glides;

[Fol. 213, col. 2.]

1852

But þanne bigan he for to mowe
With the barre, and let hem shewe,
Hw he cowþe sore smite,
For was þer non, long ne lite,

He at last succeeds in
killing twenty of
them.

1856

Þat he Mouthe ouer-take,
Þat he ne garte his croune krake;
So þat on a litel stund,
Felde he twenti to þe grund.

⁷⁸ *Sic* in MS.

⁷⁹ MS. *ar*; *but see* l. 1894.

⁸⁰ MS. *vnto me datheit*,—evidently the repetition of the first word in the succeeding line.

⁸¹ *Qu.* Havelok let the. MS. “haue le.”

THIEVES SHOOT AT HIM FROM A DISTANCE.

1860

Þo bigan gret dine to rise,
For þe laddes on ilke wise
Him asayleden wit grete dintes,
Fro fer he stoden, him with flintes

1864

And gleyues schoten him fro ferne,
For drepen him he wolden yerne;
But dursten he newhen him no more,
Þanne he bor or leun wore.

They throw stones at him.

I AND THE REST COME TO THE RESCUE.

1868

Huwe rauen þat dine herde,
And þowthe wel, þat men mis-ferde
With his louerd, for his wif,
And grop an ore, and a long knif,

1872

And þider drof al so an hert,
And cham þer on a litel stert,
And saw how þe laddes wode
Hauelok his louerd umbistode,

1876

And beten on him so doth þe smith
With þe hamer on þe stith.

Hugh Raven hears the noise,

and comes to help.

“**A**llas!” hwat hwe, “þat y was boren!
þat euere et ich bred of koren!

1880

þat ich here þis sorwe se!
Roberd! willam! hware ar ye?
Gripeth eþer unker a god tre,
And late we nouth þise doges fle,

1884

Hugh calls out to Robert and William.

Til ure louerd wreke [we];
Cometh swiþe, and folwes me!
Ich haue in honde a ful god ore:
Datheit wo ne smite sore!”

1888

“Ya! leue, ya!” quod roberd sone,
“We hauen ful god lith of þe mone.”
Roberd grop a staf, strong and gret,
þat mouthe ful wel bere a net,

Robert comes to the
rescue,

1892

And willam wendut grop a tre
Mikel grettere þan his þe, ⁸²
And bernard held his ax ful faste;
I seye, was he nouth þe laste;

and William too, and
Bernard.

[Fol. 213b, col. 1.]

1896

And lopen forth so he weren wode
To þe laddes, þer he stode,
And yaf hem wundes swiþe grete;
þer mithe men wel se boyes bete,

They fight with the
thieves.

1900

And ribbes in here sides breke,
And haelok on hem wel wreke.
He broken armes, he broken knes,
He broken shankes, he broken thes.

1904

He dide þe blode þere renne dune
To þe fet rith fro the crune,
For was þer spared heued non:
He leyden on heuedes, ful god won,

No head was spared.

1908

And made croune[s] breke and crake,
Of þe broune, and of þe blake;
He maden here backes al so bloute

He made their backs
as soft as their bellies.

Als h[er]e ⁸³ wombes, and made hem rowte

1912

Als he weren kradelbarnes:

So dos þe child þat moder þarnes.

⁸² MS. þre, the *r* being caught from the word above. Cf. l. 1903.

⁸³ Qu. here. MS. he.

THE SIXTY THIEVES ARE SLAIN.

1914

Daþeit wo ⁸⁴ recke! for he it seruede,
Hwat dide he þore weren he werewed;

1916

So longe haueden he but and bet

With neues under hernes set,

Þat of þo sixti men and on

Ne wente þer away liues non.

All sixty assailants are
slain.

⁸⁴ MS. “pe,” clearly miswritten for “po” or “wo.” See ll. 2047, 296, 300, &c.

ASKS BERNARD WHAT HAS HAPPENED.

1920

At morn, there they
lay like dogs.

ON þe morwen, hwan ⁸⁵ it was day,
Ilc on other wirwed lay,

Als it were dogges þat weren hanged,

And summe leye in dikes slenget,

1924

And summe in gripes bi þe her

Drawen ware, and laten ther.

1926

Sket cam tiding intil ubbe,

Þat haelok hauede with a clubbe

1928

Of hise slawen sixti and on
Sergaunz, þe beste þat mithen gon.
“Deus!” quoth ubbe, “hwat may þis be!
Betere his i nime ⁸⁶ miself and se,

Ubbe comes to see
what is the matter.

1932

Þat þis baret on hwat is wold,
Þanne i sende yunge or old.
For yif i sende him un-to,
I wene men sholde him shame do,

1936

And þat ne wolde ich for no þing:
I loue him wel, bi heuene king!
Me wore leuere i wore lame,
Þanne men dide him ani shame,

1940

Or tok, or onne handes leyde,
Vn-ornelike, ⁸⁷ or same seyde.”
He lep up on a stede lith,
And with him mani a noble knith,

[Fol. 213b, col. 2.]

1944

And ferde forth un-to þe tun,
And dide calle bernard brun
Vt of his hus, wan he þer cam;
And bernard sone ageyn [him] nam,

He calls for Bernard
Brown.

1948

Al to-tused and al to-torn,
Ner also naked so he was born,
And al to-brised, bac and þe:
Quoth ubbe, “bernard, hwat is þe?

Ubbe asks who has
beaten him about so?

1952

Hwo haues þe þus ille maked,
Þus to-riuen, and al mad naked?”

⁸⁵ MS. “hhan,” miswritten for “hpan,” from which it differs very slightly.

86 MS. inime.

87 MS. Vn ornelfke; but *f* should certainly be i.

ARD RELATES HAVELOK'S PROWESS.

“**L**ouerd, ⁸⁸ merci,” quot he sone,
“To-nicht also ros þe mone

1956

Comen her mo þan sixti þeues,
With lokene copes, and wide sleues,
Me forto robben, and to pine,
And for to drepe me and mine.

1960

Mi dore he broken up ful sket,
And wolde me binden hond and fet.
Wan þe godemen þat sawe,
Hauelok, and he þat bi þe wowe

1964

Leye, he stirten up sone on-on,
And summe grop tre, and sum grop ston,
And driue hem ut, þei he weren crus,
So dogges ut of milne-hous.

1968

Hauelok grop þe dore-tre,
And [at] a dint he slow hem thre.
He is þe beste man at nede,
Þat euere mar shal ride stede!

1972

Als helpe god, bi mine wone,
A þhousend of men his he worth one!
Yif he ne were, ich were nou ded,
So haue ich don Mi soule red;

1976

But it is hof him mikel sinne;

“Sixty thieves
attacked me last night.

Havelok and his
friends drove them
off.

He is worth a
thousand men.

He maden him swilke woundes þrinne,
þat of þe alþer-leste wounde
Were a stede brouht to grunde.

1980

He haues a wunde *in* the side,
With a gleyue, ful un-ride,
And he haues on þoru his arum,
þer-of is ful mikel harum,

He has some bad
wounds, more than
twenty.

1984

And he haues on þoru his þhe,
þe vn-rideste þat men may se,
And oþe[r] wundes haues he stronge,
Mo than twenti swiþe longe.

[Fol. 214, col. 1.]

1988

But siþen he hauede lauth þe sor
Of þe wundes, was neuere bor
þat so fauth so he fauth þanne;
Was non þat hauede þe hern-panne

1992

So hard, þat he ne dede alto-cruhsse,
And alto-shiuere, and alto-frusshe.
He folwede hem so hund dos hare,
Daþeyt on he wolde spare,

He followed them like
a dog does a hare.

1996

þat [he] ne made hem euerilk on
Ligge stille so doth þe ston:
And þer nis he nouth to frie,
For oþer sholde he make hem lye

2000

Ded, or þei him hauede slawen,
Or alto-hewen, or al-to-drawen.

Louerd, haui no more plith
Of þat ich was þus greþed to-nith.

2004

þus wolde þe theues me haue reft,
But god-þank, he hauenet sure kept.
But it is of him mikel scape:
I woth þat he bes ded ful rape.”

But I fear Havelok is
all but dead.”

OTHERS CONFIRM BERNARD’S STORY.

2008

Quoth ubbe, “bernard, seyst þou soth?”
“Ya, sire, that i ne ⁸⁹ lepe oth.
Yif y, louerd, a word leye,
To-morwen do me hengen heye.”

2012

þe burgeys þat þer-bi stode þore,
Grundlike and grete oþes swore,
Litle and mikle, yunge and holde,
þat was soth, þat bernard tolde.

The rest confirm
Bernard’s story.

2016

Soth was, þat he wolden him bynde,
And trusse al þat he mithen fynde
Of hise, in arke or in kiste,
þat he mouthe *in* seckes þriste.

2020

“Louerd, he haueden al away born
His þing, and him-self alto-torn,
But als god self barw him wel,
þat he ne tinte no catel.

“The thieves wanted
to steal all he had.

2024

Hwo mithe so mani stonde ageyn,
Bi nither-tale, knith or swein?
He weren bi tale sixti and ten,

Starke laddes, stalworpi men,

2028

And on, þe mayster of hem alle,

Þat was þe name giffin ⁹⁰ galle.

Hwo mouthe agey[n] ⁹¹ so mani stonde,

But als þis man of ferne londe

2032

Haueth hem slawen with a tre?

Mikel ioie haue he!

God yeue him mikel god to welde,

Boþe in tun, and ek in felde!

2036

We[l] ⁹² is set he etes mete.”

Quoth ubbe, “doth him swiþe fete,

Þat y mouthe his woundes se,

Yf that he mouthen heled ⁹³ be.

2040

For yf he mouthe couere yet,

And gangen wel up-on hise fet,

Mi-self shal dubbe him to knith,

For-þi þat he is so with.

2044

And yif he liuede, þo foule theues,

²⁰⁴⁵

Þat weren of kaym kin and eues,

He sholden hange bi þe necke;

Of here ded daþeit wo recke,

2048

Hwan he yeden þus on nithes

To binde boþe burgmen and knithes.

For bynderes loue ich neuere mo,

Of hem ne yeue ich nouht a slo.”

They were led on by
one G[r]iffin Gall.”

[Fol. 214, col. 2.]

Ubbe sends for
Havelok,

to dub him knight.

⁸⁹ MS. ine.

⁹⁰ Qu. griffin.

91 MS. agey.

92 Cf. ll. 772, 907.

93 MS. holed. See l. 2058.

SENDS FOR HAVELOK AND TAKES HIM TO HIS CASTLE.

2052

H auelok was bifore ubbe browth,
þat hauede for him ful mikel þouth,
And mikel sorwe in his herte
For hise wundes, þat we[r] so smerte.

2056

B ut hwan his wundes weren shewed,
And a leche hauede knawed,
þat he hem mouthe ful wel hele,
Wel make him gange, and ful wel mele,

2060

And wel a palefrey bistride,
And wel up-on a stede ride,
þo let ubbe al his care
And al his sorwe ouer-fare;

2064

And seyde, “*cum* now forth with me,
And goldeboru, þi wif, with þe,
And þine seriaunz al þre,
For nou wile y youre warant be;

2068

Wile y non of here frend
þat þu slowe with þin hend
Moucete wayte þe [to] slo,
Also þou gange to and fro.

2072

I shal lene þe a bowr,

Havelok is brought
before Ubbe.

A leech says he can be
healed.

Ubbe invites him and
Goldborough to his
own castle.

Þat is up in þe heye tour,
Til þou mowe ful wel go,
And wel ben hol of al þi wo.

[Fol. 214b, col. 1.]

2076

It ne shal no þing ben bitwene
Þi bour and min, also y wene,
But a fayr firrene wowe;—
Speke y loude, or spek y lowe,

2080

Þou shalt ⁹⁴ ful wel heren me,
And þan þu wilt, þou shalt me se.
A rof shal hile us boþe o-nith,
Þat none of mine, clerk ne knith,

He promises to protect
Goldborough.

2084

Ne sholen þi wif no shame bede,
No more þan min, so god me rede!”

⁹⁴ MS. sahalt; and the second a is expuncted by mistake, instead of the first.

SEES THE MIRACULOUS LIGHT WHICH ISSUES FROM HAVELOK’S MOUTH.

HE dide un-to þe borw bringe
Sone anon, al with ioynge,

2088

His wif, and his serganz þre,
Þe beste men þat mouthe be.
Þe firste nith he lay þer-inne,
Hise wif, and his serganz þrinne,

The first night, about
midnight,

2092

Aboute þe middel of þe nith
Wok ubbe, and saw a mikel lith
In þe bour þat havelok lay,
Also brith so it were day.

Ubbe wakes and sees
a great light.

2096

Ubbe says he must go
and see what it means.

“**D**eus!” quoth ubbe, “hwat may þis be?
Betere is i go miself, and se:

Hweþer he sitten nou, and wesseylen,
Or of ani shotshipe to-deyle,

2100

Þis tid nithes, also foles;
Þan birþe men casten hem in poles,
Or in a grip, or in þe fen:
Nou ne sitten none but wicke men,
2104
Glotuns, reu[e]res, or wicke þeues,
Bi crist, þat alle folk onne leues!”

He stod, and totede in at a bord,
Her he spak anilepi word,

2108

And saw hem slepen faste ilkon,
And lye stille so þe ston;
And saw al þat mikel lith
Fro havelok cam, þat was so brith.

2112

Of his mouth it com il del,
Þat was he war ful swiþe wel.
“Deus!” quoth he, “hwat may þis mene!”

He calde boþe arwe men and kene,

2116

Knithes, and serganz swiþe sleie,
Mo þan an hundred, with-uten leye,
And bad hem alle comen and se,
Hwat þat selcuth mithe be.

He peeps in, and sees
them all asleep.

The light issues from
Havelok’s mouth.

RIGHT SHOWS THAT HAVELOK IS THE HEIR.

2120

[Fol. 214b, col. 2.]

Als þe knithes were comen alle,
þer havelok lay, ut of þe halle,
So stod ut of his mouth a glem,
Rith al swilk so þe sunne-bem;

2124

þat al so lith wa[s] þare, bi heuene!
So þer brenden serges seuene,
And an hundred serges ok:
þat durste hi sweren on a bok.

2128

He slepen faste alle fiue,
So he weren brouth of liue;
And havelok lay on his lift side,
In his armes his brithe bride.

2132

Bi þe pappes he leyen naked:
So faire two weren neuere maked
In a bed to lyen samen:—
þe knithes þouth of hem god gamen,

2136

Hem forto shewe, and loken to.
Rith also he stoden alle so,
And his bac was toward hem wend,
So weren he war of a croiz ful gent,

2140

On his rith shuldre sw[ɪp]e ⁹⁵ brith,
Brithter þan gold ageyn þe lith.
So þat he wiste heye and lowe,
þat it was kunrik þat he sawe.

2144

It sparkede, and ful brith shon,
So doth þe gode charbucle ston,
þat men Mouthe se by þe lith,

The light is like that of
107 candles.

Havelok and
Goldborough are fast
asleep.

They see a bright
cross on his back,
denoting kingship.

It was light enough to
choose a penny by.

A peni chesen, so was it brith.

2148

Þanne bihelden he him faste,
So þat he knewen at þe laste,
Þat he was birkabeynes sone,
Þat was here king, þat was hem wone

2152

Wel to yeme, and wel were
Ageynes uten-laddes here.
“For it was neuere yet a broþer
In al denemark so lich anoþer,
2156
So þis man þat is so fayr
Als birkabeyn, he is hise eyr.”

95 MS. *swe*, for *swiþe*. Cf. l. 1252.

He fellen sone at hise fet,
Was non of hem þat he ne gret,

2160

Of ioie he weren alle so fawen,
So he him haueden of erþe drawen.
Hise fet he kisten an hundred sypes,
Þe tos, þe nayles, and þe lithes,

2164

So þat he bigan to wakne, 96
And wit hem ful sore to blakne,
For he wende he wolden him slo,
Or elles binde him, and do wo.

96 Here follows the catchword— “And wit hem.”

SAYS HAVELOK SHALL BE KING.

2168

They know he is
Birkabeyn's son and
heir.

They weep for joy.

[Fol. 215, col. 1.]

Havelok wakes.

Q uoth ubbe, “louerd, ne dred þe nowth,
Me þinkes that I se þi þouth.

Dere sone, wel is me,
Þat y þe with eyn[e] ⁹⁷ se.

Ubbe offers homage
to him,

2172

Man-red, louerd, bede y þe,
Þi man auht i ful wel to be,
For þu art comen of birkabeyn,
Þat hauede mani knith and sweyn;

2176

And so shalt þou, louerd, haue,
Þou þu be yet a ful yung knaue.
Þou shalt be king of al denemark,
Was þer-inne neuere non so stark.

and says he shall be
king of Denmark.

2180

To-morwen shaltu manrede take
Of þe brune and of þe blake;
Of alle þat aren in þis tun,
Boþe of erl, and of barun,

2184

And of dreng, and of thayn,
And of knith, and of sweyn.
And so shaltu ben mad knith
Wit blisse, for þou art so with.”

⁹⁷ We find *eyne* in ll. 680, 1273, &c.

2188

Havelok is blithe, and
thanks God.

Þ o was havelok swiþe bliþe,
And þankede God ful fele siþe.
On þe morwen, wan it was lith,
And gon was þisternesse of þe nith,

²¹⁹²

Vbbe dide up-on a stede

A ladde lepe, and þider bede
Erles, barouns, drenges, theynes,
Klerkes, knithes, bu[r]geys, ⁹⁸ sweynes,

2196

Þat he sholden comen a-non,
Biforen him sone euerilkon,
Also he louen here liues,
And here children, and here wiues.

⁹⁸ MS. bugeyl.

RELATES HAVELOK'S HISTORY.

2200

Hise bode ne durste he non at-sitte,
²²⁰¹

Þat he ne neme ⁹⁹ for to wite
Sone, hwat wolde þe iustise:
And [he] bigan anon to rise,

2204

And seyde sone, “liþes me,
Alle samen, þeu and fre.
A þing ich wile you here shauwe,
Þat ye ¹⁰⁰ alle ful wel knawe.

2208

Ye witen wel, þat al þis lond
Was in birkabeynes hond,
Þe day þat he was quic and ded;
And how þat he, bi youre red,

2212

Bitauhte hise children þre
Godard to yeme, and al his fe.
Hauelok his sone he him tauhte,
And hise two douhtres, and al his auhte,

Ubbe summons all his
lords.

All come to receive
his orders.

Ubbe tells them about
Birkabeyn,

[Fol. 215, col. 2.]

who commended his
children to Godard;

2216

Alle herden ye him swere
On bok, and on messe-gere,
Þat he shulde yeme hem wel,
With-uten lac, with-uten tel.

99 MS. meme; *miswritten for neme*; see ll. 1207, 1931.

100 MS. he.

2220

and how Godard slew
the two girls,

He let his oth al ouer-go,
Euere wurþe him yuel and wo!
For 101 þe maydnes here lif
Refte he boþen, with a knif,

2224

And him shulde ok haue slawen,
Þe knif was at his herte drawen,
But god him wolde wel haue saue,
He hauede reunesse of þe knaue,

but had pity on the
boy;

2228

So þat he with his hend
Ne drop him nouth, þat sor[i] fend,
But sone dide he a fishere
Swiþe grete oþes swere,

but afterwards ordered
Grim to drown him.

2232

Þat he sholde drenchen him
In þe se, þat was ful brim.

101 *Qu. Fro.*

Hwan grim saw þat he was so fayr,
And wiste he was þe Rith eir,

But Grim fled with
him to England.

2236

Fro denemark ful sone he fledde
In-til englond, and þer him fedde

Mani winter, þat til þis day
Haues he ben fed and fostred ay.

2240

Lokes, hware he stondes her:
In al þis werd ne haues he per;
Non so fayr, ne non so long,
Ne non so mikel, ne non so strong.

2244

In þis middelerd nis no knith
Half so strong, ne half so with.
Bes of him ful glad and bliþe,
And cometh alle hider swiþe,

2248

Manrede youre louerd forto make,
Boþe brune and þe blake.
I shal mi-self do first þe gamen,
And ye siþen alle samen.”

DOES HOMAGE TO HAVELOK.

2252

Oknes ful fayre he him sette,
Mouthe noþing him þer-fro lette,
And bi-cam is man Rith þare,
Þat alle sawen þat þere ware.

2256

After him stirt up laddes ten,
And bi-comen hise men; ¹⁰²
And siþen euerilk a baroun,
Þat euere weren in al that toun;

2260

And siþen drenges, and siþen thaynes,
And siþen knithes, and siþen sweynes;

Then Ubbe shows
Havelok to them all,

and bids them swear
fealty to him.

Ubbe swears fealty
first.

[Fol. 215b, col. 1.]

All the rest do the
same.

So þat, or þat day was gon,
In al þe tun ne was nouth on
2264
þat it ne was his man bicomē:
Manrede of alle hauede he nomen.

¹⁰² A word is added in the MS. after *men*, apparently *beye*. Perhaps we should read: *hise heye men*.

WEAR TO BE FAITHFUL TO HAVELOK.

Hwan he hauede of hem alle
Manrede taken, *in* the halle,
2268
Grundlike dide he hem swere,
þat he sholden him god feyth bere
Ageynes alle þat woren on liue;
þer-yen ne wolde neuer on striue,
2272
þat he ne maden sone þat oth,
Riche and poure, lef and loth.
Hwan þat was maked, sone he sende,
Vbbe, writes fer and hende,
2276
After alle þat castel yemede,
Burwes, tunes, sibbe an fremde,
þat þider sholden comen swiþe
Til him, and heren tipandes bliþe,
2280
þat he hem alle shulde telle:
Of hem ne wolde neuere on dwelle,
þat he ne come sone plattinde,
Hwo hors ne hauede, com gangande.
2284
So þat with-inne a fourtenith,

Havelok makes them
swear to be faithful to
him always.

Ubbe sends for all the
sheriffs and
constables.

In al denemark ne was no knith,
Ne conestable, ne shireue,
Þat com of adam and of eue,
2288
Þat he ne com biforn sire ubbe:
He dredden him so þhes ¹⁰³ doth clubbe.

They all come.

¹⁰³ *Qu.* þes, i.e. thighs; or the spelling *þhes* may be intentional; see l. 1984. But Sir F. Madden suggests *þeues*.

Hwan he haueden alle þe king gret,
And he weren alle dun set,

2292

Ubbe shows Havelok
to them all.

Þo seyde ubbe, “lokes here,
Vre louerd swiþe dere,
Þat shal ben king of al þe lond,
And haue us alle under hond.

2296

For he is birkabeynes sone,
Þe king þat was vmbe stonde wone
For to yeme, and wel were,
Wit sharp[e] ¹⁰⁴ swerd, and longe spere.

2300

[Fol. 215*b*, col. 2.]

Lokes nou, hw he is fayr;
Sikerlike he is hise eyr.
Falles alle to hise fet,
Bicomes hise men ful sket.”

2304

All swear to obey
Havelok.

He weren for ubbe swiþe adrad,
And dide sone al þat he bad,
And yet deden he sumdel more,
O bok ful grundlike he swore,

2308

Þat he sholde with him halde
Boþe ageynes stille and bolde,

Þat euere wo[l]de his bodi dere:
Þat dide [he] hem o boke swere.

[104](#) See l. 2645 for the final *e*.

DUBS HAVELOK A KNIGHT.

2312

Hwan he hauede manrede and oth
Taken of lef and of loth,

[2314](#)

Vbbe dubbede him to knith,
With a swerd ful swiþe brith,

2316

And þe folk of al þe lond
Bitauhte him al in his hond,
Þe cunnriche eueril del,
And made him king heylike and wel.

[2320](#)

Hwan he was king, þer mouthe men se
Þe moste ioie þat mouhte be:
Buttinge with sharpe speres,
Skirming with taleuaces, þat men beres,

2324

Wrastling with laddes, putting of ston,
Harping and piping, ful god won,
Leyk of mine, of hasard ok,
Romanz reding on þe bok;

2328

Þer mouthe men here þe gestes singe,
Þe gleymen on þe tabour dinge;
Þer mouhte men se þe boles beyte,
And þe bores, with hundes teyte;

2332

Ubbe dubs Havelok a
knight,

and makes him king.

Great joy and many
sports.

There is baiting of
bulls and boars,

þo mouthe men se eueril gleu,
þer mouthe men se hw grim greu;
Was neuere yete ioie more
In al þis werd, þan þo was þore.

2336

þer was so mike ¹⁰⁵ yeft of cloþes,
þat þou i swore you grete othes,
I ne wore nouth þer-offe croud:
þat may i ful wel swere, bi god!

2340

þere was swiþe gode metes,
And of wyn, þat men fer fetes,
Rith al so mik and gret plente,
So it were water of þe se.

and plenty of meat
and wine.

2344

þe feste fourti dawes sat,
So riche was neuere non so þat.
þe king made Roberd þere knith,
þat was ful strong, and ful with,

[Fol. 216, col. 1.]

The king makes
Robert, William, and
Hugh all barons.

2348

And willam, wendut het, his broþer,
And huwe rauē, þat was þat oþer,
And made hem barouns alle þre,
And yaf hem lond, and oþer fe,

2352

So mikel, þat ilker twent[i] knihtes
Hauede of genge, dayes and nithes.

¹⁰⁵ See l. 2342.

LOK IS MADE KING OF DENMARK.

Hwan þat feste was al don,
A thusand knihtes ful wel o bon

2356

A thousand knights
accompany the king.

With-held þe king, with him to lede;
þat ilkan hauede ful god stede,
Helm, and sheld, and brinie brith,
And al þe wepne þat fel to knith.

2360

With hem fiue thusand gode
Sergaunz, þat weren to fyht wode,
With-held he al of his genge:
Wile I na more þe storie lenge.

2364

Yet hwan he hauede of al þe lond
þe casteles alle in his hond,
And conestables don þer-inne,
He swor, he ne sholde neuer blinne,

2368

Til þat he were of godard wreken,
þat ich haue of ofte speken.
Hal hundred knithes dede he calle,
And hise fif thusand sergaunz alle,

2372

And dide sweren on the bok
Sone, and on þe auter ok,
þat he ne sholde neuere blinne,
Ne for loue, ne for sinne,

2376

Til þat he haueden godard funde,
And brouth biforn him faste bunde.

and five thousand
sergeants.

He swears to be
avenged of Godard,

and to find and bind
him.

LOK GOES TO SEEK OUT GODARD.

Þanne he haueden swor þis oth,
Ne leten he nouth for lef ne loth,

2380

þat he ne foren swiþe rathe,

Þer he was unto þe pape,
Þer he yet on hunting for,
With mikel genge, and swiþe stor.

He goes to meet
Godard.

2384

Robert, þat was of al þe ferd
Mayster, was girt wit a swerd,
And sat up-on a ful god stede,
Þat vnder him Rith wolde wede;

Robert accosts
Godard,

2388

He was þe firste þat with godard
Spak, and seyde, “hede ¹⁰⁶cauenard!
Wat dos þu here at þis pape?
Cum to þe king, swiþe and rape.

[Fol. 216, col. 2.]

and tells him to come
to the king,

2392

Þat sendes he þe word, and bedes,
Þat þu þenke hwat þu him dedes,
Hwan þu reftes with a knif
Hise sistres here lif,

2396

An siþen bede þu in þe se
Drenchen him, þat herde he.
He is to þe swiþe grim:
Cum nu swiþe un-to him,

2400

Þat king is of þis kuneriche.
Þu fule man! þu wicke swike!
And he shal yelde þe þi mede,
Bi *crist* þat wolde on rode blede!”

who will repay him.

¹⁰⁶ *Qu. helde, i.e. old. Unless it means “heed!”*

2404

Hwan godard herde þat þer þrette,
With þe neue he robert sette

Biforn þe teth a dint ful strong.

And robert kipt ut a knif long,

2408

And smot him þoru þe rith arum:

Per-of was ful litel harum.

Godard and Robert
strike each other.

GODARD'S MEN ARE BEATEN.

Hwan his folk þat sau and herde,
Hwou robert with here louerd ferde,

2412

He haueden him wel ner browt of liue,

Ne weren his two breþren and oþre fiue

Slowen of here laddes ten,

Of godardes alþer-beste men.

2416

Hwan þe oþre sawen þat, he fledden,

And godard swiþe loude gredde:

“Mine knithes, hwat do ye?

Sule ye þus-gate fro me fle?

2420

Ich haue you fed, and yet shal fede,

Helpe me nu in þis nede,

And late ye nouth mi bodi spille,

Ne haelok don of me hise wille.

2424

Yif ye id ¹⁰⁷ do, ye do you shame,

And bringeth you-self in mikel blame.”

Hwan he þat herden, he wenten ageyn,

And slowen a knit and ¹⁰⁸ a sweyn

2428

Of þe kinges ounen men,

And woundeden abuten ten.

Godard's men flee,

but Godard rallies
them.

¹⁰⁷ Qu. it.

ARD IS BOUND AND LED TO HAVELOK.

The kinges men hwan he þat sawe,
Scuten on hem, heye and lowe,

2432

And euerilk fot of hem slowe,
But godard one, þat he flowe,
So þe þef men dos henge,
Or hund men shole *in* dike slenge.

2436

He bunden him ful swiþe faste,
Hwil þe bondes wolden laste,
Þat he rorede als a bole,
Þat he wore parred in an hole,

2440

With dogges forto bite and beite:
Were þe bondes nouth to leite.
He bounden him so 109 fele sore,
Þat he gan crien godes ore,

2444

Þat he sholde of his hend plette,
Wolden he nouht þer-fore lette,
Þat he ne bounden hond and fet:
Daþeit þat on þat þer-fore let!

2448

But dunten him so man doth bere,
And keste him on a scabbed mere,

2450

Hise nese went un-to þe crice:
So ledden he þat fule swike,

2452

Til he was biforn havelok brouth,

The king's men kill all
Godard's men.

[Fol. 216b, col. 1.]

They bind Godard,

and cast him on an old
mare, to take him to
Havelok.

Þat he haue[de] ful wo wrowht,
Boþe with hungre [110](#) and with cold,
Or he were twel winter old,

2456

And with mani heui swink,
With poure mete, and feble drink,
And [with] swiþe wikke cloþes,
For al hise manie grete othes.

2460

Nu beyes he his holde blame:

[2461](#)

‘Old sinne makes newe shame:’

Wan he was [brouht] so shamelike
Biforn [111](#) þe king, þe fule swike,

2464

Þe king dede ubbe swiþe calle
Hise erles, and hise barouns alle,
Dreng and thein, burgeis and knith,

*“Old sin makes new
shame.”*

The king summons
Ubbe and the rest.

CONDEMNED TO BE HUNG.

And bad he sholden demen him rith:

2468

For he kneu, þe swike dam,
Euerildel god was him gram.
He setten hem dun bi þe wawe,
Riche and pouere, heye and lowe,

2472

Þe helde men, and ek þe grom,
And made þer þe rithe dom,
And seyden unto þe king anon,
Þat stille sat [al] so þe ston:

2476

“We deme, þat he be al quic slawen, [112](#)

They sit in judgment.

*“He is to be flayed,
drawn, and hung.”*

And siþen to þe galwes drawe[n],
At þis foule mere tayl;
Þoru is fet a ful strong nayl;

2480

[Fol. 216b, col. 2.]

And þore ben henged wit two feteres,
And þare be writen þise leteres:
‘Þis is þe swike þat wende wel,
Þe king haue reft þe lond il del,

2484

And hise sistres with a knif
Boþe refte here lif.’
Þis writ shal henge bi him þare;
Þe dom is demd, seye we na more.”

109 MS. fo.

110 MS. hungred.

111 MS. Brouht biforn; *but the word **brouht** clearly belongs to the preceding line, in which, however, it is omitted.*

112 We should perhaps read *flawen*, as required by the sense. See ll. 2495, 2502.

ARD IS FLAYED ALIVE AND HUNG.

2488

Godard is shriven.

Hwan þe dom was demd and giue,
And he was wit þe prestes shriue,
And it ne mouhte ben non oþer,
Ne for fader, ne for broþer,

2492

Þat he sholde þarne lif;
Sket cam a ladde with a knif,
And bigan Rith at þe to
For to ritte, and for to flo,

2496

A lad flays him.

And he bigan for to rore,

So it were grim or gore,
þat men mithe þeþen a mile
Here him rore, þat fule file.

He roars.

2500

þe ladde ne let no with for-þi,
þey he criede ‘merci! merci!’
þat [he] ne flow [him] eueril del
With knif mad of grunden stel.

2504

þei garte bringe þe mere sone,
Skabbed ¹¹³ and ful iuele o bone,
And bunden him rith at hire tayl
With a rop of an old seyl,

He is bound on an old
mare,

2508

And drowen him un-to þe galwes,
Nouth bi þe gate, But ouer þe falwes;
And henge [him] þore Bi þe hals:
Daþeit hwo recke! he was fals.

drawn over rough
ground,

and hung.

¹¹³ MS. Skabbeb.

ICH RAISES AN ARMY AGAINST HAVELOK.

2512

Ðanne he was ded, þat sathanas,
²⁵¹³

Sket was seysed al þat his was
In þe kinges hand il del,
Lond and lith, and oþer catel,

²⁵¹⁶

And þe king ful sone it yaf
Vbbe in þe hond, wit a fayr staf,
And seyde, “her ich sayse þe
In al þe lond, in al þe fe.”

Havelok makes Ubbe
his steward.

2520

þo swor havelok he sholde make,

2521

Al for grim, of monekes blake

A priorie to seruen inne ay

Ihesu crist, til domesday,

2524

For þe god he haueden him don,

Hwil he was pouere and iuel 114 o bon.

And þer-of held he wel his oth,

For he it made, god it woth!

2528

In þe tun þer grim was grauen,

þat of grim yet haues þe name.

2530

Of grim bidde ich na more spelle. 115—

But wan godrich herde telle,

2532

Of cornwayle þat was erl,

(þat fule traytour, that mixed cherl!)

þat havelok was king of denemark,

And ferde with him strong and stark,

2536

Comen engelond with-inne,

Engelond al for to winne,

And þat she, þat was so fayr,

þat was of engelond rith eir,

2540

þat was comen up at grimesbi,

He was ful sorful and sori,

And seyde, “Hwat shal me to rape?

Goddooth! i shal do slou hem baþe.

2544

I shal don hengen hem ful heye,

He founds a priory of
black monks for
Grim's soul,

[Fol. 217, col. 1.]

in the town of
Grimsby.

Godrich, earl of
Cornwall,

hears that Havelok has
invaded England.

He says he will slay
Havelok and his wife.

So mote ich brouke mi Rith eie!
But yif he of mi lond[e] ¹¹⁶ fle;
Hwat? wenden he to desherite me?”

2548

He raises a great army.

He dide sone ferd ut bidde,
Þat al þat euere mouhte o stede
Ride, or helm on heued bere,
Brini on bac, and sheld, and spere,

2552

Or ani oþer wepne bere,
Hand-ax, syþe, gisarm, or spere,
Or aunlaz, ¹¹⁷ and god long knif,
Þat als he louede leme or lif,

2556

Þat þey sholden comen him to,
With ful god wepne ye ber so,
To lincolne, þer he lay,
Of marz þe seuentenþe day,

The army is to meet at
Lincoln on the 17th of
March.

2560

So þat he coupe hem god þank;
And yif þat ani were so rang,
That he þanne ne come anon,
He swor bi crist, and [bi] ¹¹⁸ seint Iohan,

2564

That he sholde maken him þral,
And al his of-spring forth with-al.

¹¹⁴ The MS. has “we,” which the scribe several times writes instead of “wel.” But “wel” is a manifest blunder, since “iuel” is meant. Cf. l. 2505.

¹¹⁵ The author has here omitted to tell us that Havelok, at the desire of his wife, invades England. See the note.

¹¹⁶ Cf. l. 2599.

¹¹⁷ Printed “alinlaz” in the former edition. The first stroke of the *u* is longer than the second, and the tail of the *x* in the line above converts the second downstroke of the *u* into an apparent *i*.

¹¹⁸ Cf. l. 1112.

Þe englishe þat herde þat,
Was non þat euere his bode sat,

2568

For he him dredde swiþe sore,
So Runci spore, and mikle more.

At þe day he come sone
Þat he hem sette, ful wel o bone,

2572

To lincolne, with gode stedes,
And al þe wepne þat knith ledes.

Hwan he wore come, sket was þe erl yare, ¹¹⁹
Ageynes denshe men to fare,

2576

And seyde, “lyþes me ¹²⁰ alle samen,
Haue ich gadred you for no gamen,

But ich wile seyen you forþi;
Lokes hware here at grimesbi,

2580

Hise uten-laddes here comen,
And haues nu þe priorie numen;
Al þat euere mithen he finde,
He brenne kirkes, and prestes binde;

2584

He strangleth monkes, and nunnes boþe:
Wat wile ye, frend, her-offe Rede?

Yif he regne þus-gate longe,
He Moun us alle ouer-gange,

2588

He moun vs alle quic henge or slo,
Or þral maken, and do ful wo,
Or elles reue us ure liues,
And ure children, and ure wiues.

[Fol. 217, col. 2.]

All come to Lincoln
on that day.

Godrich tells them
what Havelok is doing
at Grimsby.

2592

But dos nu als ich wile you lere,
Als ye wile be with me dere;
Nimes nu swiþe forth and raþe,
And helpes me and yu-self baþe,

2596

And slos up-o[n] þe dogges swiþe:
For shal [i] neuere more be bliþe,

He excites them to
attack Havelok.

ENGLISH MARCH TO GRIMSBY.

Ne hoseled ben, ne of prest shriuen,
Til þat he ben of londe driuen.

2600

Nime we swiþe, and do hem fle,
And folwes alle faste me,
For ich am he, of al þe ferd,
Þat first shal slo with drawen swerd.

He will lead them
himself.

2604

Daþeyt hwo ne stonde faste
Bi me, hwil hise armes laste!”
“Ye! lef, ye!” ¹²¹ couth þe erl gunter;
“Ya!” quoth þe erl of cestre, reyner.

Earl Gunter and Earl
Reyner of Chester
support him.

2608

And so dide alle þat þer stode,
And stirte forth so he were wode.
Þo mouthe men se þe brinies brihte
On backes keste, and late rithe,

2612

Þe helmes heye on heued sette;
To armes al so swiþe plette,
Þat þei wore on a litel stunde
Grethet, als men mithe telle a pund,

[Fol. 217*b*, col. 1.]

2616

And lopen on stedes sone anon,
And toward grimesbi, ful god won,
He foren softe bi þe sti,
Til he come ney at grimesbi.

They approach
Grimsby.

[119](#) Or þare; but see l. 2954.

[120](#) MS. mi. Cf. l. 2204.

[121](#) MS. has *þe*, *pe*, or *ye* in both places. But see l. 1888.

2620

Havelok meets them
boldly,

H auelok, þat hauede spired wel
Of here fare, eueril del,
With al his ferd cam hem a-geyn,
For-bar he noþer knith ne sweyn.

2624

and kills the foremost
knight.

þe firste knith þat he þer mette,
With þe swerd so he him grette,
For his heued of he plette,
Wolde he nouth for sinne lette.

2628

Robert kills a second.

Robert saw þat dint so hende,
Wolde he neuere þepe[n] wende,
Til þat he hauede anoþer slawen,
With þe swerd he held ut-drawen.

2632

William disables a
third.

Willam wendut his swerd vt-drow,
And þe þredde so sore he slow,
þat he made up-on the feld
His lift arm fleye, with the swerd. [122](#)

[122](#) Cf. l. 1825. We should otherwise be tempted to read *sheld*; especially as the *shield* is more appropriate to the *left* arm.

3AT BETWEEN UBBE AND GODRICH.

2636

Huwe rauē ne forȝat nouth
þe swerd he hauede þider brouth,

He kipte it up, and smot ful sore
An erl, þat he saw priken þore,

2640

Ful noblelike upon a stede,
þat with him wolde al quic wede.

He smot him on þe heued so,
þat he þe heued clef a-two,

2644

And þat bi þe shu[l]dre-blade
þe sharpe swerd let [he] wade,
þorw the brest unto þe herte;
þe dint bigan ful sore to smerte,

2648

þat þe erl fel dun a-non,

Al so ded so ani ston.

Quoth ubbe, “nu dwelle ich to longe,”

And leth his stede sone gonge

2652

To godrich, with a god spere,

þat he saw a-noþer bere,

And smoth godrich, and *Godrich* him,

Hetelike with herte grim,

2656

So þat he boþe felle dune,

To þe erþe first þe croune.

Þanne he woren fallen dun boþen,

Grundlike here swerdes ut-drowen,

2660

þat weren swiþe sharp and gode,

And fouhten so þei woren wode,

þat þe swot ran fro þe crune

Hugh Raven seizes his
sword,

and cleaves an earl's
head in two.

Ubbe attacks Godrich.

Both fall.

[Fol. 217*b*, col. 2.]

They fight on foot.

[To the fet rith þere adune.] [123](#)

ICH DISPLAYS GREAT PROWESS.

2664

Þer mouthe men se to knithes bete
Ayþer on oþer dintes grete,
So þat with alþer-lest[e] dint
Were al to-shiuered a flint,

2668

So was bi-twenen hem a fiht,
Fro þe morwen ner to þe niht,
So þat þei nouth ne bl[u]nne,*
Til þat to sette bigan þe sunne.

The fight lasts from
morn to night.

2672

Þo yaf godrich þorw þe side
Vbbe a wunde ful un-ride,
So þat þorw þat ilke wunde
Hauede ben brouth to þe grunde,

Godrich wounds Ubbe
sorely.

2676

And his heued al of-slawnen,
Yif god ne were, and huwe rauen,
Þat drow him fro godrich away,
And barw him so þat ilke day.

Hugh Raven rescues
him.

2680

But er he were fro godrich drawen,
Þer were a þousind knihtes slawen
Bi boþe halue, and mo y-nowe,
Þer þe ferdes to-gidere slowe.

A thousand knights
slain.

2684

Þer was swilk dreping of þe folk,
Þat on þe feld was neuere a polk
Þat it ne stod of blod so ful,
Þat þe strem ran intil þe hul.

The pools are full of
blood.

2688

þo tarst ¹²⁴ bigan godrich to go
Vp-on þe danshe, and faste to slo,
And forth rith also leuin fares,
þat neuere kines best ne spares,

2692

þanne his [he] gon, for he garte alle
þe denshe men biforn him falle.
He felde browne, he felde blake,
þat he mouthe ouer-take.

2696

Was neuere non þat mouhte þaue
Hise dintes, noyþer knith ne knaue,
þat he felden so dos þe gres

Godrich attacks the
Danes like lightning.

He mows them down
like grass.

3AT BETWEEN GODRICH AND HAVELOK.

Bi-forn þe syþe þat ful sharp is.

2700

Hwan hauelok saw his folk so brittene,
And his ferd so swiþe littene,
He cam driuende up-on a stede,
And bigan til him to grede,

2704

And seyde, “godrich, wat is þe
þat þou fare þus with me?
And mine gode knihtes slos,
Siker-like þou mis-gos.

[Fol. 218, col. 1.]

2708

þou wost ful wel, yif þu wilt wite,
þat aþelwold þe dide site
On knes, and sweren on messe-bok,
On caliz, and on [pateyn] ¹²⁵ hok

Havelok reproves
Godrich,

2712

Ʒat þou hise douhter sholdest yelde,
Ʒan she were winnan ¹²⁶ of elde,
Engelond eueril del:
Godrich þe erl, þou wost it wel.

2716

Do nu wel with-uten fiht,
Yeld hire þe lond, for Ʒat is rith.
Wile ich forgiue þe þe lathe,
Al mi dede and al mi wrathe,

2720

For y se þu art so with,
And of þi bodi so god knith.”
“Ʒat ne wile ich neuere mo,”
Quoth erl godrich, “for ich shal slo

2724

þe, and hire for-henge heye.
I shal þrist ut þi rith eye
Ʒat þou lokes with on me,
But þu swiþe heþen fle.”

2728

He grop þe swerd ut sone anon,
And hew on haelok, ful god won,
So Ʒat he clef his sheld on two:
Hwan haelok saw Ʒat shame do

2732

His bodi þer bi-forn his ferd,
He drow ut sone his gode swerd,
And smot him so up-on þe crune,
Ʒat godrich fel to þe erþe adune.

2736

But godrich stirt up swiþe sket,
Lay he nowth longe at hise fet,
And smot him on þe sholdre so,

and bids him perform
his oaths.

Godrich refuses.

He cleaves Havelok’s
shield in two.

Havelok smites him
down.

Godrich rises, and
wounds Havelok in

Þat he dide þare undo

the shoulder.

2740

Of his brinie ringes mo,

Þan þat ich kan tellen fro;

And woundede him rith in þe flesh,

Þat tendre was, and swiþe nesh,

2744

So þat þe blod ran til his to:

Þo was havelok swiþe wo,

Havelok is enraged,

Þat he hauede of him drawen

Blod, and so sore him slawen.

2748

Hertelike til him he wente,

And godrich þer fulike shente;

and cuts off his foe's
hand.

For his swerd he hof up heye,

And þe hand he dide of fleye,

[Fol. 218, col. 2.]

2752

Þat he smot him with so sore:

Hw mithe he don him shame more?

[123](#) Cf. l. 1904.

* The MS. reading *blinne* should clearly be *blunne*. A few other suggestions of emendations will be found in the [Glossarial Index](#). See the words *Arwe*, *Birþe*, *Felde*, *Sor*, *Tauhte*, *Þenne*, *Thit*, *Werewed*, *Wreken*, &c. See also the suggestions in the preface, pp. xxxix, xli, xlvi, xlvii.

[124](#) So in MS. *Qu. faste*, as in next line.

[125](#) MS. *here repeats messe*, by mistake. Read *pateyn*. Cf. l. 187.

[126](#) MS. *wīman*, i.e. *winman* or *wimman*; but we are sure, from l. 174, that *wimman* is meant.

ICH IS BOUND AND FETTERED.

Hwan he hauede him so shamed,
His hand of plat, and yuele lamed,

2756

He tok him sone bi þe necke

Als a traytour, daþeyt wo recke!
And dide him binde and fetere wel
With gode feteres al of stel,

2760

And to þe quen he sende him,
þat birde wel to him ben grim;
And Bad she sholde don him gete,
And þat non ne sholde him bete,

2764

Ne shame do, for he was knith,
Til knithes haueden demd him Rith.
þan þe englishe men þat sawe,
þat þei wisten, heye and lawe,

2768

þat Goldeboru, þat was so fayr,
Was of engeland rith eyr,
And þat þe king hire hauede wedded,
And haueden ben samen bedded,

2772

He comen alle to crie merci,
Vnto þe king, at one cri,
And beden him sone manrede and oth,
þat he ne sholden, for lef ne loth,

2776

Neuere more ageyn him go,
Ne ride, for wel ne for wo.

He has him bound and
fettered,

and sends him to the
queen.

When the English find
out that Goldborough
is the heiress,

they submit to
Havelok.

ENGLISH SUBMIT TO GOLDBOROUGH.

Þe king ne wolde nouth for-sake,
þat he ne shulde of hem take

2780

Manrede þat he beden, and ok
Hold oþes sweren on þe bok;

But or bad he, þat þider were brouth
þe quen, for hem, swilk was his þouth,

2784

For to se, and forto shawe,
Yif þat he hire wolde knawe.
þoruth hem witen wolde he,
Yif þat she aucte quen to be.

2788

Havelok wishes to
show Goldborough to
the English.

Six earls fetch her in.

Sixe erles weren sone yare,
After hire for to fare.
He nomen on-on, and comen sone,
And brouthen hire, þat under mone

2792

In al þe werd ne hauede per,
Of hende-leik, fer ne ner.
Hwan she was come þider, alle
þe englishe men bi-gunne to falle

2796

O knes, and greten swiþe sore,
And seyden, “leuedi, k[r]istes ore,
And youres! we hauen misdo mikel,
þat we ayen you haue be fikel,

2800

For englond auhte forto ben youres,
And we youre men and youres.
Is non of us, yung ne old,
þat we ne wot, þat apelwold

2804

Was king of þis kunerike,
And ye his eyr, and þat þe swike
Haues it halden with mikel wronge:
God leue him sone to honge!”

[Fol. 218b, col. 1.]

The English ask her
pardon.

They admit she is
heiress.

2808

Quot ¹²⁷ havelok, “hwan þat ye it wite.
Nu wile ich þat ye doun site,
And after godrich haues wrouht,
Þat haues in sorwe him-self brouth,

2812

Lokes þat ye demen him rith,
For dom ne spared ¹²⁸ clerk ne knith,
And siþen shal ich under-stonde
Of you, after lawe of londe,

2816

Manrede, and holde oþes boþe,
Yif ye it wilen, and ek rothe.”
Anon þer dune he hem sette,
For non þe dom ne durste lette,

2820

And demden him to binden faste
Vp-on an asse swiþe un-wraste,
Andelong, nouht ouer-þwert,
His nose went unto þe stert;

2824

And so to lincolne lede,
Shamelike in wicke wede,
And hwan he cam un-to þe borw,
Shamelike ben led þer-þoru,

2828

Bisouþe þe borw, un-to a grene,
Þat þare is yet, als[o] y wene,
And þere be bunden til a stake,
Abouten him ful gret fir make,

2832

Havelok says they
must pass judgment
on Godrich.

They say he is to be
bound on an ass's
back,

taken to Lincoln,

bound to a stake, and
burnt.

And al to dust be brend Rith þere;
And yet demden he þer more,
Oþer swikes for to warne,
Þat hise children sulde þarne
2836
Euere more þat eritage,
Þat his was, for hise utrage.

127 MS. Guot. Cf. l. 1954.

128 Qu. spares.

Hwan þe dom was demd and seyd,
Sket was þe swike on þe asse leyð,

2840

And [læd vn-]til 129 þat ilke grene,
And brend til asken al bidene.

Þo was Goldeboru ful bliþe,
She þanked god fele syþe,

2844

Þat þe fule swike was brend,
Þat wende wel hire bodi haue shend,
And seyde, “nu is time to take
Manrede of brune and of blake,

2848

Þat ich se ride[n] and go:
Nu ich am wreke[n] 130 of mi fo.”

129 MS. “And him til,” which is nonsense. See l. 2827.

130 See l. 2992.

Hauelok anon manrede tok
Of alle englishe, on þe bok,

2852

And dide hem grete oþes swere,
Þat he sholden him god feyth bere
Ageyn alle þat woren liues,

So he is laid on the
ass, and burnt.

[Fol. 218b, col. 2.]

Goldborough rejoices.

Havelok makes the
English swear fealty.

And þat sholde ben born of wiues.

EARL OF CHESTER MARRIES GUNILD.

2856

Þanne he hauede ¹³¹ sikernesse
Taken of more and of lesse,
Al at hise wille, so dide he calle
þe erl of cestre, and hise men alle,

2860

þat was yung knith wit-uten wif,
And seyde, “sire erl, bi mi lif,
And þou wile mi *conseyl* tro,
Ful wel shal ich with þe do,

2864

For ich shal yeue þe to wiue
þe fairest þing that is oliue.

He proposes that Earl
Reyner of Chester

LOK REMEMBERS BERTRAM'S KINDNESS.

þat is gunnild of grimesby,
Grimes douter, bi seint dauy!

2868

þat me forth broute, and wel fedde,
And ut of denemark with me fledde,
Me for to burwe fro mi ded:
Sikerlike, þoru his red

2872

Haue ich liued in-to þis day,
Blissed worþe his soule ay!
I rede þat þu hire take,
And spuse, and curteyse make,

2876

For she is fayr, and she is fre,

shall marry Gunild,
Grim's daughter;

And al so hende so she may be.

Þertekene she is wel with me,

Þat shal ich ful wel shewe þe,

2880

For ich giue þe a giue,

Þat euere more hwil ich liue,

For hire shal-tu be with me dere,

Þat wile ich þat þis folc al here.”

2884

Þe erl ne wolde nouth ageyn

Þe king[e] be, for knith ne sweyn,

Ne of þe spusing seyen nay,

But spusede [hire] þat ilke day.

2888

Þat spusinge was god time maked,

For it ne were neuere clad ne naked,

In a þede samened two

Þat cam to-gidere, liuede so,

2892

So þey dide[n] al here liue:

He geten *samen* sones fiue,

Þat were þe beste *men* at nede,

Þat mouthe *riden* on ani stede.

2896

Hwan *gunnild* was to cestre brouth,

Haue lok þe gode ne for-gat nouth

Bertram, þat was the erles kok,

Þat he ne dide callen ok,

2900

And seyde, “frend, so god me rede!

Nu shaltu haue riche mede,

and he will then
always be his friend.

[Fol. 219, col. 1.]

They are married,

and have five sons.

Havelok remembers
Bertram, the earl's
cook₂...

For wissing, and þi gode dede,
þat tu me dides in ful gret nede.

2904

For þanne y yede in mi cuuel,
And ich ne haue[de] bred, ne sowel,
Ne y ne hauede no catel,
Pou feddes and claddes me ful wel.

2908

Haue nu for-þi of cornwayle
þe erldom ildel, with-uten fayle,
And al þe lond þat godrich held,
Boþe in towne, and ek in feld;

2912

And þerto wile ich, þat þu spuse,
And fayre bring hire un-til huse,
Grimes douthter, leuiue þe hende,
For þider shal she with þe wende.

2916

Hire semes curteys forto be,
For she is fayr so flour on tre;
þe heu is swilk in hire ler
So [is] þe rose in roser,

2920

Hwan it is fayr sprad ut newe
Ageyn þe sunne, brith and lewe.”
And girde him sone with þe swerd
Of þe erldom, bi-forn his ferd,

2924

And with his hond he made him knith,
And yaf him armes, for þat was rith,
And dide him þere sone wedde

2927

Hire þat was ful swete in bedde.

and makes him Earl of
Cornwall.

He is to marry Leuue,
Grim's daughter,

who is as fair as a
rose.

They are married.

131 MS. haueden.

2928

After þat he spused wore,
Wolde þe erl nouth dwelle þore,
But sone nam until his lond,
And seysed it al in his hond,

2932

And liuede þer-inne, he and his wif,
An hundred winter in god lif, 132
And gaten mani children samen,
And liueden ay in blisse and gamen.

2936

Hwan þe maydens were spused boþe,
Hauelok anon bigan ful rathe
His denshe men to feste wel
Wit riche landes and catel,

2940

So þat he weren alle riche:
For he was large and nouth chinche.

Havelok and
Goldborough lived
100 years, and had
many children.

[Fol. 219, col. 2.]

The Danes are
enriched.

132 Between this line and the next are inserted in the MS. the words: *For he saw þat he*, which have been subsequently struck out by the same hand, and the word *vacat* affixed.

LOK IS CROWNED KING OF ENGLAND.

Per-after sone, with his here,
For he to lundone, forto bere

2944

Corune, so þat [alle] it sawe,
Henglishe ant denshe, heye and lowe,
Hwou he it bar with mikel pride,
For his barnage þat was un-ride.

2948

Havelok is crowned at
London.

The feast lasts 40

Þe feste of his coruni[n]g ¹³³
Laste[de] with gret ioying

Fourti dawes, and sumdel mo;

Þo bigunnen þe denshe to go

2952

Vn-to þe king, to aske leue,

And he ne wolde hem nouth greue,

For he saw þat he woren yare

In-to denemark for to fare,

2956

But gaf hem leue sone anon,

And bitauhte hem seint Johan;

And bad ubbe, his iustise,

Þat he sholde on ilke wise

2960

Denemark yeme and gete so,

Þat no pleynte come him to.

¹³³ MS. corunig.

Hwan he wore parted alle samen,
Hauelok bi-lefte wit ioie and gamen

2964

In engelond, and was þer-inne

Sixti winter king with winne,

And Goldeboru quen, þat I wene:

So mikel loue was hem bitwene,

2968

Þat al þe werd spak of hem two:

He louede hire, and she him so,

Þat neyþer oþe[r] mithe be

For ¹³⁴ oþer, ne no ioie se,

2972

But yf he were to-gidere ¹³⁵ boþe;

days.

The Danes return
home.

Ubbe is to rule
Denmark.

Havelok remained in
England for sixty
years.

He and Goldborough
were never apart.

Neuere yete ne weren he wroþe,
For here loue was ay newe,
Neuere yete wordes ne grewe
2976
Bitwene hem, hwar-of ne lathe
Mithe rise, ne no wrathe.

[Fol. 219b, col. 1.]

134 Qu. Fro.

135 MS. togidede.

IS THE "GESTE" OF HAVELOK.

He geten children hem bi-twene
Sones and douthres rith fiuetene,

They had 15 children,
all kings and queens.

2980

Hwar-of þe sones were kinges alle,
So wolde god it sholde bifalle;
And þe douhtres alle quenes:
Him stondes wel þat god child strenes.

2984

Nu haue ye herd þe gest al þoru
Of havelok and of goldeborw.
Hw he weren born, and hw fedde,
And hwou he worn with wronge ledde

Such is the *geste* of
Havelok and
Goldborough.

2988

In here youþe, with trecherie,
With tresoun, and with felounye,

2990

And hwou þe swikes haueden thit
Reuen hem þat was here rith,

2992

And hwou he weren wreken wel,
Haue ich sey you euerildel;

PATERNOSTER FOR THE AUTHOR.

And forþi ich wolde biseken you,
þat hauen herd þe rim[e] nu,

2996

þat ilke of you, with gode wille,
Seye a *pater-noster* stille,
For him þat haueth þe rym[e] maked,
And þer-fore fele nihtes waked;

3000

þat ihesu *crist* his soule bringe
Bi-forn his fader at his endinge.

Amen.

Each of you say a
pater-noster for the
author.

NOTES.

[The following notes are abridged from the notes in Sir F. Madden's excellent edition, the abridgement being effected almost entirely by occasional omissions, and with but very slight unimportant changes of a few words, chiefly in the case of references to later editions of various works than were existing in 1828. I have added one or two short notes upon difficult constructions, but these are distinguished by being enclosed within square brackets. —W. W. S.]

- [9.](#) *He was the wicteste man at nede*
 That thurte riden on ani stede.

This appears to have been a favourite expression of the poet, and to have comprehended, in his idea, the perfection of those qualifications required in a knight and hero. He repeats it, with some slight variation, no less than five times, viz. in ll. 25, 87, 345, 1757, and 1970. The lines, however, are by no means original, but the common property of all our early poetical writers. We find them in *Lazamon*:

þis wes þe feiruste mon
þe æuere æhte ær þusne kinedom,
þa he mihte beren wepnen,
& his hors wel awilden.

Lazamon, vol. i. p. 174.

So also in the Romance of *Guy of Warwick*:

He was the best knight at neede
That euer bestrode any stede.

Coll. Garrick, K. 9. sign. Ll. ii.

Again, in the *Continuation of Sir Gy*, in the Auchinleck MS., (ed. for the Abbotsford Club, 1840, 4to; p. 266),

The best bodi he was at nede
That ever might bistriden stede,
And freest founde in fight.

And again, in the *Chronicle of England*, published by Ritson from a copy in the British Museum, MS. Reg. 12. C. xii.

After him his sone Arthur
Hevede this lond thourh and thourh.
He was the beste kyng at nede
That ever mihte ride on stede,
Other wepne welde, other folk out-lede,
Of mon he hede he never drede.

—l. 261.

The very close resemblance of these lines to those in *Havelok*, ll. 87-90, would induce a belief that the writer of the *Chronicle* had certainly read, and perhaps copied from, the Romance. The MS. followed by Ritson was undoubtedly written soon after the death of Piers Gaveston, in 1313, with the mention of which event it concludes; but in the Auchinleck copy it is continued, by a later hand, to the minority of Edward III. It only remains to be observed, that the poem in MS. Reg. 12. C. xii. is written by the same identical hand as the MS. Harl. 2253 (containing *Kyng Horn*, &c.), whence some additional light is thrown on the real age of the latter, respecting which our antiquaries so long differed.

[[15](#). “And I will drink ere I tell my tale.” *Her* = ere.]

[19](#). *And wite*, &c., i.e. And ordain that it may be so; cf. ll. 517, 1316. Both metre and grammar require the final *e*.]

[31](#). *Erl and barun*, ***dreng*** and *kayn*. The appellation of *Dreng*, and, in the plural, *Drenges*, which repeatedly occurs in the course of this poem, is

uniformly bestowed on a class of men who hold a situation between the rank of *Baron* and *Thayn*. We meet with the term more than once in Domesday Book, as, for instance, in Tit. Cestresc: “Hujus manerii [Neuton] aliam terram xv. hom. quos *Drenches* vocabant, pro xv. maneriis tenebant.” And in a Charter of that period we read: “Alger Prior, et totus Conventus Ecclesiæ S. Cuthberti, Edwino, et omnibus Teignis et *Drengis*, &c.” Hence Spelman infers, that the Drengs were military vassals, and held land by knight’s service, which was called *Drengagium*. This is confirmed by a document from the Chartulary of Welbeck, printed in Dugdale, *Mon. Angl.* V. II. p. 598, and in Blount, *Jocular Tenures*, p. 177, where it is stated, “In eadem villa [Cukeney, co. Nottingh.] manebat quidam homo qui vocabatur Gamelbere, et fuit vetus *Dreyinghe* ante Conquestum.” It appears from the same document, that this person held two carucates of land of the King *in capite*, and was bound to perform military service for the same, whenever the army went into Wales. In the Epistle also from the Monks of Canterbury to Henry II. printed by Somner, in his Treatise on Gavelkind, p. 123, we find: “Quia vero non erant adhuc tempore Regis Willelmi Milites in Anglia, sed *Threnges*, præcepit Rex, ut de eis Milites fierent, ad terram defendendam.” In Lazamon’s translation of Wace the term is frequently used in the acceptation of thayn, and spelt either *dringches*, *drenches*, *dranches*, or *dringes*. [Cf. Sw. *dräng*, a man, servant; Dan. *dreng*, a boy.] In the Isl. and Su. Goth. *Dreng* originally signified *vir fortis, miles strenuus*, and hence Olaf, King of Norway, received the epithet of *Goddreng*. See Wormii Lex. Run. p. 26. Ihre, Vet. Cat. Reg. p. 109. Langebek, Script. Rer. Danic. V. I. p. 156. The term subsequently was applied to persons in a servile condition, and is so instanced by Spelman, as used in Denmark. In this latter sense it may be found in Hickes, Diction. Isl., and in Sir David Lyndsay’s Poems,

Quhilk is not ordanit for *dringis*
But for Duikis, Empriouris, and Kingis.

V. Pinkerton’s Scotish Poems Reprinted, ii. 97.

V. Jamieson, Dict. *in voce*.

45. *In that time a man that bore*
 (Wel fyfty pund, y woth, or more.)

This insertion receives additional authority from a similar passage in the Romance of *Guy of Warwick*, where it is mentioned as a proof of the rigorous system of justice pursued by Earl Sigard,

Though a man bore an hundred pound,
Upon him of gold so round,
There n'as man in all this land
That durst him do shame no schonde.

Ellis, *Metr. Rom.* V. ii. p. 9. Ed. 1811.

Many of the traits here attributed to Athelwold appear to be borrowed from the praises so universally bestowed by our ancient historians on the character of King Alfred, in whose time, as Otterbourne writes, p. 52, “*armillas aureas in bivio stratas vel suspensas, nemo abripere est ausus.*” Cf. *Annal. Eccl. Roffens.* MS. Cott. Nero, D. ii. The same anecdote is related of Rollo, Duke of Normandy, by Guillaume de Jumieges, and Dudon de Saint Quentin.

[91.](#) *Sprong forth so sparke of glede.* Cf. l. 870. It is a very common metaphor in early English poetry.

He sprong forð an stede,
swa sparc ded of fure,
Lazamon v. ii. p. 565.

He sprange als any sparke one glede.
Sir Isumbras, st. 39 (Camd. Soc. 1844)

He spronge as sparkle doth of glede,
K. of Tars, l. 194.

And lepte out of the arsoun,
As sperk thogh out of glede.
Ly Beaus Desconus, l. 623.

Cf. Chaucer, *Cant. Tales*, l. 13833, and Tyrwhitt's note.

[110.](#) *Of his bodi, &c.* Compare the French text, l. 208.

Mes entre eus n'eurent enfant

Mes qe vne fille bele;
Argentille out non la pucele.
Rois Ekenbright fut enfermez,
Et de grant mal forment greuez;
Bien siet n'en poet garrir.

[Here *Argentille* is *Goldborough*, and *Ekenbright* answers to *Athelwold*. This quotation, and others below, shewing the passages of the French text which most nearly resemble the English poem, are from a MS. in the Herald's College, marked E. D. N. No. 14. See the Preface.]

[[118](#). *Wat shal me to rede*, lit. what shall be for a counsel to me. See *Rede* in the Glossary to *William of Palerne*.

[130](#). *And don hem of þar hire were queme*, lit. and do them off where it should be agreeable to her; i.e. and keep men at a distance as she pleased. Such seems to me the meaning of this hitherto unexplained line.

[132](#). For *me* we ought probably to read *hit*.]

[136](#). *He sende **writes** sone onon*. We must here, and in l. 2275, simply understand *letters*, without any reference to the official summonses of parliament, which subsequently were so termed, κατ' ἐξοχὴν. The word *briefs* is used in the same sense by the old French writers, and in *Lazamon* we meet with some lines nearly corresponding with the present; see ll. 6669-6678.

[[175](#). *þa*. Frequently written for *þat*. See *William of Palerne*.]

[189-203](#). *Ther-on he garte*, &c. Compare the French Romance, ll. 215-228.

Sa fille li ad comandée,
Et sa terre tote liuerée.
Primerement li fet iurer,
Veiant sa gent & affier,
Qe leaument la nurrireit,
Et sa terre lui gardereit,
Tant q'ele fust de tiel age
Qe suffrir porroit mariage.
Quant la pucele seit granz,

Par le consail de ses tenanz,
Au plus fort home la dorroit
Qe el reaume troueroit;
Qu'il li baillast ses citez,
Ses chasteus & ses fermetez.

[263.](#) *Justises dede he maken newe,
Al Engelond to faren thorw.*

The earliest instance produced by Dugdale of the Justices Itinerant, is in 23 Hen. II. 1176, when by the advice of the Council held at Northampton, the realm was divided into six parts, and into each were sent three Justices. *Orig. Judic.* p. 51. This is stated on the authority of Hoveden. Dugdale admits however the custom to have been older, and in Gervasius Dorobernensis, we find, in 1170, certain persons, called *inquisitores*, appointed to perambulate England. Gervase of Tilbury, or whoever was the author of the *Dialogus de Scaccario*, calls them *deambulantes, vel perlustrantes iudices*. See Spelman, *in voc.* The office continued to the time of Edward III., when it was superseded by that of the Justices of Assize.

[280.](#) *The kinges douthter, &c.* Comp. the Fr. l. 283.

Argentille,
La meschine qu'ert sa fille,
Que ia estoit creue & grant,
Et bien poeit auoir enfant.

[[338.](#) Sawe, put for "Say we." Cf. *bidde* for "bidde i," l. 484; *hauedet* for "hauede it," 714; &c.

[365.](#) *His quiste, &c.* "His bequest made, and (things) distributed for him."]

[433.](#) *Crist warie him with his mouth!
Waried wrthe he of north and suth!*

So, in the Romance of Merlin, Bishop Brice curses the enemies of Arthur,

Ac, for he is king, and king's son,
Y curse alle, and y dom
His enemies with Christes mouth,

By East, by West, by North, and South!

Ellis, *Metr. Rom.* V. i. p. 260.

[[506](#). For *nouth* we must read *mouth* or *wolde*. The sense is— “He thought that he would he were dead, except that he might not (*or* would not) slay him with his (own) hand.”

[550](#). The sense is— “When he had done that deed (i.e. gagged the child), *then* the deceiver had commanded him,” &c.

[560](#). *with* may mean *knowest*, but this hardly gives sense. Perhaps we should read *wilt*, i.e. “As thou wilt have (preserve) my life.”

[567](#). Mr Morris suggests that the riming words are *adoun* and *croune*. We might then read—

“And caste þe knaue so harde adoun,
þat he crakede þer hise croune.”]

[591](#). *Of hise mouth*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 71. sq.

Totes les heures q’il dormoit,
Vne flambe de lui issoit.
Par la bouche li venoit fors,
Si grant chalur auoit el cors.
La flambe rendoit tiel odour,
Onc ne sentit nul home meillour.

[676](#). *And with thi chartre make (me) fre*. Instances of the manumission of villains or slaves by charter may be found in Hickes, *Diss. Epistol.* p. 12, Lye’s Dict. *ad calc.*, and Madox’s *Formulare Anglicanum*, p. 750. The practice was common in the Saxon times, and existed so late as the reign of Henry VIII.

[[694](#). *Wite he him onliue*, if he knows him (to be) alive.

[701](#). It is evident that the words *and gate* = and goats, must be supplied. For the spelling *gate*, cf. *Pricke of Conscience*, ed. Morris, l. 6134, where *gayte* is used collectively as a plural.]

[706](#). *Hise ship*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 89.

Grim fet niefs apparailer,
Et de viande bien charger.

[715-720.](#) *Hauelok the yunge, &c. Comp. the Fr. ll. 97-105.*

Quant sa nief fut apparailée,
Dedenz fist entrer sa meisnée,
Ses cheualers & ses serganz,
Sa femme demeine & ses enfanz:
La reyne mist el batel,
Haueloc tint souz son mantel.
Il meismes apres entra,
A Dieu del ciel se comanda,
Del hauene sont desancré,
Car il eurent bon orré.

Instead of the storm, in the French text Grim's ship is attacked by pirates, who kill the whole of the crew, with the exception of himself and family, whom they spare on the score of his being an old acquaintance.

[733-749.](#) *In Humber, &c. So in the Fr. *Ceo fut el north, &c. Cf. ll. 122-135.**

Tant out nagé & tant siglé,
Q'en vne hauene out parvenu,
Et de la nief a terre issu.
Ceo fut el North, a Grimesbi;
A icel tens qe ieo vus di,
Ni out onques home habité,
Ne cele hauene n'ert pas haunté.
Il i adresca primes maison,
De lui ad Grimesbi a non.
Quant Grim primes i ariua,
En .ii. moitez sa nief trencha,
Les chiefs en ad amont drescé,
Iloec dedenz s'est herbergé.
Pescher aloit sicome il soloit,
Siel vendoit & achatoit.

[753.](#) *He took the sturgiun and the qual,
And the turbut, and lax withal,
He tok the sele, and the hwel, &c.*

The list of fish here enumerated may be increased from l. 896, and presents us with a sufficiently accurate notion of the different species eaten in the 13th century. Each of the names will be considered separately in the Glossary, and it is only intended here to make a few remarks on those, which in the present day appear rather strangely to have found a place on the tables of our ancestors. The sturgeon is well known to have been esteemed a dainty, both in England and France, and specially appropriated to the King's service, but that the whale, the seal, and the porpoise should have been rendered palatable, excites our astonishment. Yet that the whale was caught for that purpose, appears not only from the present passage, but also from the Fabliau intitled *Bataille de Charnage et de Caresme*, written probably about the same period, and printed by Barbazan. It is confirmed, as we learn from Le Grand, by the French writers; and even Rabelais, near three centuries later, enumerates the whale among the dishes eaten by the Gastrolatres. In the list of fish also published by Le Grand from a MS. of the 13th century, and which corresponds remarkably with the names in the Romance, we meet with the *Baleigne*. See *Vie Privée des François*, T. II. sect. 8.

Among the articles at Archbishop Nevil's Feast, 6 Edw. IV., we find, *Porposes and Seales* *xii.* and at that of Archbishop Warham, held in 1504, is an item: *De Seales & Porposs. prec. in gross xxvi. s. viii. d.* Champier asserts that the Seal was eaten at the Court of Francis I., so that the taste of the two nations seems at this period to have been nearly the same. For the courses of fish in England during the 14th and 15th centuries, see Pegge's *Form of Cury*, and Warner's *Antiquitates Culinariæ*, to which we may add MS. Sloane, 1986. [Cf. *Babees Book*, &c., ed. Furnivall, 1868, p. 153.]

[[784.](#) For *setes* we should probably read *seten* or *sette*, which would be as good a rime as many others. The scribe has probably made the rime more perfect than the sense. It must mean, "In the sea were they oft set." We cannot here suppose *setes* = *set es* = set them.]

[839.](#) *And seyde, Hauelok, dere sone.* In the French, Grim sends Havelok away for quite a different reason, viz. because he does not understand fishing.

[903.](#) *The kok stod, &c.* Comp. the Fr. l. 242.

Et vn keu le roi le retint,
Purceo qe fort le vist & grant,
Et mult le vist de bon semblant.
Merueillous fes poeit leuer,
Busche tailler, ewe porter.

The last line answers to l. 942 of the English version.

[939.](#) *He bar the turues, he bar the star.* The meaning of the latter term will be best illustrated by a passage in Moor's *Suffolk Words*, where, under the word *Bent*, he writes, "*Bent* or *Starr*, on the N.W. coast of England, and especially in Lancashire, is a coarse reedy shrub—like ours perhaps—of some importance formerly, if not now, on the sandy blowing lands of those counties. Its fibrous roots give some cohesion to the silicious soil. By the 15 and 16 G. II. c. 33, plucking up and carrying away *Starr* or *Bent*, or having it in possession within five miles of the sand hills, was punishable by fine, imprisonment, and whipping." The use stated in the Act to which the *Starr* was applied, is, "making of Mats, Brushes, and Brooms or Besoms," therefore it might very well be adapted to the purposes of a kitchen, and from its being coupled with turves in the poem, was perhaps sometimes burnt for fuel. The origin of the word is Danish, and still exists in the Dan. *Stær*, Swed. *Starr*, Isl. *staer*, a species of sedge, or broom, called by Lightfoot, p. 560, *carex cespitosa*. Perhaps it is this shrub alluded to in the Romance of *Kyng Alisaunder*, and this circumstance will induce us to assign its author to the district in which the *Starr* is found.

The speris craketh swithe thikke,
So doth on hegge *sterre-stike*.

—l. 4438.

[945.](#) *of alle men, &c.* Comp. the Fr. l. 254.

Tant estoit franc & deboneire,

Que tuz voloit lur pleisir fere,
Pur la franchise q'il out.

[959.](#) *Of him ful wide the word sprong.* A phrase which from the Saxon times occurs repeatedly in all our old writers. A few examples may suffice.

Beowulf wæs breame,
Blæd wide sprang.

Beowulf, ed. Thorpe, p. 2.

Welle wide sprong þas eorles word.

Lazamon, l. 26242.

Of a knight is that y mene,
His name is sprong wel wide.

Sir Tristrem, st. 2, p. 12.

The word of Horn wide sprong,
How he was bothe michel and long.

Horn Childe, ap. Rits. *Metr. Rom.* V. iii. p. 291.

See also the *Kyng of Tars*, ll. 19, 1007, *Emare*, l. 256, *Roland and Ferragus*, as quoted by Ellis, *Ly beaus Desconus*, l. 172, and *Chronicle of England*, l. 71.

[984.](#) *In armes him noman (ne) nam,
þat he doune sone ne caste.*

The same praise is bestowed on Havelok in the French text, l. 265,—

Deuant eus liuter le fesoient
As plus forz homes q'il sauoient,
Et il trestouz les abatit—

and it was doubtless in imitation or ridicule of the qualities attributed to similar heroes, that Chaucer writes of Sir Thopas, "Of wrastling was ther non his per." *Cant. Tales*, l. 13670.

[1006.](#) *To ben þer at þe parlement.* Cf. l. 1178. If we examine our historical records, we shall find that the only parliament held at Lincoln was in the year 1300, 28 Edw. I., and the writs to the *Archbishop of York*, and other

Nobles, both ecclesiastical and secular, are still extant. The proceedings are detailed at some length by Robert of Brunne, Vol. II. p. 312, who might have been in Lincoln at the time, or, at all events, was sufficiently informed of all that took place, from his residence in the county. If we could suppose that the author of the Romance alluded to this very parliament, it would reduce the period of the poem's composition to a later date, than either the style or the writing of the MS. will possibly admit of. It is therefore far more probable the writer here makes use of a poetical, and very pardonable licence, in transferring the parliament to the chief city of the county in which he was evidently born, or brought up, without any reference whatever to historical data.

[1022.](#) *Biforn here fet panne lay a tre,
And putten with a mikel ston, &c.*

This game of *putting the stone*, is of the highest antiquity, and seems to have been common at one period to the whole of England, although subsequently confined to the Northern counties, and to Scotland. Fitzstephen enumerates casting of stones among the amusements of the Londoners in the 12th century, and Dr Pegge, in a note on the passage, calls it "a Welch custom." The same sport is mentioned by Geoffrey of Monmouth, among the diversions pursued at King Arthur's feast, as will appear in a subsequent note (l. 2320). By an edict of Edward III. the practice of casting stones, wood, and iron, was forbidden, and the use of the bow substituted, yet this by no means superseded the former amusement, which was still in common use in the 16th century, as appears from Strutt's *Popular Pastimes*, Introd. pp. xvii, xxxix, and p. 56, sq. In the Highlands this sport appears to have been longer kept up than in any other part of Britain, and Pennant, describing their games, writes, "Those retained are, throwing the *putting-stone*, or stone of strength (*Cloch neart*) as they call it, which occasions an emulation who can throw a weighty one the farthest." *Tour in Scotl.* p. 214. 4to. 1769. See also *Statist. Account of Argyleshire*, xi. 287. In the French Romance of Horn, preserved in MS. Harl. 527, is almost a similar incident to the one in Havelok, and would nearly amount to a proof, that Tomas, the writer of the French text of Horn, was an Englishman.

In the Romance of *Octovian Imperator* it is said of Florent,

At wrestelyng, and at ston castynge
He wan the prys, without lesynge;
Ther n'as nother old ne yynge
So mochell of strength,
That myght the ston to hys *but* bryng,
Bi fedeme lengthe.

—l. 895.

It is singular enough, that the circumstance of Havelok's throwing the stone, mentioned in the Romance, should have been founded on, or preserved in, a local tradition, as attested by Robert of Brunne, p. 26.

Men sais in Lyncoln castelle ligges 3it a stone,
That Havelok kast wele forbi euerilkone.

[1077-1088](#). *The king Athelwald*, &c. Comp. the Fr. text, ll. 354-370.

Quant Ekenbright le roi fini,
En ma garde sa fille mist;
Vn serement iurer me fist,
Q'au plus fort home le dorroie,
Qe el reaume trouer porroie.
Assez ai quis & demandé,
Tant q'en ai vn fort troué;
Vn valet ai en ma quisine,
A qui ieo dorrai la meschine; &c.

[1103](#). *After Goldeborw*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 377.

Sa niece lur fet amener,
Et a Cuaran esposer;
Pur lui auiler & honir,
La fist la nuit lez lui gesir.

The French Romance differs here very considerably from the English, and in the latter, the dream of Argentille, her visit to the hermit, and the conversation relative to Havelok's parents, is entirely omitted.

[[1174](#). This may mean—“He (Havelok) is given to her, and she has taken (him)”—but this makes *yaf* and *tok* past participles, which they properly are not; or else we must translate it—“He (Godard) gave them to her, and she took them,” i.e. the pence. This alone is the grammatical construction, and it suits the context best; observe, that the words *ys* and *as* are equivalent to *es* = them. Cf. l. 970. See Morris; *Gen. & Exod.*, Pref. p. xviii.]

[1203](#). *Thanne he komen there*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 556.

A Grimesby s'en alerent;
Mes li prodoms estoit finiz,
Et la Dame q'is out nurriz.
Kelloc sa fille i ont trouée,
Vn marchant l'out esposée.

The marriage of Kelloc, Grim's daughter, with a merchant is skilfully introduced in the French, and naturally leads to the mention of Denmark. The plot of the English story is wholly dissimilar in this respect.

[1247](#). *On the nith*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 381.

Quant couché furent ambedui,
Cele out grant honte de lui,
Et il assez greindre de li.
As deuz se geut, si se dormi.
Ne voloit pas q'ele veist
La flambe qe de lui issist.

The voice of the angel is completely an invention of the English author, and the dream (which is transferred from Argentille to Havelok) is altogether different in its detail.

[1260](#). *He beth heyman*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 521.

Il est né de real lignage,
Oncore auera grant heritage.
Grant gent fra vers li encline,
Il serra roi & tu reyne.

[[1334](#). The words *euere-il del* are corruptly repeated from line 1330 above. Perhaps we should read *wit-uten were*, i.e. without doubt.]

[1430.](#) *Hauede go for him gold ne fe.* Cf. l. 44. So in Lazamon:

Ne sculde him neoðer gon fore
Gold ne na gærsume, &c.;
—vol. ii. p. 537.

[[1444.](#) The French text helps but little to supply the blank. It shows that Havelok and his wife sailed to Denmark, and, on their arrival, sought out the castle belonging to Sigar, who answers to the Ubbe of the English version.]

[1632.](#) *A gold ring drow he forth anon,* &c. A similar incident, and in nearly the same words, occurs in Sir Tristrem.

A ring he raught him tite,
The porter seyð nought nay,
In hand:
He was ful wis, y say,
That first yave yift in land.
—fytte i. st. 57, p. 39.

So also Wyntoun, who relates the subsidy of 40,000 moutons sent from France to Scotland in 1353, and adds,

Qwha gyvis swilk gyftyis he is wyse.

[See also *Piers Plowman*, Text A. iii. 202.]

[1646.](#) *Hw he was wel of bones,* &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 743.

Gent cors & bele feture,
Lungs braz & grant furcheure
Ententiuement l'esgarda.

[[1678.](#) This line has two syllables too little.]

[1722.](#) *Thanne he were set,* &c. This is an amplification of the Fr. l. 677, sq.

Quant fut heure del manger,
Et qe tuz alerent lauer,
Li prodoms a manger s'assist,
Les .iii. valez seeir i fist,

Argentille lez son seignur;
Serui furent a grant honor.

[1726.](#) *Kranes, swannes, veneysun, &c.* We have here the principal constituents of what formed the banquets of our ancestors. The old Romances abound with descriptions of this nature, which coincide exactly with the present. See *Richard Cœur de Lion*, l. 4221; *Guy of Warwick*; *The Squyr of Lowe Degre*, l. 317; and *Morte Arthure*, ed. Perry, p. 7.

“Wine is common,” says Dr Pegge, speaking of the entertainments of the 14th century, “both red and white. This article they partly had of their own growth, and partly by importation from France and Greece.” A few examples will illustrate this:

He laid the cloth, and set forth bread,
And also wine, both *white and red*.

Sir Degore, ap. Ellis, *Metr. Rom.* V. 3, p. 375.

And dronke wyn, and eke pyment,
Whyt and red, al to talent.

Kyng Alisaunder, l. 4178.

[Cf. *Piers Plowman*, Text B, at the end of the *Prologue*.]

In the *Squyr of Lowe Degre* is a long list of these wines, which has received considerable illustration in the curious work of Dr Henderson.

[[1736.](#) I print *kiwing*, as in Sir F. Madden’s edition; but I quite give up the meaning of it, and doubt if it is put for *kirving*. The word is obscurely written, and looks like *kilping*, and my impression is that it is miswritten for *ilk þing*, the word *þe* being put for *þer*, as frequently elsewhere. We should thus get *hwan he haueden þer ilk þing deled*, when they had there distributed every thing. This is, at any rate, the sense of the passage.]

[1749.](#) *And sende him unto the greyues.* In the French, Havelok is simply sent to an *ostel*, and the *greyve* does not appear in the story.

[1806.](#) *Hauelok lifte up, &c.* In the French, all the amusing details relative to Robert and Huwe Raven are omitted, and Havelok is made to retire to a

monastery, where he defends himself by throwing down the stones on his assailants.

[[1826](#). *wolde*, offered at, intended to hit, *would* have hit.]

[1838](#). *And shoten on him, so don on bere*
 Dogges, that wolden him to-tere.

The same comparison is made use of in the Romance of Horn Childe:

 The Yrise folk about him yode,
 As hondes do to bare.

 Rits. *Metr. Rom.* V. III. p. 289.

See [Note on l. 2320](#).

[[1914](#). “Cursed be he who cares! for they deserved it! What did they? There were they worried.” A mark of interrogation seems required after *dide he*.]

[1926-1930](#). *Sket cam tiding*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 719.

 La nouele vint a chastel,
 Au seneschal, qui n’est pas bel,
 Qe cil qu’il auoit herbergé
 Cinc de ses homes out tué.

[[1932](#). Apparently corrupt. Perhaps *is* should be *it*. “That this strife—as to what it meant.”]

[2045](#). *That weren of Kaym kin and Eues*. The odium affixed to the supposed progeny of Cain, and the fables engrafted on it, owe their origin to the theological opinions of the Middle Ages, which it is not worth while to trace to their authors. See *Beowulf*, ed. Thorpe, p. 8; and *Piers Plowman*, A. x. 135-156; answering to p. 177 of Whitaker’s edition. See also the Romance of *Kyng Alisaunder*:

 And of Sab the duk Mauryn,
 He was of *Kaymes kunrede*.

 —l. 1932.

In *Ywaine and Gawaine*, l. 559, the Giant is called “the karl of *Kaymes kyn*,” and so also in a poem printed by Percy, intitled *Little John Nobody*,

written about the year 1550.

Such caitives count to be come of Cain's kind.

Anc. Reliq. V. II. p. 130. Ed. 1765.

[2076.](#) *It ne shal no thing ben bitwene
Thi bour and min, also y wene,
But a fayr firrene wowe.*

These lines will receive some illustration from a passage in *Sir Tristrem*, where it is said,

A borde he tok oway
Of her bour.

—p. 114.

On which Sir W. Scott remarks, "The bed-chamber of the queen was constructed of wooden boards or shingles, of which one could easily be removed." This will explain the line which occurs below, 2106, "He stod, and totede in at a bord."

[2092.](#) *Aboute the middel*, &c. In the French, a person is placed by the Seneschal to watch, who first discovers the light.

[2132.](#) *Bi the pappes he leyen naked*. "From the latter end of the 13th to near the 16th century, all ranks, and both sexes, were universally in the habit of sleeping quite naked. This custom is often alluded to by Chaucer, Gower, Lydgate, and all our ancient writers." Ellis, *SPEC. METR. ROM.* V. I. p. 324, 4th Ed. In the *Squyr of Lowe Degre* is a remarkable instance of this fact:

How she rose, that lady dere,
To take her leue of that squyer;
Al so naked as she was borne
She stod her chambre-dore beforene.

—l. 671.

The custom subsisted both in England and France to a very recent period, and hence probably was derived the phrase *naked-bed*, illustrated so copiously by Archdeacon Nares in his Glossary.

[2192.](#) Cf. the French, l. 843.

Ses chapeleins fet demander,
Ses briefs escriure & enseeler;
Par ses messages les manda,
Et pur ses amis enuoia;
Pur ses homes, pur ses parenz;
Mult i assembla granz genz.

[[2201](#). Read *ne neme* = took not, sc. their way, just as in l. 1207.]

[2240-2265](#). *Lokes, hware he stondes her*, &c. Comp. the Fr. ll. 913-921.

“Veez ci nostre dreit heir,
Bien en deuom grant ioie aueir.”
Tut primerain se desafubla,
Par deuant lui s’agenuilla;
Sis homs deuint, si li iura
Qe leaument le seruira.
Li autre sont apres alé,
Chescuns de bone volenté;
Tuit si home sont deuenü.

[2314](#). *Vbbe dubbede him to knith,
With a swerd ful swithe brith.*

So likewise in the Fr. l. 928, *A cheualier l’out adubbé*. The ceremony of knighthood is described with greater minuteness in the Romance of *Ly beaus Desconus*, l. 73; and see *Kyng Horn*, ed. Lumby, ll. 495-504.

[2320](#). *Hwan he was king, ther mouthe men se*, &c. Ritson has justly remarked, Notes to *Ywaine and Gawaine*, l. 15, that the elaborate description of Arthur’s feast at Carlisle, given by Geoffrey of Monmouth, l. ix. c. 12, has served as a model to all his successors. The original passage stands thus in a fine MS. of the 13th century, MS. Harl. 3773. fol. 33 *b*. “Refecti autem epulis diversos ludos acturi campos extra civitatem adeunt. Tunc milites simulachra belli scientes *equestrem ludum* componunt, mulieribus ab edito murorum aspicientibus. Alii *cum cestibus*, alii *cum hastis*, alii *gravium lapidum jactu*, alii *cum facis*, [saxis, Edd.] alii *cum aleis*, diversisque alii alteriusmodi jocis contendentes.” In the translation of

this description by Wace we approach still nearer to the imitation of the Romance before us.

A plusurs iuis se departirent,
Li vns alerent *buhurder*,
E lur ignels cheuals mustrer,
Li altre alerent *eskermir*,
V *pere geter*, v *saillir*;
Tels i-aueit ki *darz lanconent*,
E tels i-aueit ki *lutouent*:
Chescon del gru [geu?] s'entremetait
Dunt entremettre se saueit.

MS. Reg. 13. A. xxi.

The parallel versions, from the French, of Lazamon, Robert of Gloucester, and Robert of Brunne, may be read in Mr Ellis's *Specimens of Early English Poets*. At the feast of Olimpias, described in the Romance of *Kyng Alisaunder*, we obtain an additional imitation.

Withoute theo toun was mury,
Was reised ther al maner pley;
There was knyghtis *turnyng*,
There was maiden es carolyng,
There was champions *skyrmyng*,
Of heom and of other *wrastlyng*,
Of liouns chas, of *beore baityng*,
And *bay of bor*, of *bole slatyng*.

—l. 193. Cf. l. 1045.

Some additional illustrations on each of the amusements named in our text may not be unacceptable:

1. *Buttinge with sharpe speres*. This is tilting, or justing, expressed in Wace by *buhurder*. See Strutt's *Sports and Pastimes*, p. 96, sq. 108.
2. *Skirming with taleuaces*. This is described more at large by Wace, in his account of the feast of Cassibelaunus. Cf. *Lazamon*, v. i. p. 347; l. 8144. In Strutt's *Sports and Pastimes* is a representation of this game, taken from MS. Bodl. 264, illuminated between 1338 and 1344, in which the

form of the *talevas* is accurately defined. It appears to have been pursued to such an excess, as to require the interference of the crown, for in 1286 an edict was issued by Edward I. prohibiting all persons *Eskirmer au bokeler*. This, however, had only a temporary effect in restraining it, and in later times, under the appellation of *sword and buckler play*, it again became universally popular.

3. *Wrastling with laddes, puttinge of ston*. See the notes on ll. 984 and 1022.
4. *Harping and piping*. This requires no illustration.
5. *Leyk of mine, of hasard ok*. Among the games mentioned at the marriage of Gawain, in the Fabliau of *Le Chevalier à l'Epée*, we have:

Cil Chevalier jeuent as tables,
Et as eschés de l'autre part,
O à la *mine*, o à *hazart*.

Le Grand, in his note on this passage, T. i. p. 57, Ed. 1779, writes: "Le Hasard était une sorte de jeu de dez. Je ne connais point la *Mine*; j'ai trouvé seulement ailleurs un passage qui prouve que ce jeu était tres-dangereux, et qu'on pouvait s'y ruiner en peu de tems." It appears however from the Fabliau of *Du Prestre et des deuz Ribaus*, to have been certainly a species of *Tables*, or *Backgammon*, and to have been played with dice, on a board called *Minete*. The only passage we recollect in which any further detail of this game is given, is that of Wace, in the account of Arthur's feast, Harl. MS. 6508, and MS. Cott. Vit. A. x., but it must be remarked, that the older copy 13 A. xxi. does not contain it, nor is it found in the translations of *Lazamon*, or *Robert of Gloucester*.

6. *Romanz reding*. See Sir W. Scott's note on Sir Tristrem, p. 290, [p. 306, ed. 1811]; and the Dissertations of Percy, Ritson, and Ellis.
7. *Ther mouthe men se the boles beyte,*
 And the bores, with hundes teyte.

Cf. ll. 1838, 2438. Both these diversions are mentioned by Lucianus, in his inedited tract *De laude Cestriæ*, MS. Bodl. 672, who is supposed by Tanner to have written about A.D. 1100, but who must probably be placed near half a century later. They formed also part of the amusements of the

Londoners in the 12th century, as we learn from Fitzstephen, p. 77, and are noticed in the passage above quoted from the Romance of *Kyng Alisaunder*. In later times, particularly during the 16th century, these cruel practices were in the highest estimation, as we learn from Holinshed, Stowe, Laneham, &c. See Strutt's *Sports and Pastimes*, p. 192, and the plate from MS. Reg. 2. B. vii. Also Pegge's Dissertation on Bull-baiting, inserted in Vol. ii. of *Archæologia*.

8. *Ther mouthe men se hw Grim greu*. If this is to be understood of scenic representation (and we can scarcely view it in any other light), it will present one of the earliest instances on record of any attempt to represent an historical event, or to depart from the religious performances, which until a much later period were the chief, and almost only, efforts towards the formation of the drama. Of course, the words of the writer must be understood to refer to the period in which he lived, i.e. according to our supposition, about the end of Hen. III's reign, or beginning of Edw. I. See Le Grand's notes to the *Lai de Courtois*, V. i. p. 329, and Strutt's *Sports and Pastimes*, B. 3, ch. 2.

[2344](#). *The feste fourti dawes sat*. Cf. l. 2950. This is borrowed also from Geoffrey, and is the usual term of duration fixed in the Romances.

Fourty dayes hy helden feste,
Ryche, ryall, and oneste.

Octouian Imperator, l. 73.

Fourty dayes leste the feste.

Launfal, l. 631.

And certaynly, as the story sayes,
The revell lasted forty dayes.

Squyr of Lowe Degre, l. 1113.

[2384](#). The French story here differs wholly from the English. Instead of the encounter of Robert and Godard, and the cruel punishment inflicted on the latter, in the French is a regular battle between the forces of Havelok and Hodulf (Godard). A single combat takes place between the two leaders, in which Hodulf is slain.

[2450](#). Cf. ll. 2505 and 2822. This appears to have been a common, but barbarous, method in former times of leading traitors or malefactors to execution. Thus in the Romance of Kyng Alisaunder, the treatment of the murderers of Darius is described:

He dude quyk harnesche hors,
And sette theron heore cors,
Hyndeforth they seten, saun faile;
In heore hand they hulden theo tailes.

—l. 4708.

[2461](#). We find a similar proverb in the *Historie de Melusine, tirée des Chroniques de Poitou*, &c. 12mo. Par. 1698, in which (at p. 72) Thierry, Duke of Bretagne, says to Raimondin;— “Vous autorisez par votre silence notre Proverbe, qui dit, *Qu’un vieux peché fait nouvelle vergogne.*”

[2513](#). *Sket was seysed*, &c. Comp. the Fr. l. 971.

Apres cest fet, ad receu
Le regne q’a son piere fu.

[2516](#). *And the king ful sone it yaf
Vbbe in the hond, wit a fayr staf.*

So in *Sir Tristrem*:

Rohant he yaf *the wand*,
And bad him sitte him bi,
That fre;
‘Rohant lord mak y
To held this lond of me.’

—fytte i. st. 83; p. 52.

The editor is clearly mistaken in explaining the *wand* to be a *truncheon*, or *symbol of power*. For the custom of giving seisin or investiture *per fustim*, and *per baculum*, see Madox’s *Formul. Anglican.* pref. p. ix. and Spelman, Gloss. in v. *Investire*, and *Traditio*. The same usage existed in France, *par rain et par baton*.

[2521.](#) ———of monekes blake
A priorie to seruen inne ay.

The allusion here may be made either to the Abbey of Wellow, in Grimsby, which was a monastery of *Black Canons*, said to have been built about A.D. 1110, or (what is more probable) to the Augustine Friary of Black Monks, which is stated in the *Monumental Antiquities of Grimsby*, by the Rev. G. Oliver, to have been “founded *about* the year 1280,” p. 110. No notice of it occurs in Tanner till the year 1304. Pat. 33 Edw. I. Some old walls of this edifice, which was dissolved in 1543, still remain, and the site is still called “The Friars.” If the connection between this foundation and the one recorded in the poem be considered valid, the date of the composition must be referred to *rather* a later period than we wish to admit.

[2530.](#) The French supplies what is here omitted, viz. that Havelok sails to England by the persuasion of his wife.

[Indeed, ll. 979-1006 of the French text may serve to fill up the evident gap in the story; a translation of the passage is added, to shew this more clearly.

Quant Haueloc est rois
pussanz,
Le regne tint plus de .iiii. anz;
Merueillos tresor i auna.
Argentille li commanda
Qu’il passast en Engleterre
Pur son heritage conquerre,
Dont son oncle l’out engettée,
[Et] A grant tort desheritée.
Li rois li dist qu’il fera
Ceo qu’ele li comandera.
Sa nauie fet a-turner,
Ses genz & ses ostz mander.
En mier se met quant orré a,
Et la reyne od lui mena.
Quatre vinz & quatre cenx
Out Haueloc, pleines de genz.

When Havelok is a mighty king,
He reigned more than 4 years,
Marvellous treasure he amassed.
Argentille (Goldborough) bade him
Pass into England
To conquer her heritage,
Whence her uncle had cast her out,
And very wrongly disinherited her.

The king told her that he would do
That which she should command him.
He got ready his fleet,
And sent for his men and his hosts.
He puts to sea when he has prayed,
And took the queen with him.
Four score and four hundred (ships)
Had Havelok, full of men.

Tant out nagé & siglé,
 Q'en Carleflure est ariué.
 Sur le hauene se herbergerent,
 Par le pais viande quierent.
 Puis enuoia li noble rois,
 Par le consail de ses Danois,
 A Alsî qu'il li rendist
 La terre qe tint Ekenbright,
 Q'a sa niece fut donée,
 Dont il l'out desheritée;

Et, si rendre n'el voleit,
 Mande qu'il le purchaceroit.
 Av roi uindrent li messenger—

So far has he steered and sailed
 That he has arrived at Carleflure.
 Hard by the haven they abode,
 And sought food in the country round.
 Then sent the noble king,
 By the advice of his Danes,
 To Alsî (Godrich)—that he should
 restore to him
 The land that Ekenbright (Athelwold)
 held,
 Which was given to his niece,
 And of which he had deprived her.
 And, if he would not give it up,
 He sends word that he will take it.
 To the king came the messengers.]

The remainder of the French poem altogether differs in its detail from the English.

[2927](#). *Hire that was ful swete in bedde*.] Among Kelly's Scotch Proverbs, p. 290, we find: "Sweet in the bed, and sweir up in the morning, was never a good housewife;" and in a ballad of the last century quoted by Laing, the editor of that highly curious collection, the *Select pieces of Ancient Popular Poetry of Scotland*, we meet with the same expression:

A Clown is a Clown both at home and abroad,
 When a Rake he is comely, and *sweet in his bed*.

[[2990](#). The last word is written *thit* in the MS., but, as it rimes to *rith*, we should suppose *tiht* to be the word meant. *Thit* cannot be explained, but *tiht* (or perhaps *tith*, according to our scribe's spelling) is the pp. of a verb signifying *to purpose*, which is the exact meaning required. Cf.

"And y to turne to pee have *tizt*;"
 i.e. "I have resolved to turn to thee."

Political, Religious, and Love Poems; ed. Furnivall, 1866; p. 177.]

GLOSSARIAL INDEX.

ABBREVIATIONS.

Barb. Barbour's Bruce. —Chauc. Chaucer. —Doug. Gawin Douglas's Transl. of the Æneid. —Ellis, M. R. Ellis's Specimens of Metrical Romances. —Gl. Glossary. —Jam. Jamieson's Dictionary. —Lazam. Lazamon's Transl. of Wace (ed. Madden). —Lynds. Sir D. Lyndsay's Works. —N.E. Northern English. —Percy, A. R. Percy's Reliques of Ancient English Poetry. —P. Plowm. Piers Plowman. —R. Br. Robert of Brunne. —R. Gl. Robert of Gloucester, ed. Hearne (2nd ed. 1810). —Rits. A. S. Ritson's Ancient Songs. —Rits. M. R. Ritson's Metrical Romances. —Sc. Scotch, Scotland. —Sir Tr. Sir Tristrem. —Wall. Wallace. —Web. Weber's Metrical Romances. —Wilb. Wilbraham's Cheshire Glossary. —Wynt. Wyntoun's Chronicle. —B. Lat. Barbarous Latin. —Belg. Belgic. —Fr. French. —Isl. Islandic. —Lat. Latin. —S. Saxon. —Sibb. Sibbald's Chronicle of Scottish Poetry. —Su. G. Suio-Gothic. —Teut. Teutonic. —*q.v.* Quod vide. —The Romances separately cited are sufficiently indicated by the Titles. The numbers refer to the line of the Poem.

It may be useful to add that the names of the Romances edited by Ritson are— vol. i. Ywaine and Gawin; Launfal. —vol. ii. Lybeaus Disconus; King Horn; King of Tars; Emare; Sir Orpheo; Chronicle of England. — vol. iii. Le bone Florence; Erle of Tolous; Squyr of Lowe Degre; Knight of Curtesy. Those edited by Weber are— vol. i. Kyng Alisaunder; Sir Cleges; Lai-le-freine. —vol. ii. Richard Cœur de Lion; Ipomydon; Amis

and Amiloun. —vol. iii. Seuyn Sages; Octouian; Sir Amadas; Hunting of the Hare. Beowulf and the Codex Exoniensis are quoted from Thorpe's editions.

U and V are combined; J is not used. Þ (Thorn) is alphabetized as Th.

A B C D E F G H I K L M
N O P Q R S T^Þ UV W Y

A

A, 610, 936. Apparently an error of the scribe for *Al*, but perhaps written as pronounced. N.E. and Sc. *aw*. V. Jam.

A before a *noun* is commonly a corruption of the S. *on*, as proved clearly by the examples in Tyrwhitt's Gl., Jam., and Gl. Lynds. *Adoun*, q.v. is an exception. *A-two*, 1413, 2643. See [On](#).

Aboven, *prep*. S. above, 1700.

Abouten, *prep*. S. [*on-bútan*] about, 521, 670, 1010, &c. *Abuten*, 2429.

Adoun, *adv*. S. down, 567. *Adune*, 2735. *Doun*, 901, 925, &c. *Dun*, 888, 927. *Dune*, 1815, 2656. A.S. *of-dúne*.

Adrad, *part*. *pa*. S. afraid, 278, 1048, 1163, 1682, 2304. *Adradde*, 1787. *Adred*, 1258. *Odrat*, 1153. Sir Tr. p. 174; K. Horn, 124. See [Dred](#).

Agen, *prep*. S. [*on-gean*] against, 1792. *Ageyn*, 493, 569, 2024, &c. *Ageynes*, 2153, 2270, &c. *Ayen*, 489, 1210, 2799. *Yen*, 2271. *Ageyn*, toward, 451, 1696, 1947; opposite to, 1809; upon, on, 1828. *Ayen*, towards, 1207. *Ageyn him go*, 934, opposite him, so as to bear an equal weight. *Ageyn hire*, 1106, at her approach. *Ageyn þe lith*, 2141, opposed to the light, on which the light shines. V. R. Gl., R. Br., Chauc. &c.

Ageyn, *adv*. S. again, 2426.

Al, *adv*. S. wholly, entirely, 34, 70, 139, 203, &c.

Al, *adj.* S. *all*, 203, 264, &c.; every one, 104; every part, 224; *plu.* *alle*, 2, 150, &c.

Albidene, *adv.* See *Bidene*.

Als, *Also*, *Also*, *conj.* S. [*eal-swá*] as, like, so, 306, 319, &c. *Als*, 1912, as if. *Al so foles*, like fools, 2100. *Als* is merely the abbreviation of *Al so*; and the modern as is again shortened from *als*. In *Lazamon* it is often written *alse*, as in l. 4953.

And he hæfde a swithe god wif
& he heo leouede *alse* his lif.

Cf. *Havelok*, l. 1663. *Als* and *Also* are used indifferently, and universally by the old English and Scotch poets.

Alper-beste, *adj.* S. best of all, 182, 720, 1040, 1197, 2415. *Alper-lest*, *Alper-leste*, 1978, 2666, least of all. It is the gen. c. pl. of *Alle*, joined to an *adj.* in the superl. degree, and is extensively employed. *Alre-leofust*, *Alre-heudest*, *Alre-kenest*, *Lazamon*, *Althe-werste*, K. Horn, MS. *Alder-best*, *Alder-most*, R. Br. *Alther-best*, *Alther-formest*, &c. Web. *Alther-furste*, *Alther-next*, *Alther-last*, Rits. M. R. *Alder-first*, *Alder-last*, *Alder-levest*, Chauc. *Alder-liefest*, Shakesp.

Amideward, *prep.* S. in the midst, 872. *Amiddewart*, K. Horn, 556.

Amydward, K. Alisaund. 690. *A mydward*, Ly Beaus Desc. 852.

Amydward, Doug. Virg. 137, 35.

An, *conj.* S. and, 29, 359, &c. So used by *Lazamon*, and still in Somersetsh. V. Jennings. *Ant*, 36, 557, K. Horn, 9, &c.

And, *conj.* *if*, 2862.

Andelong, *adv.* S. lengthways, i.e. from the head to the tail, 2822.

Ovyrtwart and *endelang*
With strenges of wyr the stones hang.

R. *Cœur de Lion*, 2649.

Chauc. *endelong*, C. T. 1993.

Anilepi, *adj.* S. [*ánlepig*] one, a single, 2107. *Onlepi*, 1094. In the very curious collection of poems in MS. Digb. 86 (written in the Lincolnshire

dialect, temp. Edw. I.) we meet with this somewhat rare word:

A! quod the vox, ich wille the telle,
On *alpi* word ich lie nelle.

Of the vox and of the wolf (Rel. Ant. ii. 275).

It occurs also in the Ormulum.

Anoþer, *adj.* S. *Al another*, 1395, in a different way, on another project.

Ah al hit iwruth *on other*
Sone ther after.

Lazamon, l. 21005.

Ac Florice thought *al another*.

Flor. and Blaunchevl. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 3, p. 125, ed. 1803.
(Cf. Horn, ed. Lumby, p. 52, l. 32.)

Anuye, v. Fr. to trouble, weary, 1735; R. Gl., K. Alisaund. 876; Chauc.

Melibeus. *Noye*, Lynds. Gl. q.v.

Are, *adj.* S. former, 27. Cf. are, *adv.*, Sir Tr. p. 32; Rits. M. R., Web., R. Gl.,
R. Br., Minot. p. 31. *Air*, *Ayr*, Sc. V. Jam. See [Er](#), [Or](#).

Aren, 1 and 3 p. *pl.* S. are, 619, 1321, &c. *Arn*, Chauc.

Arke, *n.* S. Lat. a chest or coffer, 2018. R. Br., Jam.

Armes, *n. pl.* Lat. arms, armor, 2605, 2613, 2925.

Arum for Arm, 1982, 2408.

Arwe, S. [*earg*] timid, 2115. Alter the punctuation, and read—

He calde boþe arwe men and kene,
Knithes and serganz swiþe sleie.
“Arwe or ferefulle. *Timidus*.”

Prompt. Parv.

Cf. Stille, q.v.

As for Has, 1174.

Asayleden, *pa. t. pl.* Fr. assailed, 1862.

Asken, *n. pl.* S. ashes, 2841. *Aske*, R. Gl. *Askes*, R. Br. *Ashen*, Chauc. *Assis*, Doug.

Astirte, *pa. t.* leaped, 893. *Astert*, King's Quair, ap. Jam. See [Stirt](#).

At, *prep.* S. of or to, 1387. Yw. and Gaw. (Rits.) 963. Still existing in Scotland.

At-sitte, *v.* S. contradict, oppose, 2200. It corresponds with the term *with-sitten*, 1683. In R. Gl. it is used synonymously with *at-stonde*.

For ther nas so god knygt non no-wer a-boute France,
That in joustes scholde *at-sitte* the dynt of ys lance.

—p. 137.

See [Sat](#).

Aucte, Auchte, Auhte, Authe, *n.* S. possessions, 531, 1223, 1410, 2215.

And alle the *æhten* of mine londe.

Lazamon, l. 25173.

Aughtte, K. Alisaund. 6884. *Aucht*, Doug. Virg. 72, 4; Lynds. Gl.

Aucte, Auht, Auhte, *v. imp.* (originally *pa. t.* of Aw, or Owe) S. [*ágan*, *áhte*] ought, 2173, 2787, 2800. *Aught*, Sir Tr. p. 44. *Ohte*, K. Horn, 418. *Aght*, Yw. and Gaw. 3229. *Aute*, R. Gl. *Aught*, Chauc. Troil. 3, 1801. *Aucht*, Doug. Virg. 110, 33.

Aute, Awcte, (*pa. t.* of the same verb), possessed, 207, 743. *Aught*, Sir Tr. p. 182. Ly Beaus Desc. 1027. *Oght*, Le bone Flor. 650. *Auht*, R. Br. p. 126; Wynt., Lynds. Gl.

Aueden. See [Haueden](#).

Aunlaz, *n.* Anelace, 2554. "A kind of knife or dagger, usually worn at the girdle." Tyrw. note on Chauc. l. 359. So in Matth. Paris, "Genus cultelli, quod vulgariter *Anelacius* dicitur." V. Gl. in voc. and Todd's Gl. to Illustr. of Chauc. In *Sir Gawan and Sir Galoran*, ii. 4, an *anlas* signifies a sharp spike fixed in the chanfron of a horse. Probably from the Francic *Anelaz*, *Analeze*. V. Jam.

Auter, *n.* Fr. Lat. altar, 389, 1386, 2373. Sir Tr. p. 61, Octovian, 1312,
R. Br., Chauc. *Awter*, Barb.

Ax, *n.* S. axe, 1776, 1894.

Ay, *adv.* S. ever, aye, always, 159, 946, 1201, &c. Ae, Sc. V. Jam.

Ayen. See [Agen](#).

Ayþer, *pron.* S. [*Ægþer*] either, each, 2665. *Eþer*, 1882. *Athir*, Sc. V. Jam.
See [Other](#).

Awe, *v.* S. to owe, own, possess, 1292. It may also very possibly be a
corruption of *Have*. Cf. ll. 1188, 1298.

B

Bac, *n.* S. back, 1844, 1950, &c; *backes*, *pl.* 2611.

Baldelike, *adv.* S. boldly, 53. *Baldeliche*, R. Glouc. *Baldely*, R. Br., Minot,
p. 20.

Bale, *n.* S. sorrow, misery, 327.

Bar. See [Beren](#).

Baret, *n.* (O.Fr. *barat*, Isl. *baratta*) contest, hostile contention, 1932.

Ther nis *baret*, nothir strif,
Nis ther no deth, ac euer lif.

Land of Cokaygne, ap. Hickes, Thes. 1, p. 231.

In alle this *barette* the kyng and Sir Symon Tille a lokyng tham sette, of
the prince suld it be don.

R. Brunne, p. 216. Cf. p. 274.

That mekill bale and *barete* till Ynglande sall brynge.

Awntyrs of Arthure, st. 23.

Barfot, *adj.* S. barefoot, 862.

Barnage, *n.* Fr. barons or noblemen collectively, baronage, 2947. Yw. and
Gaw. 1258. Web. Doug. Virg. 314, 48.

Barre, *n.* Fr. bar of a door, 1794, 1811, 1827. Synonymous with Dore-tre, q.v. Chauc. C. T. 552.

Barw. See [Berwen](#).

Bape, *adj.* S. both, 1336, 2543. *Bethe*, 694, 1680.

Be. See [Ben](#).

Be-bedde, *v.* S. to provide with a bed, 421.

Bede, *n.* S. prayer, 1385.

Bede, *v.* S. to order, to bid, 668, 2193, 2396; to offer, 1665, 2084, 2172. *Beden*, *pa. t. pl.* offered, 2774, 2780. *Bedes*, bids, 2392. Of common occurrence in both senses. See [Bidd](#).

Bedden, *v.* S. to bed, put to bed, 1235. *Bedded*, *Beddeth*, *part. pa.* put to bed, 1128, 2771.

Bedels, *n. pl.* S. beadles, 266. V. Spelm. in *v. Bedellus*, and Blount, *Joc. Ten.* p. 120, ed. 1784.

Beite, Beyte, *v.* to bait, to set dogs on, 1840, 2330, 2440. *Bayte*, R. Br. From the Isl. Beita, incitare; Su. Goth. *Beita biorn*, to bait the bear. V. Jam. and Thomson's Etymons.

Bem. See [Sunne-bem](#).

Ben, *v.* S. to be, 19, 905, 1006, &c. *Ben*, *pr. t. pl.* are, 1787, 2559. *Be*, *Ben*, *part. pa.* been, 1428, 2799. *Bes*, *Beth*, *imp.* and *fut.* be, shall be, 1261, 1744, 2007, 2246. *Lat be*, 1265, 1657, leave, relinquish, a common phrase in the Old Romances. *Lat abee*, Sc. V. Jam.

Benes, *n. pl.* S. beans, 769.

Beneysun, *n.* Fr. blessing, benediction. 1723. R. Br., Web., Chauc. C. T. 9239. Lynds. Gl.

Bere, *n.* S. bear, 573, 1838, 1840, 2448.

Bere, Beren, *v.* S. to bear, to carry, 581, 762, 805. *Ber*, 2557; *Bar*, *pa. t.* bore, 557, 815, 877. *Bere*, 974. *Beres*, *pr. t. pl.* bear. 2323.

Bermen, *n. pl.* S. bar-men, porters to a kitchen, 868, 876, 885. The only author in which this term has been found is Lazamon, in the following passages:

Vs selve we habbet cokes,
to quecchen to cuchene,
Vs sulue we habbet *bermen*,
& birles inowe. —l. 3315.
Weoren in þeos kinges cuchene
twa hundred cokes,
& ne mæi na man tellen
for alle þa *bermannen*.
—l. 8101.

Bern, *n.* S. child, 571. *Barn*, *bearne*, R. Br. *Bairn*, Sc.

Berwen, *v.* S. [*beorgan*] to defend, preserve, guard, 697, 1426; *burwe*, 2870.

Barw, *pa. t.* 2022, 2679. The original word is found in Beowulf:

Scyld-weall gebearg
Líf and líce.
(The shield-wall defended
Life and body.)
—l. 5134.

So in K. Horn, MS. Laud. 108.

At more ich wile the serue,
And fro sorwe the *berwe*.
—f. 224*b*, c. 2.

Bes. See [Ben](#).

Bes for Best, 354.

Best, Beste, *n.* Fr. beast, 279, 574, 944, 2691.

Bete, *v.* S. [*beátan*] to beat, fight, 1899, 2664, 2763. *Beten*, *pa. t. pl.* beat, struck, 1876. Chauc. C. T. 4206, to which Tyrwh. gives a Fr. derivation.

Betere, *adv. comp.* S. better, 1758.

Beye, *v.* S. to buy, 53, 1654. *Byen*, 1625.

Beyes, *pr. t.* for Abeyes, S. suffers, or atones for, 2460.

His deth thou *bist* to night,
Mi fo.

Sir Tristr. p. 146.

We shulden alle deye
Thy fader deth to *beye*.

K. Horn, 113.

An of yow schall *bye* thys blunder.

Le bone Flor. 1330.

See Jam. in v. Aby. Web. Gl. and Lynds. Gl.; also Nares, v. Bye.

Bicomen, *pa. t. pl.* became, 2257; *part. pa.* become, 2264. *Bicomes, imp. pl.* become (ye), 2303.

Bidd, Bidde, v. S. offer, 484, 2530; order, bid, 529, 1733. *Ut bidde*, 2548, order out. *Biddes, pr. t.* bids, orders, 1232. *Bidde*, to ask, 910. R. Glouc., Lynds. Gl. See [Bede](#).

Bidene, *adv.* forthwith, 730, 2841.

“Rohand told anon
His aventours *al bidene*.”

Sir Tr. p. 45.

From Du. *bij dien*, by that.

Bifalle, v. S. to happen, befall, 2981. Bifel, *pa. t.* 824. *Fel*, 1009; appertained, 2359.

Biforn, *prep.* S. (1) before, 1022, 1034, 1364, &c.; *bifor*, 1357; *biforen*, 1695; (2) in front of, 2406; *bifor*, 1812.

Bigan, *pa. t.* began, 1357. *Bigunnen, pl.* 1011, 1302. *Biginnen, pr. t. pl.* begin, 1779.

Bihalue, v. S. to divide into two parts, or companies, 1834. *Halue* occurs as a *noun* in Chauc. Troil. 4, 945.

Bihel for Beheld, 1645. *Bihelden, pa. t. pl.* beheld, 2148.

Bihetet, *pa. t.* S. promised, 677. *Bihight*, Sir Tr. p. 105. *Behet*, *Bihet*, R. Gl. *Be-hette*, R. Br. *Be-hete*, Web., Rits. M. R. *Behighte*, Chauc.

Bihoten, *part. pa.* promised, 564. *Behighte*, Chauc.

Bihoue, *n.* S. behoof, advantage, 1764. R. Gl., R. Br., Chauc.

Bikenneth, *pa. t.* S. betokens, 1268. *Bikenne*, R. Br.

Bileue, *imp.* tarry, remain, 1228. *Bilefte*, *pa. t.* remained, 2963. From v. S. *belifan*, to be left behind.

Winde thai hadde as thai wolde,
A lond *bilaf*t he.

Sir Tristr. p. 29. Cf. pp. 38, 60.

He schal wiþ me *bileue*,
Til hit beo nir eue.

K. Horn, ed. Lumby, 363.

Horn than, withouten lesing,
*Bilaf*t at hom for blode-leteing.

Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R. V. 3, p. 298.

Sojourn with us evermo,
I rede thee, son, that it be so.
Another year thou might over-fare,
But thou *bileve*, I die with care.

Guy of Warw. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 23.

See also the Gl. to R. Gl., R. Br. and Web., to which add *Emare*, 496, and Gower, Conf. Am. This is sufficient authority for the reading adopted in the text, and it may hence be reasonably questioned, whether *bilened* in Lye, and *belenes* in *Sir Gawan and Sir Galoran*, i. 6, quoted by Jamieson in v. Belene, be not the fault of the scribe, or of the Editors.

Bimene, v. S. mean, 1259.

Binden, v. S. to bind, 1961. Used passively, 2820, as *Bynde*, 42. *Bounden*, *pa. t. pl.* 2442. *Bunden*, 2506. *Bounden*, *part. pa.* 545. *Bunden*, 1428.

Binne, *adv.* S. within, 584. *Byn*, Rits. M. R. *But and ben*, Doug., Virg., 123, 40; without and within. V. Jam., in v. Ben.

Birde. *See* Birþe.

Birþe (*should rather be* birþ), 3 *p. s. pres.* it behoves, 2101. *Hence* birde, 3 *p. s. pt. t.* behoved, 2761. A.S. *býrian*, *gebýrian*, to fit, suit, be to one's taste. *See* *Buren* in Stratmann.

Birþene, *n.* S. *burden*, 900, 902.

Bise, *n.* Fr. a north wind, 724. *Bise traverse*, a north-west or north-east wind. *Cotgr.*

Après grant joie vient grant ire,
Et après Noel vent bise.

Rom. de Renart, 13648.

The term is still in common use.

Biseken, *v.* S. to beseech, 2994.

Biswike, *part. pa.* S. cheated, deceived, 1249.

Hu þu biswikest
Monine mon.

Lazam. l. 3412.

Byswuke, K. Horn, 296; *Yw. and Gaw.* 2335. *Bisuike*, R. Br. *Beswyke*, R. *Cœur de L.* 5918.

Bitaken, *v.* S. [*bitácan*, *tácan*] to commit, deliver, give in charge, 1226.

Bitechen, 203, 384, 395. *Bi-teche*, *pr. sing.* 384; *imp. sing.* 395. *Lazam.*

5316. *Bitake*, Sir Tr. p. 87. *Byteche*, K. Horn, 577. *Biteche*, Web. *Betake*, *Beteche*, Chauc., Barb., Wall. *Bitauhte*, *pa. t.* delivered, 206, 558.

Bitauhte, 2212, 2317, 2957. *Bitawchte*, 1224. *Bitawte*, 1408. *Tauhte*,

2214. *Bitæht*, *Bitachet*, *Lazam.* *Bitaught*, Sir Tr. p. 85. *Bitoke*, K. Horn,

1103. *Betok*, Ly Beaus Desc. 82. *Betauht*, *bitauht*, *tauht*, *biteched*, R. Br.

Bitake, R. Gl. *Betake*, Sir Guy. *Betaught*, Chauc. *Betaucht*, Doug., Lynds.

Bite, *v.* S. to taste, drink, 1731.

Horn toc hit hise yfere,
Ant seide, Quene, so dere,
No beer nullich bite,
Bote of coppe white.

K. Horn (Ritson), 1129.

Biþ for *By* the, 474. Cf. l. 2470.

Bituene, *Bitwenen*, *Bitwene*, *prep.* S. between, 748, 2668, 2967.

Blac, *adj.* S. black, 555, 1008. *Pl. Blake*, 1909, 2181, &c.

Blakne, *v.* S. to blacken in the face, grow angry, 2165.

And Arthur sæt ful stille,
ænne stunde he wes *blac*,
and on heuwe swithe wak,
ane while he wes reod.

Lazam. l. 19887.

Tho Normans were sorie, of contenance gan *blaken*.

R. Brunne, p. 183.

Blawe. *v.* S. to blow, 587. *Blou*, *imp.* blow, 585.

Blede, *v.* S. to bleed, 2403.

Bleike, *pl. adj.* bleak, pale, wan, 470. A.S. *blác*, bleak, Su.-G. *blek*.

Blenkes, *n. pl.* blinks, winks of the eye, in derision, 307. R. Br. p. 270; Sc. V. Jam. Suppl. Derived from S. *blican*, Su.-G. *blænka*, Belg. *blencken*, to glance. See Gl. Lynds.

Blinne, *v. n.* S. to cease, 2367, 2374. Sir Tr. p. 26; Rits. M. R. Web., R. Gl., Chauc.; so in Sc. V. Jam. Gl. Lynds. *Blinne*, *pa. t. pl.* ceased, 2670. *Blinneth*, *pr. t.* ceases, 329.

Blissed, *part pa.* S. blessed, 2873.

Bliþe, *adj.* S. happy, 632, 651.

Blome, *n.* S. bloom, flower, 63.

Bloute, *adj.* soft, 1910. Sw. *blöt*, soft, pulpy.

Bode, *n.* S. command, 2200, 2567. Sir Tr. p. 121, Web.

Bok, *n.* S. book, 1173, 1418, &c. See [Messe-bok](#).

Bole, *n.* [Isl. *bolli*, W. *bwla*. Cf. A.S. *bulluca*] bull, 2438. *Boles*, *pl.* 2330.

Bon, Bone. See [O-bone](#).

Bondemen, *n. pl.* S. husbandmen, 1016, 1308. R. Gl.

Bone, *n.* S. [*bén*] boon, request, 1659. Sir Tr. p. 31, and all the Gloss.

Bor, *n.* S. boar, 1867, 1989. *Bores, pl.* 2331.

Bord, *n.* S. (1) table, 1722. K. Horn, 259; Rits. M. R., Web., Chauc.; (2) a board, 2106. See the note on l. 2076.

Boren, *part. pa.* S. born, 1878.

Boru, *n.* S. borough, 773, 847, 1014, 1757, 2086, 2826. *Borwes, pl.* 1293, 1444, 1630. *Burwes*, 55, 2277. Sir Tr. pp. 12, 99. Chalmers is certainly mistaken when he says it does not signify *boroughs*, but *castles*. Introd. Gl. p. 200. In *Lazamon* the word is always clearly distinguished from *castle*, as it is in many other writers. V. Spelm. in v. *Burgus*.

Bote, *adv.* S. but, only, 721. See [But](#).

Bote, *n.* S. remedy, help, 1200. *Lazm.*, Sir Tr. p. 93; Web., Rits. M. R., Rob. Gl., R. Br., Minot, Chauc., Doug., Lynds. Gl.

Bopen, *adj. pl.* S. both, 173, 697, 958; *g. c.* of both, 2223.

Bounden, Bunden. See [Binden](#).

Bour, Boure, Bowr, *n.* S. [*búr*] chamber, 239, 2072, 2076, &c. In *Beowulf* the apartment of the women is called *Bryd-bur*; l. 1846.

Ygarne beh to *bure*
& lætte bed him makien.

Lazam. l. 19042.

Honder hire *boures* wowe, *K. Horn*, 982, MS., where Rits. Ed. reads *chambre* wowe. Cf. Sir Tr. p. 114; Rits. M. R., Web., R. Br., Doug., V. Jam. See [note on l. 2076](#).

Bouthe, *pa. t.* S. bought, 875, 968. Cf. Sir Tr. p. 104.

Bouth, *part. pa.* bought, 883.

Boyes, *n. pl.* S. boys, men, 1899.

Brayd, *pa. t.* S. (1) started, 1282. Chauc., Gaw. and Gal. iii. 21; R. Hood, ii. p. 83; (2) drew out, 1825, a word particularly applied to the action of drawing a sword from the scabbard.

Sone his sweord he ut *abræid*.

Lazam. l. 26533.

Cf. Am. and Amil. 1163; Sir Ferumbras, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 387. Rauf Coilzear, ap. Laing, and Wall. i. 223.

Brede, *n.* S. bread, 98. *Bred*, 1879.

Breken, *v.* S. to break, 914. *Broken*, *pa. t. pl.* broke, 1238.

Brennen, Brenne, *v.* S. to burn, 916, 1162; Rits. M. R., Rob. Gl., R. Br., Chauc. *Brenden*, *pa. t. pl.* burnt, 594, 2125. *Brend*, *part. pa.* burnt, 2832, 2841, &c. Sir Tr. p. 93.

Brenne. See [On brenne](#).

Brigge, *n.* S. bridge, 875. Sir Tr. p. 148. Still used in Sc. and N.E.

Brihte. See [Brith](#).

Brim, *adj.* S. furious, raging, 2233; R. Br. p. 244; Chauc. Rom. Rose, 1836. *Breme*, Rits. M. R. It originally signified the sea itself, and was afterwards used for the raging of the sea, Beowulf, l. 56; Compl. of Scotland, p. 62. V. Jam.

Bring, Bringen, *v.* S. to bring, 72, 185, &c.

Brini, Brinie, *n.* S. [Mæso-Goth. *brunjo*] cuirass, 1775, 2358, 2551. *Brinies*, *pl.* 2610. Sir Tr. p. 20. *Burne*, *Lazam.* *Brenye*, K. Horn, 719, MS. See Merrick's Gl. to Ess. on Anc. Armor. The *Brini* then worn was of *mail*, as appears from l. 2740, *Of his brinie ringes mo*. Hence in Beowulf it is termed *Breostnet*, l. 3100; *Here-net*, 3110; *Hringedbyrne*, 2495. So in the French K. Horn, MS. Douce, *Mes vnc de sun halberc maele ne falsa*. See Rits. Gl. M. R.

Brisen, *v.* S. to bruise, beat, 1835. See [To-Brised](#).

Brith, *adj.* S. bright, 589, 605, &c. *Brihte*, 2610. *Bryth*, 1252. *Brithter*, *comp.* brighter, 2141.

Brittene, *part. pa.* S. destroyed, 2700; R. Br. p. 244. *Pistill of Sussan*, ap. Laing. In Doug., Virg. pp. 76, 5; 296, 1, the verb has the sense of *to kill*, which it may also bear here. See *Bruten* in *Will. of Palerne*.

Brod, *adj.* S. broad, 1647.

Broucte, *pa. t. and pp.* brought, 767. *Brouht*, 1979. *Broute*, 2868. *Brouth*, 336, 64. *Browt*, 2412. *Browth*, 2052. *Brouct of liue*, 513, 2412, dead. *Brouthen*, *pl.* brought, 2791.

Brouke, 1 *p. pres. sing.* S. brook, enjoy, use, 311, 1743, 2545 (cf. Ch. *Non. Pr. Ta.* 480).

So *brouke* thou thi croune!

K. *Horn*, 1041.

Cf. Rits. Gl. M. R., Rich. C. de Lion, 4578; Chauc. C. T. 10182, 15306, R. Hood, V. i. 48, ii. 112; Lynds. Gl. Percy, A. R. In Sc. *Bruike*. With these numerous instances before him, it is inconceivable how Jamieson, except from a mere love of his own system, should write: 'There is no evidence that the Engl. *brook* is used in this sense, signifying only to bear, to endure.'

Broys, *n.* S. broth, 924. *Brouwys*, R. Cœur de L. 3077; Sc. V. Jam. and Brockett's North country words, v. *Brewis*; also Nares. Sc. *brose*.

Brune, *adj. pl.* S. brown, 2181, 2249.

Bulder, *adj. or n.* 1790. In the north a *Boother* or *Boulder*, is a hard flinty stone, rounded like a bowl. Brockett's Gl. So also in Grose, *Boulder*, a large round stone. *Bowlders*, Marsh. Midl. Count. Gl. The word has a common origin with Isl. *ballaðr*, Fr. *boulet*, Sc. *boule*, in Doug. V. Jam.

Bunden. See [Binden](#).

Burgeys, *n.* S. burgess, 1328. *Burgeis*, 2466, *pl.* 2012. *Burgmen*, 2049. *Burhmen*, *Borhmen*, Lazamon., V. Spelm. in v. *Burgarii*.

Burwe. See [Berwen](#).

Burwes. See [Boru](#).

But, Bute, *conj.* S. except, unless, 85, 690, 1149, 1159, 2022, 2031, 2727.
But on, 535, 962, except. *Butand*, Sc. *But yf*, 2972, unless. [It should be noted that *but on* should properly be *one* word, being the A.S. *búton* or *bútan*, except. But it is written as two words in the MS.]

But, *n.* 1040. Probably the same as *Put*, q.v. The word *Bout* is derived from the same source.

But, *part. pa.* contended, struggled with each other (*or perhaps* struck, thrust, pushed), 1916. *Buttinge*, *part. pr.* striking against with force, 2322. From the Fr. *Bouter*, Belg. *Botten*, to impel, or drive forward. V. Jam. Suppl. in v. *Butte*, and *Butt* in Wedgwood.

Butte, *n.* a flounder or plaice, 759. Du. *bot*. See Halliwell.

Byen. See [Beye](#).

Bynde. See [Binden](#).

Bynderes, *n. pl.* S. binders, robbers who bind, 2050.

C

Caliz, *n.* S. chalice, 187, 2711.

Lunet than riche relikes toke,
The *chalis* and the mes boke.

Yw. and Gaw. 3907.

Callen, v. S. to call, 747, 2899.

Cam. See [Komen](#).

Canst, *pr. t.* S. knowest, 846. *Cone*, 622, canst. *Kunne*, *pl.* 435. V. Gl.
Chauc. in v. *Conne*. Jam. and Gl. Lynds. See [Couthie](#).

Carl, *n.* S. churl, slave, villain, 1789. *Cherl*, 682, 684, 2533. *Cherles*, *g. c.* churl's, 1092. *Cherles*, *pl.* villains, bondsmen, 262, 620. Sir Tr. p. 39; V. Spelm. in v. *Ceorlus*, and Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Casten. See [Kesten](#).

Catel, *n.* Fr. chattels, goods, 225, 2023, 2515, 2906, 2939. Web. Gl., R. Br., P. Plowm., Chauc.

Nowe hath Beuis the treasure wone,
Through Arundell that wyll runne,
Wherefore with that and other *catel*,
He made the castle of Arundel.

Syr Bevys, O. iii.

Cauenard, *n.* Fr. [*cagnard caignard*] a term of reproach, originally derived from the Lat. *canis*, 2389. V. Roquef. Menage.

This crokede *caynard* sore he is adred.

Rits. A. S. p. 36.

Sire *olde kaynard*, is this thin aray?

Chauc. C. T. 5817.

Cayser, Caysere, *n.* Lat. emperor, 977, 1317, 1725. *Kaysere*, 353.

Cerges, *n. pl.* Fr. wax tapers, 594. *Serges*, 2125. Chauc. Rom. R. 6251; V. Le Grand. *Vie privée des F.*; V. 3, p. 175.

Chaffare, *n.* S. merchandise, 1657. R. Cœur de L. 2468, R. Gl., Sir Ferumbras, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 412, Chauc., R. Hood, i. 87. *Chaffery*, Sc. V. Lynds. Gl.

Cham for Came, 1873.

Chanbioun, *n.* Fr. champion, 1007. Sir Tr. p. 97. *Chaunpiouns*, *pl.* 1015, 1031, 1055; V. Spelm. in v. *Campio*. Cf. A.S. *cempa*.

Chapmen, *n. pl.* S. merchants, 51, 1639; R. Gl., R. Br., Chauc. In Sc. pedlars. V. Jam., and Gl. Lynds.

Charbucle, *n.* Fr. Lat. a carbuncle, 2145. *Charbocle*, *Syr Bevys*. *Charbokull*, Le bone Flor. 390. *Charboucle*, Chauc. C. T. 13800. *Charbukill*, Doug. Virg. 3, 10.

Cherl. See [Carl](#).

Chesen, *v.* S. to choose, select, 2147. Sir Tr. p. 27; K. Horn, 666; Rits. M. R., Web., R. Br., Chauc., V. Jam. in v. *Cheis*.

Chinche, *adj.* Fr. niggardly, penurious, 1763, 2941.

Bothe he was scars, and *chinche*.

The Sevyn Sages, 1244.

So in Chauc. Rom. Rose, 5998, and Gower, *Conf. Am.* 109 b.

Chiste, *n.* S. Lat. chest, 222. *Kiste*, 2018. *Kist*, Yorksh. and Sc.; V. Jam. and Lynds. Gl.

Citte, *pa. t.* S. cut, 942. *Kit*, Web. M. R. *Kyt*, Syr Eglam. B. iv. *Kette*, Syr Bevys, C. iii. So Chauc. C. T. 6304.

Claddes, *pa. t. 2 p.* S. claddest, 2907.

Clapte, *pa. t.* S. struck, 1814, 1821.

Clare, *n.* Fr. spiced wine, 1728. See *Claret* in Prompt. Parv.

Clef, *pa. t.* S. cleft, 2643, 2730.

Cleue, *n.* S. dwelling, 557, 596. A.S. *cleofa*.

Cleuen, *v.* S. to cleave, cut, 917.

Clothe, Clothen, *v.* S. to clothe, 1138, 1233. In l. 1233, Garnett suggests that *clopen* may be a *nom. pl.* = clothes. If so, *dele* the comma after it.

Clutes, *n. pl.* S. clouts, shreds of cloth, 547. *Clottys*, Huntyng of the hare, 92. Cf. Chauc. C. T. 9827, and *Clut* in Bosworth.

Clyueden, *pa. t. pl.* S. cleaved, fastened, 1300.

Cok, *n.* Lat. cook, 967. *Kok*, 903, 921, 2898. *Cokes*, *Kokes*, *g. c.* cook's, 1123, 1146.

Comen, Comes, Cometh. See [Komen](#).

Cone. See [Canst](#).

Conestable, *n.* Fr. constable, 2286. *Conestables*, *pl.* 2366.

Conseyl, *n.* Fr. counsel, 2862.

Copes. See [Kope](#).

Corporaus, *n.* Fr. Lat. the fine linen wherein the sacrament is put, 188; Cotgr. V. Du Cange, and Jam. in *v. Corperale*.

After the relics they send;
The *corporas*, and the mass-gear,
On the handom [halidom?] they gun swear,
With wordes free and hend.

Guy of Warw. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 77.

Corune, *n.* Lat. crown, 1319, 2944.

Coruning, *n.* Lat. coronation, 2948.

Cote, *n.* S. cot, cottage, 737, 1141.

Couel, *n.* coat, garment, 768, 858, 1144. *Cuuel*, 2904. *Kouel*, 964. The word is connected with A.S. *cufle*, *cugele*, a cowl.

Couere, *v.* Fr. to recover, 2040.

And prayde to Marie bryght,
Kevere hym of hys care.

Ly Beaus Desc. 1983.

Hyt wolde covyr me of my care.

Erl of Tol. 381.

Coupe, *v.* buy, buy dearly, get in exchange, 1800. Icel. *kaupa*.

Couth. See [Quath](#).

Coupe, *pa. t.* of Conne, *v. aux.* S. knew, was able, could, 93, 112, 194, 750, 772. *Koupen*, *pl.* 369.

More he *couthe* of veneri,
Than *couthe* Manerious.

Sir Tristr. p. 24.

See [Canst](#).

Crake, Crakede. See [Kraken](#).

Crauede, *pa. t.* S. craved, asked, 633.

Crice, *n.* explained to mean *rima podicis* in Coleridge's Glossarial Index, 2450. Cf. A.S. *crecca*. Icel. *kryki*, a corner. In Barb. x. 602, *crykes* is used for *angles*, corners. See [Krike](#).

Crist, *n.* Lat. Gr. Christ, 16, &c. *Cristes*, *g. c.* 153. *Kristes*, 2797.

Croiz, *n.* Fr. Lat. cross, 1263, 1268, 1358, &c. *Croice*, Sir Tr. p. 115.

Croud, *part. pa.* crowded, oppressed (?) 2338. K. Alisaund, 609. Cf. A.S. *crydan*, *p. p. gecróden*.

Croun, Croune, *n.* Fr. crown, head, 568, 902, 2657. *Crune*, 1814, 2734.

Fykenildes *crowne*

He fel ther doune.

K. Horn, 1509.

Cf. K. of Tars, 631; Le bone Flor. 92, and Erle of Tol. 72.

Cruhsse. See [To-cruhsse](#).

Crus, brisk, nimble, 1966. It is the Sw. *krus*, excitable, Sc. *crouse*. See *Crouse* in Atkinson's Cleveland Glossary.

Cunnriche, *n.* S. kingdom, 2318. *Kinneriche*, 976. *Kuneriche*, 2400.

Kunerike, 2804. *Kunrik*, 2143. In the last instance it means *a mark of royalty, or monarchy*. Web. *Kyngriche*, *Kynryche*.

Curt, *n.* Fr. court, 1685.

Curteys, Curteyse, *adj.* Fr. courteous, 2875, 2916.

Cuuel. See [Couel](#).

D

Dam, *n.* 2468, here used in a reproachful sense, but apparently from the same root as the Fr. *Dam*, *Damp*, *Dan*, and *Don*, i.e. from *Dominus*.

Dame, *n.* Fr. Lat. mistress, lady, 558, 1717. V. Gl. Chauc.

Danshe, *n. pl.* Danish men, 2689, 2945, &c. See [Denshe](#).

Datheit, *interj.* 296, 300, 926, 1125, 1887, 1914, 2047, 2447, 2511. *Dathey*, 1799, 1995, 2604, 2757. An interjection or imprecation, derived from the Fr. *Deshait*, *dehait*, *dehet*, explained by Barbazan and Roquefort, *affliction, malheur*; [from the O.F. *hait*, pleasure]. It may be considered equivalent to Cursed! Ill betide! In the old Fabliaux it is used often in this sense:

Fils à putain, fet-il, lechiere,
Vo jouglerie m'est trop chiere,
Dehait qui vous i aporta,
Par mon chief il le comparra.

De S. Pierre et du Jogleor, 381.

The term was very early engrafted on the Saxon phraseology. Thus in the *Disputation of Ane Hule and a Niztingale*, l. 99.

Dahet habbe that ilke best,
That fuleth his owe nest!

It occurs also frequently in the Old English Romances. See *Sir Tristr.* pp. 111, 191; *Horn Childe*, ap. *Rits.* V. 3, p. 290; *Amis and Amil.* 1569; *Sevyn Sages*, 2395; *R. Brunne*, where it is printed by Hearne *Dayet*. To this word, in all probability, we are indebted for the modern imprecation of *Dase you! Dise you! Dash you!* still preserved in many counties, and in Scotland. *V. Jam. Suppl. v. Dash you.*

Dawes, n. pl. S. days, 27, 2344, 2950. *Dayes*, 2353.

Ded, Dede, n. S. death, 149, 167, 332, 1687, 2719, &c.

Ded, part. pa. S. dead, 2007.

Dede, n. S. deed, action, 1356.

Dede, Deden, Dedes. See [Do](#).

Deide. See [Deye](#).

Del, n. S. deal, part, 218, 818, 1070, &c. *Web.*, *R. Gl.*, *R. Br.*, *Chauc. Deil*, *Sc. V. Jam.*

Deled, part. pa. S. distributed, 1736. See [To-deyle](#).

Demen, v. S. to judge, pass judgment, 2467. *Deme, Demen, pr. t. pl.* judge, 2476, 2812. *Demden, pa. t. pl.* judged, 2820, 2833. *Demd, part. pa.* judged, 2488, 2765, 2838.

Denshe, adj. Danish, 1403, 2575, 2693. See [Danshe](#).

Deplike, adj. S. deeply, 1417. Synonymous with *Grundlike*, q.v.

Dere, n. S. dearth, scarcity, 824, 841. *R. GL.* p. 416.

Dere, *adv.* S. dearly, 1637, 1638.

Dere, *v.* S. to harm, injure, 490, 574, 806, 2310. *Dereth*, *pr. t.* injures, 648.
K. Horn, 148; R. Br. p. 107; K. of Tars, 192; Chauc. *Deir*, Sc. Doug.
Virg. 413, 52; Lynds. Gl.

Dere, *adj.* S. dear, 1637, 2170, &c.

Deuel, *n.* S. devil, 446, 496, 1188. *Deueles*, *g. c.* devil's, 1409.

Deus. This is undoubtedly the vocative case of the Lat. *Deus*, used as an interjection, 1312, 1650, 1930, 2096, 2114. "Its use was the same in French as in English. Thus in King Horn:

Euuers Deu en sun quer a fait grant clamur,
Ohi, *Deus!* fait il, ki es uerrai creatur,
Par ki deuise, &c.

Harl. MS. 527, f. 66 b. c. 2.

It was probably introduced into the English language by the Normans, and its pronunciation remained the same as in the French.

And gradde 'as armes,' for *Douce* Mahons!

K. Alisaunder, 3674.

It is curious to remark, that we have here the evident and simple etymology of the modern exclamation *Deuce!* for the derivation of which even the best and latest Lexicographers have sent us to the *Dusii* of St Augustine, the *Dues* of the Gothic nations, *Diis* of the Persians, *Teus* of the Armoricans, &c. Thomson very justly adds, that all these words, 'seem, like *dæmon*, to have been once used in a good sense,' and in fact are probably all corruptions of the same root. Cf. R. Brunne, p. 254, and Gl. in *v. Deus*. For the first suggestion of this derivation the Editor is indebted to Mr Will. Nicol." —M.

Deye, *v.* S. to die, 840. *Deide*, *pa. t. pl.* died, 402.

Dide, Diden, Dides. See [Do](#).

Dike, *n.* S. ditch, 2435. *Dikes*, *pl.* 1923. N.E. and Sc., V. Jam. and Brockett.

Dine, *n.* S. din, noise, 1860, 1868.

Dinge, v. S. to strike, scourge, beat, 215, 2329. *Dong*, pa. t. struck, 1147. *Dungen*, part. pa. beaten, or scourged, 227. Sc. and N.E. See Jam. Gl., Lynds., and Ray.

Dint, n. S. blow, stroke, 1807, 1817, 1969, &c. *Dent*, Sir Tr. p. 92; Chauc. *Dynt*, R. Br. *Dintes*, pl. 1437, 1862, 2665. *Duntes*, K. Horn, 865. *Dentys*, Rits. M. R. *Dyntes*, R. Gl. *Dintes*, Minot, p. 23; V. Gl. Lynds.

Do, Don, v. S. The various uses of this verb in English and Scotch, in an auxiliary, active, and passive sense, have been pointed out by Tyrwhitt, Essay on Vers. of Chauc. Note (37), Chalmers, Gl. Lynds. and Jamieson. It signifies: to do, *facere*, 117, 528, 1191; to cause, *efficere*, 611; *do casten*, 519; *do hem fle*, 2600, to put or place (used with *in* or *on*), 535, 577, &c. *Dones on* = *don es on* = do them on, put them on (see [Es](#)), 970. *Dos*, pr. t. 2 p. dost, 2390. *Dos*, pr. t. 3 p. does, 1994, 2434, 2698. *Doth*, *Don*, pr. t. pl. do, 1838, 1840. *Doth*, imp. do, cause (ye), 2037. *Dos*, imp. pl. do ye, 2592. *Dede*, *Dide*, pa. t. caused, 658, 970, &c. *Dede*, *Dide*, pa. t. put, placed, 659, 709, 859. *Dedes*, *Dides*, pa. t. 2 p. didest, 2393, 2903. *Deden*, *Diden*, pa. t. pl. caused, 242; did, performed, 953, 1176, 2306. *Don*, part. pa. caused, 1169. *Don*, part. pa. done, 667. *Of liue haue do*, 1805, have slain.

Dom, n. S. doom, judgment, 2473, 2487, 2813, &c. Sir Tr. p. 127.

Dore, n. S. door, 1788.

Dore-tre, n. S. bar of the door, 1806. See [Tre](#).

Douhter, n. S. daughter, 120, 2712. *Douthe*, 1079. *Douther*, 2867, 2914. *Douhtres*, pl. 350, 2982. *Douthres*, 2979. *Doutres*, 717.

Doun. See [Adoun](#).

Doutede, pa. t. Fr. feared, 708.

Douthe, n. Fr. fear, 1331, 1377.

Douthe, pa. t. of Dow, v. imp. S. [*dugan*, valere, prodesse] was worth, was sufficient, availed, 703, 833, 1184. It is formed in the same manner as *Mouthe*, Might. See Sir Tr. p. 77; Jam. and Gl. Lynds. in v. Dow.

Drad. See [Dred](#).

Drawe, Drawen. See [Drou](#).

Dred, *imp.* dread, fear (thou), 2168. *Dredde*, *pa. t. pl.* dreaded, feared, 2289, 2568. *Drad*, *part. pa.* afraid, 1669. See [Adrad](#).

Drede, *n.* S. dread, 1169; doubt, anxiety, care, 828, 1664. Chauc.

Dremede, *pa. t.* S. (used with *me*), dreamed, 1284, 1304.

Dreinnen, Drenchen, Drinchen, *v.* S. to drown, 553, 561, 583, 1416, 1424, &c. *Drenched*, *part. pa.* drowned, 520, 669, 1368, 1379. V. Gl. Web., R. Gl., Chauc.

Dreng, *n.* See [note on l. 31](#).

Drepen, *v.* S. to kill, slay, 1783, 1865, &c. *Drepe*, would slay, 506. *Drop*, *pa. t.* killed, slew, 2229. Bosworth gives *drepan*, to slay. Cf. Sw. *dräpa*.

Dreping, *n.* slaughter, 2684. Cf. A.S. *drepe*.

Drinchen. See [Dreinnen](#).

Drinken, *v.* S. to drink, 459, 800.

Drinkes, *n. pl.* S. drinks, liquors, 1738.

Drit, *n.* [Icel. *drítr*, Du. *dreet*] dirt, 682. A term expressing the highest contempt. K. Alisaund. 4718; Wicliffe. So, in an ancient metrical invective against Grooms and Pages, written about 1310,

Thah he zeue hem cates *dryt* to huere companage,
3et hym shulde arewen of the arrerage.

MS. Harl. 2253, f. 125.

Cf. Jam. Suppl. in *v. Dryte*, and Gl. Lynds.

Driuende. See [Drof](#).

Drou, *pa. t.* S. drew, 705, 719, &c. *Vt-drow*, *pa. t.* out-drew, 2632. *With-drow*, withdrew, 498; (*spelt* wit-drow), 502. *Drawe*, *Drawen*, *part. pa.* drawn, 1925, 2225, 2477, 2603, &c. *Ut-drawe*, *Ut-drawen*, out-drawn, 1802, 2631. See [To-Drawe](#).

Drof, *pa. t.* S. drove, 725; hastened, 1793, 1872. *Driuende*, *part. pr.* driving, riding quickly, 2702.

Drurye, *n.* Fr. courtship, gallantry, 195. Web., Rits. M. R., P. Plowm.,
Chauc., Lynds.

Dubbe, *v.* Fr. S. to dub, create a knight, 2042. *Dubbede*, *pa. t.* dubbed, 2314.
Dubban to ridere, Chron. Sax. An. 1085, [11086]. *To cnihte hine dubben*,
Lazam. l. 22497. “Hickes, Hearne, Gl. R. Gl., and Tyrwhitt, Gl. Chauc.,
all refer the word to the Saxon root, which primarily signified *to strike*,
the same as the Isl. *at dubba*. Todd on the contrary, Gl. Illustr. Chauc.,
thinks this questionable, and refers to Barbazan’s Gl. in *v. Adouber*,
which is there derived from the Lat. *adaptare*. Du Cange and Dr Merrick
give it also a Latin origin, from *Adoptare*, and by corruption *Adobare*.”
—M. The etymology is discussed in Wedgwood, s.v. *Dub*. See [Note on l. 2314](#).

Duelle, *v.* S. to dwell, give attention, 4.

A tale told Ysoude fre,
Thai *duelle*:
Tristrem that herd he.

Sir Tristr. p. 181.

Cf. Sir Otuel, l. 3, and Sevyng Sages, 1. *Dwellen*, to dwell, remain, 1185;
to delay, 1351. *Dwellen*, *pr. t. pl.* dwell, tarry, 1058. *Dwelleden*, *pa. t. pl.*
dwelt, tarried, 1189.

Dunten, *pa. t. pl.* S. struck, beat, 2448.

Dwelling, *n.* delay, 1352

Dun. See [Adoun](#).

Dungen. See [Dinge](#).

Dursten, *pa. t. pl.* S. durst, 1866.

[E](#)

Eie, *n.* S. eye, 2545. *Heie*, 1152. *Eyne*, *pl.* eyes, 680, 1273, 1364; *eyen*,
1340; *eyn*, 2171.

Eir, *n.* Fr. Lat. heir, 410, 2539. *Eyr*, 110, 289, &c. Jam. gives it a Northern
etymology, in *v. Ayr*.

Ek, *conj.* S. [eac] eke, also, 1025, 1038, 1066, &c. Ok [Su.-G. och, Du. ook] 187, 200, 879, 1081, &c. V. Jam. in v. Ac.

Eld, *adj.* S. old, 546. *Helde*, 2472. *Heldeste*, sup. 1396.

Elde, *n.* S. age, 2713. *Helde*, 128, 174, 387, 1435.

Ælde hæfde heo na mare

Buten fihtene 3ere.

Lazam. l. 25913.

R. Br. In Sc. *Eild*. It was subsequently restricted to the sense of *old age*, as in Chauc.

Elles, *adv.* S. else, 1192, 2590.

Em, S. uncle, 1326. Sir Tr. p. 53. Properly, says Sir W. Scott, an uncle by the father's side. It appears however to have been used indifferently either on the father's or mother's side. See Hearne's Gl. on R. Gl. and R. Br., Web., Erle of Tol. 988; Chauc. Troil. 2, 162, and Nares. Prov. Eng. *Eam*.

Er, *adv.* S. before, 684. *Her*, 541. *Are*, Sir Tr. p. 152. *Er*, K. Horn, 130. See [Are](#), [Or](#).

Er, *conj.* S. before, 317, 1261, 2680. *Her*, 229.

Erl, *n.* S. earl, 189, &c. *Erles*, *g. c.* 2898, earl's. *Herles*, 883. *Erldom*, earldom, 2909.

Ern, *n.* S. eagle, 572. Rits. M. R. Octovian, 196; R. Gl. p. 177; Will. of Palerne.

Erþe, *n.* S. earth, 740; ground, 2657.

Erþe, *v.* S. to dwell, 739. A.S. *eardian*.

Es, a plural pronoun signifying *them*, as in *don es on* = put them on, 970. See *Gen. and Exod.* ed. Morris, pref. p. xix.

Et, a singular pronoun, equivalent to *it*, used in *hauenet* = *hauen et*, 2005; *hauedet* = *haued et*, 714.

Ete, Eten, v. S. to eat, 791, 800, 911, &c. *Hete, Heten*, 146, 317, 457, 641. *Et, imp.* eat (thou), 925. *Et, Het, pa. t.* ate, 653, 656. *Etes, fut. 2 p.* thou shalt eat, 907. *Eteth, fut. 3 p.* shall eat, 672. *Eten, part. pa.* eaten, 657.

Eþen, *adv.* S. hence, 690. *Hepen*, 683, 845, 1085, 2727.

Eþer. See [Ayþer](#).

Euere, Eure, *adv.* S. ever. 207, 424, 704, &c. *Heuere*, 17, 327, 830.

Euereich, *adj.* S. every, 137. *Euere il*, 218, 1334, 1644. *Euere ilc*, 1330. *Eueri*, 1070, 1176, 1383. *Eueril*, 1764, 2318, &c. *Euerilk*, 2258, 2432. *Euerilkon*, every one, 1062, 1996, 2197. See [II](#).

Euere-mar, *adv.* S. evermore, 1971.

Eyen, Eyn, Eyne. See [Eie](#).

Eyr. See [Eir](#).

F

Fader, *n.* S. Lat. father, 1224, 1403, 1416. Sir Tr. p. 35; K. Horn, 114. The cognate words may be found in Jam.

Faderles, *adj.* fatherless, 75.

Fadmede, *pa. t.* S. fathomed, embraced, 1295. From *fæthmian*, *Utraque manu extensa complecti*, Cod. Exon., ed. Thorpe, p. 334. It has the same meaning in Sc. V. Jam.

Falle, v. S. to fall, 39, &c. *Falles, imp. pl.* fall ye, 2302. *Fel, pa. t.* fell, appertained. 1815, 2359. *Fellen, pa. t. pl.* fell, 1303.

Fals, *adj.* S. false, 2511.

Falwes, *n. pl.* S. fallows, fields, 2509. Chauc. C. T. 6238, where Tyrwh. explains it *harrowed lands*.

Fare, *n.* S. journey, 1337, 2621. R. Gl. p. 211; R. Br., Minot, p. 2 (left unexplained by Rits.); Barb. iv. 627. *Schip-fare*, a voyage, Sir Tr. p. 53.

Faren, v. S. to go, 264. *Fare*, 1378, 1392, &c. *Fare, pr. t. 2 p.* farest, behavest, 2705. *Fares, pr. t. 3 p.* goes, flies, 2690. *Ferde, pa. t.* went, 447,

1678, &c.; behaved, 2411. *For* (went), 2382, 2943. *Foren*, *pa. t. pl.* went, 2380, 2618.

Faste, *adv.* S. attentively, earnestly, 2148.

Tristrem as a man
Fast he gan to fight.

Sir Tristr. p. 167.

Bidde we ȝeorne Ihū Crist, and seint Albon wel *faste*,
That we moten to the Ioye come, that euere schal i-laste.

Vita S. Albani, MS. Laud. 108. f. 47 b.

Fastinde, *part. pr.* S. fasting, 865.

Fauth. See [Fyht](#).

Fawen, *adj.* S. fain, glad, 2160. *Fawe*, K. of Tars, 1058; Octovian, 307;
R. Gl. p. 150; Chauc. C. T. 5802.

Fe, *n.* S. fee, possessions, or money, 386, 563, 1225, &c. See Jam. and
Lynds. Gl.

Feble, *adj.* Fr. feeble, poor, scanty, 323.

Feblelike, *adv.* feebly, scantily, 418. *Febli*, Sir Tr. p. 179, for *meanly*.

Feden, *v.* S. to feed, 906. *Feddes*, *pa. t. 2 p.* feddest, 2907.

Fel. See [Bifalle](#), [Falle](#).

Felawes, *n. pl.* S. fellows, companions, 1338.

Feld, *n.* S. field, 2634, 2685, 1291.

Felde, Felede. *pa. t.* S. felled, 67, 1859, 2694. *Felden* (? read *he ne fellen*,
they did not fall), 2698. *Feld*, *part. pa.* felled, 1824. Sir F. Madden writes
— “in l. 2698, I prefer reading *ne felden*, did not fell, governed by *that*.
In l. 67, Garnett suggested *felede*, pursued, from Swed. *följade*.”

Fele, *adj.* S. many, often, 778, 1277, 1737, &c. Sir Tr. p. 19.

Fele, *adv.* S. very, 2442.

Fend, *n.* S. fiend, 506, 1411, 2229.

Fer, *adv.* S. far, 359, 1863, 2275, &c. *Ferne*, far, 1864; *pl. adj.* foreign, 2031.

þa kingges buh stronge,
And of *ferrene* lond.

Lazam. l. 5528.

Cf. Chauc. Prol. l. 14.

Ferd, *n.* S. army, 2384, 2548, &c. *Ferde*, 2535. *Lazam.*, R. Gl., R. Br., Web. *Ferdes*, *pl.* 2683.

Ferde. See [Fare](#).

Fere, *n.* S. companion, wife, 1214. Sir Tr. p. 157. K. Horn, Web., R. Gl., R. Br., Minot, Chauc. *Feir*, Sc. V. Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Ferlike, *n.* S. wonder, 1258. *Ferlik*, 1849. Sir Tr. p. 21. Originally in all probability an *adj.*

Ferþe, *adj.* S. fourth, 1810.

Feste, *n.* Fr. feast, 2344, &c.

Feste, *v.* Fr. to feast, 2938.

Festen, *v.* S. to fasten, 1785; (used passively) 82. *Fest*, *pa. t.* fastened, 144.

Fet. See [Fot](#).

Fete, *v.* S. to fetch, bring, 642, 912, 937, &c. Used passively, 316, 2037. *Fetes*, *pr. t. s.* fetch, 2341. V. Pegge's Anecd. of Engl. Lang. p. 135.

Fetere, *v.* S. to fetter, chain, 2758. Used passively.

Feteres, *n. pl.* S. fetters, 82, 2759.

Fey, *n.* Fr. faith, 255, 1666. *Feyth*, 2853.

Fiht, *n.* S. fight, 2668, 2716.

Fikel, *adj.* S. fickle, inconstant, 1210, 2799.

File, *n.* vile, worthless person, 2499.

Men seth ofte a muche *file*,
They he serue boten a wile,

Bicomen swithe riche.

Hending the hende, MS. Digb. 86.

So in R. Br. p. 237.

David at that while was with Edward the kyng,
Ȝit auanced he that *file* vntille a faire thing.

It is used for *coward* by Minot, pp. 31, 36. Cf. Du. *vuil*, foul, malicious.

Finden, v. S. to find, 1083. *Finde*, 220. *Fynde*, 42. *Funden*, *pa. t. pl.* found, 602. *Funde*, *part. pa.* found, 2376. *Funden*, 1427.

Fir, *n.* S. fire, 585, 1162, &c. *Fyr*, 915.

Firrene, *adj.* S. made of fir, 2078. *Firron*, Doug. Virg. 47. 34.

Flaunes, *n. pl.* Fr. custards, or pancakes, 644. See Way's note in Prompt. Parv.

Fledden, *pa. t. pl.* S. fled, 2416.

Flemen, v. S. to drive away, banish, 1160. R. Gl., R. Br., Chauc., Rits. A. S.
So in Sc. V. Jam.

Flete, *pres. subj.* S. float, swim, 522. Sir Tr. p. 27; K. Horn, 159; Chauc.
Fleit, Sc. V. Jam.

Fleye, v. S. to fly, 1791, 1813, 1827, 2751. *Fley*, *pa. t.* flew, 1305.

Flo, v. S. to flay, 612, 2495. K. Horn, 92. *Flow*, *pa. t.* flayed, 2502. *Flowe*,
pa. t. pl. 2433.

Flok, *n.* S. flock, troop, 24. See [Trome](#).

Flote, *n.* S. boat, 738. A.S. *flóta*, a ship; Icel. *floti*, (1) a ship, (2) a fleet; cf. Lazam. 4530.

Flour, *n.* Fr. flower, 2917.

Fnaste, v. S. to breathe, 548. Cf. A.S. *Fnæstiað*, the wind-pipe, *Fnæstan*,
puffs of wind. *Fnast* = breath in *Owl and Nightingale*, l. 44.

Fo, *n.* S. foe, 1363, 2849; *pl.* foos, 67.

Fol, *n.* Fr. fool, 298. *Foles*, *pl.* 2100.

Folc, Folk, *n.* S. men collectively, people, 89, 438, &c.

Folwes, *imp.* S. follow ye, 1885, 2601.

Fonge, *v.* S. to take, receive, 763; 2 *p. pres. subj.* 856. In common use from Lazam. to Chauc. and much later.

For, *prep.* S. *For to* is prefixed to the inf. of verbs in the same manner as the Fr. *pour*, or Sp. *por*. It is so used in all the old writers, and in the vulgar translation of the Scriptures, and is still preserved in the North of England. Cf. 17, &c. *For* = on account of, 1670. Sir Tr. p. 62.

For, Foren. See [Faren](#).

Forbere, *v.* S. spare, abstain from, 352. Chauc. Rom. R. 4751. *Forbar*, *pa. t.* spared, abstained from, 764, 2623.

Forfaren, *v.* S. to perish, 1380. R. Br. *Forfard* (*p. p.*) Ly Beaus Desc. 1484. The inf. is also used in Web., P. Plowm., Chauc. In Sc. *Forfair*. V. Compl. of Scotl. p. 100, and Gl. Lynds.

Forgat, *pa. t.* S. forgot, 2636, &c. *Foryat*, 249.

For-henge, *v.* to kill by hanging, 2724. Cf. Du. *verhangen zich*, to hang one's self.

Forlorn, *part. pa.* S. utterly lost, 770, 1424. *Forloren*, 580. R. Br., Rits. M. R., Chauc. Used actively, Sir Tr. p. 35.

Forþi, *adv.* S. on this account, therefore, because, 1194, 1431, 2043, 2500, 2578. Sir Tr. p. 14, and in all the Gloss.

Forthwar, *adv.* S. forthward; i.e. as we go on, 731.

Forw, *n.* S. furrow, 1094.

Forward, *n.* S. promise, word, covenant, 486. *Forwarde*, 554. Lazam. l. 4790. Sir Tr. p. 13. Rits. M. R., Web., R. Gl., R. Br., Minot, Chauc.

Fostred, *part. pa.* S. nourished, 1434, 2239.

Fot, *n.* S. *Euerilk fot*, 2432, every foot, or man. *Fet*, *pl.* 616, 1022, 1303, 2479. *Fote*, 1054, 1199.

Fouhten. See [Fyht](#).

Fourtenith, *n.* S. fortnight, 2284.

Fremde, *adj.* (used as a *n.*) S. stranger, 2277.

Vor hine willeth sone uorgiete
Tho *fremde* and tho sibbe.

MS. Digb. 4.

Ther ne myhte libbe
The *fremede* ne the sibbe.

K. Horn, 67.

See also R. Gl. p. 346; Chron. of Eng. 92; P. Plowm., Chau., Jam. and Gl.
Lynds.

Freme, *v.* S. to perform, 441.

Fri, *adj.* S. free, liberal, 1072. Chauc.

Frie, *v.* to blame, 1998. Icel. *fryja*, to blame. Cf. *freles*, blameless. *Allit.*
Poems, ed. Morris, A. 431.

Fro, *prep.* S. from, 265, &c.

Frusshe. See [To-frusshe](#).

Ful, *adv.* S. very, much, completely, 6, 82, &c. *Ful wo*, 2589, much sorrow.

Ful, Fule, *adj.* S. foul, 506, 555, 626, 965, &c. *Foule*, 1158.

Fulike, *adv.* S. foully, shamefully, 2749.

Fulde, *part. pa.* S. filled, complete, 355.

Funde, Funden. See [Finde](#).

Fyht, *v.* S. to fight, 2361. *Fauth*, *pa. t.* fought, 1990. *Fouhten*, *pa. t. pl.*
fought, 2661.

Fyn, *n.* Fr. Lat. ending, 22. R. Br., Minot, Chauc., &c.

G

Ga, *v.* S. to go. See [Ouer-ga](#).

Gad, *n.* S. goad, 279. *Gaddes*, *pl.* 1016. In Gl. Ælfr. among the instruments of husbandry occur *Gad*, stimulus, and *Gadiron*, aculeus. So in *The Fermeror and his Docter*, printed by Laing:

Quhen Symkin standis quhisling with ane quhip and ane
gaid,
Priking and zarkand ane auld ox hide.

V. Jam. in v. *Gade*, 4. and Nares.

Gadred, *part. pa.* S. gathered, 2577.

Gadeling, *n.* S. an idle vagabond, low man, 1121.

þa wes æuer alc cheorl
Al swa bald alse an eorl,
& alle þa *gadelinges*
Also heo weoren sunen kinges.

Lazam. l. 12333.

Cf. K. Alisaund. 1733, 4063. *Gadlyng*, Rob. of Cicyle, MS. Harl. 1701. R. Gl. p. 277, 310. Chauc. Rom. Rose, 938. The word originally meant *Vir generosus*. See Beowulf, l. 5227.

Gaf. See [Yeue](#).

Galwe-tre, *n.* S. the gallows, 43, 335, 695. Le Bone Fl. 1726. Erle of Tol. 657. *Galues*, *Galwes*, *Galewes*, 687, 1161, 2477, 2508. R. Br., Chauc. Cf. Ihre Gl. Suiog. in v. *galge*, ab Isl. *gayl*, ramus arboris.

Gamen, *n.* S. game, sport, 980, 1716, 2135, 2250, 2577; joy, 2935, 2963. *Gamyn*, Barb. iii. 465. V. Jam.

Gan, *pa. t.* S. began, 2443. V. Jam.

Gangen, *v.* S. to go, walk, 370, 845, &c. *Gange*, 796. *Gongen*, 855. *Gonge*, 1185, 1739, &c. *Gonge*, *pr. t.* 2 *p.* goest, 690, 843. *Gangande*, *part. pr.* on foot, walking, 2283. Wynt. V. Jam.

Garte, *pa. t.* S. made, 189, 1857, &c. *Gart*, 1001, 1082. *Gert*, Sir Tr. p. 147. V. Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Gat, Gaten. See [Geten](#).

Gate, *n.* S. (1) way, road, 846, 889. Sir Tr. p. 27; (2) manner, fashion (see [bus-gate](#)), 783, 2419, 2586.

Genge, *n.* S. family, company, 786, 1735; retinue, 2353, 2362, 2383.

þe king of þan londe
Mid muchelere *genge*.

Lazam. l. 6156.

Hence *Gang*. V. Todd's Johns.

Gent, *adj.* Fr. neat, pretty, 2139. Sir Tr. p. 87, R. Br., Chauc.

Gere. See [Messe-gere](#).

Gest, *n.* Fr. tale, adventure, 2984. See Note in Warton's Hist. E. P., V. 1.
p. 69. Ed. 1840.

Gete, *v.* to guard, watch, keep, 2762, 2960. Icel. *gæta*, to guard. Cf.
Ormulum, 2079. [Suggested by Garnett.]

Geten, *v.* S. to get, take, 792. *Gete*, 1393. *Gat*, *pa. t.* begot, got, 495, 730.
Gaten, *Geten*, *pa. t. pl.* begot, 2893, 2934, 2978. *Getes*, *f. t. 2 p.* shalt get,
908.

Ghod *for* Good, 255.

Gisarm, *n.* Fr. a bill, 2553. See Gl. Rits. M. R., Spelm. in v., Jam. Dict., and
Merrick's Gl. in v. *Gesa*, *Gesum*. ["Distinguished from other weapons of
the axe kind by a spike rising from the back. There were two kinds, viz.
the *glaive-gisarme*, with a sabre-blade and spike; and the *bill-gisarme*, in
shape of a hedging-bill with a spike." Godwin's Archæol. Handbook,
p. 254.]

Giue. See [Yeue](#).

Giue, *n.* S. gift, 2880. *Gyue*, 357. *Yeft*, 2336.

Giueled, piled up, 814. [The O.Fr. *gavelé* means piled up, heaped together.
To *gavel* corn (see Halliwell) is to put it into heaps, and a *gavel* is a heap
of corn. But this may very well be derived from *gable*, since a heap takes
the shape of a peaked end of a house; and the O.Fr. term is probably
originally Teutonic, and connected, as *gable* is, with Mæso-Goth. *gibla*, a

pinnacle, with which compare German *giebel*, Du. *gevel*, and hence our word would be taken from a verb *givelen*, to pile up. The fish in Havelok's basket would be what the Dutch call *gevelvormig*, or formed like a gable, or like the peaked end of a *stack* of hay or corn, whence the author's expression—*giueled als a stac*, piled up in the shape of a stack. Other explanations are *flayed*, from Du. *villen*, to flay; or *filed*, ranged in rows upon a stick, where *stick* is represented by *stac*. But the latter supposition would require the reading *on* rather than *als*; not to mention the fact that if fish are carried *in a pannier* they would not resemble fish carried *on a stick*. Nor is it quite satisfactory to say that *giueled* is put for *gefilled*, filled; for this is not elucidated by the expression *als a stac*, any more than the explanation *flayed* is. *Gable* is Icel. *gafl*, Sw. *gafvel*, Dan. *gavl*, Du. *gevel*, Ger. *giebel*, *gipfel*, &c. Its forked shape seems to give rise to Ger. *gabel*, Sw. *gaffel*, a fork; respecting which set of words see *Gaff* in Wedgwood.]

Gladlike, *adv.* S. gladly, 805, 906, 1760.

Glede, *n.* S. a burning coal, 91, 869. Rits. M. R., Web., R. Br., Chauc. See [Note on l. 91](#).

Gleieue, Gleyue, Fr. a spear, lance, 1770, 1844, 1981. *Gleiues*, *Gleyues*, *pl.* 267, 1748, 1864. Dr Merrick explains it, "A weapon composed of a long cutting blade at the end of a staff." See R. Gl. p. 203; Guy of Warw. R. iii.; Chauc. Court of Love, 544; Percy, A. R.

Glem, *n.* S. gleam, ray, 2122. See [Stem](#).

Gleu, *n.* S. game, skill, 2332. Properly, says Sir W. Scott, the joyous science of the minstrels. Cf. Sir Tr. p. 24, 35, 150.

Gleymen, *n. pl.* S. gleemen, 2329. *Glewemen*, Sir Tr. p. 110.

Whar bin thi *glewmen* that schuld thi *glewe*,
With harp and fithel, and tabour bete.

Disp. betw. the bodi & saul, ap. Leyd. Compl. of Scotl.

Glutuns, *n. pl.* Fr. gluttons, wicked men, 2104.

Va, *Glutun*, envers tei nostre lei se defent.

K. Horn, 1633, MS. Douce.

Cf. K. Horn, 1124, ap. Rits., Yw. and Gaw. 3247; R. Cœur de L. 5953, and Chauc.

Gnede, *adj.* S. niggardly, frugal, 97. Nearly equivalent to *chinche*, l. 1763. Printed *guede* in Sir Tr. p. 169. [Cf. *Gnede* in Halliwell, and A.S. *gneadlícnes*, frugality.]

God, *n.* S. gain, wealth, goods, 797, 2034; *pl.* gode, 1221. R. Gl., R. Br., Chauc.

God, Gode, *adj.* S. good, excellent, 7, &c.

Goddot, Goddoth, *interj.* god wot! 606, 642, 796, 909, 1656, 2543; cf. 2527. It is formed probably in the same manner as *Goddil*, for God's will, in Yorksh. and Lanc. V. Craven dialect, and View of Lanc. dialect, 1770, 8vo. The word before us appears to have been limited to Lincolnshire or Lancashire, and does not appear in the Glossaries. Other instances are in the *Cursor Mundi*, MS. Cott. Vesp. F. iii. fol. 87*b*, and in MS. Cott. Galba E. ix. fol. 61. It also occurs in a translation of a French Fabliau, written in the reign of Edw. I.

Goddot! so I wille,
And loke that thou hire tille,
And strek out hire thes.

La fablel & la cointise de dame Siriz, MS. Digb. 86.

Grundtvig told me (adds Sir F. Madden) that it is "undoubtedly the same interjection spelled *Ioduth* in the old Danish rime-chronicle."

Gome, *n.* S. man, 7.

Gon, *v.* S. to go, walk, 113, 1045. *Goth*, *imp.* go ye, 1780. *Gon*, *part. pa.* gone, 2692.

Gonge, Gongen. See [Gange](#).

Gore, 2497. See [Grim](#).

Gos, *n.* S. goose, 1240. *Gees*, *pl.* 702.

Gouen. See [Yeue](#).

Goulen, *pr. t. pl.* 2 *p.* S. howl, cry, 454. *Gouleden, pa. t. pl.* howled, cried, 164.

An *yollen* mote thu so heye,
That ut berste bo thin ey.

Hule and Nihtingale, l. 970.

Used also by Wicliffe. In Scotland and the North it is still preserved, but in the South *Yell* is used as an equivalent. See Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Gram, *n.* S. grief, 2469.

Graten, *v.* S. [*grætan*] to weep, cry, cry out, 329. *Grede*, 96. *Grete, pres. pl.* 454, 2703. *Gret, pa. t.* cried out, wept, 615, 1129, 2159. *Gredde*, 2417. *Greten, pa. t. pl.* wept, 164, 415, 2796. *Grotinde, part. pr.* weeping, 1390. *Graten, part. pa.* wept, 241. *Igroten*, 285. See Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Graue, *v.* S. to bury, 613. *Grauen, part. pa.* buried, 2528. Web., Sir Guy, li. iv., Chauc.

Greme, *v.* S. to irritate, grieve, 442. In R. Br. *Gram* is used as a verb, in the same sense.

Grene, *n.* desire, lust, 996. It is simply the Mæso-Goth. *gairuni*, lust; Icel. *girni*, desire. V. Jam. in *v.* Grene. Halliwell suggests *sport, play*, to which it is *opposed*.

Gres, *n.* S. grass, 2698.

Gret, *adj.* S. great, heavy, loud, 807, 1860. *Greth*, 1025; *pl. grete*, 1437, 1862. *Grettere, comp.* greater, 1893.

Grete. See [Graten](#).

Grepede, 2003. Explained as *greeted, accosted*, by Sir F. Madden; but the use of *p* (not *th*) renders this doubtful. May it not signify *treated, handled* (lit. *arrayed*), from the *vb.* *greype*?

Grethet. See [Greype](#).

Greting, *n.* S. weeping, 166.

Grette, *pa. t.* S. accosted, greeted, 452, 1811, 2625. *Gret, part. pa.* accosted, greeted, 2290.

Greu, *pa. t.* S. grew, prospered, 2333; *pl.* grewe, 2975.

Greue, *v.* S. to grieve, 2953.

Greyþe, *v.* S. [geráedian] to prepare, 1762. *Greyþede, pa. t.* prepared, 706.

Greyþed, part. pa. prepared, made ready, 714. *Grethet*, 2615. Lazam.

l. 4414. Sir Tr. p. 33. Sc. *Graith*. V. Jam. and Gl. Lynds.

Greyue, *n.* S. [geréfa] greave, magistrate, 1771. *Greyues, g. c.* greave's,

1749. *Greyues, pl.* 266. V. Spelm. in v. *Grafio*, and Hickes, Diss. Epist.

p. 21, n. p. 151.

Grim, *adj.* S. cruel, savage, fierce, 155, 680, 2398, 2655, 2761. R. Br., Rits.

M. R. See *Beowulf*, l. 204.

Grim, *n.* [smut, dirt, 2497. The explanation is that Godard, on being flayed, did not bear his sentence as one of rank and blood would have done, but began to roar out as if he were mere *dirt* or *mud*, i.e. one of the dregs of the common herd. This curious expression is ascertained to have the meaning here assigned to it by observing (1) that *grim* and *gore* must be substantives, and (2) that they must be of like signification; but chiefly by comparing the line with others similar to it. Now the context, in the couplet following, repeats that “men might hear him roar, that *foul vile* wretch, a mile off;” and in l. 682, Godard calls Grim “a *foul dirt*, a thrall, and a churl.” The author clearly uses *dirt* and *churl* as synonyms. The word *grim* is the Danish *grim*, soot, lampblack, smut, dirt, answering to the English *grime*; see *grime* in Atkinson's Glossary of the Cleveland dialect. *Gore* is the A.S. *gór*, wet mud, or clotted blood, in the latter of which senses it is still used. See “*Gore. Limus*” in Prompt. Parv., and Way's note.]

Grip, *n.* griffin, 572. Web. *Graip*, Sc., V. Jam. The plural *gripes* is in Lazam.

l. 28062, and K. Alisaund. 4880. Swed. *grip*.

Grip, *n.* S. [græp] ditch, trench, 2102. *Gripes, pl.* 1924. V. Jam. in v. *Grape*;

and Skinner, v. *Groop*. Cf. Swed. *grop*.

Gripen, *pr. t. pl.* S. gripe, grasp, 1790. *Gripeth, imp.* gripe ye, 1882. *Grop*,

pa. t. grasped, 1776, 1871, 1890, &c.

Grith, *n.* S. peace, 61, 511. *Grith-sergeans*, 267, legal officers to preserve the peace. These must not be confounded with the *Justitiiarii Pacis* established in the beginning of Edw. III. reign, and called *Gardiani Pacis*. V. Spelm. in v. Cf. Icel. *grið*.

Grom, *n.* male child, youth, 790; young man, 2472. Belgic *grom* has the same sense of *boy*. Cf. Icel. *gromr*, homuncio. So in *Sir Degore*, A. iv.

He lyft up the shete anone
And loked upon the lytle *grome*.

It generally elsewhere signifies *lad*, *page*.

Gronge, *n.* Fr. grange, 764. [Halliwell says that, in *Lincolnshire*, a lone farm-house is still called a *grange*. In old English it is sometimes spelt *graunge*, which comes near the form here used. Cf. Fr. *grange*; Ital. *grangia* (Florio), a country-farm.]

Grop. See [Gripen](#).

Grotes, *n. pl.* S. [*grót*] small pieces, grit, dust, 472, 1414.

Grotinde. See [Graten](#).

Grund, *adj. used as adv.* 1027. See [Grundlike](#).

Grunde, *n.* S. *dat. c.* ground, 1979, 2675.

Grunden, *part. pa.* S. ground, 2503. Yw. and Gaw. 676. *Grounden*, Chauc.

Grundlike, *adv.* heartily, 651, 2659; deeply, 2013, 2268, 2307, where it is equivalent to *Deplike*, q.v. The word is undoubtedly Saxon, but in the Lexicons we only find *Grundlinga*, funditus, from Ælf. Gl. It is used by Lazamon, l. 9783.

Cnihtes heom gereden
Grundliche feire.

Gyue. See [Giue](#).

[H](#)

Hal, all, 2370.

[<i>Hal</i> , more probably, is shortened from <i>half</i> , like <i>twel</i> from <i>twelue</i> .]
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Halde, v. S. to hold, take part, 2308. *Holden*, to keep or observe, 29, 1171. *Haldes*, *pr. t.* 3 *p.* holds, 1382. *Hel*, *pa. t.* held, 109. *Helden*, *pa. t. pl.* held, 1201. *Halden*, *part. pa.* held, holden, 2806.

Hals, *n.* S. neck, 521, 670, 2510. *Sir Tr.* *p.* 109.

Halue, *n.* S. side, part; *bi bothe halue*, 2682. See [Bi-halue](#).

Haluendel, *n.* S. the half part, 460. *R. Gl.* *p.* 5; *R. Br.*; *K. Alisaund.* 7116; *Emare*, 444; *Chron. of Engl.* 515; *R. Hood*, i. 68.

Handlen, v. S. to handle, 347. *Handel*, 586.

Hangen, v. S. to hang, 335, 695. *Hengen*, 43, &c. *Honge*, 2807. *Henged*, *part. pa.* hung, 1922, 2480. Cf. [For-henge](#).

Harum *for* Harm, 1983, 2408.

Hasard, *n.* Fr. game at dice, 2326. See [Note on l. 2320](#).

Hatede, *pa. t.* S. hated, 1188.

Hauen, v. S. to have, 78, &c. *Hawe*, 1188. *Haue*, 1298. *Haues*, *Hauest*, *pr. t.* 2 *p.* hast, 688, 848. *Haues*, *Haueth*, *pr. t.* 3 *p.* haveth, hath, has, 1266, 1285, 1952, 1980, &c. *Hauet*, hath, 564. *Hauen*, *pr. t. pl.* have, 1227. *Hauenet*, have it, 2005. *Hauede*, *pa. t.* had, 649, 775, &c. *Hauedet*, 714, had it. *Haueden*, *pa. t. pl.* had, 238, &c. *Aueden*, 163. *Haue*, *Hauede*, *Haueden*, *subj.* would have, 1428, 1643, 1687, 2020, 2675.

HauI *for* Haue I, 2002.

He, *pron.* S. Is often understood, as in ll. 869, 1428, 1777, and hence might perhaps have been designedly omitted in ll. 135, 860, 1089, 2311, though the metre seems to require *he* in 135 and 1089. *He*, *pl.* they, 54, &c.

Heie, *n.* See [Eie](#).

Heie, *adj.* S. tall, 987. *Hey*, 1071, 1083; high, 1289. *Heye se*, 719. *Heye curt*, 1685. *Heye and lowe*, 2431, 2471, &c.

Hel, Helden. See [Halde](#).

Helde, Heldeste. See [Eld](#).

Helen, *v.* S. [*háelan*] to heal, 1836. *Hele*, 2058. *Holed*, *part. pa.* healed, 2039.

Helm, *n.* S. helmet, 379, 624, 1653, &c. *Helmes*, *pl.* 2612.

Helpen, *v.* S. to help, 1712. *Helpes*, *imp. pl.* help ye, 2595. *Holpen*, *part. pa.* helped, 901.

Hem, *pron.* S. them, 367, &c.

Hend. See [Hond](#).

Hende *for* Ende, 247.

Hende, *n.* S. a duck, 1241. A.S. *ened*; Lat. *anas* (*anat-is*); Du. *eend*; Icel. *önd*. “Ende mete, for dookelyngys, *Lenticula*,” and again, “Ende, dooke byrde, *Anas*.” Prompt. Parv.

Hende, *adj.* courteous, gentle, 1104, 1421, 1704, 2793, 2877, 2914; skilful, 2628. It certainly is the same word with *hendi*, *hendy*. See Tyrwh. on C. T. 3199; Gl. R. Glouc.; Amis and Amil. 1393; Ly Beaus Desc. 333; Morte Arthur, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. i. p. 359, &c.; Dan. and Sw. *händig*, dexterous.

Hende, *adv.* S. near, handy, 359, 2275. Web.

Hendeleik, *n.* courtesy, 2793. Cf. *Allit. Poems*, ed. Morris, B. 860.

Henged, Hengen. See [Hangen](#).

Henne, *adv.* S. hence, 843, 1780, 1799. In the same manner is formed *Whenne*, K. Horn, 169, which Ritson thought a mistake for *whence*.

Henne, *n.* S. hen, 1240. *Hennes*, *pl.* 702.

Her. See [Er](#).

Her, *adv.* S. here, 689, 1058, &c. *Her offe*, 2585, hereof.

Her, *n.* S. hair, 1924. *Hor*, 235.

Herboru, *n.* S. habitation, harbour, lodging, 742. *Herberowe*, Web.; *Herbegerie*, R. Br.; *Harbroughe*, Sq. of Lowe Degre, 179; *Herberwe*, Chauc.; *Herbry*, Wynt.; *Herberye*, Lynds. Gl. q.v. and Jam.

Herborwed, *pa. t.* S. lodged, 742. Laȝam., Chauc., V. Jam. in v. *Herbery*.

Here, *pron.* S. their, 52, 465, &c.

Here, *n.* S. army, 346, 379, 2153, 2942. R. Br., K. Alisaund, 2101.

Here, Heren, v. S. to hear, 4, 732, 1640, 2279, &c. *Y-here*, 11. *Herd*, *Herde*,
pa. t. heard, 286, 465, &c. *Herden*, *pa. t. pl.* 150.

Herinne, *adv.* S. herein, 458.

Herkne, *imp. s.* S. hearken, 1285. *Herknet*, *imp. pl.* hearken ye, 1.

Herles. See [Erl](#).

Hernes, *n.* Fr. armour, harness, 1917. R. Br., &c.

Hernes, *n. pl.* S. brains, 1808.

Hern-panne, *n.* S. skull, 1991. Yw. and Gaw. 660; R. Cœur de L., 5293.
Hardynpan, Compl. of Scotl. p. 241; V. Gl.

Hert, *n.* S. hart, deer, 1872.

Herte, *n.* S. heart, 479, 2054, &c. *Herte blod*, 1819. Laȝam. l. 15846; Sir Tr.
p. 98; Chauc.

Hertelike, *adv.* S. heartily, 1347, 2748.

Het, *part.* S. hight, named, 2348. *Hoten*, *part. pa.* called, named, 106, 284.

Het, Hete, Heten. See [Ete](#).

Hetelike, *adv.* S. hotly, furiously, 2655.

And Guy hent his sword in hand,
And *hetelich* smot to Colbrand.

Guy of Warw. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 82.

In Sir Tr. p. 172, *Hethelich* is explained *Haughtily* by the Editor, and by
Jam. *reproachfully*. Cf. *Hetterly* in Gloss. to *Will. of Palerne*.

Hethede, *pa. t.* commanded, 551. A.S. *hetan*. The *th* is here pronounced like
t, as elsewhere.

Hepen. See [Epen](#).

Heu, *n.* S. hue, colour, complexion, 2918. Very common. We may hence explain the “inexplicable phrase” complained of by Mr Ellis, Spec. E. E. P. V. I. p. 109. “On *heu* her hair is fair enough” —occasioned by Ritson having inadvertently copied it *hen*, from the MS.; see Anc. Songs, p. 25.

Heued, *n.* S. head, 624, 1653, 1701, 1759, &c. *Heuedes*, *pl.* 1907.

Heuere. See [Euere](#).

Heui, *adj.* S. heavy, 808; laborious, 2456.

Hew, *pa. t.* S. cut, 2729. Sir Tr. p. 20.

Hext, *adj. sup.* S. highest, tallest, 1080. *Haxt*, Lazamon; *Hext*, K. Alisaund. 7961; R. Gl.; Chauc.

Hey, Heye. See [Heie](#).

Heye, *adv.* S. on high, 43, 335, 695, &c.

Heylike, *adv.* S. highly, honourably, 2319. *Heyelike*, 1329.

Heyman, *n.* S. nobleman, 1260. Sir Tr. p. 82. *Heymen*, *Heyemen*, *pl.* 231, 958.

Hi, Hic. See [Ich](#).

Hider, *adv.* S. hither, 868, 885, 1431.

Hides, *n. pl.* S. hides, skins, 918.

Hijs, *pron.* S. his, 47, 468. *Hise*, 34, &c. *Hyse*, 355. [The final *e* is most used with *plural* nouns.]

Hile, *v.* S. [*hélan*] to cover, hide, 2082. *Hele*, Sir Tr. p. 19, Web., Rits. M. R., Chauc. *Hilles*, Yw. and Gaw. 741. V. Jam. in *v. Heild*. — Somersetsh.

Him, *pron.* S. them, 257, 1169.

Hine, *n. pl.* S. hinds, bondsmen, 620. Web. *Hinen*, R. Gl., V. Jam. in *v.*

Hinne. See [Per-inne](#).

Hire, *pron.* S. her, 127, &c. *Hire semes*, it beseems her, 2916.

His *for* Is, 279, 1973, 2692.

Hise. See [Hijs](#).

Hof *for* Of, 1976.

Hof, *pa. t.* S. heaved, 2750.

Hok, *n.* S. hook, 1102.

Hol, *adj.* whole, well, 2075.

Holi, *adj.* S. holy, 1361. [*Printed hoh in the former edition.*]

Hold, *adj.* S. firm, faithful, 2781, 2816.

Ant suore othes *holde*,
That huere non ne sholde
Horn never bytreye.

K. Horn, 1259.

Cf. R. Glouc. p. 377, 383, 443; K. Alisaund. 2912; Chron. of Engl. 730.

Hold, Holde, *adj.* S. old, 30, 192, 417, 956, &c.; former, 2460.

Holden. See [Halde](#).

Hole, *n.* S. socket of the eye, 1813.

Holed. See [Helen](#).

Holpen. See [Helpen](#).

Hond, *n.* S. hand, 2446. *Hon*, 1342. *Dat. c.* hend, 505, 2069; *pl.* hondes, 215, 636. *Hond-dede*, *n.* S. handiwork, 92.

Honge. See [Hangen](#).

Hor. See [Her](#), *n.*

Hore, *n.* mercy, 153. See [Ore](#).

Horn, *n.* S. 779. [This probably refers to the *shape* of the simnel. Halliwell says, a Simnel is “generally made in a *three-cornered* form.” Cracknels are still made with pointed and turned up ends, not unlike *horns*.]

Hors, *n.* S. horse, 2283. *Horse-knaue*, groom, 1019. So in a curious satirical poem, temp. Edw. II.

Of rybaudz y ryme,

Ant rede o my rolle,
Of gedelynges, gromes,
Of Colyn, & of Colle;
Harlotes, *hors knaues*,
Bi pate & by polle.

MS. Harl. 2253, f. 124 b.

Used also by Gower, Conf. Am. See Todd's Illustr. p. 279.

Hosen, *n. pl.* S. hose, stockings, 860, 969. In Sir Tr. p. 94, trowsers seem to be indicated.

Hoslen, *v.* S. to administer or receive the sacrament, 212. *Hoslon*, 362.

Hosled, *part. pa.* 364. *Hoseled*, 2598. Le Bone Flor. 776. Chauc.

Hoten. See [Het](#).

Houes, *pr. t.* S. behoves, 582. [*Read bi-houes?*]

Hul, *n.* S. hollow, i.e. vale, 2687. A.S. *hole*. Cf. l. 2439.

Hund, *n.* S. hound, 1994, 2435. *Hundes*, *pl.* 2331.

Hungred *for* Hunger, 2454.

Hungreth, *pr. t.* hunger, 455. *Hungrede*, *pa. t.* hungered, 654.

Hure, *pron.* S. our, 338, 842, 1231, &c.

Hus *for* Us, 1217, 1409.

Hus, *n.* S. house, 740. *Huse*, 2913. *Hws*, 1141. *Milne-hous*, mill-house, 1967.

Hyl, *n.* S. heap, 892. *Hil*, hill, 1287.

Hw, W, *adv.* S. how, 120, 288, 827, 960, 1646, &c. *Hwou*, 2411, 2946, 2987, &c.

Hwan, *adv.* S. when, 408, 474, &c. See [Quan](#).

Hware, *adv.* S. where, 1881, 2240, 2579. *Hwar-of*, whereof, 2976. *Hwere*, 549, 1083.

Hwat, *pron.* S. what, 596, 635, 1137, 2547. Wat, 117, 541, &c. Wat is yw, 453. Hwat or Wat is þe, 1951, 2704.

Hwat. See [Quath](#).

Hwel, *n.* S. whale, or grampus, 755. Hwæl, balena, vel cete, vel cetus. Ælf. Gl. See [Qual](#).

Hweper, *adv.* S. whether, 294, 2098.

Hwi, *adv.* S. why, 454. See [Qui](#).

Hwil, *adv.* S. whilst, 301, 363, 538, 2437.

Hwile, *n.* S. time, 722, 1830.

Hwil-gat, *adv.* S. how, lit. which way, 838. Howgates, Skinner.

Hwit, *adj.* S. white, 1729.

Hwo, *pron.* S. who, 296, 300, 368, 2604, &c. See [Wo](#).

Hwor, *adv.* S. whether, 1119. Hwore-so, wheresoever, 1349.

Hwou. See [Hw](#).

Hws. See [Hus](#).

Hyse. See [Hijs](#).

[I](#)

Ich, *pron.* S. I, 167, &c. Ihc, 1377. Hic, 305. Hi, 487. I, 686. Y, 15, &c.

Id for It, 2424.

I-gret, 163. See [Grette](#).

I-groten. See [Graten](#).

Il, *adj.* S. each, every, 818, 1740, 2112, 2483, 2514. Ilc, 1056, 1921. Ilke, 821, 1861, 2959, 2996; (= same), 1088, 1215, 2674, &c. Ilker, each (of them), 2352. Ilkan, each one, 1770, 2357. Ilkon, 1842, 2108. See [Eueri](#).

Ille, *adv.* S. Likede hire swithe ille, 1165, it displeased her much. Sir Tr. p. 78. A common phrase. Ille maked, ill treated, 1952.

I-maked. See [Maken](#).

Inne, *adv.* S. in, 762, 807. See [Perinne](#).

Inow, *adv.* S. enough, 706, 911, 931, &c. *Ynow*, 563, 1795. *Ynou*, 904.

Intil, *prep.* S. into, 128, 251, &c. See [Til](#).

Ioie, *n.* Fr. joy, 1209, 1237, 1278, &c. *Ioye*, 1315.

Ioyinge, *n.* gladness, 2087.

Ioupe, *n.* Fr. a doublet, 1767. Roquefort gives the form *Jupe*, but *Jupon* or *Gipoun* is more usual. See *Jupon* in Halliwell, and *Gipe* in Roquefort.

Is *for* His, 735, 2254, 2479.

Iuele, *n.* S. evil, injury, 50, 1689. *Yuel*, 2221. *Yuele*, 994. *Iuel*, sickness, 114. *Yuel*, 144, 155.

þa þe he wes ald mon,
þa com him *ufel* on.

Lazam. l. 19282.

Ful iuele o-bone, very lean, 2505; cf. 2525.

Iuele, *adv.* S. evilly, 2755. *Me yuele like*, displease me, 132. Cf. [Ille liken](#).
[K](#)

Kam. See [Komen](#).

Kaske, *adj.* strong, vigorous, 1841. Sw. *karsk*.

Kaym, *n. p.* Cain, 2045. See [note in loc](#).

Kayn, *n.* 31, 1327. Evidently a provincial pronunciation of *Thayn*, which in the MS. may elsewhere be read either *chayn* or *thayn*. By the same mutation of letters *make* has been converted into *mate*, *cake* into *cate*, *wayke* into *wayte*, *lake* into *late* (R. Hood, l. 106), &c., or *vice versâ*. See [Thayn](#).

Kaysere. See [Cayser](#).

Keft, *part. pa.* purchased, 2005. *Sure keft* = sourly (bitterly) purchased it.
See [Sure](#) and [Coupe](#).

Keling, *n.* 757, cod of a large size, Jam. q.v. The *kelyng* appears in the first, course of Archb. Nevil's Feast, 6 Edw. IV. See Warner's *Antiq. Cul.* Cotgrave explains *Merlus*, A Melwall or *Keeling*, a kind of small cod, whereof stockfish is made.

Keme. See [Komen](#).

Kempe, *n.* S. knight, champion, 1036. V. Jam. in v.

Kene, *adj.* S. keen, bold, eager, 1832, 2115. A term of very extensive use in old Engl. and Sc. poetry, and the usual epithet of a knight.

Kesten, *v.* S. to cast in prison, or to overthrow, 81, 1785 (used passively). *Casten*, cast, throw, 2101. *Keste*, *pa. t.* cast, 2449. *Keste*, *part. pa.* cast, placed, 2611; [or it may be the infin. mood.]

Keuel, *n.* S. a gag, 547. See *Kevel* in Hall., *Kewl* in. Jam. A.S. *cæfli*, a halter, headstall.

Kid, *part. pa.* S. made known, discovered, 1060. Sir Tr. p. 150; R. Br.; Yw. and Gaw. 530; Minot, p. 4; Chauc. From *cýþan*, notum facere.

Kin, Kyn, *n.* S. kindred, 393, 414, 2045.

Kines, *n.* S. *gen. c.* kind, 861, 1140, 2691. *None kines* = of no kind; *neuere kines* = of never a kind.

Kinneriche. See [Cunnriche](#).

Kippe, *v.* S. [*cépan*] to take up hastily, 894. *Kipt*, *Kipte*, *pa. t.* snatched up, 1050, 2407, 2638.

Horn in is armes hire *kepte*.

K. Horn, 1208.

Kypte heore longe knyues, and slowe faste to gronde.

Rob. Glouc. p. 125.

Kept up, snatcht up, Gl. R. Br. Jamieson derives the word from Su.-G. *kippa*, to take anything violently. V. in v. *Kip*. Ihre quotes the Icel. *kipti up* = snatched up.

Kirke, *n.* S. church, 1132, 1355. *Kirkes*, *pl.* 2583. V. Gl. Lynds. and Jam.

Kiste. See [Chiste](#).

Kiste, *pa. t. s.* kissed, 1279. *Kisten, pa. t. pl. S.* kissed, 2162.

Kiwing, *n.* 1736. [Respecting this word I can only record my conviction that it is not safe to quote it, as the MS. is indistinct. I read the word as *kilþing*, which I believe to be merely miswritten for *ilk þing* (which the scribe also spells *il þing*), and I suppose the sense of the line to be—
“when they had there distributed *everything*.”]

Knaue, *n.* S. lad, 308, 409, 450, &c. Attendant, servant, 458. *Cokes knaue*, scullion, 1123.

Heore cokes & heore *cnaues*
Alle heo duden of lif dæzen.

Lazam. l. 13717.

V. Jam. in v. Gl. Lynds. and Gl. Todd's Illustr. Chauc.

Knawe, *v. S.* to know, 2785. *Knawe, pr. t. pl.* know, 2207. *Kneu, pa. t.* knew, 2468. *Knawed, part. pa.* known, 2057.

Knichth, Knith, *n. S.* knight, 77, 343, &c. *Knictes, pl.* 239. *Knithes*, 1068. *Knihtes*, 2706.

Kok, *n.* a cook, 873, 180, 891, 903, 921, 2898. See [Cok](#).

Komen, *v. S.* to come, 1001. *Comes, Cometh, imp, pl.* come ye, 1798, 1885, 2247. *Kam, pa. t.* came, 766, 863. *Kom*, 1309. *Cam*, 2622. *Komen, pa. t, pl.* came, 1012, 1202. *Comen*, 2790. *Keme*, 1208. *Comen, part. pa.* come, 1714.

Kope, *n.* Lat. cope, 429. *Copes, pl.* 1957.

Koren, *n. S.* corn, 1879.

Kouel. See [Couel](#).

Kouþen. See [Couþe](#).

Kradel-barnes, *n. pl. S.* children in the cradle, 1912.

Kraken, *v. S.* to crack, break, 914. *Krake*, 1857. *Crake*, 1908. *Crakede, pa. t.* cracked, broke, 568. *Kraked, part. pa.* 1238.

Krike, *n.* S. creek, 708.

Kunne. See [Canst](#).

Kuneriche, Kunerike, Kunrik. See [Cunnriche](#).

Kyne-merk, *n.* S. mark or sign of royalty, 604. In the same manner are compounded *cine-helm*, *cine-stol*, &c.

& Cador þe kene
scal beren þas *kinges marke*;
hæbben hæze þene drake,
biforen þissere duȝeðe.

Lazam. l. 19098.

Thyll ther was of her body
A fayr chyld borne, and a godele,
Hadde a dowbyll *kynges marke*.

Emare, 502.

[L](#)

Lac, *n.* S. fault, reproach, 191, 2219. Yw. and Gaw. 264, 1133. *Lak*, R. Br., Rom. of Merlin, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. i. p. 252. Sir Orpheo, 421. *Lakke*, P. Plowm. Chauc. So in Sc. V. Jam. and Gl. Lynds. v. *Lak*, *Lack*.

Ladde, *n.* S. lad, 1786. *Ladden*, *pl.* 1038. *Laddes*, 1015, &c. A term subsequently applied to persons of low condition. “When *laddes* weddeth leuedis—” Prophecy of Tho. of Essedoune, MS. Harl. 2253, f. 127.

Large, *adj.* Fr. Lat. liberal, bountiful, 97, 2941. R. Gl. Yw. and Gaw. 865. Sir Orpheo, 27. Sevyn Sages, 1251. Chauc.

Late, *v.* S. [*létan*] *pres. subj.* let, suffer, 486. *Late*, *pr. t.* let, permit, 1741. *Late*, *imp.* let, suffer, 17, 1376, 2422. *Leth*, *pa. t.* let, suffered, 2651; caused, 252. *Late*, *part. pa.* or *inf.* put, 2611.

Laten, *v.* S. [*létan*] to leave, 328. *Late be*, *imp.* leave, relinquish, 1265; *inf.* 1657. *Let*, *pa. t.* left, 2062. *Laten*, *part. pa.* left, abated, 240, 1925.

Lath, *n.* S. injury, 76. *Lathe*, 2718, 2976.

Lauhwinde, *part. pr.* S. laughing, 946.

Laute, *pa. t.* S. [læccan, læhte] received, took, 744. *Lauthe*, 1673. *Lauth*, *part. pa.* received, taken, 1988. *I-lahte*, Lazam. l. 29260.

Horn in herte *lahte*

Al þat he him *tahte*.

K. Horn (ed. Lumby), 243.

Laght, Yw. and Gaw. 2025. *Laught*, K. Alisaund. 685, 1109. *Lauht*, R. Br. (See Hearne's blundering Gl. in voc.) Rits. A. S. p. 46. *Laucht*, Wall. ix. 1964.

Laumprei, *n.* S. lamprey, 771. *Laumprees*, *pl.* 897.

Lawe, Lowe, *adj.* S. low, 2431, 2471, 2767, &c.

Lax, *n.* S. [læx] salmon, 754, 1727. *Laxes*, *pl.* 896. V. Spelm. and Somn. in v. Jamieson says, it was "formerly the only name by which this fish was known." Cf. Dan. Sw. Icel. *lax*.

Layke, *v.* S. [lácan] to play, 1011. *Leyke*, *Leyken*, 469, 950, 997. *Leykeden*, *pa. t. pl.* played, 954. In the same sense the verb is found in P. Plowman, and Sevyng Sages, 1212. So in Sc. and N.E. V. Jam. v. *Laik*, Ray, Brockett, and Crav. Dial. v. *Lake*.

Leche, *n.* S. physician, 1836, 2057.

Led, a caldron, kettle, 924. Chauc. Prol. 202.

Lede, Leden, *v.* S. to lead, 245, &c; *utlede*, 89. Cf. 346, 379. *Ledes*, *pr. t.* 3 *p.* uses, carries, 2573. *Ledde*, *pa. t.* led, 1686. *Ledden*, *pa. t. pl.* led, 2451.

Lef, *adj.* S. agreeable, willing, *lef and loth*, 261, 440, 2273, 2313, 2379, 2775. A very usual phrase. See Beowulf, l. 1026. Chauc. C. T. 1839. R. Hood, l. 41. *Leue*, 431, 909. Sir Tr. p. 187. K. Horn, 949, &c. *Leuere*, *comp.* more agreeable, rather, 1193, 1423, 1671, &c. *Lef*, used as adv. willingly, in the phrase "Ye! lef, ye!" = yes, willingly, yes, 2606; cf. l. 1888.

Leidest. See [Leyn](#).

Leite, *adj.* S. light, 2441.

Leme, *n.* S. limb, 2555. *Lime*, 1409. *Limes*, *pl.* 86.

Leman, *n.* S. mistress, lover, 1191. *Lemman*, 1283, 1312, 1322. Used by all the old writers, and applied equally to either sex.

Lende, *v.* S. to land, 733. Sir Tr. p. 13. R. Br. See Jam. in *v.* *Leind*.

Lene, *v.* S. [*leanian*] to lend, grant, 2072.

I sal *lene* the her mi ring.

Yw. and Gaw. 737.

Lenge, *n.* the fish called *ling*, 832. [*Asellus longus*, or *Islandicus*, Ray.] It was a common dish formerly. Thus we have *Lynge in jelly*, in Archb. Nevil's Feast, 6 Edw. IV., and *Lyng in foyle*, in Warham's Feast, 1504. See Pegge's *Form of Cury*, p. 177, 184, and MS. Sloane, 1986.

Lenge, *v.* S. to prolong, 1734, 2363. P. Plowm.

Leoun, *n.* Lat. lion, 573. *Leun*, 1867.

Lepe, *v.* S. escape from (?) 2009. *Loupe*, to leap, 1801. *Lep*, *pa. t.* leapt, 891, 1777, 1942. *Lopen*, *pa. t. pl.* 1896, 2616.

Lere, Leren, *v.* S. to learn, 797, 823; to teach, 2592. *Y-lere*, 12.

Lese, *v.* S. *imp. s.* 3 *p.* loose, 333. Sir Tr. p. 110.

Leth. See [Late](#).

Lette, *v.* S. [*létan*, *lettan*] to hinder, retard, 1164, 2253, 2819; to stop, cease, 2445, 2627. *Let*, *pa. t.* stopped, stayed, 2447, 2500. *Leten*, *pa. t. pl.* stopped, delayed, 2379.

Leue, *n.* S. leave, 1387, 1626, 2952, &c.

Leue, *adj.* See [Lef](#).

Leue, *v.* S. [*lýfan*] *imp. s.* grant, 334, 406, 2807. K. Horn, 465, MS.; R. Gl., Erle of Tol. 365. Guy of Warw. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 77, where it is misprinted *lene*. It is very frequently used in the old Engl. Metrical Lives of the Saints, MS. Laud, 108. [The true distinction between *leue* and *lene* is, that the former is the A.S. *lýfan*, G. *erlauben* = grant in the sense of *allow*, *permit*, and is invariably intransitive; whilst *lene* is the A.S. *lænan*, G. *leihen* = grant in the sense of *give*. The confusion between the senses of *grant* has led to confusion between *lene* and *leue*, and in at least five

passages of Chaucer (C. T. 7226, 13613; Tro. ii. 1212, iii. 56, v. 1749, ed. Tyrwhitt) many editions wrongly have *lene*. In the last three instances Tyrwhitt rightly prints *leve*, but unnecessarily corrects himself in his Glossary. I regret to add that I have thrice made a similar mistake. In Piers Plowman, A. v. 263, and in Pierce the Ploughman's Crede, ll. 366 and 573, for *lene* read *leue*. Halliwell's remark, that "the [former] editor of Havelok absurdly prints *leue*" is founded upon the same misconception, and he is wrong in his censure. See the use of *lefe* in the Ormulum, ed. White.]

Leued, *pa. t.* S. left, 225.

Leuedi, *n.* S. lady, 171, &c. *Leuedyes*, *pl.* 239. V. Hickes, Diss. Ep. p. 52, n. Leuere. See [Lef](#).

Leues, *pr. t.* 3 *p.* S. believes, 1781, 2105. From *lefan*.

Leuin, *n.* S. lightning, 2690. R. Br. p. 174. Yw. and Gaw. Chauc. C. T. 5858. Doug. Virg. 200, 53.

Lewe, *adj.* S. warm, 498, 2921.

A opened wes his breoste,
þa blod com forð *luke*.

Lazam. l. 27556.

Leyd, Leyde. See [Leyn](#).

Leye, *n.* S. lie, falsehood, 2117.

Leve, *v.* S. to lie, speak false, 2010.

Leyke, Leyken. See [Layke](#).

Leyk, *n.* S. game, 1021, 2326. So in Beowulf, l. 2084, *sweorda-gelác*, and Sir Tr. p. 118, *love-laike*. In the *pl.* *laykes*, Minot, p. 10. In Lanc. a player is still called a *laker*.

Leyn, *v.* S. to lay, 718. *Leyde*, *pa. t.* laid, 50, 994, &c.; stopped, 229.

Leidest, *pa. t.* 2 *p.* laidest, 636. *Leyden*, *pa. t. pl.* laid, 1907. *Leyd*, *part. pa.* laid, 1689, 1722, 2839.

Lich, *adj.* like, 2155.

Lict, Lith, *n.* S. light, 534, 576, 588, &c.

Lift, *adj.* S. left (*lævus*), 2130.

Ligge, Liggen, *v.* S. to lie down, 802, 876, 882, 1374. See [Lyen](#).

Lime, Limes. See [Leme](#).

Lite, *adj.* S. little, 276, 1730. *Litel*, 1858, &c. *Litle*, 2014.

Lith. See [Lict](#).

Lith, *imp.* S. light (thou), 585.

Lith, *adv.* S. lightly, 1942.

Lith, *n.* S. alleviation, comfort, peace, 1338. *Lybe*, 147. It also occurs as a sb. in *Lazam*. l. 5213. As an *adj.* it occurs in *Lazam*. l. 7242. *Sir Tr.* p. 43, 82. *R. Cœur de L.* 2480, and *Emare*, 348, from the *v. líðian*, alleviare. Cf. *Icel. líð*, sometimes used to mean *help*. See *Leathe* in Atkinson's *Cleveland Glossary*.

Lith, *n.* S. 2515. This word is explained by Ritson *plains*, by Hearne *tenements*, and by Jamieson a *ridge* or *ascent*. Its real signification seems unknown, but may be conjectured from the following passages.

No asked he lond no *lithe*.

Sir Tristr. p. 101.

Ther wille not be went, ne lete ther lond ne *lith*.

R. Brunne, p. 194.

where it answers to the Fr. Ne volent lesser tere ne *tenement*.

Who schall us now geve londes or *lythe*.

Le Bone Flor. 841.

Here I gif Schir Galeron, quod Gaynour, withouten ony gile,
Al the londis and the *lithis* fro laver to layre.

Sir Gaw. and Sir Gal. ii. 27.

[See Glossary to *William of Palerne*, s.v. *Lud*.]

Lithes, *n. pl.* S. the extreme points of the toes, or articulations, 2163.

Fingres lith, extremum digiti, *Luc.* 16, 24.

Līpes, *imp. pl.* S. listen, 1400, 2204. *Lybes*, 2576. The verb in the Sax. is *hlystan*, but in Su.-G. *lyda*, and Isl. *hlyda*, which approaches nearer to the form in the poem. So also in K. Horn, 2, *wilen lithe*, MS.; R. Br. p. 93; R. Hood, I. p. 2; Minot, p. 1. Still used in Sc. and N.E. V. Jam. and Brockett.

Littene, *part. pa.* [or *inf.?*] 2701. “*Qu.* cut in pieces, from the same root as to *lith*, divide the joints. V. Jam. Suppl.” —M. [Or it may mean disgraced, wounded, defeated. Cf. Su.-Goth. *lyta*, to wound; Icel. *lyta*, to disgrace; Sw. *lyte*, a defect, *litt*, deformed; Dan. *lyde*, a blemish.]

Liue, *n.* S. *dat. c.* life, 232; *brouth of liue*, dead, 513, 2129. K. Horn, 188. *Of liue do*, kill, 1805. *Liues*, *gen. c. as adv.* alive, 509, 1003, 1307, 1919, 2854. See [On-liue](#).

Liuen, *v.* S. to live, 355. *Liuede*, *Liueden*, *pa. t. pl.* lived, 1299, 2044.

Lof, *n.* S. loaf, 653.

Loke, Loken, *v.* S. to look after, take care of, to behold, 376, 2136. *Lokes*, *pr. t. 2 p.* lookest, 2726. *Loke*, *imp.* look, 1680, 1712. *Lokes*, *imp. pl.* look ye, 2240, 2292, 2300, 2579, 2812. *Lokede*, *pa. t.* looked, 679, 1041.

Loken, Lokene, *part. pa.* S. fastened, locked, closed, 429, 1957. So in the Const. Othonis, Tit. *de habitu Clericorum*; “In mensura decenti habeant vestes, et *cappis clausis* utuntur in sacris ordinibus constituti.” V. Spelm. in v. *Cappa clausa*. So also in the *Ancren Riwle*, fol. 17— “gif he haues a wid hod and a *lokin* cape, &c.”

The reference to the *Ancren Riwle* is to MS. Titus D 18, fol. 17; cf. the edition by Morton (Camd. Soc. 1853), p. 56.

Lond, Londe, *n.* S. land, 64, 721, &c. *Lon*, 340.

Long, *adj.* S. tall, 987, 1063. So K. Horn, 100.

Longes, *pr. t. 3 p.* S. belongs, 396. R. Br., Chauc., &c.

Lopen. See [Lepe](#).

Loth, *adj.* S. loath, unwilling, 261, 440, &c. See [Lef](#).

Louede, *pa. t.* S. loved, 71. *Loueden*, *pa. t. pl.* 955.

Louerd, *n.* S. lord, master, 96, 483, &c. *Lowerd*, 621.

Louerdinges, *n. pl.* S. lordings, masters, 515, 1401. See Note in Warton's Hist. Engl. Poet. V. I. p. 19. Ed. 1840.

Loupe. See [Lepe](#).

Low, *pa. t.* S. laughed, 903. K. Horn, 1502. *Lowen*, *pa. t. pl.* 1056.

Lowe, *n.* S. [*hlæw*] hill, 1291, 1699. Rits. M. R., Web., &c. V. Jam. and Brockett's Gl. v. *Lawe*.

Luue, *n.* S. love, 195. [*Luue-drurye* seems here to be a compound word, meaning *love-courtship*. *Lufe-drowrie* also = love-token, *Lyndesay's Sq. Meldrum*, 1003. See [Drurye](#).]

Lyen, *v.* S. to lie (in bed), 2134. *Leyen*, *pt. pl.* lay, 475.

Lype. See [Lith](#).

[M](#)

Maght, Mait. See [Mowe](#).

Make, *n.* S. mate, companion, wife, 1150. K. Horn, 1427. K. Alisaund. 3314. Le Bone Flor. 881. Chauc. Sc. *Maik*. V. Jam.

Maken, *v.* S. to make, 29, &c. *Make*, 676. *Makeden*, *pa. t. pl.* made, 554. *I-maked*, *part. pa.* made, 5.

Male, *n.* Fr. a budget, bag, wallet, 48. Lazamon, l. 3543. Web., Chauc., R. Hood.

Malisun, *n.* Fr. malediction, curse, 426. Sir Tr. p. 179.

Manred, Manrede, *n.* S. homage, fealty, 484, 2172, 2180, 2248, 2265, 2312, 2774, 2816, 2847, 2850. Leg. of S. Gregori, ap. Leyd. Compl. of Scotl. See Jam. for further examples.

Marz, *n.* Lat. March, 2559.

Maugre, Fr. in spite of, 1128, 1789. See Tyrwh. Gl. to Chauc. and Jam. in v.

Maydnes, *n. pl.* S. maidens, 467, 2222.

Mayster, *n.* Fr. master, 1135; chief, 2028, 2385.

Mayt, Mayth. See [Mowe](#).

Mede, *n.* S. reward, 102, 685, 1635, 2402.

Mele, *n.* S. oat-meal, 780.

Mele, *v.* Fr. to contend in battle, 2059. Gaw. and Gol. ii. 18. *Mellay*, Wynt. viii. 15, 19. V. Jam.

Meme, 2201, *probably miswritten for neme*; see [Nime](#).

Men (used with a sing. vb. like the Fr. *on*), men, people, 390, 647, 2610.

Mene, *v.* S. to mean, signify, 2114. *Menes*, *pr. t. 3 p.* means, 597.

Menie, *n.* Fr. family, 827. *Meynie*, 834. This word is to be found from the time of Lazamon to Shakespeare. Jamieson attempts to derive it from the North. V. in *v. Menzie*. See *maisnie* in Roquefort.

Mere, *n.* S. mare, 2449, 2478, 2504.

Messe, *n.* Fr. Lat. the service of the mass, 243, 1176. *Messe-bok*, mass-book, 186, 391, 2710. *Messe-gere*, all the apparel, &c., pertaining to the service of the mass, 188, 389, 1078, 2217.

Mest, *adj. sup.* S. greatest, 233. *Moste*, 1287; tallest, 983.

Mester, *n.* Fr. trade, 823. K. Horn (ed. Lumby), 229.

Met, *pp.* S. dreamt, 1285.

Mete, *n.* S. meat, 459, &c. *Metes*, *pl.* 1733.

Meynie. See [Menie](#).

Michel, *adj.* S. much, 510, 660. *Mik*, 2342. *Mike*, 960 (cf. Horn Childe, ap. Rits. V. 3, 292), 1744, 1761, 2336. *Mikel*, 122, 478, &c.

Micte, Micten, Micthe, Mithe, Mithest, Mithen. See [Mowe](#).

Micth, *n.* S. might, power, 35.

Middelerd, *n.* S. the earth, world, 2244. *Middelærd*, Lazam., Rits., Web., R. Gl., Minot, &c. So in Sc. V. Jam.

Mik, Mike, Mikel. See [Michel](#).

Milce, *n. S.* [*mildse*] mercy, 1361. A! me do þine *milce*, Lazam. l. 4681;
R. Gl. It is usually coupled with *ore*.

Milne-hous. See [Hus](#).

Mirke, *adj. S.* dark, 404. R. Br., Lynds.; *merke*, Chauc. Still used in Sc. and
N.E. V. Jam.

Misdede, *pa. t. S.* did amiss, 337; injured, 992, 1371. *Misdo*, *part. pa.*
misdone, offended, 2798.

Misferde, *pa. t. S.* behaved, or proceeded ill, 1869. See [Faren](#).

Misgos, *pr. t. 2 p. S.* goest or behavest amiss, 2707.

Misseyd, *part. pa. S.* spoken to reproachfully, 1688.

Mithe, Mythe, *v. S.* [*miðan*] to conceal, hide, dissemble, 652, 948, 1278.
Sche might no lenger *mithe*. Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R. V. 3, p. 310.

Mixed, *adj.* vile, base, 2533. From *S. myx*, *fimus*. Cf. *Mix* in *William of*
Palerne.

Mo, *adj. comp. S.* more, 1742, 1846.

Mod, *n. S.* mood, humour, 1703.

Moder, *n. S.* mother, 974, 1388, &c.

Mone, *n. S.* moon, 373, 403.

Mone, *n. S.* mind, say, opinion, 816. Cf. A.S. *myne*, *monian*, *monung*; Icel.
munr. Hence, to *mone*, to *relate*, R. Cœur de L. 4636, and to *animadvert*,
in Barbour. It appears to express the Fr. phrase *par le mien escient*,
K. Horn, 467, MS. Douce. In nearly the same sense *mone* may be found
in K. Alisaund. 1281, R. Gl. pp. 281, 293. Cf. ll. 1711, 1972.

Mone, *v. pl.* [Isl. *mun*] must, 840. *Maun*, Sc. *Mun*, Yorksh. Cumb. V. Jam.

Morwen, *n. S.* morning, 811, 1131, 2669, &c. *To-morwen*, 530, 810.
Amorwe, Sir Tr., K. Horn.

Moste. See [Mest](#).

Mote, *v. S.* may, 19, 406, 1743, 2545. *Moten*, *pl.* 18.

Moun. See [Mowe](#).

Mowe, *v.* S. *pres. sing.* may, be able, 175, 394, 675. *Mowen*, *pl.* 11. *Moun*, 460, 2587. *Mait*, *pr. t. 2 p.* mayest, 689. *Mayt*, 845, 852, 1219. *Mayth*, 641. *Maght*, *pa. t. 2 p. s.* mightest, 1348. *Mithe*, *Mithest*, 855, 1218. *Micte*, *Micthe*, *Mithe*, *pa. t. 3 p.* might, 42, 233, 1030, 1080. *Mouchte*, *Moucte*, *Mouchthe*, *Mouthe*, *Mowcte*, 145, 356, 376, &c. *Micte*, *Micten*, *Mithen*, *pl.* 232, 516, 1929, 2017. *Mouhte*, *Mouthe*, *Mouthen*, 1183, 2019, 2039, 2328, 2330, &c. V. Pegge's *Anecd. of Engl. Lang.* p. iii.

N

Na, *adv.* S. no, 2363, 2530.

Nam. See [Nime](#).

Nayles, *n. pl.* S. nails, 2163.

Ne, *adv.* S. nor, 44, &c.

Nede, *n.* S. need, necessity, 9, &c. *Nedes*, *pl.* 1092.

Neme. See [Nime](#).

Ner, *adv.* S. near, 990, 1949.

Nese, *n.* S. nose, 2450.

Nesh, *adj.* S. [*nesc*] soft, tender, 2743. *Neys*, 217. *Web.*, *Rits. M. R.*, *Rob. Br.*, *Chauc.* Still used in N.W. part of England.

Neth, *n.* S. net, 752, 808, 1026; *pl. netes*, 783.

Neth, *n.* S. neat, cattle, 700, 1222. *Netes*, *g. c.* neat's, 781.

Nepeles, *conj.* S. nevertheless, 1108, 1658.

Neue, *n.* S. fist, 2405. *Neues*, *pl.* 1917. V. *Jam.*

Neure, *adv.* S. not, never, 80, 672; *neuere a polk*, ne'er a pool, 2685. *Neuere kines*, of no kind, 2691.

Ney. *adv.* nigh, near to, nearly, 464, 640, 2619.

Neys. See [Nesh](#).

Neyþer, Neþe, *pron.* S. neither, not either, 458, 764, 2970, &c. *Noper*, 2623. *Noyþer*, 2697.

Newhen, v. S. [*nehwan*] to approach, 1866. In the more recent form to *neigh* it is used in several of the old Romances, Chauc., and Minot.

Nicht, Nicth, *n.* S. night, 533, 575. *Niht*, 2669. *Nith*, 404, 1247, 1754. *Nithes*, *g. c.* of night, 2100. *Nihtes*, *nithes*, *pl.* 2353; *nihtes*, 2999.

Nime, v. S. *pr. s.* take, or go, 1931. *Nim*, *imp.* take, 1336. *Nam*, *pa. t.* took, 900; went, 2930. *Neme*, *pl.* went, 1207; cf. l. 2201. *Nomen*, took, 2790. *Nomen*, *Numen*, *part. pa.* taken, 2265, 2581. *Nimes*, *imp. pl.* go ye, 2594; *nime*, go we, 2600. In the first sense this verb is common in all the Glossaries, but in the latter sense *To go* it occurs nowhere but in the Gl. to Rob. Brunne, who, from being a Lincolnshire man, approaches nearer to the language of the present poem than any other writer. [In N.E. to *nim* is to walk with quick, short steps.]

Nis, *for* Ne is, is not, 462, 1998, 2244.

Nither-tale, *n.* S. night-time, 2025. See Chaucer, Prol. l. 97.

Noblelike, *adv.* S. nobly, 2640.

Nok, *n.* [Belg. *nock*] nook, corner, 820; *nouth a ferthinges nok*, not the value of a farthing. The same phr. is in the *Manuel des Pechés* of Rob. of Brunne, MS. Harl. 1701, fol. 39.

Nomen. See [Nime](#).

Non, *adj.* S. no, 518, 685, 1019; no one, 934, 974.

Note, *n.* S. a nut, 419. *Nouthe*, 1332.

Nop̃er. See [Neyþer](#).

Nou, *adv.* S. now, 328, 1362, &c. *Nu*, 2421, 2460, 2650, &c.

Nout, Nouth, Nouht, *n.* or *adv.* S. not, naught, nothing, not at all, 249, 505, 566, 648, 1733, 2051, 2822. *Nowt*, *Nowth*, 770, 2168, 2737.

Nouthe. See [Note](#).

Noyþer. See [Neyþer](#).

Nu. See [Nou](#).

Numen. See [Nime](#).

Nytte. v. S. make use of, require for use, 941. A.S. *nyttian*, *neotan*, G. *nützen*, Du. *nutten*.

O

O. See [On](#).

Of, *prep.* S. off, 130, 216, 603, 857, 1850, 2444, 2626, 2676, 2751, &c. *Of londe*, out of the land, 2599. Sir Tr.

Offe, *prep.* S. of, 435. *Of*, 436.

Offrende, Dan. Fr. offering, 1386.

Ofte, *adv.* S. often, 226, &c.

Ok. See [Ek](#).

On, *adj.* S. one, 425, 1800, 2028, 2263, &c.

On, *in* But on. See [But](#).

On, *prep.* S. in, on. *On liue*, 281, 363, 694, 793 &c. *O liue*, 2865. *On two*, 471, 1823, 2730, in two; *a two*, 1413, 2643. *O londe*, 763, on, or in land. *On knes*, 1211, 1302, 2710, on knees; *o knes*, 2252, 2796. *On brenne*, 1239, in flame, on fire. *O nith*, 1251, in the night. *On nithes*, 2048. *O worde*, 1349, in the world (see [Werd](#)). *O mani wise*, 1713, in many a manner. *On gamen*, 1716, in sport. *On lesse hwile*, 1830, in less time. *O bok*, 2307, 2311, on the book. *Wel o bon*, 2355, 2525, 2571, strong of body. *Iuele o bone*, 2505, lean. *On hunting*, 2382. *O stede*, 2549, on steed. *Up-o the dogges*, 2596, on the dogs. From these examples, added to those which occur in every Glossary, it is evident the Sax. *prep.* *On* was subsequently corrupted to *O* and *A*. See Tyrwh. and Jam. *A nycht* in Barb. xix. 657, explained by the latter *one* night, is according to the above rule *In the night*, as confirmed by l. 1251. Sir Tr. pp. 47, 114. R. Glouc.

One, *adj.* S. alone, singly, 815, 936, 1153, 1710, 1742, 1973, 2433.

There hue wonede al *one*.

K. Horn, 80.

See Tyrwh. Gl., Chauc. v. *On*.

Ones, *adv.* S. once, 1295.

Onfrest, v. delay, 1337. From Su.-G. *fresta*, to delay, A.S. *firstan*, from Su.-Goth. *frest* or *frist*, A.S. *fyrst*, a space of time. Cf. Dan. and Sw. *first*, a truce. *Frest*, delay, Barb. vii. 447.

Onlepi. See [Anilepi](#).

Onne, *prep.* S. on, 347, 1940.

Onon, *adv.* S. anon, speedily, 136, 447, 1964, 2790.

Ontil, *prep.* S. unto, for, 761.

Or, *adv.* S. previously, before, 728, 1043, 1356, 1688, &c. *Or outh longe*, 1789, before any long time.

Ore, *n.* S. favour, grace, mercy, 153, 211, 2443, 2797. Ich hadde of hire milse an *ore*. Hule and Nihtingale, l. 1081. Sir Tr. p. 24. *K. Horn* (ed. Lumby), 1509. See Tyrwhitt's Note on Chauc. C. T. 3724, and Ritson's Note, Metr. Rom. V. iii. p. 263. A.S. *ár*.

Ore, *n.* S. oar, 718, 1871, &c. *Ores*, *pl.* 711.

Osed *for* Hosed, 971.

Oth, *n.* S. oath, 2009, 2272, &c. *Oþes*, *pl.* 2013, 2231, &c.

Oþe *for* Oþer, 861, 1986, 2970.

Oþer, *conj.* S. either, or, 94, 674, 787, &c. See [Ayther](#).

Oþer, *adj.* S. [*alter*] the other of two, second, 879. *þe oþer day*, 1755, the following day.

Day hit is igon & *oþer*,
Wiþute sail & roþer.

K. Horn, ed. Lumby, 187.

So also R. Br. p. 169, and Wynt.

Oþer, *adj.* S. [*alius*] other, 2490. *Oþre*, *pl.* others, 1784, 2413, 2416.

Ouer-fare, v. S. to pass over, cease, 2063. See [Fare](#).

Ouer-go, v. S. to be disregarded, 2220.

Ouer-gange, v. S. to get the superiority over, 2587.

Ouer-þwert, *adv.* S. across, 2822. *Ouerthuert*, R. Br. p. 241. *Overtwert*, Ly Beaus Desc. 1017. *Overthwarte*, Syr Eglamore, B. iii. Chauc. C. T. 1993.

Oune, *adj.* S. own, 375, 2428.

Oure, *n.* bank, shore, 321. G. *ufer*. A.S. *ófer*. Cf. “to þan castle of Deoure on þere sæ oure.” *Lazamon*, l. 31117.

Outh, *n.* S. [*awiht*] any space of time, aught, 1189; cf. l. 1789; anything, 703. [*Outh douthe* = was worth anything, was of any value.]

[P](#)

Palefrey, *n.* Fr. saddle-horse, 2060. See Gl. on Chauc. in v. Pegge’s Anec. Engl. Lang. p. 289.

Pappes, *n. pl.* Lat. breasts, 2132.

Parred, *part. pa.* confined, fastened in, barred in, 2439. We have met with this word only in one instance, where Ritson leaves it unexplained.

Yn al this [tyme] was sir Ywayn
Ful straitly *parred* with mekil payn.

Yw. and Gaw. 3227.

[It is undoubtedly equivalent to O.E. *sperre*, or *spere*. Halliwell, s.v. *Parred*, quotes “3e are *parred* in . . . 3e are so *spered* in.” So, too, the Ital. *sbarra* is the Fr. *barre*. Cf. A.S. *sparran*, O.N. *sperra*, Sc. *spar*. Hence the derivation of *park*, O.E. *parrock*, an enclosure.]

Pastees, *n. pl.* Fr. pasties, patés, 644.

Ther beth bowris and halles,
Al of *pasteiis* beth the walles.

Land of Cokaygne, MS. Harl. 913, f. 5.

Pateyn, *n.* Lat. the Plate used in the service of the Mass, 187.

Paþe, *n.* S. path, road, 2381, 2390. *Papes*, *pl.* 268.

Patriark, *n.* Lat. patriarch, 428.

Payed, *part. pa.* Fr. satisfied, content, 184. Rits. M. R., Web., R. Gl., R. Br. *Apaied*, Chauc.

Pelle, *v.* drive forth (*intr.*), hurry forth, 810. Deriv. uncertain, unless it be connected with Lat. *pello*, Eng. *impel*. Cf. Eng. *pelt*.

Peni, *n.* S. penny, 705, 2147. *Penies*, *pl.* 776, 1172.

Per, *n.* Fr. peer, equal, 989, 2241, 2792.

Pike, *v.* to pitch (used passively), 707. Teut. *pecken*, Lat. *picare*. The verb in Saxon is not extant, but only the *n.* *pic*.

Pine, *n.* S. pain, grief, 405, 540, 1374. Sir Tr. p. 12. V. Jam.

Pine, *v.* S. to grieve, 1958.

Plat. See [Plette](#).

Plattinde, *part. pr.* tramping along, moving noisily or hurriedly, 2282. From the beating noise of the feet, like Sc. *platch* (q.v. in Jam.). See [Plette](#).

Plawe, *v.* S. to play, 950. *Pleye*, 951.

Playces, *n. pl.* plaice, 896.

Pleinte, *n.* Fr. complaint, 134. *Pleynte*, 2961.

Plette, *v.* S. [*plættian*] to strike, 2444. *Plat*, *pa. t.* struck, 2755. *Plette*, 2626; *pl. plette*, hurried, moved noisily, 2613. [Cf. *Plattinde*, and note the double use of Sc. *skelp*, to beat, to hurry, and O.E. *strike*, to beat, to move along.]

Plith, *n.* S. [*pliht*] harm, 1370, 2002. Lazam. l. 3897.

Poke, *n.* S. a bag, 555, 769. *Pokes*, *pl.* 780.

Poles, *n. pl.* S. pools, ponds of water, 2101.

Polk, *n.* S. pool, puddle, 2685. *Pow*, Sir Tr. p. 171. *Pulk*, Somersetsh.

Pouere, Poure, *adj.* Fr. poor, 58, 101, 2457, &c.

Poureluke, *adv.* poorly, 323.

Prangled, *part. pa.* compressed, 639. Cf. Du. *prangen*, to pinch; Dan. *prange Seil*, to crowd sail.

Preie, *pr. t.* S. pray, 1440. *Prey, imp.* pray (thou), 1343. *Preide, pa. t.* prayed, 209.

Prest, *n.* S. priest, 429, 1829. *Prestes, pl.* 2583.

Priken, *v.* S. to spur a horse, ride briskly, 2639.

Prud, *adj.* S. proud, 302.

Pulten, *pa. t. pl.* so reads the MS. l. 1023, instead of *putten*. Both have the same signification. So in the Romance of *Rob. of Cecyle*, Harl. MS. 1701, f. 94, c. 1, *pulte* occurs for *put*, placed, and *pylt* in R. Cœur de L. 4085; *pelte*, Sir Tr. p. 95. In the *imp.* *Pult* for *put*, *place*, is used in *Hending the Hende*, MS. Digb. 86. In the signification of *drove forward*, which is nearer to the sense we require, we find *pylte* in K. Horn, 1433, and R. Glouc. Hence the Engl. word *pelt*. See *Putten*. Cf. *Pult* in Gl. to *Will. of Palerne*.

Pund, *n. pl.* S. pounds, 1633.

Put, *n.* cast, throw, 1055. *But*, 1040.

Putten, *v.* to cast, throw, propel forward, 1033, 1044. *Puten*, 1051. *Putte, pa. t.* cast, 1052. *Putten, pa. t. pl.* cast, threw, 1023, 1031, 1844. From the Fr. *bouter*, Teut. *buitten*, or Belg. *botten*, to drive or propel forward, or, as others suggest, from the Br. *pwtiaw*, which has the same meaning, or Isl. *potta*. From the same root are derived both *Put* and *But*. Thus to *butt* in Sc. is to drive at a stone in curling, and to *put* in Yorksh. is to push with the horns. In the passage before us it is applied to a particular game, formerly in great repute. See [Note on l. 1022](#). Cf. Ramsay's Poems, ii. 106. The word is still retained in the North, and Sc. V. Jam. and Brockett. See *But* and *Pulten*.

Putting, Puttinge, *n.* casting, 1042, 1057, 2324.

Pyment, *n.* B.L. spiced wine, 1728. See [Note on l. 1726](#).

Q

Qual, *n.* S. [hwæɫ] whale or grampus, 753. See [Hwel](#).

Quan, Quanne, *adv.* S. when, 134, 204, 240, &c. See [Hwan](#).

Quath, *pa. t.* S. quoth, 606, 642, &c. *Hwat*, 1650, 1878. *Wat*, 595. *Quod*, 1888. *Quodh*, 1801. *Quot*, 1954, 2808. *Couth*, 2606.

Queme, *adj.* S. agreeable, 130, 393. *Web.*, *Rits. M. R.*, *Rob. Br.*, *R. Glouc.*, *Gower*, *Chauc.*

Quen, *n.* S. queen, 2760, 2783, &c. *Quenes*, *pl.* 2982.

Qui. See [Hwi](#).

Quic, Quik, *adj.* S. alive, 612, 613, 1405, 2210, 2476, &c., *quik and ded*.

This is the usual language of the Inquisitiones post mortem, which commence at the early part of Henry III. reign. For the usage of the term, see *Gl. to Sir Tr.* p. 98. *Yw. and Gaw.* 668. *Chron. of Engl.* 762, &c. The word is preserved in the vulgar version of the Scriptures, and Creed.

Quike, quick, alert, 1348. *Al quic wede*, 2641. Cf. l. 2387.

Quiste, *n.* S. [cwide] bequest, will, 219, 365. *Quede*, *K. Alisaund.* 8020.

Quod, Quodh, Quot. See [Quath](#).

R

Radde. See [Rede](#).

Ran. See [Renne](#).

Rang, *adj.* S. [ranc] perverse, rebellious, 2561.

Rath, *n.* S. counsel; hence, an adviser, 75. *Dat. c. rathe*, in the phrase *to rathe*, 2542; for the meaning of which, see [Red](#).

Rape, *adv.* S. speedily, readily, quickly, 358, &c. (In l. 1335, I prefer considering it as a verb.)

Rathe, *v.* S. [rædan] to advise, 1335. A provincial pronunciation of *Rede*. In l. 2817, it is still broader, “Yif ye it wilen and ek *rothe*.” In the same manner *Rode* is spelt, and was undoubtedly pronounced *Rothe*, *Ly Beaus Desc.* 425, and *Abode* is spelt *Abothe*, *ib.* 1118. Cf. ll. 693, 1681, 2585, of the present poem, in all which instances the *d* in *rede* has the sound of *th*.

Recke, *pr. t. subj.* S. may reck, may care, 2047, 2511. Sir Tr. p. 124, &c.

Red, *n.* S. advice, counsel, 180, 518, 826, 1194, 2871, &c. *To rede*, lit. for a counsel, i.e. advisable, 118, 693; spelt *to rathe*, 2542.

Rede, *v.* S. to direct, advise, 104, 148, 361, 687, &c. *Radde*, *pa. t.* advised, 1353. V. Jam. in v. and Hearne's Gl. to R. Glouc.

Reft, Refte, Reftes. See [Reue](#).

Regne, *pr. t. pl.* Fr. Lat. reign, assume the superiority, 2586. *Reng*, *Ring*, Sc. V. Jam. in v.

Renne, *v.* S. to run, 1161, 1904. *Ran on blode*, *pa. t.* 432. So in Sir Tr. p. 176, *His heued ran on blod*; and in MS. Harl. 2253, f. 128,

Lutel wot hit any mon hou loue hym haueth y-bounden,
That for vs o the rode *ron*, ant bohte vs with is wounde.

Reue, *n.* S. magistrate, 1627. See [Greyue](#).

Reue, Reuen, *v.* S. [*reafian*] to take away, bereave, rob, 480, 2590, 2991. *Refte*, *pa. t.* took away, bereaved, 2223, 2485. *Reftes*, *pa. t.* 2 *p.* took away, 2394. *Reft*, *part. pa.* taken away, bereaved, 1367, 1672, 2483; spoiled, 2004. Still used in the North.

Reures, *n. pl.* S. robbers, bereavers, 2104.

Alle bacbiteres wendet to helle,
Robberes & *reueres* & the monquelle.

A lutel sermun, MS. Cal. A. ix. f. 246, b.

V. Jam. in v. *Reyffar*.

Reunesse, Rewnesse, *n.* S. compassion, 502, 2227.

Rewe, *v.* S. to have pity, to compassionate, 497, 967. *Rewede*, *pa. t.* (*impersonal*) 503.

Richelike, *adv.* S. richly, 421.

Ricth, Ricthe. See [Rith](#), [Rithe](#).

Ricthwise, *adj.* S. [*rihtwis*] righteous, just, 37. Rits., Web. M. R., Rob. Br., Minot, Lynds., R. Hood. [MS. *has rirth wise*.]

Riden, v. S. to ride, 10, &c.

Rig, *n.* S. back, 1775. So in Lazam. l. 6718. Burne he warp on *rigge*.

Rike, *n.* S. kingdom, 290. *Heuene riche*, 133, 407. See [Cunnriche](#).

Rim, Rym, *n.* S. Fr. rhyme, poem, 21, 2995, 2998. So Chauc. *Rime of Sire Thopas*. [The modern false spelling *rhyme* is due to confusion of Eng. *rime* with the Gk. *rhythm*.]

Ringen, v. S. to ring, 242, 1106. *Ringes*, *pr. t. sing.* ring, 390. *Rungen*, *part. pa.* rung, 1132.

Ringes, *n. pl.* S. rings of mail, 2740. See [Brini](#).

Rippe, *n.* fish-basket, 893. Hence a *Rippar*, B. Lat. *riparius*, is a person who brings fish from the coast to sell in the interior. V. Spelm. in v. Nares prefers the etymology of *ripa*, but without reason. *Rip* is still provincial for an osier basket. See Jam. and Moore. So also in a curious Latin and English Vocabulary, written out by Sire John Mendames, Parson of Broomstrop [Broomsthorp, Co. Norf.] in the middle of the 15th cent., and now preserved in the valuable MSS. library of T. W. Coke, Esq. *Cophinus* is explained *A beryng lepe*, or *ryppe*, terms still retained in the county. Jam. gives Icel. *hrip*, a basket.

Rith, Ricth, *n.* S. right, justice, inheritance, 36, 395, 1099, 1383, 2717.

Rith, *adj.* S. right (*dexter*), 604, 1812, 2140, 2545, 2725.

Rithe, Ricthe, *adj.* S. right (*rectus*), 772, 846, 1201, 2235, 2473.

Rith, Rithe, *adv.* S. rightly, 420, 1701, 2611, &c.; exactly, just, 872, 2494, 2506.

Ritte, v. to rip, make an incision, 2495.

The breche adoun he threst,
He *ritt*, and gan to right.

Sir Tristr. p. 33.

[Cf. Sw. *rista*, Dan. *riste*, to slash, cut; G. *ritzen*. Perhaps connected also with Du. *rijten*, G. *reissen*, to tear.]

Robben, v. S. to rob, 1958.

Rode, *n.* S. the rood, cross, 103, 431, 1357, &c. V. Todd's Gl. Illustr. Chauc.

Rof, *n.* S. roof, 2082.

Rome, *v.* S. to roam, travel about, 64.

Rore, *v.* S. to roar, 2496, &c. *Rorede*, *pa. t.* roared, 2438.

Roser, *n.* Fr. rose-bush, 2919. Chauc., Pers. Tale, *De luxuria*.

Rothe. See [Rathe](#).

Rowte, *v.* S. [*hrutan*] to roar, 1911. R. Cœur de L. 4304. V. Gl. Lynds. and Jam. in *v.* Cf. Icel. *hrjota*, Sw. *ryte*. The word is still retained in the provinces. V. Brockett and Wilbr.

Runci, *n.* B. Lat. a horse of burden, 2569. V. Du Cange and Spelm. The word is common both in Fr. and Engl. writers. Cf. Span. *Rozin-ante*.

Rungen. See [Ringen](#).

Rym. See [Rim](#).

S

Sal *for* Shall, 628.

Same *for* Shame, 1941. V. Jam.

Samen, *adv.* S. together, 467, 979, 1717, &c. Web., Rits. M. R., Rob. Br. So also in Sc. V. Jam.

Samened, *part. pa.* S. assembled, united, 2890. Web., R. Br. p. 2.

Sare, *adv.* S. sore, sorrowfully, 401.

Sat, *pa. t.* S. opposed, 2567. See [Atsitte](#). In Sc. is *Sit*, *Sist*, to stop, from Lat. *sistere*. V. Jam.

Sautres, *n. pl.* Fr. Lat. Psalters, Hymns for the Office of the Dead, 244.

Sawe, *written for* sa we, i.e. say we, 338.

Sawe, Sawen, Say. See [Se](#).

Sayse, *v.* B. Lat. to seise, give seisin or livery of land, 251, 2518. *Seysed*, *pa. t.* seised, 2931, *part. pa.* 2513. Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R. V. 3,

p. 309.

Scabbed, Skabbed, *adj.* S. Lat. scabby, scurvy, 2449, 2505.

Scape, *n.* S. harm, injury, 1352. *Scapes*, *pl.* 269. R. Br., V. Gl. *Skaith*, Sc. V. Jam.

Sche, Scho, Sho, *pron.* S. she, 112, 126, 649, 1721, &c.

Schifte *for* Shrift, absolution, 1829.

Schoten, Shoten, *pa. t. pl.* S. shot, cast, 1838, 1864. *Scuten*, 2431.

[<i>Shoten</i> , in l. 1838, means <i>rushed</i> , <i>darted</i> , <i>flew</i> .]
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Schulle, *n.* a plaice, 759. Sw. *skolla*, a plaice. See Coleridge's Glossarial Index.

Se (*the S. art.*) the, but perhaps a mistake of the scribe, l. 534, as it is not elsewhere used.

Se, *n.* S. sea, 535, &c.; *gen.* seis, 321.

Se, Sen, *v.* S. to see, 1021, 1273, &c. *Sest*, *pr. t.* 2 *p.* seest, 534. *Sen*, *pr. t. pl.* see, 168, 1217. *Sawe*, *Sowe*, *pa. t.* saw, 1182, 1323. *Say*, 881. *Sawen*, *Sowen*, *pa. t. pl.* 957, 1055, 2255. *Sene*, *part. pa.* 656.

Seckes, *n. pl.* S. sacks, 2019.

Segges, *n. pl.* Fr. [*seches*] 896. In Cotgr. the *Seche* is explained the Sound, or Cuttle fish. The *Seches de Coutance* were held in the highest estimation. V. Le Grand. See also Jam. *v.* *Sye*.

Sei, *v.* See [Seyen](#).

Seis. See [Se](#).

Seken, *v.* S. to seek, 1629. The reading is confirmed by an old poem in MS. Digb. 86.

Sire, we ben knizttes fer i-fare,
For to *sechen* wide-ware.

La vie seint Eustace, qui out noun Placidus.

Selcouth, *n.* S. wonder, strange thing, 124, 1059. *Selcuth*, 2119. It was in all probability originally an *adj.* as *Selkuth*. Strange, wonderful, 1284.

Sele, *n.* S. seal, 755.

Seli, *adj.* S. simple, harmless, 477, 499. R. Gl., Chauc.

Selthe, *n.* S. success, 1338. A.S. *sélð*. [Cf. *selehðe* in *Lazam*. l. 25136, and see *selehðe* in Stratmann's Dictionary of Old English. The line seems to be a proverb, and the meaning is— "Rest and success are companions." Goldborough tells him to avoid delay, since rest may accompany success, but cannot precede it.]

Sembling, *n.* Fr. assembling, 1018. It may also be compared with the Su.-G. *samlung*, conventus.

Semes, *pr. t.* in the phrase, *hire semes* = it beseems her, it becomes her, 2916. *Semedede*, *pa. t.* was suitable, was fit, 976. See *Seem* in Wedgwood.

Sen, Sene. See [Se](#).

Sendes, *pr. t.* sendeth, sends, 2392. *Sende*, *pa. t.* sent, 136, &c.

Serf-borw, *n.* S. surety, pledge, 1667. In MS. Soc. Antiq. No. 60, known by the name of *The Black Book of Peterborough*, is an instrument in which many names both of Saxon and Danish origin appear as the *Borhhanda*, or Sureties, otherwise called *Festermen*. See Jam. and the Glossaries, for further examples.

Serganz, *n. pl.* Fr. attendants, officers, 2088, 2091, 2116. *Sergaunz*, 1929, 2361, 2371. *Seriaunz*, 2066. V. Spelm. in v. *Servientes*, and Hickes, Thes. T. i. p. 148.

Serges. See [Cerges](#).

Serk, *n.* S. shirt, 603. Emaré, 501. R. Br.

Seruen, *v.* S. to serve, 1230.

Seruede, *pa. t.* S. deserved, 1914. Web. M. R. So in Sc. V. Jam.

Sest. See [Se](#).

Sette, *v.* S. to set, descend, 2671.

Sette, *pa. t.* S. set, placed, 2405; appointed, 2571. *Setten, pa. t. pl.* set, 1211. *Sette, part. pa.* set, placed, 2612.

Seyen, *v.* S. to say, 2886. *Seyst, pr. t. 2 p.* sayest, 2008. *Seyde, pa. t. 3 p.* said, 117, &c. *Seyden, pa. t. pl.* said, 376, 1213. *Seyden*, have said, 456. *Sey, part. pa.* said, 2993.

Seysed. See [Sayse](#).

Seyst. See [Seyen](#).

Seyt, *pr. t. s.* put for *seyt it*, i.e. say it; or else put for *seyth*, i.e. say, 647. So in Sir Tr. p. 117,

For mani men *seyt* ay whare.

Shaltou, shalt thou, 1800. *Shaltow*, 1322. *Shaltu*, 2180, 2186, 2882, 2901.

Shamelike, *adv.* S. shamefully, disgracefully, 2825. *Schamliche*, Sir Tr. p. 93.
.....

Shankes, *n. pl.* S. legs, 1903. *Sconke*, Lazam. l. 15215. See Rits. A. S. p. 16, and Diss. p. xxxi. *Schankis*, Sc. V. Jam.

Shar, *pa. t.* S. share, cut, 1413. So in Am. and Amil. 2298, Her throtes he *schar atvo*.

Shauwe, Shawe, *v.* S. to shew, 2206, 2784. *Sheu*, 1401.

Shel, Sheld, *n.* S. shield, 489, 624, 1653, &c.

Shende, *v.* S. to ruin, destroy, 1422. Bevis of H. ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 99. Chauc. *Shent, pa. t.* shamed, disgraced, 2749; *part. pa.* shend, 2845. The more common sense of this verb is the latter. V. Jam.

Shere. Clearly miswritten for *she were*, 1250.

Sheu. See [Shauwe](#).

Shides, *n. pl.* S. It here expresses pieces of wood cleft at the end, 917. In Doug. Virg. *Schide* signifies a billet of wood, 223, 10; or a chip, splinter, 207, 8. So in *Rauf Coilzear*, st. 39, Schaftes of schene wode they scheueride in *schides*. So also in P. Pl. The word is preserved in Lanc.

This custom of skinning eels by inserting the head in a cleft stick, is still practised, we are informed, in the fish markets.

Shir, *adj.* S. bright, 588, 916, 1253, &c.

Shireue, *n.* S. sheriff, 2286. *Shireues*, *pl.* 266.

Sho, *pron.* See [Sche](#).

Sho, *v.* S. to shoe, 1138.

Shof, *pa. t.* S. shoved, pushed, 871, 892.

Shol, *1 p. s.* (if I) shall, 1782. *Sal*, I shall, 628. *Shole*, *pl.* shall, 562, 645, 1788. *Shul*, 328. *Sholen*, 621, 1127, 1230, &c. *Shulen*, 731, 747, &c. *Shoren* (so in MS.), 1640. *Sule*, shall ye, will ye, 2419. *Shude*, I should, 1079. *Sholdest*, shouldst, 2712. *Sholden*, *pl.* 1020, 1195. *Shulden*, 941.

Sholdre, *n.* S. shoulder, 2738. *Shuldre*, 604, 1262. *Shudre-blade*, 2644. *Sholdres*, *pl.* shoulders, 1647, 1818. *Shuldren*, 982.

Shon, *n. pl.* S. shoes, 860, 969.

Shop, *qu.* Shok, shook, struck, destroyed, 1101. But Sewel gives Du. *schoppen*, to strike. Cf. Eng. *chop*.

Shotshipe, *n.* S. [*scot*, *symbolum*, *scipe*, *societas*] An assembly of persons who pay pecuniary contribution or reckoning, 2099.

For al Sikelines quiden
Sotscipe heo heolden,
And swa longe swa beoð æuere,
Ne scal hit stonde næuere.

Lazam. l. 23177.

Cf. *sotschipes*, *pl.* in Leg. of St. Kath. MS. Cott. Tit. D 18, fol. 144 *b.* See Nares, *v.* *Shot-clog*.

Shrede, *n.* S. a fragment, piece cut off, 99. [As it was given off the “board,” to “feed the poor,” it must mean a piece of bread or meat. Correct “*shrede* = clothing” in Coleridge’s Glossarial Index.]

Shres, *n.* S. shears, 857.

Shride, v. S. to clothe (himself), 963. *Shrid*, *part. pa.* clothed, 978.

Shriue, Shriuen, v. S. to confess, make confession, 362, 2598. *Shriue*, *Shriuen*, *part. pa.* 364, 2489.

Shrud, *n.* S. clothing, 303.

Shude, Shul, Shulen. See [Shol](#).

Shuldre, Shuldren. See [Sholdre](#).

Shuldreden, *pa. t. pl.* S. shouldered, 1056.

Sibbe, *adj.* S. related, allied, 2277. *Sir Tr.* p. 44. See [Fremde](#).

Siden, *n. pl.* S. sides, 371.

Sike, v. S. to sigh, 291.

Siking, *n.* S. sighing, 234.

Sikerlike, *adv.* S. surely, 422, 625, 2301, 2707, 2871. *Sikerly*, *Sir Tr.* p. 35, &c.

Sikernesse, *n.* S. surety, security, 2856. *R. Glouc.*, *R. Br.*, *Chauc.*

Simenels, *n. pl.* Fr. 779, a finer sort of bread, “q. a *simila* h. e. puriori farinae parte.” *Spelm.* Assis. pan. 51 Hen. III. *Symnellus* vero de quadrante ponderabit 2 sol. minus quam Wastellum. It elsewhere appears to be a sort of cake, or cracknel. So in the *Crieries de Paris*, v. 163, *Chaudes tartes et siminiaus*. V. Nares in v.

Sinne, *n.* S. fault, 1976. *Ne for loue ne for sinne*, 2375. *Wolde he nouth for sinne lette*, 2627. Traces of this phrase may be elsewhere found:

Neyther for love nor yet for awe
 Lyuinge man none than they saw.
Sir Degore, c. iv.

Maboun and Lybeaus
 Faste togedere hewes,
 And stente *for no synne*.
Ly Beaus Desc. 1957.

Sire, Syre, *n.* Fr. The term in ll. 310, 1229, is used not only to express respect, but command. A parallel passage is in R. Cœur de L. 2247. It simply means *Sir*, ll. 909, 2009.

Site, *v.* S. to sit, 2809. *Sittes*, *pr. t. 2 p.* sittest, 1316. *Sitten*, *pr. t. pl.* sit, 2098. *Site on knes*, i.e. kneel, 2708.

Sipe, Sipen, *adv.* S. then, afterwards, after, 399, 472, 1414, 1814, 1988, &c.

Sipe, *n.* S. time, 1052. *Sipe*, *Sipes*, *pl.* 213, 778, 1737, 2189. *Sybe*, *Sybes*, 2162, 2843. *Sir Tr.* p. 55, &c.

Sket, *adv.* quickly, soon, 1926, 1960, 2303, 2493, 2513, 2574, 2736, 2839. *Sir Tr.* pp. 36, 40, &c.; Ly Beaus Desc. 484; K. Alisaund. 3047; R. Cœur de L. 806; Rom. of Merlin, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. i. p. 228. [Icel. *skjótt*, quickly, from *skjótr*, quick, swift. The adj. is still preserved in the surname Skeat or Skeet.]

Skirming, *n.* Fr. skirmishing, 2323. Web. M. R. See [Note on l. 2320](#).

Slawe, Slawen. See [Slo](#).

Slenge, *v.* S. to sling, cast out, 2435. *Slenget*, *part. pa.* slung, 1923.

Slepes, *pr. t. 2 p.* sleepest, 1283.

Sleie, Sley, *adj.* skilful, expert, 1084, 2116. *Sir Tr.* pp. 23, 28; Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R. V. 3, p. 296; Emare, 67; R. Glouc. p. 350; Barb. xix. 179; Doug. 137, 12. Jamieson derives it from Su.-G. *slug*, Isl. *slægr*. Cf. Sw. *slug*.

Slike, *adv. or perhaps adj.* smoothly, or smooth, 1157. “*Slyke*, or smothe. *Lenis*.” Prompt. Parv.

Slo, *n.* S. sloe, berry, 849, 2051.

Slo, *v.* S. to slay, 512, 1364, 1412, &c. *Slou*, 2543. *Slos*, *pr. t. 2 p.* slayest, 2706. *Slos*, *imp. pl.* strike ye, 2596. *Slou*, *Slow*, *pa. t.* slew, 501; struck, 2633. *Slowe*, *Slowen*, *pa. t. pl.* slew, 2414, 2427, 2432; struck, fought, 2683. *Slawe*, *Slawen*, *part. pa.* slain, 1803, 1928, 2000, &c. In l. 2747 (as in 2596, 2633, 2683) it has only the sense of *struck*, wounded, agreeably to the signification of the original word, *sleán*, *sleáhan*, Cædere, ferire.

Smerte, *adj. pl.* S. painful, 2055.

Smerte, *v.* S. to smart, 2647.

Smot, *pa. t.* S. smote, 2654.

So, a large tub, 933. See *So* in Halliwell. Dan. *saa*, a pail.

So, *conj.* S. as, 279, 349, *et pass.*

Softe, *adj.* S. of a mild disposition, 991.

Softe, *adv.* S. gently, 2618.

Somdel, *adj.* S. somewhat, in some measure, 240. *Sumdel*, 450, 497, 1054, 2306, 2950. Web., R. Gl., Chauc.

Sond, *n.* S. sand, 708, 735.

Sone, *n.* S. son, 660, 839. *Sones*, *pl.* 2980.

Sone, *adv.* S. soon, 78, &c.; so soon as, 1354.

Sor, *n.* S. sorrow, 234. *Sorwe*, 1374; pain, sore, 1988.

Sor, *adj.* S. sore, detestable, 2229. [Perhaps it should be *sori*.]

Sorful, *adj.* S. sorrowful, 151, 2541.

Sori, *adj.* S. sorrowful, 151, 477.

Soth, Sothe, *n.* S. truth, 36, 647, 2008, &c.

Soplike, *adv.* S. truly, 276.

Soupe, *v.* Fr. to sup, 1766.

Southe, *pa. t.* S. sought, 1085.

Sowe, Sowen. See [Se](#).

Sowel, *n.* victuals, 767, 1143, 2905. Properly, anything eaten with bread as a relish. See *Sool* in Halliwell. Dan. *suul*.

Span-newe, *adj.* quite new, 968. This is the earliest instance on record of the use of this word. For its disputed etymology see Jam., Nares, Todd's Johns., and Thoms. Etymons; but especially Wedgwood's Etym. Dict.

Span = chip; *Span-new*, chip-new. A.S. *spón*. It occurs in Chauc. Troil. iii. 1671.

Sparkede, *pa. t.* S. sparkled, 2144.

Spede, *v.* S. to speed, prosper, 1634.

Speke, *n.* S. speech, 946.

Speke, Speken, *v.* S. to speak, 326, 369, 548, 1070, &c. *Spak*, *pa. t.* spoke, 2389, 2968. *Speken*, *part. pa.* spoken, 2369.

Spelle, *n.* S. story, relation, 338. K. Horn, 951.

Spelle, *v.* S. to relate, tell forth, 15, 2530.

Spen *for* Spent, 1819.

Sperd, Sperde, *part. pa.* S. barred, bolted, 414, 448. Still common in the North. V. Brockett.

Spille, *v.* S. to perish, 2422. *Of limes spille*, 86, suffer the loss of limbs. K. Horn, 202. Web., Chauc.

Spired, *part. pa.* S. speered, inquired, 2620. V. Jam. in *v.*

Spore, *n.* S. spur, 2569.

Sprauleden, *pa. t. pl.* S. sprawled, 475.

Sprong, *pa. t.* S. sprung, 959. See the Note. *Sprongen*, 869. *Sprungen*, *part. pa.* risen, 1131.

Sprote, *n.* S. sprout, 1142. A.S. *sprote*, a sprig, sprout.

Spuse, Spusen, *v.* S. to espouse, marry, 1123, 1170, 2875. *Spusede*, *pa. t. pl.* espoused, 2887. *Spused*, *part. pa.* 1175, 2928. *Spuset*, 1266.

Spusing, *n.* S. espousals, marriage, 1164, 1177, 2886.

Stac, *n.* S. 814. [This I believe to mean simply a stack, or heap, like the Dan. *stak*, Sw. *stack*. I add Sir F. Madden's note in the edition of 1828.] A stack, or, more properly, *stick* of fish, a term applied to eels when strung on a row, 'sic dicta, quod trajecta vimine (quod *stic* dicimus)

connectebantur.' *Spelm.* A *stica* consisted of 25 eels, and 10 *Sticæ* made a *Binde*. Glanv. lib. 2, c. 9.

Stalworpi, Stalworpe, Stalwrthe, adj. S. strong, valiant, courageous, 24, 904, 1027, &c. *Stalworpeste*, *sup.* 25.

Stan-ded, *adj.* S. dead as a stone, completely dead, 1815. *Stille als a ston*, 928. Cf. K. of Tars, 549; Erle of Tol. 754; Launfal, 357. See Gl. to *Partenay*.

Star, *n.* Icel. a species of sedge, 939. Icel. *stör*; Sw. *starr*; Dan. *stær*. See the Note.

Stareden, *pt. t. pl.* 1037. Probably miswritten for Stradden, contended. Cf. Su.-Goth. and Sw. *strida*, to contend.

Starinde, *part. pr.* staring, 508.

Stark, *adj.* S. stiff, stout, strong, 341, 380, 608, &c. V. Jam. in v.

Stede, *n.* S. steed, horse, 10, &c.

Stede, *n.* S. place, 142, 744. *Stedes*, *pl.* 1846.

Stem, *n.* S. a ray of light, beam, 591. It is equivalent to *Glem*, l. 2122.

Therewith he blinded them so close,
A *stime* they could not see.

R. Hood, l. 112.

Cf. Brockett's Gl. in v. *Stime*.

Sternes, *n. pl.* stars, 1809. *Ageyn þe sternes* = exposed to the sky, or to the open air.

Stert, *n.* S. leap, 1873. Chaucer has *at a stert* for immediately, C. T. 1707.

Stert, *n.* S. [*steort*, cauda] tail, 2323. *Start* is still retained in the North.

Steuene, *n.* S. voice, 1275.

Sti, *n.* S. road, way, 2618. Sir Tr. p. 192; Yw. and Gaw. 599; Emare, 196; Sevyng Sages, 712; R. Br. Chaucer uses *stile* in the same sense, C. T. 12628, and Minot, p. 5, in both which passages the respective Editors have made the same mistake in explaining it. [Cf. G. *steg*, a pass.]

Stille, *adj.* S. quiet, 955, 2309.

Stille, *adv.* S. in a low voice, secretly, 2997. Sir Tr. p. 55; K. Horn, 315.

Stirt, Stirte, *pa. t.* S. started, leaped, 398, 566, 873, 1049, &c. *Stirte, Stirten, pa. t. pl.* started, hurried, 599, 1964, 2609. Derived by Skinner from S. *astirian*, movere, by Jam. from Teut. *steerten*, volare. See [Astirte](#). Cf. G. *stürzen*; and see *Start* in Wedgwood.

Stith, *n.* S. anvil, 1877. Chauc. Still provincial. V. Moore, and Brockett.

Stiward, *n.* S. steward, 666.

Stonden, *n.* S. to stand, 689. *Stondes, pr. t. 3 p.* standeth, stands, 2240, 2983. *Stod, pa. t.* stood, 591, 679. *Stoden, pa. t. pl.* 1037.

Stor, *adj.* S. hardy, stout, 2383. Lazam. l. 9126; Yw. and Gaw. 1297; Chron. of Engl. 464; Sq. of Lowe D. 658; Ly Beaus Desc. 1766. *Steir, Sture, Sc. ap. Jam.* Cf. Sw. *stor*.

Stra, *n.* S. straw, 315, 466. A.S. *streow, streaw*. Cf. [Strie](#).

Strenes, *pr. t. 3 p.* S. begets, 2983. From *streónan*, gignere. Cf. K. Alisaund. 7057.

Strie, *n.* a straw, 998. See [Stra](#).

Strout, *n.* dispute, contention, 1039. Cf. A.S. *strúdan*, and *Strother* in Atkinson's Cleveland Glossary.

Stroute, *v.* S. to make a disturbance, 1779. Bosworth explains A.S. *strúdan, strútian*, as having originally the sense to bustle about.

Stunde, *n.* S. short space of time, 2614. V. Gl. to R. Glouc. See [Vmbestonde](#).

Sturgiun, Sturgun, *n.* sturgeon, 753, 1727. Cf. Sw. *stör*, Dan. *stör*.

Suere, Suereth. See [Sweren](#).

Suete, *adj.* S. sweet, 1388. Cf. l. 2927.

Sueyn, Sweyn, *n.* S. swain, villain, 343, 1328, &c. *Sweynes, pl.* 371, 2195. It is generally used in opposition to *knight*.

Svich, *adj.* S. such, 60.

Suilk, *adj.* such (things), 644. See [Swilk](#).

Sule. See [Shol](#).

Sumdel. See [Somdel](#).

Sunne-bem, *n.* S. sun-beam, 592, 2123.

Swerd, *n.* S. sword, 1759, &c. *Swerdes*, *pl.* 1769, 2659.

Sweren, *v.* S. to swear, 494. *Suereth*, *pr. t. s.* swear, 647. *Swor*, *pa. t.* swore, 398, 2367. *Suere*, *pr. subj. 2 p. s.* 388.

Swike, *n.* S. deceiver, traitor, 423, 551, 626, 1158, 2401, 2451, &c. *Swikes*, *pl.* 2834, 2990. *Lazam. l.* 12942; *R. Gl. p.* 105.

Swikel, *adj.* S. deceitful, 1108.

For alle þine witien

Beoð swiðe swikele.

Lazam. l. 15848.

Hoe beth of swikele kunne

Ther mide the witherwinne.

The sawe of Seint Bede, MS. Digb. 86.

He was suikel, fals, ant fel.

Chron. of Engl. 791.

Swilen, *v.* S. [*swilian*, Ps. vi. 6] to wash, 919. It occurs also in Rob. of Brunne's *Handling Sinne*, l. 5828. Still provincial.

Swilk, *adj.* S. such, 1118, 1625, 2123, 2684, 2783. *Suilk*, 644.

Swinge, *v.* S. to beat, chastise (used *passively*), 214. *Swngen*, *part. pa.* beaten, 226. *Lazam. l.* 21070. So in *Syr Bevys*, C. ii. All at ones on him they *swonge*. In the North the verb retains the same meaning; *v.* Brockett.

Swink, *n.* S. labour, 770, 801, 2456.

Swinken, *v.* S. to labour, 798. *Swank*, *pa. t.* laboured, 788.

Swire, *n.* S. neck, 311. Formerly in universal use, and still preserved in the provinces.

Swipe, Swype, *adv.* S. very, exceedingly, 110, 217, 341. Quickly, 140, 682, 690; *ful swithe*, 2436, appears a pleonasm. *Swithe forth and rathe*, quickly forth, and soon, 2594.

Swot, *n.* S. sweat, perspiration, 2662. The word has the same meaning in Cædmon, f. 24, ed. Thorpe, p. 31, l. 8, which seems to contradict Mr Price's assertion to the contrary, in Warton's Hist. Engl. Poetr. p. lxxi., ed. 1840.

Swngen. See [Swinge](#).

Syre. See [Sire](#).

Sype, Sypes. See [Sipe](#).

Sype, *n.* S. scythe, 2553, 2699.

[T](#)

Tabour, *n.* Fr. tabor, 2329.

Tale, *n.* S. number, 2026.

Taleuaces, *n. pl.* Fr. large shields, 2323. See the Note on l. 2320.

Tarst (*so in MS.*), 2688; almost certainly an error for *faste*, which appears in the next line. Also, the movements of Godard are compared to the course of lightning.

Tauhte, *pt. s.* committed, 2214, probably an error for *bitauhte*. See [Bitaken](#).

Tel, *n.* S. deceit, reproach, 191, 2219. A.S. *tálu*.

Telle, *v.* S. to count, number, 2615. *Told, part. pa.* numbered, esteemed, 1036.

Tene, *n.* S. grief, affliction, 729.

Tere, *v.* S. to tar (used passively), 707.

Teth, *n. pl.* S. teeth, 2406.

Teyte, *adj.* S. 1841, 2331. [Explained “lively” by Coleridge, Stratmann, and Morris, as if from Icel. *teitr*, *hilaris*. This I believe to be completely wrong. The word occurs in Allit. Poems, ed. Morris, B. 871, with reference to *tight* lasses, and in l. 1841 of Havelok we have a reference to *tight* lads. In l. 2331 it may also mean *flawless*, *staunch*. “*Theet*, *adj.* water-tight. O.N. *þiettr* or *þéttr*, *densus*, *solidus*. O.Sw. *thæter*, Sw. Dial, *tjett* or *tjætt*, Dan. *tætt*, Germ. *dicht*. Ihre gives . . . *ett tätt fat*, a flawless vessel. ‘*Thyht*, hool fro brekyng, not brokyn. *Integer*, *solidus*. Prompt. Parv.’” Atkinson’s Glossary of the Cleveland dialect.]

[*Teyte* may mean *lively*. My explanation is not generally accepted.]

See [Endnote](#).

Ða, *written for* þat, 175.

Ðan, Ðanne, *adv.* S. then, 51, 1044, &c.; when, 226, 248, *et sæpius*; than if (*quàm*), 944, 1867.

Ðar, *adv.* where (?) 130. See the Note; and cf. [þer](#).

Ðare, *adv.* S. there, 2481, 2739. Cf. þer, þore.

Ðarne, *v.* to lose, be deprived of, 2492, 2835. *Ðarnes*, *pr. t.* wants, is deprived of, 1913. *Ðarned the ded*, 1687; [clearly miswritten for *þoled þe ded*, suffered death. The scribe was thinking of *þarned þe lif*; cf. l. 2492.] The verb only exists in the Sax. in the pt. t. *þærnode*, Chron. Sax. p. 222, ed. Gibs., which is derived by Lye from the Cimbr. *At thuerna*, or *thorna*, *diminui*, *privari*. V. Hickes Thes. i. p. 152. [I.e. it is from the root of the Sw. *tarfva*, Icel. *thurfa*, Goth. *thaurban*, with the *f* dropped, and with the addition of the *passive* or *neuter* infinitive-ending denoted by *-ne*, like *-na* in Sw., *-nan* in Mæso-Gothic. See *þarnenn* in Gl. to Ormulum.]

Ðas, *read* Was, 1129. [As þ at the beginning of a word is never put for *t*, it is not = Sc. *tas*, takes, as some have suggested.]

Ðaue, *v.* S. [*þafian*] to grant, 296; bear, sustain, 2696. Ormulum, 5457.

Thayn, *n.* S. nobleman, 2184. *Thein*, 2466. *Thaynes*, *pl.* 2260. *Theynes*, 2194. See [Kayn](#).

Ðe, *n.* S. thigh, 1950. *Ðhe*, 1984. *Ðes*, *pl.* 1903. *Ðhes*, 2289.

Ðe, *adv.* S. (*written for þer*), there, 142, 476, 863, 933. *Ðe with*, therewith, 639. See [þer](#).

Ðe, *conj.* S. though, 1682. *Ðei*, 1966. *Ðey*, 807, 992, 1165, 2501. See [þou](#).

Ðede, *n.* S. country, dwelling, 105; place, 2890. Web., Le Bone Flor. 246. R. Br. p. 18. V. Jam.

Ðef, *n.* S. thief, 2434. *Ðeues*, *pl.* 1780.

Ðei, *pron.* S. they, 1020, 1195, &c.

Ðei, Ðey, *conj.* though. See [þe](#).

Ðenke, *pr. subj.* S. think, 2394. *Ðenkeste*, *pr. t. 2 p.* thinkest thou, 578.

Ðenne, *adv.* S. thence, 1185. [Perhaps in l. 777, we should put the comma after *þenne*; “when he came thence,” &c.]

Ðer, *adv.* S. where, 318, 448, &c.; there, *passim*; the place whence, 1740. *Ðerinne*, therein, 535, &c. *Ðerhinne*, 322. *Ðerof*, *Ðeroffe*, thereof, 372, 466, 1068, &c. *Ðerþoru*, by that means, 1098. *Ðertil*, *Ðerto*, thereto, 396, 1041, 1045. *Ðerwit*, *Ðerwith*, therewith, 1031, 1046. See [þe](#), [þore](#).

Ðere, *pron.* S. their, 1350.

Ðerl *for* Ðe erl, the earl, 178.

Ðertekene, 2878. [Coleridge’s Glossarial Index has “Thertekene = mark thereto. A.S. *tácnian*.” But this is a very awkward phrase, and I should prefer to suppose *þer-tekene* = by the token, i.e. in token. *Tekene* answers to the Sw. *tecken*, a token; and *þer* is found as a prefix in *P. Plowman* in the phr. *þer-while* = *þe while*, i.e. in the time that. The only difficulty is that *þer* is properly feminine (A.S. *þære*), whilst *tecken* in Sw. and *tácen* in A.S. are neuter. *In tokne* (= in token) occurs in Shoreham’s poems, ed. Wright, 131.]

Ðet, *conj.* S. that (*quòd*), 330.

Ðet, *pron.* S. that, 879.

Ðeþe, Ðeþen, *adv.* S. thence, 2498, 2629.

Ðeu, Ðewe, *n.* S. in a servile condition or station, 262, 2205. R. Gl.

þewes, *n. pl.* S. manners, 282. *Lazam.*, Rits. M. R., Web., P. Plowm.,
Chauc., Gl. Lynds., Percy, A. R.

þi. See [Forþi](#).

þi for þy, thy, 2725.

þider, *adv.* S. thither, 850, 1012, 1021, &c.

þigge, *v.* S. [*þicgan*] to beg, 1373. This word is chiefly preserved in the Sc.
writers. Wall. ii. 259; Doug. Virg. 182, 37; Evergreen, ii. 199; Bannatyne
Poems, p. 120, V. Jam. in v., who derives it from Su.-G. *tigga*, Alem.
thigen, petere. [See *tigga* in Ihre. “Thyggyng or beggyng,
Mendicacio.” Prompt. Parv.]

þis for þise, these, 1145.

þisternesse, *n.* S. darkness, 2191.

Dalden from þan fihte

Al bi þustere nihte.

Lazam. l. 7567; cf. *Gen. and Ex.*, 58.

Thit, *pp.* 2990. [The rime shews that the *i* is long; and, whether the *th* is
sounded like *t*, or (which is more likely) the word should have been
written *tiht* or *tith*, we may be tolerably confident that it is equivalent to
the O.E. *tight* or *tigt*, a *pp.* signifying *intended*, *purposed*, *designed*,
which is the exact sense here required. Stratmann gives five instances of
it, of which one is— “To brewe the Crystene mennys banys Hy hadden
tyght,” Octovian, 1476.]

þo, *pron.* S. those, 1918, 2044.

þo, *pron.* thou. See [þu](#).

þo, *adv.* S. then, 930; when, 1047. *Thow*, 1669.

þore, *adv.* S. there, 741, 922, 1014, &c. *Þortil*, thereto, 1443. *Þorwit*,
therewith, 100. See [þe](#), [þer](#).

þoru, *adv.* S. through, 627, 774, 848, &c. *Þoruth*, 1065, 2786. *Þorw*, 264,
367, 2646. *Puruth*, 52.

þoruthlike, *adv.* S. thoroughly, 680.

Þou, *conj.* S. though, 124, 299, &c. Þo, 1020. See [þe](#).

Þoucte, *pa. t.* S. thought, 504, 507, &c. Þouthte, 1073. Þowthe, 1869.

Þouthte, 1166. *Þat god thoucte*, 256, that seemed good. Cf. *Sir Tr.* pp. 30, 36. And so in MS. Vernon, Bodl.

Riche metes was forth brouht
To all men *that gode thouht*.

Disp. betw. a Crystene mon and a Jew, f. 301.

[Or, if we read “*þat god him þoucte*,” this would mean “that seemed good to him;” cf. l. 197.]

Þouth, *n.* S. thought, 122, 1190.

Þral, *n.* S. slave, villain, 527, 684, 1097, 1158, 2564, 2589. In an opprobrious sense, 1408. *Sir Tr.* p. 175.

Þrawe, *n.* S. space of time, moment, 276, 1215. Web., Rits. M. R., Rob. Br., Doug. Virg. Þrow, Chauc., Gower, &c.

Þredde, Þridde, *adj.* S. third, 867, 2633.

Þrette, *pa. t.* S. threatened, 1163.

Þrie, 730. [In the former edition it is glossed “trouble, affliction; apparently the same as *Tray* or *Trey*,” cf. A.S. *tréga*. But this renders the construction difficult, nor is it clear that *trey* and *þrie* can be identified. Without doubt, the usual meaning of *þrie* is *thrice*, which is easily construed, only it remains to be shewn why *thrice* should be introduced; unless perhaps it signifies *in a threefold degree*.]

Þrinne, *num.* S. three, 716, 761, 1977, 2091.

Þrist, Þristen, *v.* S. to thrust, 1152, 2019, 2725. *Þrist, part. pa.* thrust, 638.

Þu, *pron.* S. thou, 527, &c. Þou, 527, &c. Þo, 388. Þw (*read þat þw instead of þw that?*), 1316. Tow, 1322. Tu, 2903. It is often joined to the verb which precedes, as *Shaltow*, *Wiltu*, &c. The *gen.* is *þin*, 1128; the *acc.* is *þe*, 529.

Þurte, *pt. t. s.* need, might, 10. [It answers to the A.S. *þurfan*, *pt. t. ic þorfte*, Icel. *þurfa*, *pt. t. þurfti*, Mæso-Goth. *þaurban*, *pt. t. þaurfta*. See

Ormulum, l. 16164, and Sir F. Madden's note to *port* in Gl. to *Will. of Palerne*.]

Þuruth. See [Þoru](#).

Þus for Þis, 785, 2586. (*In comp.* þus-gate.)

Tid, *n.* S. time, hour, 2100.

Til, *prep.* S. to, 141, 762, 864, &c. See [Intil](#), [Þertil](#).

Til, *v.* S. to tell, 1348.

Tilled, *part. pa.* S. obtained, acquired (lit. drawn, taken), 438. V. Gl. R. Br. in *v. tille*, and see quotation under *Goddot*.

Tinte, *pa. t.* S. lost, 2023. Sir Tr. p. 104. V. Jam.

Tirnedén, *pa. t. pl.* S. turned, 603.

Tiþandes, *n. pl.* Icel. tidings, 2279.

To-, in composition with verbs, is usually augmentative, or has the force of the Lat. *dis-*. *To-brised*, *part. pa.* very much bruised, 1950. (See [Brisen](#).) *To-cruhsse*, *inf.* crush in pieces, 1992. *To-deyle*, *inf.* divide, 2099. (See [Deled](#).) *To-drawen*, *part. pa.* dragged or pulled to death, 2001. (See [Drou](#).) *To-frusshe*, *inf.* break in pieces, 1993. *To-hewen*, *part. pa.* hewn in pieces, 2001. *To-riuen*, *part. pa.* torn or riven in pieces, 1953. *To-rof*, *pa. t.* burst open, 1792. *To-shiuere*, *inf.* shiver in pieces, 1993. *To-shiuered*, *part. pa.* shivered to pieces, 2667. *To-tere*, *inf.* tear in pieces, 1839. *To-torn*, *part. pa.* torn in pieces, 1948, 2021. *To-tusede*, *part. pa.* entirely rumped or tumbled, 1948. In one case only we find it to be merely the *prep. to* in composition; viz. in *To-yede*, *pa. t.* went to, 765. (See [Yede](#).) [See note on this prefix in Gloss. to *William of Palerne*.]

To, *adv.* S. too, 303, 689, 691, &c.

To, *n.* S. toe, 1743, 1847, &c. *Tos*, *pl.* 898, 2163.

To, *num.* S. two, 2664.

To, *prep.* follows its case in ll. 197, 325, 526.

To-frusshe, *v.* Fr. [*froisser*] to dash or break in pieces, 1993.

The Sarezynes layde on with mace,
And al *to-frussched* hym in the place.

R. Cœur de L. 5032. Cf. 5084.

He suld sone be *to-fruschyt* all.

Barb. x. 597.

So also Doug. Virg. 51, 53. V. Jam. in v. *Frusch*.

Togidere, Togydere, *adv.* S. together, 1128, 1181, 2683, 2891.

Tok, *pa. t.* S. took, 354, 467, 537. *Toke, pa. t. 2 p.* 1216. *Token, pa. t. pl.* 1194, *Token under fote*, 1199.

Told. See [Telle](#).

Totede, *pa. t.* peeped, looked, 2106. This verb is thrice found in P. Ploughman's Crede, ll. 142, 168, 339. Although it would appear a rare word from its not appearing in Hearne, Ritson, or Weber, yet in later times it, occurs often, and is instanced by Jamieson from Patten's Account of Somerset's Expedition, p. 53, and by Nares from Hall, Latimer, Spenser, and Fairfax. It also occurs four times in the *Ancren Riwe*, ed. Morton, 1853. In Sc. it is pronounced *Tete*, which is derived by Jam. from the same stock as Su.-G. *titt-a*, explained by Ihre, "Per transennam veluti videre, ut solent curiosi, aut post tegmina latentes." V. the authorities quoted, Todd's Johns. and Wilbr. Gl. [Cf. Sw. *titta*; Dan. *titte*, to peep; Dan. *tittelege*, to play at bopeep.]

To-tusede, *part. pa.* entirely rumped or tumbled, 1948. See Nares, in v. *Tose*, and *Tousle*, *Toozle*, in Jam., Brockett, &c. Cf. G. *zausen*.

Toun, *n.* S. town, 1750, &c. *Tun*, 764, 1001, &c. *Tunes, pl.* 1444, 2277.

Tour, *n.* Fr. tower, 2073.

Tre, *n.* S. a bar or staff of wood, 1022, 1821, 1843, 1882, &c. *Dore-tre*, 1806, 1968, bar of the door.

Trewe, *adj.* S. true. 1756.

Tristen, v. to trust, 253.

Tro. See [Trowe](#).

Trome, *n.* S. [*truma*] a troop, company, 8.

Heo makeden heore sceld-*trome*

Lazam. l. 9454.

Bisydes stondeth a feondes *trume*,

And waiileth hwenne the saules cume.

Les Unze peyne, &c. MS. Coll. Jes. 29.

The same mode of expression used above occurs lower down, l. 24, “A stalworpi man in a *flok*,” which is also found in *Lazamon*,

Cador ther wes æc,

þe kene wes on *flocke*.

—l. 23824.

And in *Sir Guy*, H. iii.

Then came a knight that hight Sadock,

A doughty man in every *flock*.

Trone, *n.* Lat. throne, 1316.

Trowe, *n.* S. to believe, trust, 1656. *Tro*, 2862. *Trowede*, *pa. t.* believed, 382. *Sir Tr.* p. 41.

Trusse, *v.* Fr. [*trousser*] to pack up, to truss, 2017. R. Gl. Hence to *make ready*, K. Alisaund. 7006. Minot, p. 50, which Ritson was unable to explain.

Tuenti, *num.* S. twenty, 259.

Tumberel, *n.* a porpoise, 757. In Spelm. *Timberellus* is explained, a small whale, on the authority of Skene, Vocab. Jur. Scot. L. Forest, *Si quis cetum*. In Cotgr. also we find “*Tumbe*, the great Sea-Dragon, or Quadririver; also the Gurnard, called so at Roan.” [But the Sw. *tumlare*, a porpoise, *lit.* a tumbler, suggests that the name may be given from its *tumbling* or *rolling*. The Dan. *tumler*, however, is a dolphin.]

Tun. See [Toun](#).

Turues, *n. pl.* S. turf, peat, 939. Chauc. C. T. 10109. V. Spelm. in *v.* and Jennings’ Somersetsh. Gl.

Twel *for* Twelve, 2455.

U

Ueneysun, *n.* Fr. venison, 1726.

Vmbestonde, *adv.* S. for a while, formerly, 2297.

& heo seileden forth,
þæt inne sæ heo comen,
þa *vmbe stunde*
ne sæge heo noht of londe.

Lazam. l. 11967.

It is equivalent to *umbe-while* or *vmwhile*, Sc. *umquhile*. See [Stunde](#).

Umbistode, *pa. t.* S. stood around, 1875. See [Bistode](#), [Stonden](#).

Vn-bi-yeden, *pa. t. pl.* S. surrounded, 1842. See [Yede](#).

Vnblithe, *adj.* S. unhappy, 141. Sir Tr. p. 171.

Unbounden, *pa. t. pl.* S. unbound, 601.

Underfong, *pa. t.* S. understood, 115. This sense of the verb is not found elsewhere. It is in the present poem synonymous with *Understod* (as Lat. *accipere*, *percipere*).

Understonde, *v.* S. to receive, 2814. *Understod*, *pa. t.* received, 1760.

Understonde, *pr. subj.* receive, 1159. So in K. Horn, 245, ed. Rits.

Horn child thou *vnderstond*,
Tech him of harpe and song.

where the MS. Laud 108 reads *vnderfonge*. See Lumby's ed. l. 239.

Unker, *pron. g. c. dual.* S. of you two, 1882.

Vnkeueleden, *pa. t. pl.* S. ungagged, 601. See [Keuel](#).

Unkyndelike, *adv.* S. unsuitably, 1250.

Vnornelike, *adj.* S. basely, or degradingly, 1941. The only word in the Sax. remaining to which it can be referred, is *unornlic*, tritus, Jos. 9. 5. The following instances also approach the same stock:

Ne speke y nout with Horne,
Nis he nout so *vnorne*.

K. Horn, 337.

Mi stefne is bold & noȝt *vnorne*,
Ho is ilich one grete horne,
& þin is ilich one pipe.

Hule and Niztingale, l. 317.

[Ihre shews that Icel. and Su.-Goth. *orna* mean to acquire vital heat, to grow warm. Hence *unorne* means unfervent, spiritless, feeble, old. Thus, in the *Hule and Niztingale* it means *feeble, weak*; in Jos. 9. 5, it is used of *old, worn-out* shoes. In the Ormulum, *unnorne* occurs frequently, in the sense of *poor, mean, feeble*; see ll. 827, 3668; also *unnornelig*, meaning *meanly, humbly, obscurely*, in ll. 3750, 4858, 7525, 8251.]

Unride, *adj.* S. [*ungereod, ungerydu*] It is here used in various significations, most of which, however, correspond to the senses given by Somner. Large, cumbersome (of a garment), 964; unwieldy (of the bar of a door), 1795; deep, wide (of a wound), 1981, 2673; numerous, extensive (of the nobility), 2947. *Unrideste, sup.* deepest, widest, 1985. In the second sense we find it in Sir Tristr. p. 167,

Dartes wel *unride*
Beliagog set gan.

And in *Guy of Warwick*, ap. Ellis, M. R. V. 2, p. 79.

A targe he had ywrought full well,
Other metal was ther none but steel,
A mickle and *unrede*.

In the fourth sense we have these examples:

Opon Ingland for to were
With stout ost and *unride*.

Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R. V. 3, p. 283.

Schir Rannald raugh to the renk ane rout wes *unryde*.

Sir Gaw. and Gol. ii. 25.

The soudan gederet an ost *unryde*.

K. of Tars, 142.

Cf. also *Sir Guy*, Ee. iv. in Garrick's Collect. 'Ameraunt drue out a swerde *unryde*.' In the sense of huge, or unwieldy, we may also understand it in *Sir Tr.* p. 148, 164; *Guy of Warw.* ap. Ell. M. R. V. 2, p. 78; *Horn Childe*, ap. Rits. V. 3, p. 295. In R. Brunne, p. 174, it expresses loud, tremendous. Sir W. Scott and Hearne are both at fault in their Glossaries, and even Jamieson has done but little to set them right, beyond giving the true derivation, and then, under the cognate word *Unrude*, Doug. Virg. 167, 35, &c., errs from pure love of theory.

Vnrith, *n.* S. injustice, 1369.

Unwrast, *Unwraste*, *adj.* S. [*unwræste*] feeble, worthless, 2821; rotten, 547. This word occurs in the Saxon Chron. 168, 4 (ed. Thorpe, p. 321), applied to a rotten ship, and this appears to have been the original meaning. The sense in which it was subsequently used may be learnt by comparing *Lazam.* ll. 13943, 29609; *R. Gl.* p. 586; *Chron. of Engl.* 662, 921; *Ly Beaus Desc.* 2118 (not explained by Rits.); *K. Alisaund.* 878; *R. Cœur de L.* 872, and *Sevyn Sages*, 1917. It is not found in *Jam.* Cf. *A.S. wræst*, firm.

Uoyz, *n.* Lat. voice, 1264.

Vre, *pron.* S. our, 13, 596, &c.

Vt, *prep.* S. out, 89, 155, &c. *Uth*, 346, 1178.

Ut-bidde. See [Bidd](#).

Ut-drawe, *Ut-drawn*, *Vt-drow*, *Ut-drown*. See [Drou](#).

Uten, *prep.* S. out, exhausted, 842; without, foreign, as in *Uten-laddes*, 2153, 2580, foreigners.

Ut-lede. See [Lede](#).

Utrage, *n.* S. outrage, 2837.

[W](#)

W. See [Hw](#).

Wa, *n.* S. woe, wail, 465.

Wade, v. S. Lat. to pass, go, 2645. *Wede*, 2387, 2641. Vid. Nares.

Wagge, v. S. to wield, brandish, 89.

Waiten, Wayte, Wayten, v. Fr. to watch, 512, 1754, 2070. Chauc. Cf. O.Fr. *gaiter*.

Waken, v. S. to watch, 630. *Waked*, *part. pa.* watched, kept awake, 2999.
See R. Br., Sq. of L. D. 852. Chauc.

Wakne, v. S. to wake, awaken, 2164.

Wan, *adv.* S. when, 1962.

War, *adj.* S. aware, wary, 788, 2139.

Warie, v. S. to curse, 433. *Waried*, *part. pa.* cursed, 434. Emare, 667. *Wery*,
Minot, p. 7. *Warrie*, Chauc. See Gl. Lynds.

Warp, *pa. t.* S. threw, cast, 1061.

Al swa feor swa a mon
Mihte *werpe*ⁿ ænne stan.
Lazam. l. 17428.

So in Sc. Doug. Virg. 432, and Barb. iii. 642. V. Jam.

Washen, v. S. to wash, 1233.

Waste *for* Was þe, 87.

Wastel, *n.* Fr. cake, or loaf made of finer flour, 878. *Wastels*, *pl.* 779. See
Todd's Illustr. of Chauc., who derives the name from *wastell*, the vessel
or basket in which the bread was carried. V. Du Cange, Spelm. Jam. In
Pegge's Form of Cury, p. 72, 159, we meet with *Wastels yfarced*.

Wat, *pron.* See [Hwat](#).

Wat, v. See [Quath](#).

Wat, *pp.* known, 1674. See [Wot](#).

Wawe, *n.* S. wall, 474, 2470. The phrase *bith wawe*, 474, is also found in
Rits. A. S. p. 46, which is left unexplained by the Editor, and is badly
guessed at by Ellis. By the aid of Moor's Suffolk Gl. we are enabled to
ascertain the meaning of an expression which is not yet obsolete. "By the

walls.” Dead and not buried. “A’ lie bi’ the walls” —said, I believe, only of a human subject. [This remark only applies to l. 474. In ll. 1963, 2470, the phrase refers to the benches placed round the walls in the great hall, whereon men slept at night, and sat in council by day.] Wowe, 1963, 2078. Still so pronounced in Lanc., &c.

Waxen. See [Wex](#).

Wayke, *adj. pl.* S. weak, 1012.

Wayte, Wayten. See [Waiten](#).

We, 115, 287, 392, 772. Apparently an error of the scribe for *wel*, but its frequent repetition may cause it to be doubted, whether the *l* may not have been purposely dropped.

Wede, *v.* See [Wade](#).

Wede, *n.* S. clothing, garments, 94, 323, 861. In very general use formerly, and still preserved in the phrase, a widow’s *weeds*.

Weddeth *for* Wedded, 1127.

Wei, Weie, *n.* S. way, road, 772, 952.

Weilawa, Weilawei, *interj.* S. woe! alas! 462, 570. See Gl. Sir Tr., Rits. M. R., and Chauc. [A.S. *wá la wá*, woe, lo! woe; now corrupted into *wellaway*.]

Wel, *adv.* S. full, *passim*. *Wel sixti*, 1747; *wel o-bon*. See On. *Wel with me*, 2878. *Wol*, 185.

Wel, *n.* S. weal, wealth, prosperity (*for wel ne for wo*), 2777.

Welde, *v.* S. to wield, govern (a kingdom), 129, 175; (a weapon), 1436; (possessions), 2034. *Weldes*, *pr. t. 2 p.* *wieldest*, governest, 1359.

Wende, *v.* S. to go, 1346, 1705, 2629. *Wenden*, *pr. t. pl. subj.* 1344. *Wende*, *pr. t. pl. 2 p.* go, 1440. *Wend*, *part. pa.* turned, 2138.

Wene, *v.* S. *pres. sing.* ween, think, 655, 840, 1260, &c. *Wenes*, *pr. t. 2 p.* thinkest, 598. *Wenestu*, 1787, thinkest thou. *Wend*, *Wende*, *pa. t.* thought, 374, 524, 1091, 1803, &c. *Wenden*, *pa. t. pl.* 1197, 2547.

Wepen, *pr. t.* or *pa. t. pl.* S. weep, wept, 401.

Wepne, *n.* S. weapon, 89, 490, 1436, &c.

Wer *for* Were, 1097.

Werd, *n.* S. world, 1290, 2241, 2335, 2792, 2968. *O worde*, in the world, 1349. Cf. *Ward* = world, in *Lancelot of the Laik*, and *Gen. and Exod.* ed. Morris, ll. 280, 591.

Were, *v.* S. [*werian*] to defend, 2152, 2298. Sir Tr. p. 156; Yw. and Gaw. 2578; Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R., V. 3, p. 289; K. of Tars, 189; Chauc. C. T. 2552, V. Note, p. 182. *Werie*, K. Horn, ed. Lumby, 785, Web., Minot, Gl. Lynds.

Were, should be, 2782. *Weren*, 3 *p. pl.* were, 156, &c.

Weren, 784. Sir F. Madden says—Garnett conjectured *weirs* or dams, from Isl. *ver*. [If *weren* be really a plural noun, I should prefer to translate it by *pools*; cf. A.S. *wær*, Icel. *ver*, Su.-Go. *wär*. Ihre says— “*Wär*, locus, ubi congregari amant pisces, ut solent inter brevia et vada. Isl. *ver*, *fiskaver*. A.S. id. unde *ver-hurde* apud Bens. custos septi piscatorii, Angl. *wier*, *wear*, &c.” See *wer* in Stratmann. In this case the line means— “in the sea-pools he often set them,” and the note on the line (q.v.) is wrong.]

Werewed, *part. pa.* S. worried, killed, 1915. [We should probably insert a mark of interrogation, thus— “Hwat dide he? þore weren he werewed,” i.e. “What did they effect? There were they slain.” Spelt *wirwed*, 1921. Cf. Du. *worgen*, and see Jam. s.v. *Wery*, and *Worry* in Atkinson’s Gl. of Cleveland dialect.]

Werne, *v.* S. to refuse, deny, 1345. *Werne*, *pr. t.* 3 *p. s. subj.* refuses, forbids, 926. Sir Tr. p. 88; K. Horn, 1420, &c.

Wesseyl, *n.* S. wassail, 1246.

Wesseylen, *pr. t. pl.* wassail, 2098. *Wosseyled*, *part. pa.* 1737. See Rits. A. S. Diss. p. xxxiii. *n.* Hearne’s Gl. to R. Glouc. in v. *Queme and Wasseyl*, Selden’s Notes on Drayton’s *Polyolb.* p. 150, and Nares.

Wex, *pa. t.* S. waxed, grew, 281. *Waxen*, *part. pa.* grown, 302, 791.

Wicke, Wike, Wikke, *adj.* S. wicked, vile, 66, 319, 425, 665, 688, &c.
Swithe wicke, 965, very mean. *Swiþe wikke cloþes*, 2458, very mean
clothing. *Wicke wede*, 2825, mean clothing.

Wicth, With, *n.* S. [*wiht*] whit, bit, small part, 97, 1763, 2500. Lazam.
l. 15031; Sevyn Sages, 293. 'The loue of hire ne lesteth no *wyht* longe,'
MS. Harl. 2253, f. 128.

Wicth, With, *adj.* courageous, stout, active, 344, 1008, 1064, 1651, 1692,
&c. *Wicteste*, *sup.* 9. An epithet used universally by the ancient poets, and
to be found in every Gloss. merely differing in orthography, as spelt
Waite, *Wate*, *Wight*, *Wich* &c. [Sir F. Madden suggests a derivation from
A.S. *hwæt* (Icel. *hvátr*), acute, brave. Wedgwood suggests Sw. *vig*,
nimble. Cf. Su.-Goth. *wig*, Icel. *vigr*, fit for war (A.S. *wig*).]

Wider, *adv.* S. whither, where, 1139.

Widuen, Wydues, *n. pl.* S. widows, 33, 79.

Wif, *n.* S. wife, 2860; woman, 1713. *Wiues*, *pl.* 2855.

Wike, Wikke. See [Wicke](#).

Wil, *adv.* S. while, 6.

Wil, *adj.* lost in error, uncertain how to proceed, 863; at a loss, without
experience, 1042. Wynt. vi. 13, 115. V. Jam. who derives it from Su.-G.
wild, Isl. *villr*. It is radically the same with *wild*.

Wile, will, 352, 485, &c. *Wilde*, 528, 1135, wilt thou; *Wiltu*, 681, 905. *Wilen*,
pl. 732, 920, 1345, 2817, &c.

Wille, *n.* S. will, 528.

Wimman, *n.* S. woman, 1139, 1168, &c. *Wman*, 281. *Wymman*, 1156.

Win, *n.* S. wine, 1729. *Wyn*, 2341.

Winan, *v.* S. to get to, arrive at, 174. V. Gl. to *Will. of Palerne*.

Winne, *n.* S. joy, gain, 660, 2965. *Muchere winne*, Lazam. l. 10233. Horn
Childe, ap. Rits. M. R., V. 3, p. 294.

Wirchen, *v.* S. to work, cause, 510.

Wirwed. See [Werewed](#).

Wis, *adj.* S. wise, prudent, 180, 1421, 1635; skilled, 282.

Wislike, *adv.* S. wisely, 274.

Wisse, *v.* S. to direct, ordain, advice, 104, 361. Sir Tr. p. 29; K. Horn, Chron. of Engl. 499; Chauc., Gl. Lynds.

Wissing, *n.* S. advice, or conduct, 2902.

Wiste, *pa. t.* S. knew, 115, 358, 541, &c. *Wisten*, *pa. t. pl.* 1184, 1187, 1200, &c.

Wit, *prep.* S. with, 52, 505, 701, 905, 1090, 2517, &c.; by, 2489. *Wituten*, 179, 247, 2860, without. *Withuten*, 425, except. *With than*, provided that, 532. *With that*, 1220.

Wite, *v.* S. [*wítan*, decernere] *pres. subj. or imp.* decree, ordain, 19, 1316.

Wite, *v.* S. *pres. subj. or imp.* preserve, guard, defend, 405, 559. R. Gl. p. 98, 102. So in the *Carmen inter Corpus & Animam*, MS. Digb. 86.

The king that al this world shop thoru his holi miztte,
He wite houre soule from then heuele wiztte.

And in the French Romance of Kyng Horn, MS. Harl. 527, f. 72, b. c. 2.

Ben iurez *Wite God*, kant auerez beu tant,
Kant le vin uus eschaufe, si seez si iurant.

Wite, Witen, *v.* S. [*witan*, cognoscere] to know, 367, 625, 2201, 2786; to recollect, 2708. *Wite*, *pr. t. pl. 2 p.* know, 2808; *imp. 3 p.* wite, know, 517. *Wite*, *3 p. s. subj.* (if) he know, 694. *Witen*, *pr. t. pl. 2 p.* know, 2208. See [Wot](#).

With, *conj.* See [Wit](#).

With, *n.* See [Wicth](#).

With, *adj.* See [Wicth](#).

With, *adj.* S. white, 48, 1144.

With-sitten, *v.* S. to oppose, 1683. R. Br., Web.

Wlf, *n.* S. wolf, 573.

Wluine, *n.* S. she-wolf, 573. Dan. *ulfinde*, a she-wolf.

Wman. See [Wimman](#).

Wnden, *part. pa.* S. wound, 546.

Wo, *pron.* S. who, whoso, 76, 79, &c. See [Hwo](#).

Wo, *n.* S. woe, sorrow, 510, &c.

Wod, *adj.* S. mad, 508, 1777, 1848, &c. *Wode*, *pl.* 1896, 2361.

Wok, *pa. t.* S. awoke, 2093.

Wol. See [Wel](#).

Wole, will, 1150. *Wolde*, *would*, 354, 367, &c. *Wode*, 951, 2310. *Wolden*, *pl.* 456, 514, 1057.

Wombes, *n. pl.* S. bellies, 1911.

Wom so, *pron.* S. whomso, 197.

Won, Wone, great number, plenty, in phr. *ful god won*, in great quantity (*in* 1791 *it seems to mean* with great force), 1024, 1791, 1837, 1907, 2325, 2617, 2729. R. Gl., Horn Childe, ap. Rits. M. R., V. 3, p. 308, 314; R. Cœur de L. 3747; K. Alisaund, 1468; K. of Tars, 635; Minot, p. 14; Chauc. *Wane*, Yw. and Gaw. 1429; *Wayn*, Wall. viii. 947. Cf. Gl. to *Will. of Palerne*.

Wone, *n.* S. (probably the same as *ween*, Sir Tr. p. 59, 78), opinion, conjecture, 1711, 1972. Cf. l. 816, and the Glossaries, in v. *Wene*.

Wone, *v.* S. to dwell, 247, 406. *Woneth*, *pr. t.* 3 p. dwelleth, 105.

Wone, *part. pa.* wont, 2151, 2297. K. Horn, 36; R. Gl. Chron. of Engl. 632; Web., Chauc. [A.S. *wune*, a custom.]

Wonges, *n. pl.* S. fields, plains, 397, 1444. Cf. l. 1360. Spelman thinks arable land is meant by the term, rather than pasture.

Wore, 2 and 3 p. s. were, 504, 684, &c. *Wore*, *Woren*, *pl.* 237, 448, &c. It is not merely a licentious spelling, as conjectured by Sir W. Scott.

Worþe, v. S. *imp.* may he be, 1102, 2873. *Wrth*, 434. *Wurþe*, 2221. Lazam. l. 28333. Sir Tr. p. 49, and all the Gloss., including Lynds.

Wosseyled. See [Wesseylen](#).

Wot, Woth, *pr. t. 1 p.* S. know, 119, 213, 653, 1345, &c. *Wost*, *pr. t. 2 p.* knowest, 527, 582, 1384, &c. *Woth*, *pr. t. 3 p.* knows, 2527. *Wot*, *pl. 1 p.* know, 2803. *Wat*, *part. pa.* known, 1674.

Wowe. See [Wawe](#).

Wrathe, n. S. wrath, anger, 2719, 2977. See [Wroth](#).

Wreieres, n. *pl.* S. betrayers, spoilers, 39.

The *wraiers* that weren in halle,
Schamly were thai schende.

Sir Tristr. p. 190.

Wreken, v. S. to avenge, revenge, 327, 1901. *Wreke*, *imp.* revenge (thou), 1363. *Wreken* (*miswritten for wreke*), 3 *p. imp.* 544. *Wreke*, *pr. pl. subj.* 1884. *Wreke*, *Wreken*, *part. pa.* revenged, 2368, 2849, 2992. Sir Tr. p. 190, &c.

Wringen, v. S. to wring, 1233.

Writ, n. S. writing, 2486. *Writes*, *pl.* writs, letters, 136, 2275. See [note to l. 136](#).

Wrobberes, n. *pl.* S. robbers, 39.

Wros, n. *pl.* corners, 68. So in the *Leg. of S. Margrete*, quoted by Dr Leyden:

Sche seiþe a wel fouler thing
Sitten in a wro;

which Jamieson aptly derives from the Su.-G. *wraa*, angulus. Cf. Dan. *vraa*, a nook, corner.

Wroth, *adj.* S. wrath, angry, 1117. *Wroþe*, 2973. See [Wrathe](#).

Wrouht, *pa. t.* S. wrought, 2810. *Wrouth*, 1352. *Wrowht*, 2453.

Wrth. See [Worthe](#).

Wunde, *n.* S. wound, 1980, 2673, &c. *Wounde*, 1978. *Wundes*, *pl.* 1845, 1898, 1986. *Woundes*, 1977, &c.

Wurpe. See [Worpe](#).

[Y](#)

Y, *pron.* I. See [Ich](#).

Ya, *adv.* S. yea, yes, 1888, 2009, 2607. *Ye*, 2606. See Rits. note to Yw. and Gaw. l. 43. In l. 2009, we should probably have found *yis* in a more southern work. See the note to *zis* in Gl. to *Will. of Palerne*. The distinction between *no* (l. 1800) and *nay* (l. 1136) is rightly made.

Yaf. See [Yeue](#).

Yare, *adj.* S. ready, 1391, 2788, 2954. Sir Tr. p. 28; Rits. M. R., Web., Chauc., Gl. Lynds.

Yaren, *v.* S. to make ready, 1350. This word in all the Gloss. has the form of *Yarken*.

Yede, *pa. t.* S. went, 6, 774, 821, &c. *Yeden*, *pa. t. pl.* 889, 952.

Yeft. See [Giue](#).

Yelde, *v.* S. to yield, 2712; *imp.* 3 *p.* requite, 803. Very common formerly in this sense. *Yeld*, *imp.* yield (thou), 2717.

Yeme, *v.* S. to take charge of, govern, 131, 172, 182, 324, &c. *Yemed*, *pa. t.* governed, 975, 2276. Sir Tr. p. 115, Rits. M. R., Web., R. Gl., Chauc.

Yen. See [Agen](#).

Yerne, *adv.* S. eagerly, anxiously, 153, 211, 880, 925. Web., Rits. M. R., Chauc.

Yerne, *v.* S. to desire earnestly, 299. Lazam. l. 4427. K. Horn, 1419; R. Br., Chauc., Gl. Lynds.

Yete, *adv.* S. yet, 495, 973, 996, 1043.

Yeue, *v.* S. to give, 298, &c. *Yeueth*, *pr. t.* 3 *p.* giveth, 459. *Yif*, *imp.* give (thou), 674; 3 *p.* *yeue*, 22; *pl.* *yeueþ*, 911. *Yaf*, *pa. t.* gave, or gave heed,

315, 419, &c. *Gaf*, 218, 418, 1311, &c. *Gouen*, *pa. t. pl.* 164 (in phr. *gouen hem ille*, gave themselves up to grief); *Sir Tr.* p. 129. *Giue*, *part. pa.* 2488; *gouen*, 220. *Youenet* = *Youen it*, given it, 1643. For *yaf* in l. 1174, see [note on the line](#).

Y-here. See [Here](#), v.

Yif, *prep.* S. if, 126, 377, 1974, &c. *Yf*, 1189.

Yif. See [Yeue](#).

Y-lere. See [Lere](#).

Ynow. See [Inow](#).

Youenet. See [Yeue](#).

Ys. See [note to l. 1174](#).

Yuel, Yuele. See [Iuele](#).

Yunge, *adj.* S. young, 368, &c.

Yure, *pron.* S. your, 171.

INDEX OF NAMES TO “HAUELOK.”

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ATHELWOLD (*spelt* Apelwald, l. 1077), is king of England, and governs wisely, pp. 2, 3;
feels he is dying, p. 4;
bequeaths his daughter to the care of Godrich, pp. 6, 7;
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Auelok, *another spelling of* Haelok, 1395, 1793.

BERNARD BRUN (i.e. Bernard Brown; so called in ll. 1751, 1945),
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BERTRAM (*named* in l. 2898),
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BIRKABEYN (*spelt* Bircabein, l. 494);
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Cestre (Chester), 2607, 2859, 2896.

Cornwayle (Cornwall), 178, 2908;
Cornwalie, 884.

Crist, 16, &c.;
—krist, 22;
gen. kristes, 2797.

Dauy, seint, 2863.

Denemark (Denmark), 340, 381, 386, &c.

Denshe, *sing. adj.* Danish, 1403;
pl. 2575, 2693, 2938.
Danshe, 2689.

Douere (Dover), 139, 265.
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Engelond (England), 59, 202, 250, &c.;
—Engellond, 1093;
—Engelonde, 208;
—Englond, 1270;
—Engeland, 108, 610;
—Hengelond, 999;
gen. Engelondes, 63.

Englishe, *pl. adj.* (*followed by men*), 2766, 2795;
—Englis (*used absolutely*), 254;
—Henglishe, 2945.

Giffin [*Qu.* Griffin] Galle, 2029.

GODARD (*gen.* Godardes, l. 2415),
is made regent of Denmark, pp. 12, 13;
shuts up Birkabeyn's children in a castle, p. 13;
kills Swanborow and Helfled, p. 15;
spares Havelok, p. 16;
but afterwards hires Grim to drown Havelok, p. 17;
is attacked by Havelok, p. 67;
is taken prisoner, p. 68;
condemned, flayed, drawn, and hung, pp. 70, 71.

GODRICH (*spelt* Godrigh, l. 178),

- is Earl of Cornwall, p. 6;
- is made regent of England, pp. 7, 8, 9;
- shuts Goldborough up in Dover castle, p. 10;
- makes Goldborough marry Havelok, p. 33;
- raises an army against Havelok, p. 72;
- excites his men, p. 73;
- marches to Grimsby, p. 74;
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- fights with Havelok, pp. 77, 78;
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GOLDEBORU (*or* Goldeborw, l. 2985),

- is daughter of King Athelwold, p. 4;
- is committed to the care of Godrich, pp. 8, 9;
- shut up in Dover castle, p. 11;
- is sent for to Lincoln, p. 33;
- is married to Havelok, p. 36;
- hears an angel's voice, p. 39;
- encourages Havelok to go to Denmark, p. 41;
- rejoices at Godrich's death, p. 81;
- is queen of England, p. 85.

See [Havelok](#).

GRIM, a fisher, is hired by Godard to drown Havelok, p. 17;
discovers Havelok to be the right heir to the crown, p. 19;
takes Havelok over to England, p. 20;
founds Grimsby, p. 23;
sends Havelok to Lincoln, p. 26;
dies, p. 37.

[In l. 2333, there seems to be an allusion to a spectacle, in which the history of Grim is represented.]

Grimes, *gen. c. of* Grim, 1343, 1392, 2867.

Grimesbi, 745, 2540, 2579, 2617, 2619;

—Grimesby, 1202.

Gunnild (daughter of Grim, marries Earl Reyner of Chester), 2866, 2896.
Gunter (an English earl), 2606.

HAUELOK, son of king Birkabeyn of Denmark, p. 13;
spared by Godard, p. 16;
but given over by him to Grim to be drowned, p. 17;
spared and fed by Grim, p. 20;
goes to England, p. 22;
sells fish, p. 25;
works as a porter, p. 27;
puts the stone, p. 31;
marries Goldborough, p. 35;
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returns to Denmark, p. 43;
trades there, p. 44;
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is known to be heir of Denmark by a miraculous light, p. 60;
is dubbed knight by Ubbe, p. 65;
is king of Denmark, p. 66;
defeats Godard, p. 68;
invades England, p. 72;
defeats Godrich, p. 77;
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lives to be a hundred years old, p. 83;
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is king for sixty years, p. 85.

[The story is called "þe gest of Hauelok and of Goldeborw," l. 2985.]

Helfled (Havelok's sister), 411.

Hengelsonde (England), 999.

Henglishe (*pl.* English), 2945.

Humber (the river), 733.

Huwe Rauen (one of Grim's sons), 1398, 1868, 2349, 2636, 2677;

spelt Hwe, 1878.

Iohan, seint; the patron saint to whom Havelok commits his Danes, 2957;
bi seint Iohan! 1112, 2563.

Spelt Ion, 177.

Iudas, 319, 425, 1133.

Lazarun (= Lazarum, *acc.* of Lazarus), 331.

Cf. “Lord” —said Guy— “that reared *Lazaroun*,” &c. Guy of
Warwick, in Ellis, *Met. Rom.* (ed. Halliwell), p. 227.

Leue (Grim’s wife), 558, 576, 595, 642.

Leuiue (Grim’s daughter, married to Bertram), 2914.

Lincolne, 773, 847, 862, 980, 1105, 2558, 2572, 2824.

Lindeseye (N. part of Lincolnshire), 734.

Lundone (London), 2943.

Marz (March), 2559.

Reyner (earl of Chester), 2607.

Roberd þe rede (Grim’s eldest son), 1397, 1686, 1888, &c.;

—Robert, 2405, 2411, &c.;

gen. Roberdes, 1691.

Rokesborw (explained by Prof. Morley to mean Rokeby, but it is surely
Roxburgh), 265;

—Rokesburw, 139.

Roxburgh is spelt *Rokesburgh* in Walsingham, ed. Riley, i. 340, &c.

Sathanas (Satan), 1100, 1134, 2512.

Swanborow (Havelok’s sister), 411.

UBBE, a great Danish lord, p. 44;

entertains Havelok, p. 45;

takes him to his castle, p. 57;

does homage to Havelok, p. 63;

dubs him knight, p. 65;

his combat with Godrich, p. 75;
is sorely wounded, p. 76.

Willam Wendut (one of Grim's sons), 1690, 1881, 1892, 2348, 2632;
—Wiliam Wenduth, 1398.

Winchestre, 158, 318.

Yerk (York), 1178.

Ynde, India, 1085.

JOHN CHILDS AND SON, PRINTERS.

Transcriber's Note on Texts:

This book exists in at least two forms, distinguished by minor differences in the modern (1868) material. The title page(s), verso and introduction give no hint that there were any changes or additions; references to the “former” and “present” edition are to Madden alone (Roxburghe, 1828) contrasted with Skeat (EETS, 1868). For convenience the two 1868 variants will be called “preliminary” and “final”. The 1975 reprint used the “final” version.

Emendations:

p. 24, [l. 784](#). Perhaps we should, however, read *se-weren*, and the note on the line (p. 93) may be wrong. See *Weren* in the Glossary.

The preliminary version of the Emendations reads:

... Perhaps there should be no stop in the line, and ...

There are no differences in the body text or Note.

The last five Emendations— changes to glossary items *Greting*, *Hal*, *Shoten* (*Schoten*), [Teyte](#), *Bise*— are missing from the preliminary version.

Glossary:

Datheit, *interj.* ... [from the O.F. *hait*, pleasure].

In the preliminary version, the bracketed addition reads “possibly from *hair*, to hate”.

Pastees ... Al of *pasteiis* beth the walles.

The preliminary version has the apparent error *pasteüs*.

Weren ...

The preliminary version is printed without brackets but is otherwise identical.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE LAY OF
HAVELOK THE DANE ***

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